MY DIARISED LIFE.... IN RETIREMENT

aka A REPURPOSED EXISTENCE

PATRICK A ERNEST

2020 - 2025

R E T I R E M E N T M I S S I O N S T A T E M E N T

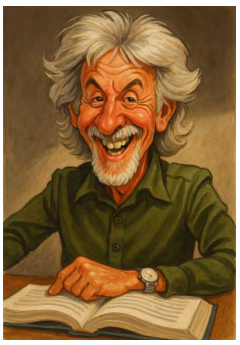
It is my intention to be a successful retiree by ensuring;

- *I Maintain and improve my relationship with Janny and actively contribute to improving her quality of life and happiness,*
- *I Strive for personal fulfilment and growth in retirement by way of remaining challenged and involved through purposeful activities, and*
- *I Keep fit and motivated*

P A ERNEST – June, 2019

A Repurposed Existence

Best to get busy…. the clock is ticking!



When I was approaching that point of time in my life when I could see retirement on the horizon, I dutifully commenced planning for this significant and final life phase. Fortunately for me I could envision, in a roundabout way, what retired life could look like. The word retirement, in my opinion, didn't really reflect this stage of my life. The word *repurposed* was more fitting. I wanted to have a new purpose. I wanted to keep working, but with a renewed resolution, one that was based on "giving back" and giving my time freely. It would appear that all roads in my life have led to this "Third Age" of my existence. It is ultimately my obligation to use all of my life's learnings, experiences, setbacks and successes to position myself to give back – to somehow make a difference.

Concurrently, my intention was to continue documenting my journey, hence this text is a continuation of *My Diarised Life*, which detailed my life during my working years. At the commencement of compiling this text, I had been repurposed for four years. I am amazed how those four years have gone so quickly. Jann and I have completed and achieved a lot, even during the dark days of the Covid lockdowns.

I will continue to acquire great joy from the occassional flick through of my diarised books and, who knows, perhaps others may enjoy what is amassed within these pages.

What follows are snippets, mementos, notations, recollections, hopes, dreams, achievements, thoughts and highlights from my diaries, in and throughout my Third Age….2020 onwards. It serves as documented evidence that so much is happening within my jurisdiction.

A diarised collage of a repurposed existence and an addendum to my autobiography.

Life….in overdrive

Repurposed

I knew that at some point in time
my pursuits will become more purposeful.
A deep held desire to give back,
Now's not the time to be regretful

I am now unshackled
Unconstrained, I can now write
My world appears so much larger
To my creative and artistic delight

It's late in the third quarter
and I'm kicking with the breeze
I'm compiling lots of obsessions
and I'm very much at ease

I now pen biographies
and interview punters at will,
elderly lives unfolding before me
providing a perpetual thrill

I turn my pursuits inward
to penning my family's stories,
in providing a lasting family legacy
outlining our family glories…
from extensive domestic inventories.

For some unknown reason
I have a propensity to write
Compiling all my thoughts composed
And hiding in plain sight

I am four years into the journey
and I'm appreciating more and more
how grateful I am
than ever I was before

An election again looms,
time to work for the bureaucracy
A chance to do our bit
and deliver Australian democracy

A need to count the populace
Boots on the ground required
Again we are called upon
Our services much desired

A strong yearning I have
to see this planet before I depart,
to travel us much as I can
and with my dearest sweetheart,
wondrous stories we can impart

They are new Australians,
finding their way to our shores.
I tutor them in our lingo
So that they may open many doors

When my music becomes somewhat vague
and by some means fails to resonate
It would be best that I acknowledge
that perhaps this is my checkmate

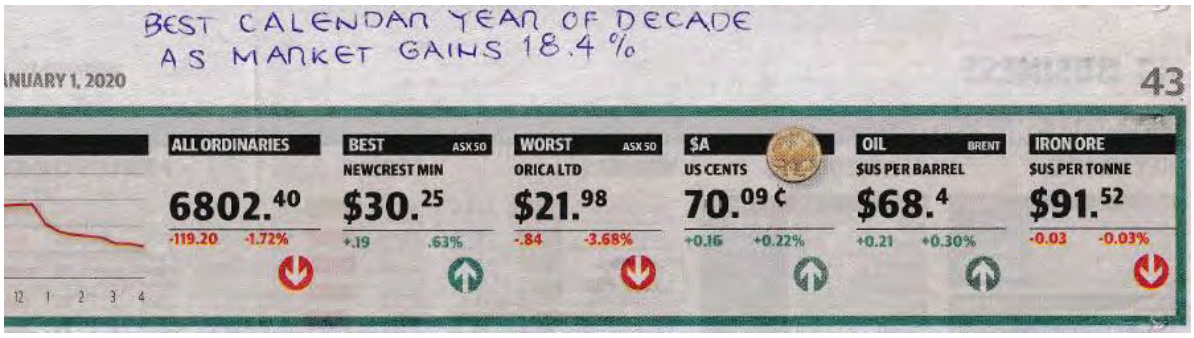
I have worked for forty years
as a means to an end,
and at its conclusion
a repurposed life I befriend,
because now the clock is ticking
and a fulfilled life hence will depend.

2020

2020 was obliterated by a global pandemic.
Refer to my text

A
CORONAVIRUS
JOURNAL

Wednesday January 1, 2020



Looks like the market, and by association Superannuation funds, are going to have a great year.

Sunday January 12, 2020

Neil Peart, legendary drummer and lyricist with RUSH, has died at age 67 from brain cancer. I reached out to Jim Griffin upon hearing the news.

Saturday January 25, 2020

WHEN his children asked him for a lift to the shops, Paul Averte was running out of excuses.

He really just didn't have the energy.

He weighed 157kg and couldn't walk 100m without feeling exhausted.

He was sitting in the family home in Bulleen one Sunday, watching his wife lead their two eldest children to the car to take them to the shopping centre.

"It suddenly hit me like a tonne of bricks that they were 16 and 17 at the time and, pretty soon, they wouldn't need me to drive them anywhere because they'd be able to drive themselves," Averte says.

"I was running out of time to do those simple family chores.

"Plus, we were going on a family holiday to Europe and I knew I'd need a seatbelt extension (on the plane) and I really didn't want that."

The 49-year-old automotive engineer says he gradually began gaining weight in year 12, using eating to relieve the stress of exams.

But the following years at university

OVEREATING

were even more stressful and resulted in him mixing the high calories of alcohol with a cocktail of takeaway food, anxiety and little exercise.

"We'd leave the pub and grab an extra-large pizza while we were waiting for the taxi, washed down with a large bottle of Coke," he says.

"But the worst habit I accumulated was always ordering more food than I needed whether I was in a takeaway or an elegant restaurant — an extra plate of fries, an extra bowl of pasta or some more wontons.

"I'd always buy too much food, particularly bread, at the supermarket too and that habit continued through my 20s, 30 and 40s."

He had tried many diets but turned to the Cambridge Weight Plan which changed his life.

In nine months, he lost 75.2kg and is now on a maintenance program.

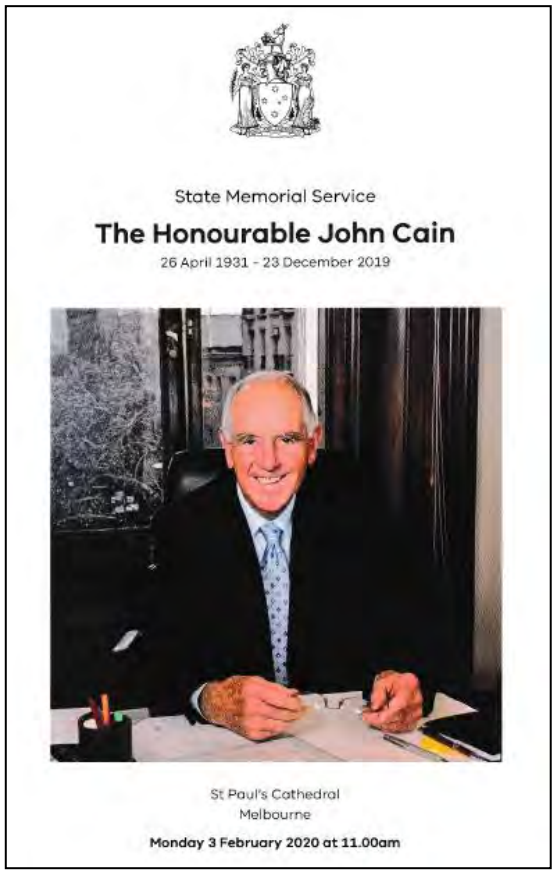
His meals were supplied but consisted of porridge for breakfast which he still loves, rice, curries, pasta and snacks of protein bars and shakes.

"Being a very large person when I started, food was all about volume for me," he says. "I needed to feel full so I started eating more slowly.

"That was the other good habit I adopted and it changed everything.

"At first, I had to force myself to eat slowly but now I go out for lunch with the guys from work and they're wanting to get back to the office while I'm still going."

I cut this article out of the Saturday Herald Sun. I worked with Paul Averte (above) for many years. His job involved sitting at his CAD station all day and he only ever moved to eat. His problem wasn't just overeating.
He was a fair-dinkum big bloke. An amazing transformation.



Monday February 3, 2020

Janny and I attended the State Memorial Service for former Premier John Cain at St Paul's Cathedral.

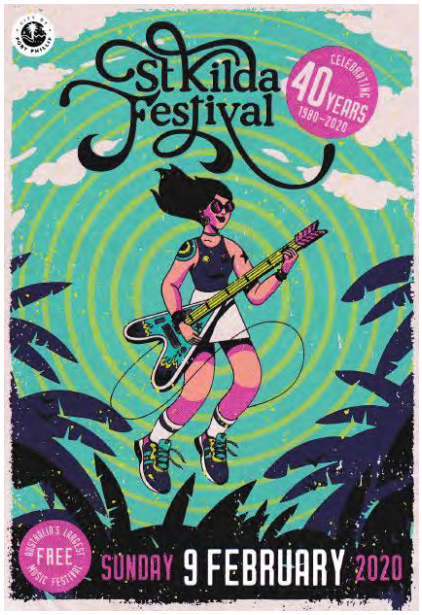
Without doubt the best Victorian Labor Premier this state has ever had.

"A straight shooter, a good egg, honest and decent".

"If there's an easy way and a hard way, pick the right way".

Wednesday February 5, 2020

Completed my 10th blood plasma donation today.



Sunday February 9, 2020

Janny and I attended the St Kilda Festival today.

Tuesday February 11, 2020

Janny and I picked up Savvy so she could attend an appointment with;
Dr. Fiona Simpson – 8 Laver Street, Kew.

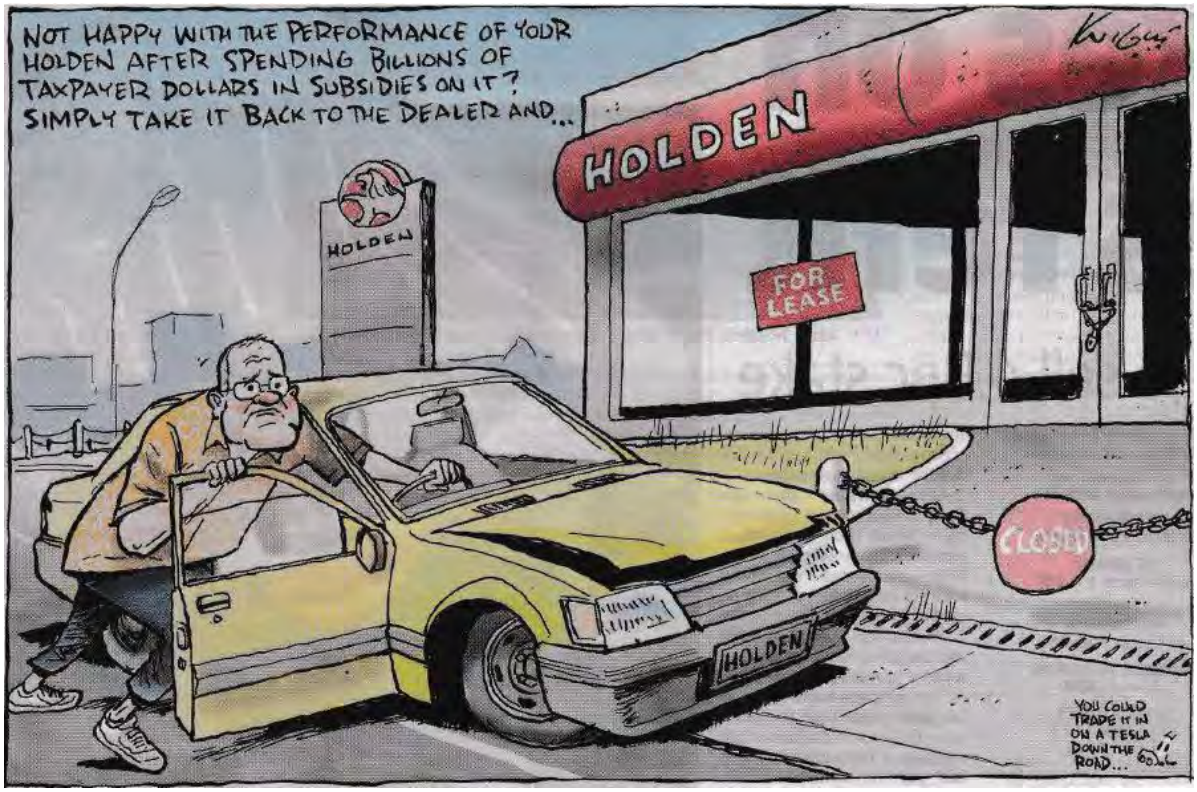
"It was quite a journey and challenge trying to find the Doctor's practice. Once located, the waiting room was old, musty smelling with overgrown dead plants.
Accordingly, Dr. Simpson's appearance did not surprise me, as she fitted in well in her environment – she was old, slightly dishevelled, terrible teeth and on crutches".

Tuesday February 18, 2020

E N D O F T H E L I O N
R U S T I N P E A C E H O L D E N

Anger as Aussie icon axed.
Holden brand retired in Australia and New Zealand.

Sung to the tune of;
"Football, meatpies, kangaroos and Holden cars"
Women's football
Vegie pies
Labradoodles and
Hyundai's
Just doesn't do it for me!



Nothing surprises me when it comes to the Australian Automotive industry. Breaks my heart when you think where we have come from, to this.

Friday February 28, 2020

Sent this email to Rob Hine on the occasion of his retirement.

Rob Hine <r.hine@dci.com.au>
RE: A NEW BEGINNING
28/02/2020 9:44 AM

To
'deadlyernest' <deadlyernest@bigpond.com>

Thank you very much Pat,

Your kind words mean a lot.

It has been a pleasure and privilege knowing you over these years and I greatly appreciate your mentoring, guidance and assistance not only in a working capacity but in life in general. You have helped shape that person that I am for the better.

We fly out to Bali tomorrow for a lazy week then it will be off camping with our first trip up to the origin of the Murray River in the Snowy Mountains and then following it for its entirety.

Take care mate and hope to catch up soon.

My new email is:

robandkimhine@yahoo.com and I will retain my old number.

Regards

Rob Hine

From: deadlyernest [mailto:deadlyernest@bigpond.com]
Sent: Thursday, 27 February 2020 7:19 PM
To: r.hine@dci.com.au
Subject: A NEW BEGINNING

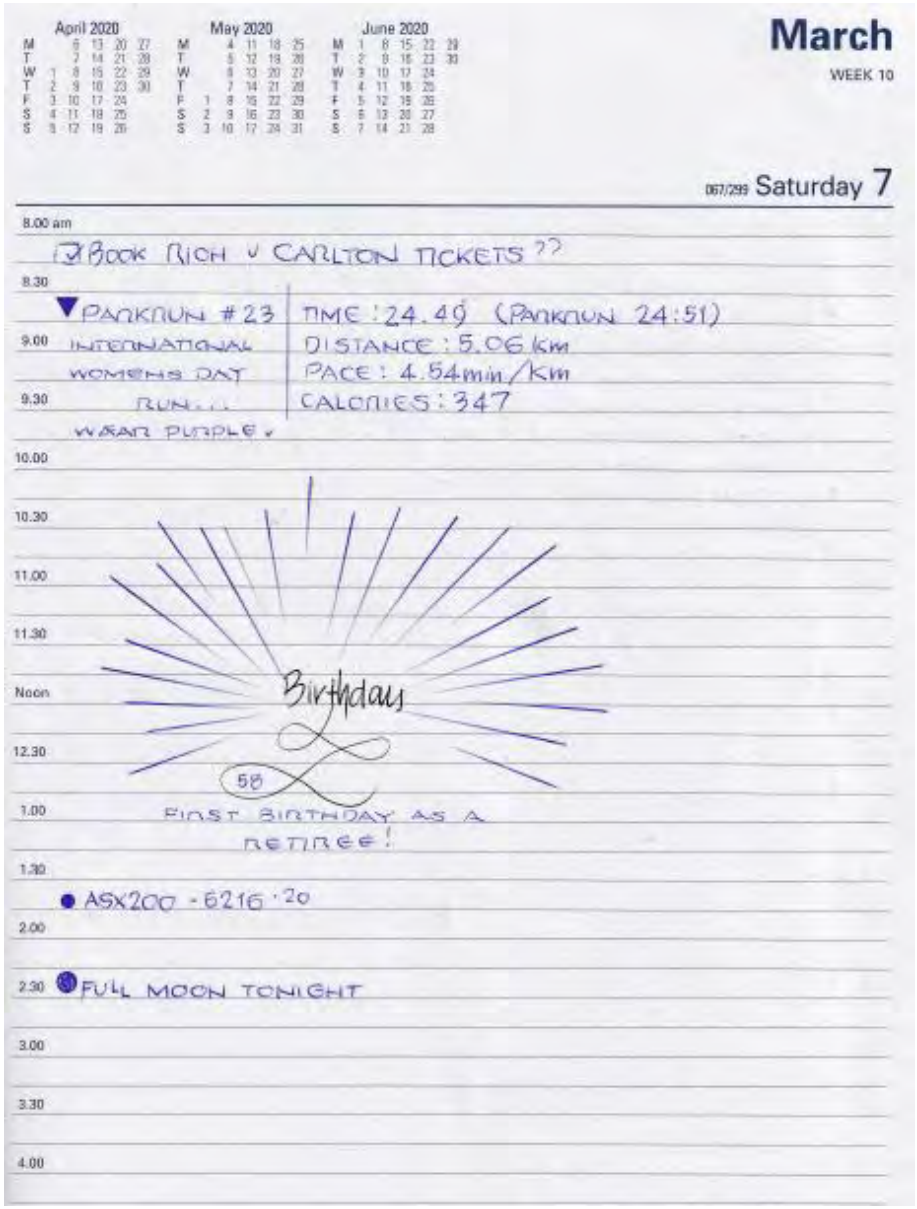
Good morning Rob,
By my reckoning (and if there has been no changes to your plans), today is your retirement day.
To that end I would to extend my heartfelt congratulations to you.
Throughout the journey you have been a good friend and a terrific work colleague.
I believe we made a good team, navigating the challenges that Q101, Q1 and TS16949 threw at us. (Thorpy was useful as well but don't tell him that).
As you enter the third stage of your life, I would like to wish you and Kim all the very best as retirees and Happy Birthday for tomorrow.
Stay safe.

Cheers,
Pat

PS - apologies for not being able to attend your farewell - I have a volunteer appointment this morning.

. . . .

Saturday March 7, 2020



Note the "??" marks following the diary entry task to book Richmond v Carlton tickets. Something was looming.

Tuesday March 17, 2020
Our 30th Wedding Anniversary

Dear Mr & Mrs Ernest,
Welcome back after 30 years! It is fantastic to see you again after so long. Please enjoy these amenities to help celebrate your 30th anniversary. If you need anything please let us know.
Kindest regards,
Katherine Vadnjal
Guest Relations

Janny and I stayed at the Grand Hyatt to celebrate our 30th Wedding Anniversary – the same hotel we stayed at on our wedding night.

I sent my thoughts to The Age on the **23rd of July, 2020;**

Dear Sir/Madam,

Please see my thoughts below;

If only he knew!

After reading Wayne Campbell's heartfelt and personal tribute to the late Shane Tuck, I couldn't help but feel that if Shane was aware of his sentiments, he may very well still be with us. Should all of us be making a greater effort to make those around us more cognizant of their significance and impact? Whilst his words were very moving, it's a shame it's post-mortem.

Pat Ernest – Kew

Friday July 31, 2020

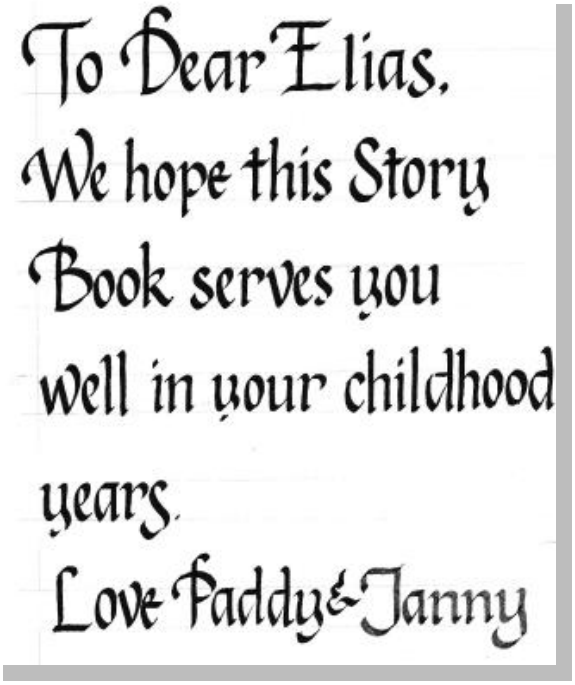
NO LUNCH FOR YOU!.

Spare a thought for our much loved radio titan John Burns, who signs off this week. Dubbed Sir Lunchalot for his famous long lunches, Burnso won't even be getting that, thanks to the coronavirus horror show.

. . . .

Saturday November 28, 2020

We gifted young Elias with a story book.

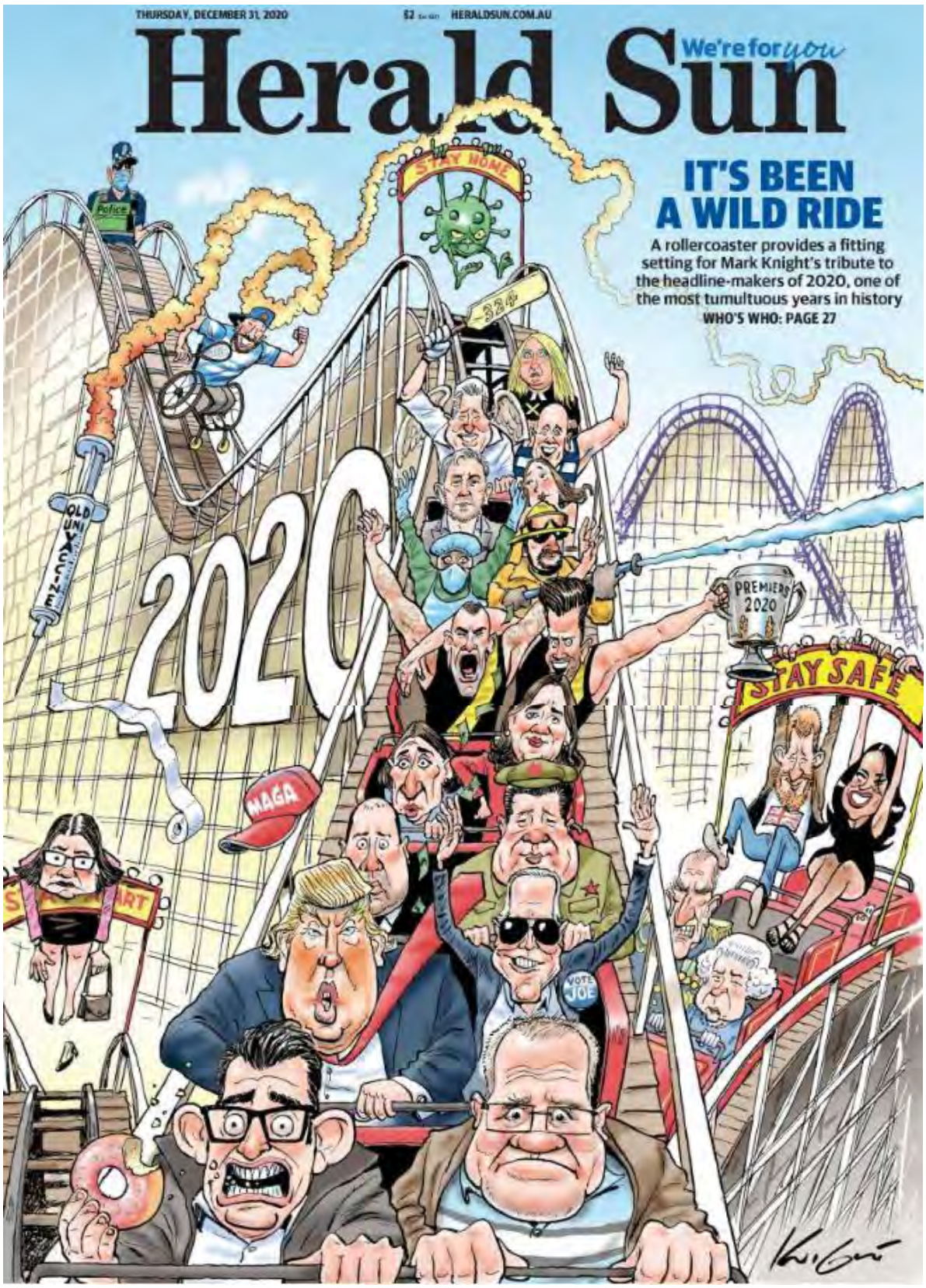


In May of this year I penned my thoughts regarding the Australian national anthem "Advance Australia Fair", basically endorsing Mike Sheahan's proposal to change it to "I Am Australian".
It was published in the 50/50 column of the Herald Sun in the same month.

50/50

I AGREE with Mike Sheahan (*SHS*, 3/5), the anthem is a dirge and difficult to sing. Few people know the words. *I Am Australian* is the obvious replacement.
Arthur Scott, Dromana

I'M with Mike. Truth be told, I have not given a lot of thought to our anthem. Perhaps that's part of the problem. I've always felt *Advance Australia Fair* is a bit clunky and difficult to sing. I listened again to *I Am Australian*, and it is inclusive of our indigenous heritage and culture, as well as all those who have come from afar to build our wonderful nation. Thanks Mike, for opening my tear-filled eyes.
Pat Ernest, Kew



Farewell 2020

Refer to my Coronavirus Journal, which outlines how wild a ride it was.

2021

The ravages of Covid continue.

Saturday January 2, 2021
Boulevard Run
Time: 49.17
Distance: 8.40km
Pace: 5.52min/km
Calories: 581

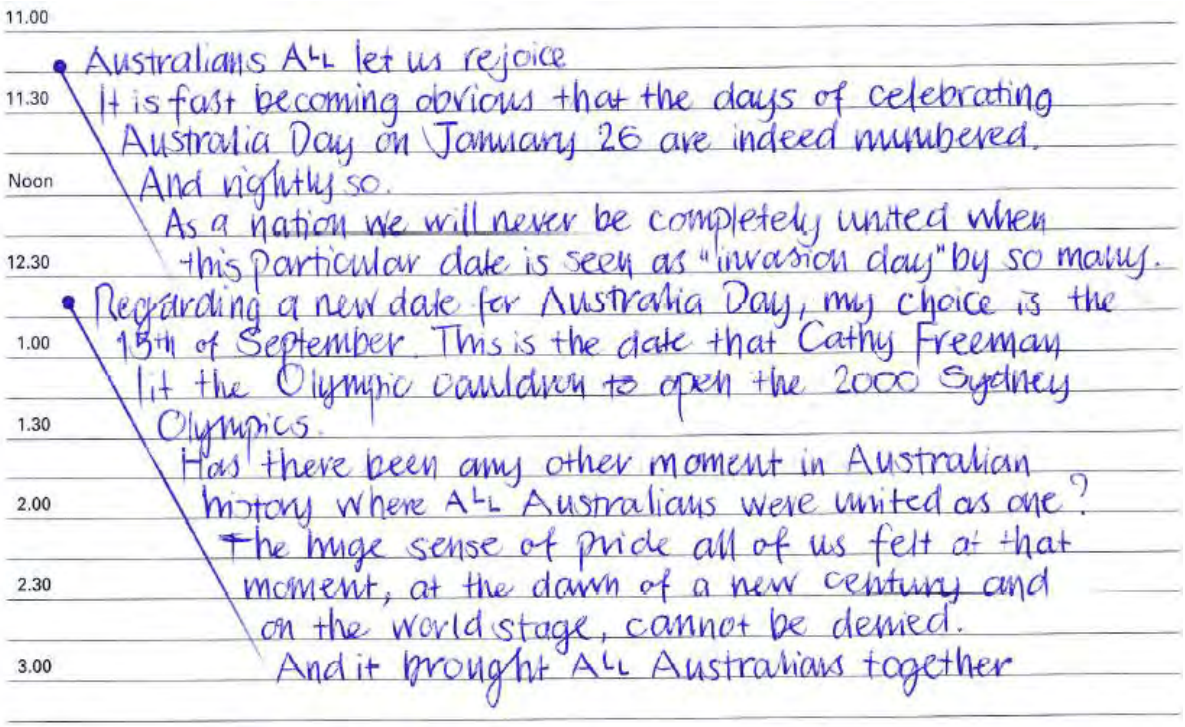
Wednesday January 6, 2021
Mob Rules: Trump's deplorables descend on Washington, smash their way into Congress – 5 dead!
The death and destruction that was inflicted upon Washington is what happens when the cynical prey upon the niave.
I: lack of experience or informed judgement

Sunday January 10, 2021
Love him or hate him, Donald Trump will be remembered as one of this century's most facinating figures. Will he make a comeback?

Monday January 11, 2021
Janny and me departed for Halls Gap today.

Wednesday January 20,2021
NBN was connected to our home today by Dan and his (big) team. We contacted Telstra to get a modem. A Telstra technician will visit and set it up.

Friday January 22, 2021


11.00
Australians ALL let us rejoice
11.30 It is fast becoming obvious that the days of celebrating Australia Day on January 26 are indeed numbered.
Noon And rightly so.
As a nation we will never be completely united when
12.30 this particular date is seen as "invasion day" by so many.
Regarding a new date for Australia Day, my choice is the
1.00 15th of September. This is the date that Cathy Freeman lit the Olympic cauldron to open the 2000 Sydney
1.30 Olympics.
Has there been any other moment in Australian
2.00 history where ALL Australians were united as one?
The huge sense of pride all of us felt at that
2.30 moment, at the dawn of a new century and on the world stage, cannot be denied.
3.00 And it brought ALL Australians together

My diary thoughts regarding a new date for Australia Day.

. . . .

Friday January 29, 2021
Current projects;

- Volunteer tutor
- Internet modem
- TV streaming services
- Book binding (memoir)
- Reschedule Bali
- Autobiography
- Towbar on Mazda 2
- Read Noel Whittaker
- NAB Trade
- Workplace Health & Safety
- "The Two of Us" – print

Friday February 1, 2021

"If you're curios and determined, you can do whatever you want up to most any age"

Lorraine Bayly

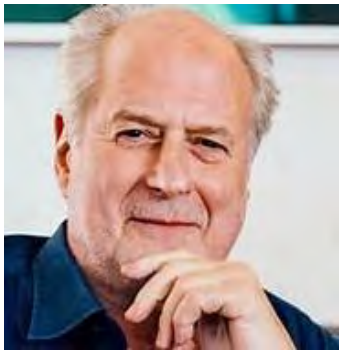
"Money not in pocket,
money not your"

Eddie Lau – Punter

Monday February 22, 2021

Met Karen and Val for lunch at Zagames Reservoir and unveiled my memoir.

CSL Research Program – potential blockbuster heart attack drug – $832M R&D bill!
"If the product works and the trial is successful, it would be the single biggest opportunity for a product that CSL has developed".

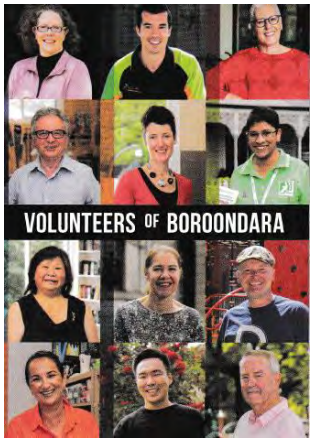


Tuesday March 2, 2021

Michael Gudinski passed away today, aged 68.

Brendan Fraser rang me to firm up a time/date to commence work.

Wednesday March 3, 2021
My first volunteer tutor session.
Wayne Huang – Malvern Library.
First session was to get to know each other. He talked about his background. I briefly outlined mine. I asked him if he knew the three levels of Australian government – he eventually wrote them down. He does have trouble writing the letter "a", as I in Libor instead of Labor.



Thursday March 4, 2021

Having purpose boosts
motivation, productivity, resilience and focus
Resilience: ability to spring back to original form
after being bent or stretched –
ability to readily recover from shock or depression

We are now connected to the NBN.

Saturday March 6, 2021

Spent the day at Kath's for a working bee and had dinner with Kath, Jeff, Janine and Gary.

Sunday March 7, 2021

We had lunch at The Anglers Tavern in Maribyrnong.

Tuesday March 16, 2021

BUYING INTO THE VIBE – RESERVOIR

Property searches for homes in Coburg and Reservoir have skyrocketed 72 and 80 percent compared to 2019. Edwardes Street and Broadway in Reservoir are home to a number of new café's, restaurants and bars, that have changed the vibe of the area and is attracting a younger buyer set.

Sunday April 11, 2021

Focus on being grateful as it will get you on the superhighway to happiness quicker than almost anything else.
Today is the first cold day of the year – Min. 11°C ~ Max. 13°C.

Sunday April 18, 2021

Grief is the price you pay for love – Queen Elizabeth II
There is more in you than you know – Prince Phillip

Sunday April 25, 2021

The first rule of compounding is to
never interrupt it unnecesarily
Wise Old Billionaire Charlie Munger

The distance of 1 light year is 9.46 trillion kilometres

Thursday May 6, 2021

Over the 2020/2021 financial year to date, the median balanced option fund returned 12.2%, reflecting the strength and speed of the post pandemic recovery.

Friday May 7, 2021

Today I worked at DCI – Invoice #005: $810
Iron ore price $197.68 per tonne – a record.

Thursday May 27, 2021

- 2.20pm – Dr. Schulberg. Result of CT abdomen scan. Minor diverticular disease – no action required. However, concern raised over the observation of an approximately 0.8cm (8mm) subpleural pulmonary nodule on my right lung. Post inflammatory nodule. Formal low dose helical CT chest recommended.
  Worst case scenarion – lung cancer!

Saturday May 29, 2021

The Australian sharemarket has rocketed to a new high. May will cap off the longest monthly winning streak in about 14 years, while the Commonwealth Bank closed above $100 for the first time.

Thursday June 24, 2021

REASONS WHY PLAYING AND COLLECTING VINYL WILL ALWAYS BE BETTER…
Album artwork. Quality and thoughtful artwork is hard to appreciate on something CD sized and under. However, holding a record in hand places a fully fledged art filled canvas before your eyes for complete scrutiny. It's not just an album cover either – perusing album liner notes to glean any information about the album and its production is just as satisfying. And who doesn't love a gatefold cover.

Sunday July 11, 2021

Ash Barty has defeated Karolina Pliskova 6–3, 6–7 (4–7), 6–3
Simply SmASHing!

Friday July 23, 2021

Tokyo 2020 Olympics Opening Ceremony tonight.

Monday July 26, 2021
Ariane Titmus – "to be a legend, you have to beat a legend".

Tuesday August 17, 2021
World peace – it's all about differing belief systems….political – communism, faith – radical islam. The gap between us and them is getting wider.

Friday September 24, 2021
For over three decades John Elliott has loomed large in Australian public life. Of his varied roles including President of the federal Liberal Party and Chairman of Elders IXL, he rates the twenty year presidency of his beloved Carlton Football Club as the most important.

VALE JOHN ELLIOTT

Thursday September 30, 2021

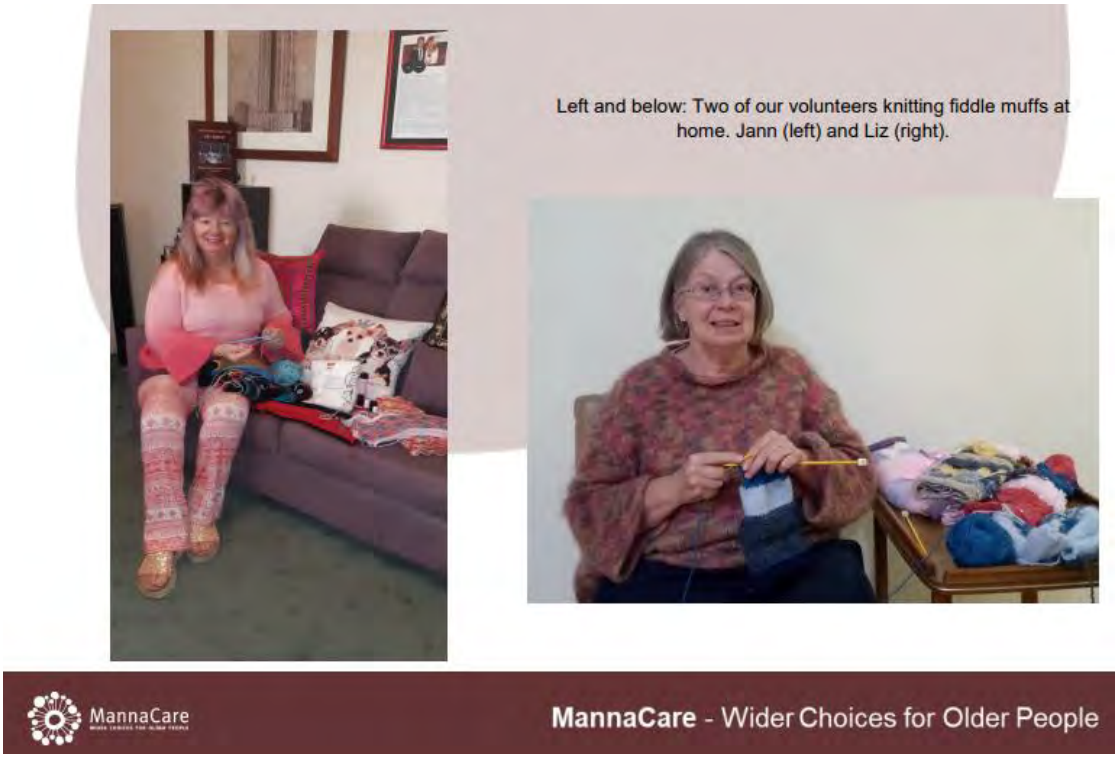
Hi Pat,

Attached is a photo of Juana, who LOVED her bio. Here she is posing in front of it in her bedroom.

Tanya Warms – MannaCare Volunteer Coordinator

October 2021

The masthead of the MannaCare volunteer newsletter.



Janny was included in the October Volunteer Vignette

Wednesday Decedmber 1, 2021

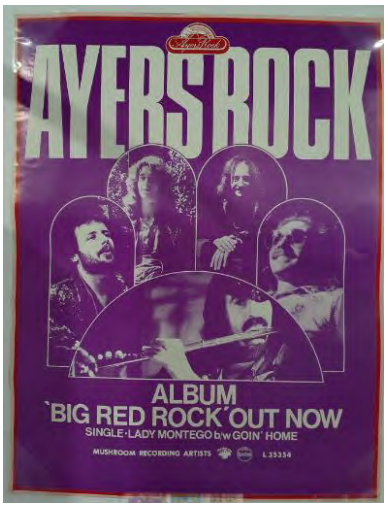
We attended the MannaCare Christmas Thankyou Party via Zoom.

Sunday December 5, 2021

It's how we do things around here.

December 17, 2021

Janny and I attended an exhibition called Pasted and Wasted: Melbourne Music Poster Expo. I took photo's of the following posters that resonated with me.



COLD CHISEL
Last Stand
LIVE

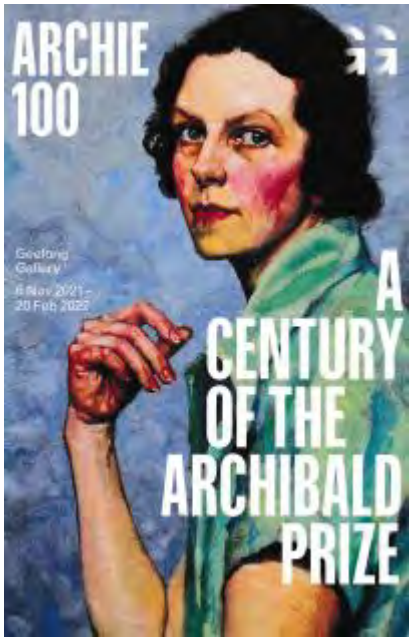
The Living End
SAVE THE DAY
TOUR '98
+ Special guests
AREA-7

Midnight Oil

THE REAL SOUND OF AUSTRALIA
THE BUSHWACKERS
BAND
APPEARING:

Farewell 2021

2022



Friday January 7, 2022

We visited the Geelong Gallery for the ARCHIE 100 Century of the Archibald Exhibition.
Some stunning portraits, especially Brett Whitely's work.
With Graeme.
Afterwards we had lunch at Little Creatures Brewery.

On **Sunday January 9**, I diarised the following quote from the late Kerry Packer;

"If anybody in this country doesn't minimise their tax they want their head read.
As a government I can tell you you're not spending it that well that we should be paying extra"

Pay the man, but don't tip him!

Images taken at sunrise on **Australia Day, 2022**
Yarra Boulevard, Kew

"My wish and hope is that
we eternally advance Australia fair"

Saturday January 29, 2022

Ash Barty d Danielle Collins 6-3, 7-6 (7-2). To claim the Australian Open.
Ash was 1-5 down in the second set.
"This is a dream come true, I'm so proud to be an Aussie".

In wartime we look for heroes, individuals to inspire us in difficult times. That person we have found in Ash Barty.

Monday February 21, 2022

Played golf at Cape Schank RACV Resort with Zoe. We had a golf cart and this was a championship golf course. 18 holes.

Wednesday February 23, 2022

Europe on the brink of war.
Putin's Peacekeeping....
I'll take that piece (Luhansk)
and that piece (Donetsk).

In the jungle, the only law is the law of survival.
Putin has shattered any last pretence that some "rules based order" or system of restraint will protect countries from domination by foreign powers.
We have been warned.

RUSSIA COMMENCES INVASION OF UKRAINE

Mad Vlad invades Ukraine, threatening "consequences never seen in history" for anyone who stands in his way.

Mad Vlad unleashes his dogs of war!

Their courage could now not just save Ukraine,
But also save Europe from Putin's next war.
And delay China's threatened invasion of Taiwan.
That makes Ukraine's heroes ours too.
May we find the patriotism – and manhood – to create our own.

Thursday February 24, 2022

Janny and I checked in to the Sofitel and attended Moulin Rouge at the Regent.

SOFITEL
HOTELS & RESORTS

Bonsoir Ms. Ernest,
I just wanted to sincerely apologise for the difficulties experienced on check-in today but we hope you are having a magnifique stay so far. If there is anything more we can do, please do not hesitate to let us know.
Warmest regards,
Madeline & the Front Office Team.

I received my Seniors Card and Seniors Myki card today.

The Hon Daniel Andrews MP
Premier of Victoria

24 February 2022

[redacted]
Mr Patrick Ernest
WILLSMERE
79 WILTSHIRE DRIVE
KEW VIC 3101

Dear Mr Ernest

Welcome to the Seniors Card program, a partnership between the Victorian Government and business to thank older Victorians for their contribution to our State and to support seniors to lead active and healthy lives.

Your Seniors Card entitles you to numerous benefits, including discounts from thousands of participating businesses, free off-peak travel vouchers (enclosed) and concession fares on public transport services. As a new Seniors Card holder you receive a free Seniors myki (attached). Information on how to use your seniors myki is enclosed along with the Welcome to Seniors Card brochure, which has great information and tips for getting the most out of your Seniors Card.

A directory, listing discounts from participating businesses, and special offers is available online at seniorsonline.vic.gov.au.

We hope you enjoy the benefits of your card. If you have any queries please visit seniorsonline.vic.gov.au or call 1300 797 210.

The Hon Daniel Andrews MP
Premier

The Hon Anthony Carbines MP
Minister for Disability, Ageing and Carers

Tuesday March 1, 2022

Janny and I departed on our road trip to Queensland, stopping at Dubbo overnight. We had to repair a flat front tyre when we were in Dubbo.

While we were in Brisbane we received the news that Shane Warne had passed away in Koh Samui of a heart attack. We were in shock.

Gone too soon – Warney was only 52.
Friday March 4, 2022

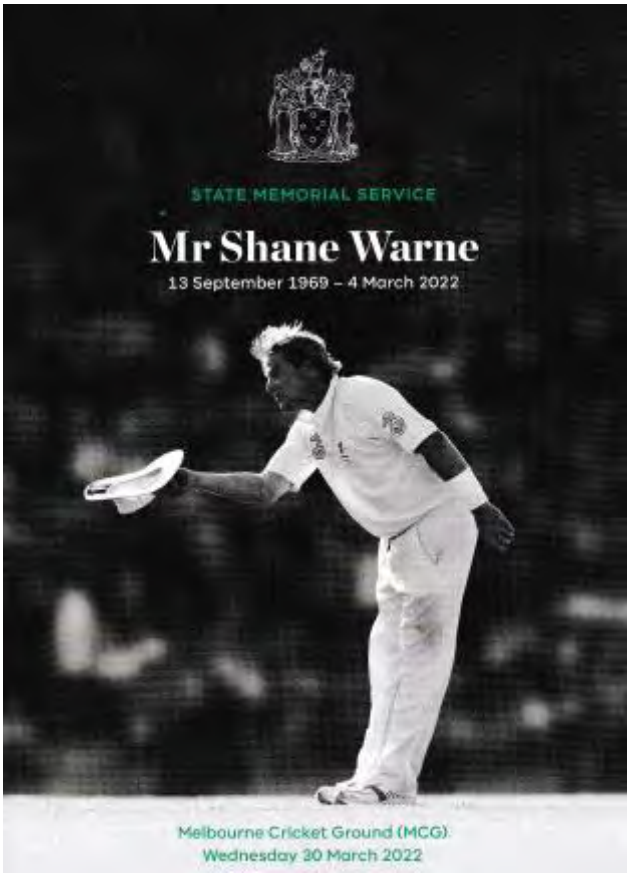
Wednesday March 21, 2022

Saturday March 26, 2022

Today we travelled to Drouin to view a tandem bike that we spotted on marketplace. It turned out to be perfefect for our needs and we purchased it.

Wednesday March 30, 2022

We attended the Shane Warne State Memorial Service at the MCG this evening. A very moving service.
Warny crammed a lot into his 52 years.
Later in the evening the MCG Southern Stand was christened the Shane Warne Stand.



Saturday April 2, 2022

ParkRun this morning – Run number 43
Time: 28:43
Distance: 5:09
Pace: 5:39
Calories: 339

Wednesday April 6, 2022

Janny and I attended the State Library this morning and then checked out a new exhibition at the Old Treasury Building;

LOST JOBS
THE CHANGING WORLD OF WORK

Image: 1948, A lamp cleaner on Princes Bridge.

Friday April 22, 2022

The Carlton Football Club's Brian Cook was consulting members for their thoughts on a Purpose Statement for the club. I submitted the following to the Club;

"The CFC exists to provide
a football club of choice and to
conduct itself
in a manner that engenders pride in the club,
by being a progressive and respectful employer.
Playing a fair and competitive brand of football
and
respecting and valuing club members".

Saturday April 23, 2022

I completed my 46th ParkRun this morning at Albert Park Lake in a time of 24:06.
Completely different run to my normal Studley Park trail run, this run is totally flat and we were able to take in stunning views of the city.
Attended with Janny, Graeme and Zoe.

Tuesday April 26, 2022

An astronomical delight - four planets were aligned in the night sky. Saturn, Mars, Venus and Jupiter could be viewed all in a line and the next time this event occurs is in 500 years from now.

Thursday May 5, 2022

We travelled to Bendigo to attend the ELVIS – DIRECT FROM GRACELAND exhibition at the Bendigo Art Gallery. It was so good that we went through the exhibition twice. Priscilla Presley was at the opening and there were 300 authentic artefacts owned by Elvis. We stayed at the Shamrock Hotel.

"The fans want my shirt.
They can have my shirt.
They put it on my back".

Elvis Presley – 1957

Saturday May 7, 2022

Poor Albo is struggling with a media pack intent on tripping him up on policy detail.

Sunday May 8, 2022

STRESS LESS ABOUT MONEY
Scott Pape, The Barefoot Investor, outlined the following in the paper this morning;
"Get a 5% pay rise (at least).
You need to hit your boss up for a raise.
You need to get at least a 5% or you'll be going backwards"
DCI are currently negotiating an EBA, which expires 30 June.

The caricatures of our candidates, Monique and Josh, cracked me up.

Wednesday May 11, 2022

AEC Australian Electoral Commission

F I R S T D A Y
Pre Poll duties – 12.30pm to 8.30pm
Cooper Early Voting Centre
710 High Street Thornbury

Wednesday May 18, 2022

While working at the PPVC, and as a Ballot Box Guard, I assisted a lady pushing her Senate ballot paper into the WILLS ballot box when my wedding ring caught the edge of the slot, dislodged and fell into the ballot box. I will have to wait until after the election for it to be opened and hopefully retrieved. The box was conspicuously marked up with my details.

Friday May 20, 2022

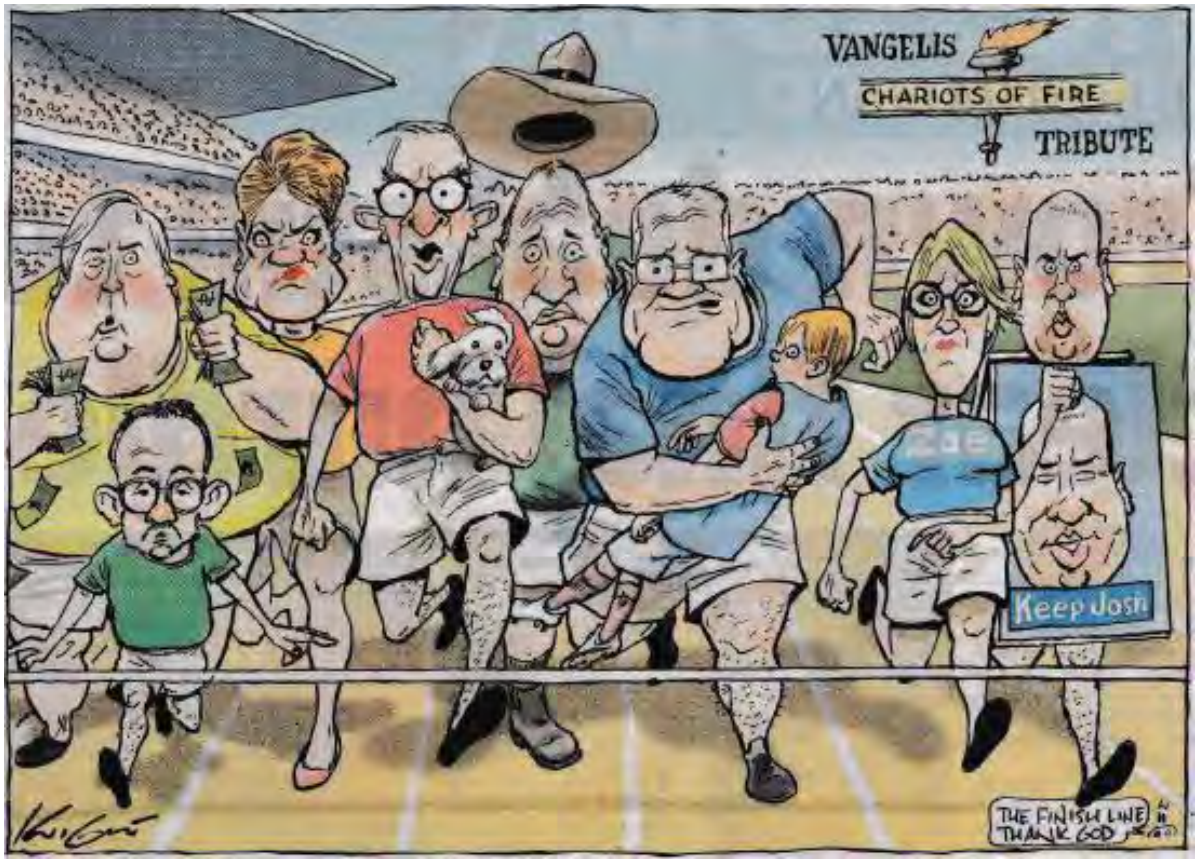
POLITICAL ADVERTISING
Lib's tell fibs! Save our homes, save our homes.
It won't be easy under Albanese. That's not my job, That's not my job, that's not my job to do that.

Saturday May 21, 2022

F E D E R A L E L E C T I O N D A Y

ScoMo and Albo in Melbourne for final pitch to voters as the election race tightens and Victoria holds key to power

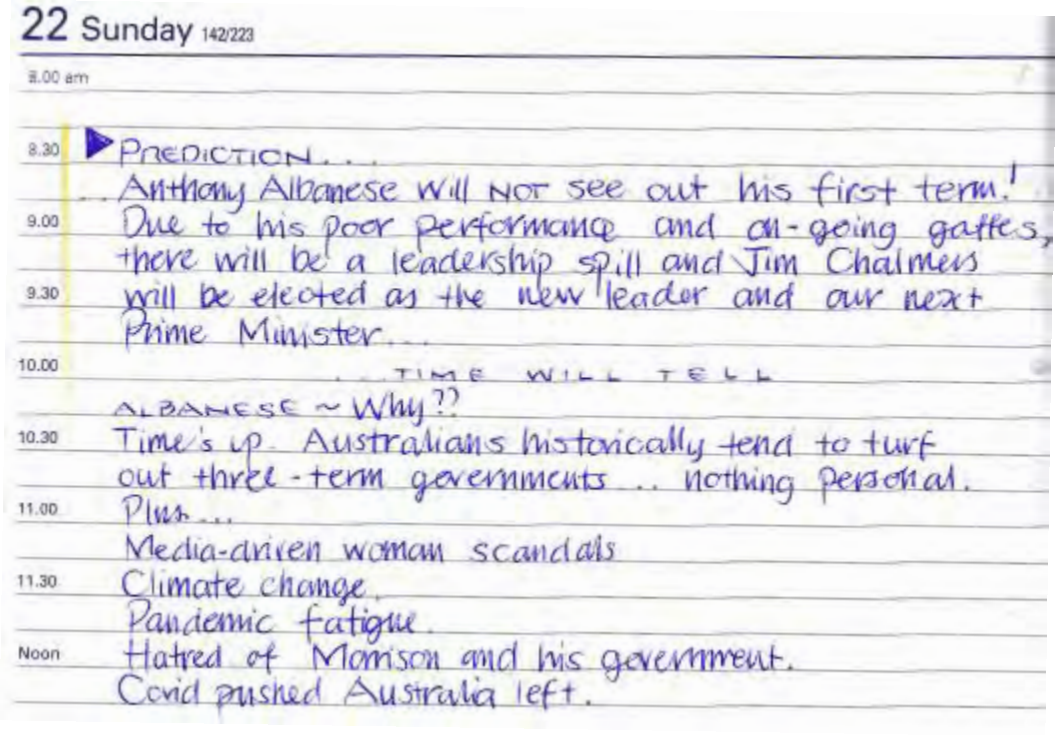
I noted in my diary the following thoughts and ponderances on the day;
Will Josh retain his seat?
Will "Teal" independents have their day?
Will there be another "miracle" for ScoMo?
The coalition deserves another 3 year term because their record is strong, we know what we are getting and they have stood up when we needed strong leadership.



Sunday May 22, 2022

The aftermath….
Prediction….Anthony Albanese will not see out his first term! Due to his poor performance and on-going gaffes, there will be a leadership spill and Jim Chalmers will be elected as the new leader and our next prime minister.

Albanese ˜ why?
Time's up. Australians historically tend to turf out three-term governments…..nothing personal.
Plus;
Media driven scandals, climate change, pandemic fatigue, hatred of Morrison and his government and Covid pushed Australia to the left.



Tuesday May 24, 2022

For Carlton Football Club, to improve the membership experience;
"Perhaps the club could provide membership flexibility/options for memberships, i.e. a general admission but with reserved seats for the big games at the MCG – Collingwood, Essendon and Richmond. This would save us time in reserving seats for these games".

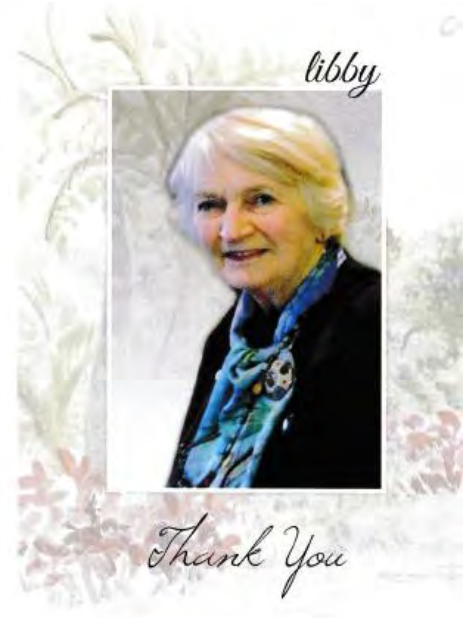
Monday May 30, 2022

Today I received a phone call from the Campbellfield vote counting centre confirming they had found my ring. I was so pleased and drove up there to pick it up. So relieved.

My ring was in a plastic bag, with my original box note on the outside.

Friday June 24, 2022

Today we attended a memorial service for Elizabeth "Libby" Tipping - Janine's mother.



Saturday June 25, 2022

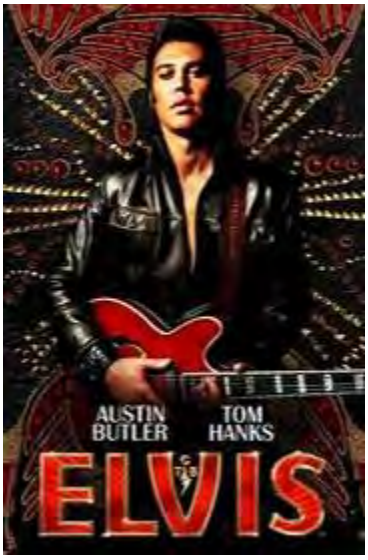
AIRWAVE FEUD CAME TO ED

Jordan DeGoey has been in the wars again, partying big time in Bali. Perhaps he can land a lucrative sponsorship deal with Bintang.

Meanwhile, it can be said that Eddie McGuire and Neil Mitchell don't like each other, and never really have.
A colossally bitter exchange peppered with insults and accusations on 3AW last Thursday proved that once and for all.

Monday June 27, 2022

Today we saw the movie Elvis at the Sun Theatre at Yarraville. For me this has been the year of Elvis. I have discovered how superb his music is, together with the Bendigo exhibition and the release of this excellent movie, the King has been a welcomed relevation.



Wednesday July 6, 2022

"The income element of share portfolios
is still delivering for investors"

"A man who both spends and saves money
is the happiest because he has both enjoyments".

Saturday July 16, 2022

We attended the Carlton v Geelong game at the "G" and picked up our Bruce Doull bobble heads. Then had lunch in the ground at The Paddock.

Wednesday July 13, 2022

While at the State Library I read a book by Rowdy Crowther titled "You'll Hate Retirement". I made note of of the following points which resonated with me;

- Perhaps I had been institutionalised to my job – the structure, routine and predictability that it gave me.
- The retirement trifecta;

  1. enough money
  2. good health
  3. family

Need something more? Refer to my Lifestyle Portfolio

- Three components of happiness
  1. something to do
  2. someone to love
  3. something to look forward to

Emotional desires;
The desire….

1. to be taken seriously
2. for my place
3. for something to believe in
4. to connect
5. to be useful
6. to belong
7. for more
8. for control
9. for something to happen
10. for love

- I became very jealous of people who had somewhere to go.
- Retiree is code for;
  "I have given up on life, I'm irrelevant. I have been stripped of identity and purpose.
- My darker alter ego….that little voice which whispers unhelpful crap in my ear – usually as I awaken every morning. The Villian of Fear.
- We define who we are and who and what we care about, not by what we promise, but what we do.
- Chose to take action – defeat the Villain of Fear.
- Audit your work life before retiring – understand what you will be losing.

Friday July 22, 2022

I officially became an organ donor.

Sunday August 7, 2022

A message to Janny…

"To meet her was to be beguiled by a warmth
and a charm and smile and laugh that was
all evidence of her refusal to be bowed
by life's slings and arrows".

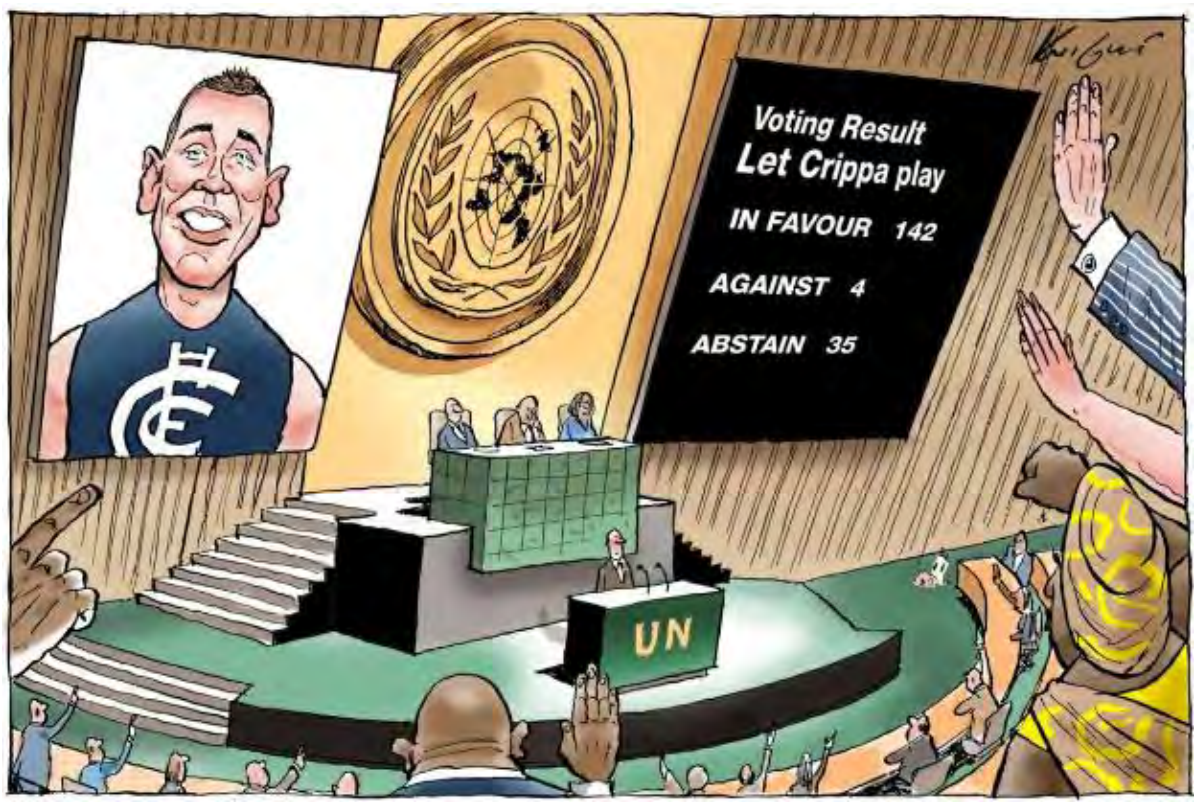
Saturday August 13, 2022

ALLORDS: 7288.80
ASX200: 7032.50
CBA: $100.34
CSL: $292.85
WES: $47.24

Saturday August 13, 2022

This was displayed in the Saturday Herald Sun today.

Saturday August 13, 2022



The most discussed, scrutinised, examined, analysed, dissected, and studied tribunal appearance in history. A potential Brownlow could hinge on its outcome.

Monday August 15, 2022

"Travel – don't put it off. Travel is best enjoyed whilst still strong of body and mind".

Tuesday August 16, 2022

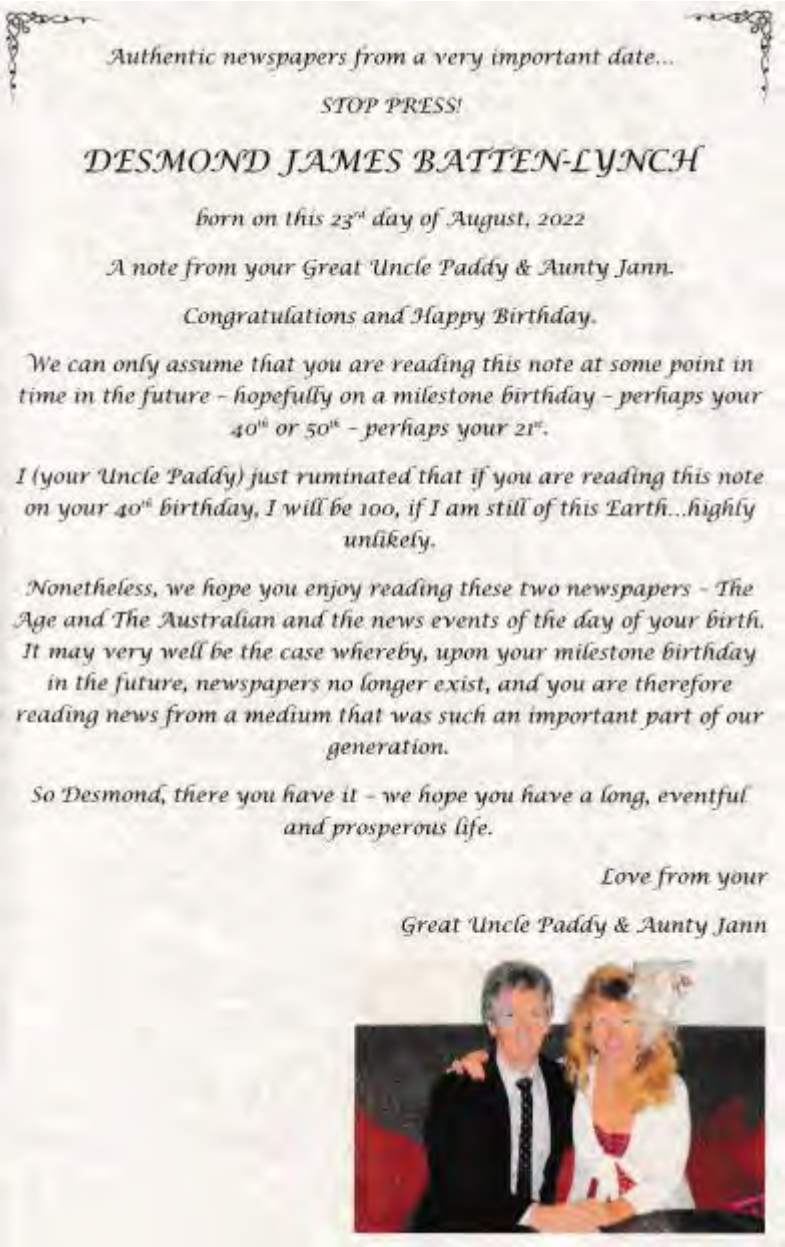
I spent the day at MannaCare Grevillea House archiving their documents.

Wednesday August 17, 2022

Janny and I visited the Docklands Library – 107 Victoria Harbour Promenade.

Tuesday August 23, 2022

WELCOME TO
DESMOND JAMES BATTEN-LYNCH



Authentic newspapers from a very important date...

STOP PRESS!

DESMOND JAMES BATTEN-LYNCH

born on this 23rd day of August, 2022

A note from your Great Uncle Paddy & Aunty Jann.

Congratulations and Happy Birthday.

We can only assume that you are reading this note at some point in time in the future – hopefully on a milestone birthday – perhaps your 40th or 50th – perhaps your 21st.

I (your Uncle Paddy) just ruminated that if you are reading this note on your 40th birthday, I will be 100, if I am still of this Earth...highly unlikely.

Nonetheless, we hope you enjoy reading these two newspapers - The Age and The Australian and the news events of the day of your birth. It may very well be the case whereby, upon your milestone birthday in the future, newspapers no longer exist, and you are therefore reading news from a medium that was such an important part of our generation.

So Desmond, there you have it – we hope you have a long, eventful and prosperous life.

Love from your

Great Uncle Paddy & Aunty Jann

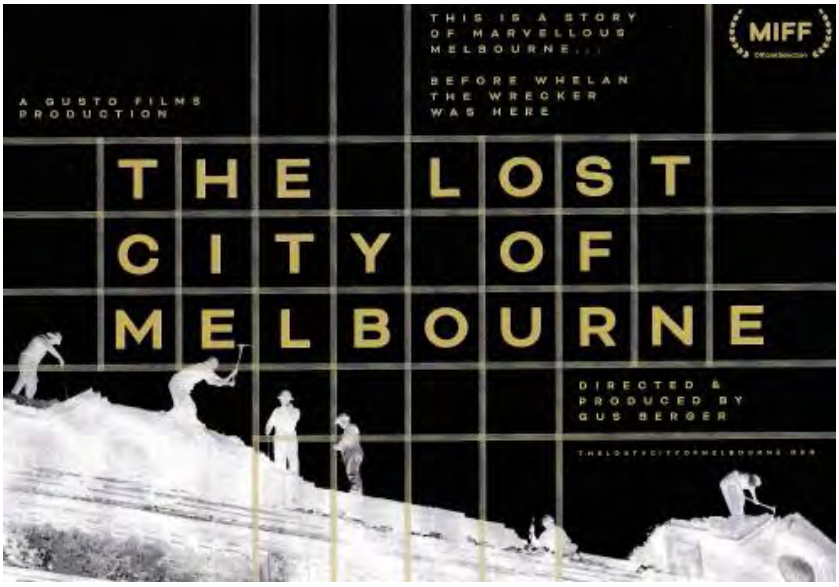
We inserted this flyer into Desi's newspaper from the day of his birth.

Sunday August 28, 2022

I completed the DE CASTELLA RUN on the Kew Yarra Boulevard this morning.
10km run
Time: 54.03
Pace: 5.22
Calories: 696

Thursday September 8, 2022

Janny and I went to the Westgarth Cinema to see the documentary THE LOST CITY OF MELBOURNE. It was fitting that we saw it at the Westgarth, as the show highlighted many beautiful old Melbourne cinema's that went under the wrecking ball. Whelan The Wrecker was kept very busy.



Sunday September 11, 2022

We saw Rose Tattoo at Musicland in Fawkner today. There with Jeff, Jimmy, Terrie and Rob.

Monday September 13, 2022

Splendid isolation – cycling and running.
It removes all the noise and gives you time for your brain to process.

Uncle Dave passed away at midnight last night.

Friday September 16, 2022

I was pleasently surprised when I received a medal for completing the de Castella Run and was first in my age category.

Old Xaverians' Athletic Club
Founded in 1930
Affiliated with Athletics Victoria
Affiliated with the Old Xaverians' Association
A member of the Associated Public Schools Old Colleeians' Amateur Athletic Association

INDIGENOUS MARATHON FOUNDATION

18 Sunburst Avenue, North Balwyn. 3104
0403 910 183
christopher.worsnop@austin.org.au
31 August 2022

Congratulations on winning a medal in your age group in the de Castella Run this year. Your medal is enclosed.

Thanks for your participation. The run was a great success and we have been able to make a significant contribution to the Indigenous Marathon Foundation and One in Five so that they can continue their important work in remote indigenous communities, and support people with mental health issues.

If you would like some more running competition and/or coaching, you are welcome at the Old Xaverians' Athletic Club. Just let me know.

We hope to see you at next year's run on the 27th August 2023.

Yours sincerely,

Christopher Worsnop
President

Sunday September 18, 2022

YOU LITTLE CRIPPER!
CRIPPS: 29
NEALE: 28
MILLER: 27

Coming into the last round of the season, Paddy Cripps was on 26 votes and needed a three vote best on ground perfomance to leap frog Lachie Neale and Touk Miller. In the back of my mind I new Crippa had a good game against the Pies. As is the drama that is part and parcel of Brownlow night, the final game votes to be read were Carlton v Collingwood. P. Cripps – 3 votes! Unbelievable.

Remarkably, prior to the count, Scott Gullan predicted the following;
The Carlton skipper dominated the first half of the season and that best on ground in the final round will see him come over the top and snatch it by one vote.

Thursday October 6, 2022

HISTORY'S WORST DECISIONS
and the people who made them

VLADIMIR PUTIN
AND THE SPECIAL MILITARY OPERATION
Motivation – Pride, Greed

Thursday October 27, 2022

I have never sen so much rain as we are having now. No doubt more flooding will occur.

We've got to get out of this place,
if it's the last thing we ever do"

Friday October 28, 2022

Janny and I flew out to Bali today and checked into the Pullman Legian.

Friday November 11, 2022

My start date at the VEC for the state election has been delayed as I have tested positive for Covid-19. Caught it on the return flight back from Bali.

Saturday November 26, 2022

VICTORIAN STATE ELECTION TODAY

Pity the Victorian electorate didn't pay attention to this.
Can you believe it – another four years of this joker!

I had a long day, starting at the Early Voting Centre at 9.30am, sorting votes and then at 4.30pm I departed for the Kew Uniting Church for counting, packing up and delivery duties. Got home after midnight.

Saturday December 3, 2022

We were gifted free Guns N' Roses tickets at the MCG via Gary. Attended with Jeff, Jimmy amd Meg. Prime seats too.

Monday December 5, 2022

As regular visitors to Bali, Janny and I were amused by the recent Indonesian ruling regarding sex outside marriage. Not sure how they intend to police it.

Keep away from the deep end.

Saturday December 10, 2022

Christmas was to be at Jeff's today, but sadly he contracted COVID-19 and the plans were in dissaray. I hastily rang Terrie and she kindly allowed the function to take place at her home.
Talking to Pat Cormick that day, I mentioned that I had created a Coronavirus Journal during our two plus years in lockdown. He was extremely interested in reading it so I decided to gift him my book. In it I inserted the following letter.

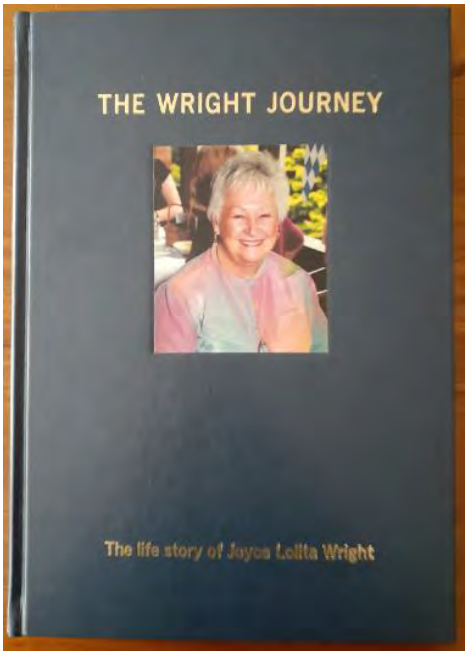
Pat and Robyn,
Please accept my Coronavirus Journal as a gift and memento of an unprecedented time in our lives.
I view this "gift" as a mere pittance when compared
to the wonderful and on-going contributions you have made in our lives.
I, and I suspect all my siblings owe you a great deal of gratitude for your love, support and presence in the life and times of the family Ernest.
I hope and trust that you will enjoy my Journal
and its insights into a period of uncertainty, despair
and at times, incarceration.

Best regards,
Paddy

. . . .

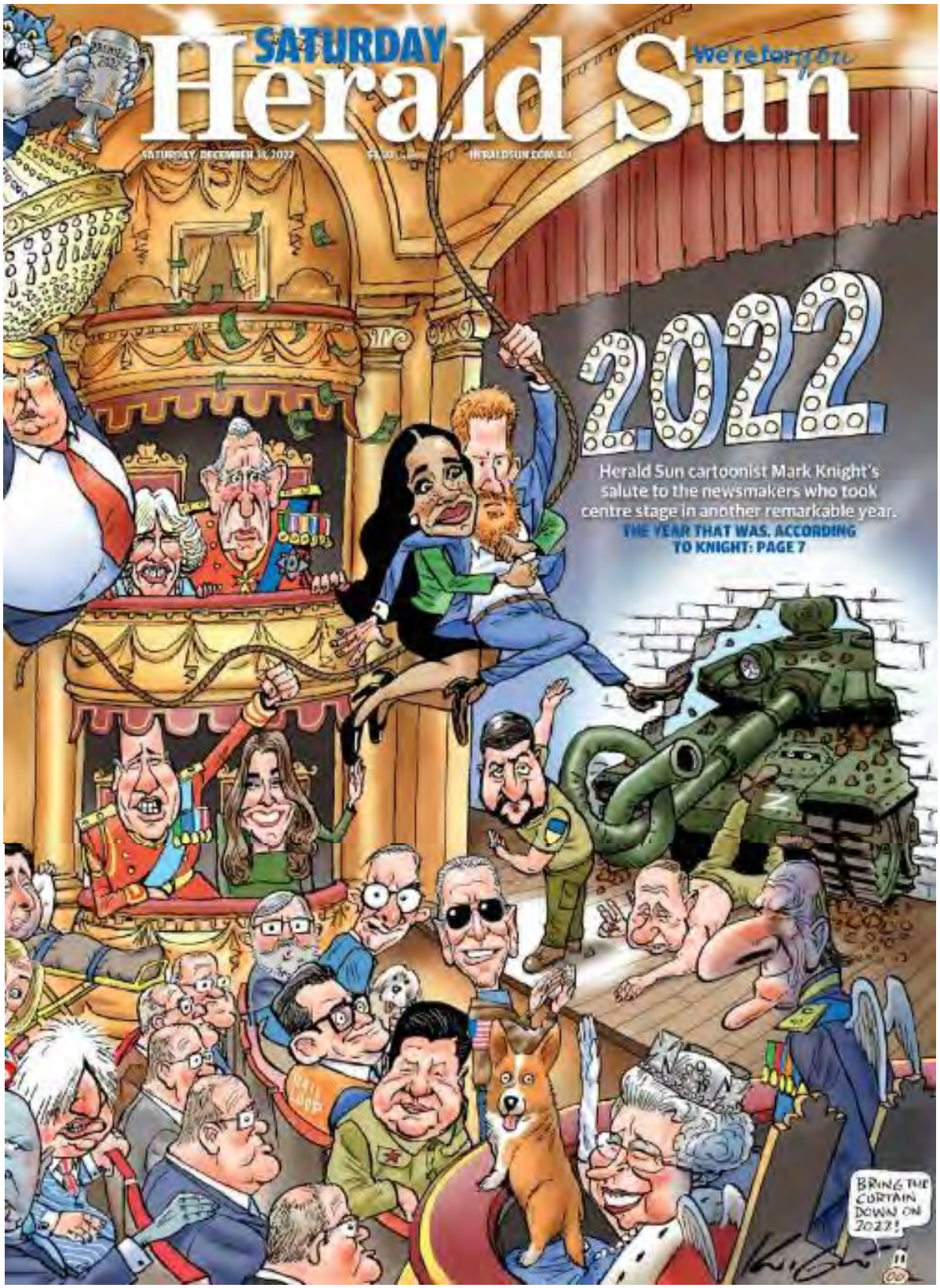
Saturday December 10, 2022

I also took the opportunity at Terrie's to present Joyce with her biography.



That evening Janny and I attended the Billy Joel concert at the MCG.

. . . .



Farewell 2022

2023

Thursday January 5, 2023

Janny and I commenced 2023 in Adelaide and travelled to Auburn to commence our tandem bike ride along the Clare Riesling Trail.
Challenging but enjoyable.
Janny and I are tandemaniacs. Riding a tandem can be fascinating, and ocassionally, a frightening experience. We have the constant companionship of each other.

Sunday January 22, 2023

Met Graeme for lunch in Chinatown.

Wednesday January 25, 2023

Victoria's economy has been described as an immigration based Ponzi Scheme.

"Did you Flametree the lunch"? Catching up with old friends - "Do you remember so and so"?

"Career Best".

. . . .

Walked across the Glass Bridge in Bali with Graeme.

Sunday February 26, 2023

P I S C E S
Shouldn't you be doing something?
Don't you have tasks that need completing?
Duties to attend to?
Promises to fulfil?
Aren't people expecting things from you?
OF COURSE!
Which is why I need to set some boundaries.
Although I can't shirk my responsibilities,
I can reset everyone's expectations.

Wednesday March 1, 2023

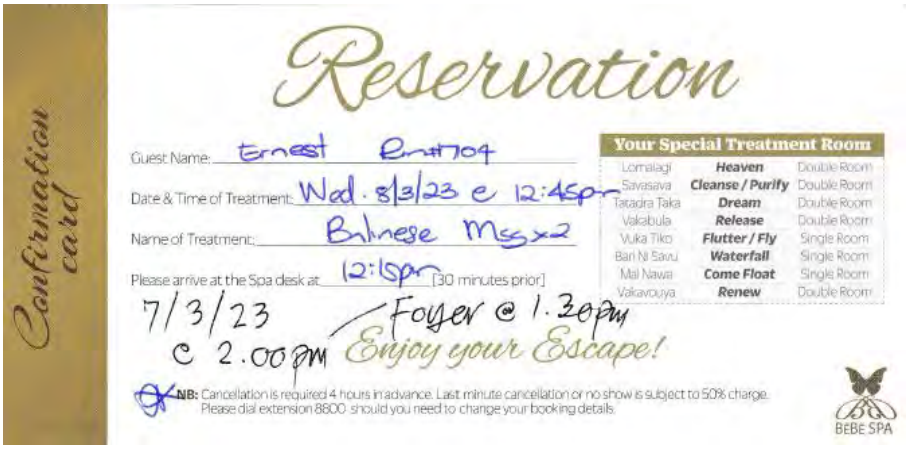
Sent the following message to Pat Cormick after being made aware of his medical problems;

Dear Pat,
We have just sadly heard about your predicament. Please know that you are in our hearts and thoughts at this time and wish you all the best for your forthcoming surgery and a speedy recovery.
Love and best wishes from Pat & Jann Ernest

Friday March 3, 2023

We departed for Fiji today.

Tuesday March 7, 2023



Janny and I had a lovely massage at the
Outrigger Bebe Spa.
A nice birthday indulgence.

Thursday March 9, 2023

Janny and I had a day trip to Tivua Private Island.
A great day was had. We had a beautiful lunch, drinks were provided and the snorkelling was divine. While snorkelling, I took Janny's hand and we snorkelled together.

29530
PORT PHILLIP CITY COUNCIL
Elwood Carpark - Meter ELP3
EXPIRES Plate: 1UV3RI

FRI 17 MAR 2023 03:35 PM

FEE PAID: $12.92
ENTERED: 17 Mar 01:18 PM
Card# 4557... $0.12 fee included
ABN 21 762 977 945 INCLUDES GST
PLACE ON DASH THIS SIDE UP

Friday March 17, 2023
Janny and I had lunch at Elwood Bathers for our 33rd Wedding Anniversary.

Sunday March 19, 2023

It was great to be able to complete the Long Course "Run for the Kids" in my 60's.
Time ~ 1:16:04 (76:04)
Distance ~ 14.36km
Pace ~ 5:18m/km
Calories ~ 1004
Footnote: 9/4/2006 ~ 72:38 – 14/3/2010 ~ 68:21

Wednesday April 12, 2023

Janny, Jeff and I drove to Adelaide for the inaugural Gather Round. The drive made all the more enjoyable in the Santa Fe. We stayed at the Riviera Adelaide Hotel on North Terrace.
Carlton played Adelaide Crows in the first game of the round on Thursday April 13. Unfortunately we were flogged, but it was a great experience nonetheless. The AFL set up a very good fan zone in Elder Park.

Saturday April 15, 2023

Monday April 24, 2023

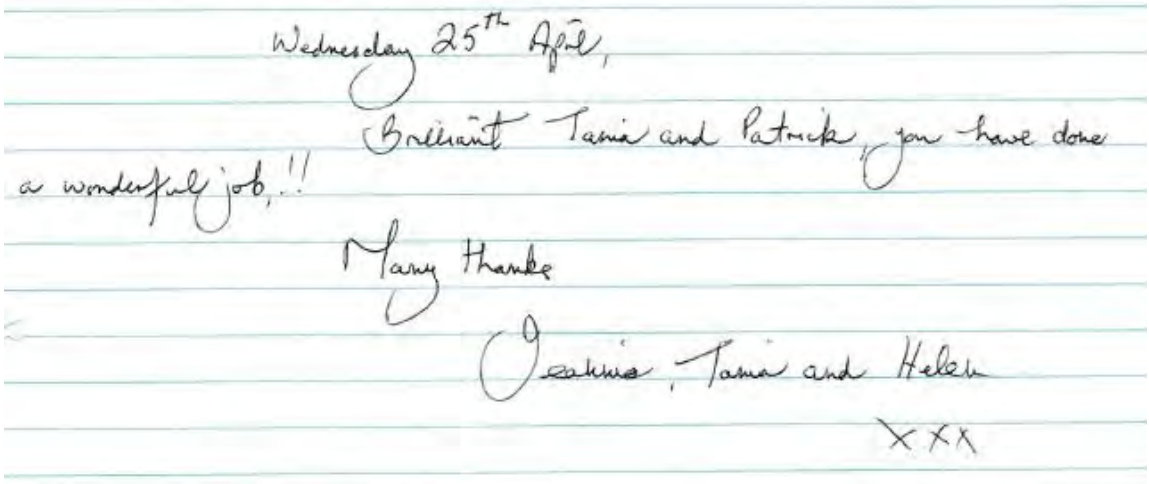
When I finished my final prawn,
I had a technicolured yawn,
and I chundered in
the old Pacific sea

Sir Les Patterson

Tuesday April 25, 2023 – ANZAC Day

IN FLANDERS FIELDS THE POPPIES BLOW
Between the crosses, row on row,
That mark our place, and in the sky,
The larks, still bravely singing,
Fly sacred heard amid the guns below.

Janny and I assisted at MannaCare with ANZAC day activities.



Wednesday 25th April,

Brilliant Tania and Patricia, you have done a wonderful job,!!

Many thanks

Jeannie, Tania and Helen

XXX

From Jeannie, regarding Albert's biography.

Saturday May 13, 2023

LARRIKINS –
UNITE
AGAINST
THE
WOKE

With the recent passing of Barry Humphries, you can't help but think that the great Aussie larrikan's days are numbered.

Carlton played and lost to Brisbane recently.
I note Percy Jones' observations of that loss;

"We had the ball plenty of times. But our kicking, Christ, it was atrocious," the four-time premiership ruckman said.

"You look at some of those blokes and you think, 'Christ, how can they miss them?'

"They obviously aren't trying to miss them, are they? They're trying to hit a player on the chest – if they're aiming for an opposition player they are being successful.

"Maybe if they aimed for the opposition player then they'd hit Carlton."

Sunday May 14, 2023

NATIONAL Volunteer Week will be celebrated from May 15 – 21.
The week long event recognises the vital support that the millions of volunteers in Australia provide to their communities and encourages people to consider volunteering.

Thursday May 18, 2023

Janny and I were keynote speakers at the MannaCare Volunteer's Lunch at the Greythorn Bowling Club. My speech is below;

National Volunteer Week

Mannacare Talk – May 18, 2023

The Change Makers

Good afternoon – my name is Pat Ernest and I am a volunteer at MannaCare. Part of the Change Makers theme of this Volunteer Week is TURNING YOUR PASSION INTO PURPOSE and I think that best typifies me.

MannaCare have an established and wonderful program of creating biographies for their residents, so one of my roles at MannaCare is as a **Biographer.** This involves interviewing residents or their family members and documenting their life story.

I love writing and listening to people's life stories. I have just completed my own autobiography, my sisters Biography and my work memoir. MannaCare has given me the opportunity to turn **my passion into purpose.**
There is something very special about hearing people's lives come to life. I genuinely enjoy penning biographies of the MannaCare residents.
Another great aspect of creating biographies is that I am of an age, the last of the Baby Boomer cohort, whereby I can easily tap into and recognise their journey, whether they worked at the PMG, SEC, the Gas & Fuel or one resident who worked as a fitter and turner (which I am) at a company called Vickers Ruwolt, which was one of Melbourne's largest engineering works, located in Richmond, where the IKEA site (Victoria Gardens) is now. I actually visited this site as an apprentice **fitter and turner** in the 1970's as part of my trade school learning. They had the biggest machine shop I had ever seen.

Upon interviewing another resident, he revealed that he was a lifelong Richmond supporter. I couldn't help myself and asked him "Now Rex, you've been around a while and seen a lot of Richmond players – who is the best Tiger you've seen. He didn't hesitate - confidently naming Royce Hart as the best Richmond player he's ever seen. So good!

I have always maintained that the best program on TV is the ABC's **Australian Story,** and I reckon many in the audience would agree. So when I research and write a resident's biography, I feel like I'm watching another episode of Australian Story....again so good!

The concept of compiling and writing biographies is such an important endeavour. In my opinion, everyone has a story, and it is so important to document it before it's too late, because when it's over, it's over and all that valuable life story intel is gone forever, thus denying the next generation of family members their valuable legacy.

MannaCare have long recognised the importance of their Biography Service and I am honoured to be part of the program – so to MannaCare, thank you for enabling me to **turn my passion into purpose.**
My other role at MannaCare is in **office administration**, namely archiving and filing. I reckon if you looked up the definition of PROCRASTINATION in the dictionary, you would probably see the words **archiving and filing**. I know this from experience as a Quality Manager for a manufacturing company, that archiving and filing*, whilst an important function, is one of those tasks that I would put off until my workload quietened down – and guess what, things never quietened down. **Eventually** I had to go in on the weekend to be able to carry out the task uninterrupted. **My role**, archiving and filing, allows the paid staff at MannaCare to focus on their core job functions without having to stop and carry out this time consuming task, so I see this as a noble cause.

That's the way I see it anyway.

I **well remember** when, **during COVID**, MannaCare kept in contact with Jann and I and allowed us to keep involved. I think that although this week recognises the work of us Volunteers, sometimes it's worthwhile to also acknowledge those who work in the background - the efforts of those individuals and organisations that recruit, supervise, encourage and enable us Volunteers to do our thing.

Again, a big thank you to Tanya and the team at MannaCare for all their support throughout our tenure. They are a great organisation to work for.

I think I have used up my allocated time so thanks for listening. Cheers.

Thursday May 25, 2023

Janny and I attended FMIG Imaging for a Coronary Calcium Score via a CT scan. This scan measures the amount of calcified plaque in the coronary arteries.

Saturday May 27, 2023

SYDNEY V CARLTON
11.11.77 6.15.51
JASON DUNSTALL ON FOX FOOTY
"I can't deal with this honestly….
…if I was a Carlton Coach or supporter….I have no hair to pull out. The inability to do something decent with the football. Their kicking skills from the moment this game started, and it's not just this week, it has been consistent throughout the year. Their inability to hit targets, to kick to advantage of teamates, inability to make good decisions with ball in hand. It's mind boggling – it is that bad, it is hard to watch".

Sunday May 28, 2023

On 3AW…..
The continuing tirades of Snapper – the disillusioned and disgruntled Carlton member. There's a bit of Snapper in all of us long suffering Carlton people!!

Monday May 29, 2023

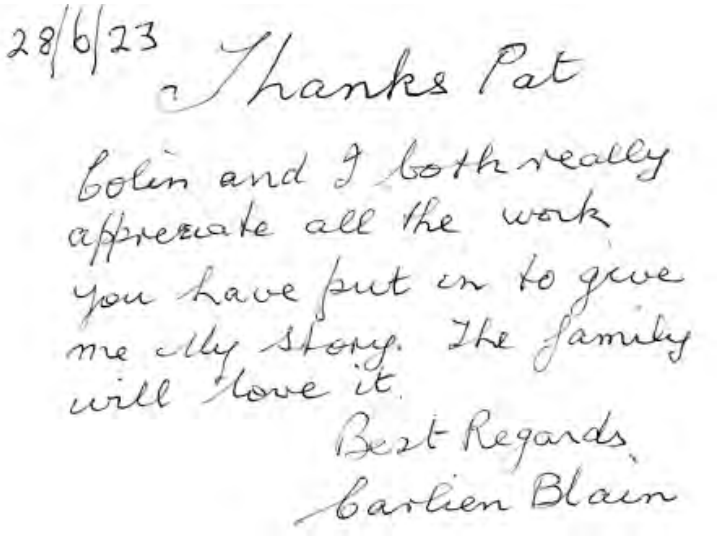
Saw Doctor Schulberg.
My CT Calcium Score – 167. Janny's CT Score: Zero
Moderate plaque burden, indicative of a moderate coronary vascular disease risk. Cholesterol: 6.5 – Too High! DIETARY CHANGES REQUIRED!!

Saturday June 10, 2023

Janny and I departed for Legian, Bali.
During this holiday I read the book 1971 – Never A Dull Moment. The book advocates that 1971 was a landmark year in the history of popular music. Hard to argue against this…Led Zeppelin, David Bowie, the Rolling Stones, Pink Floyd, Marvin Gaye, Carole King, Rod Stewart, the solo Beatles et al…. all at their peak.

Wednesday June 28, 2023

Property – "the stigma that all landlords are greedy, wealthy people. Baby boomers don't fare much better". Noted at the State Library.



A thank you note from Carlien Blain following the completion of her Biography.

Tuesday July 4, 2023

Janny and I attended the *Russell Morris – The Real Thing* concert at Hamer Hall. In the foyer we spotted Clive Palmer, who bank rolled the concert. Money well spent Clive.

Sunday July 9, 2023

The forthcoming Referendum will be very challenging for the YES campaign. Their just not getting any traction.

Sunday July 16, 2023

New taxes and regulations are driving investment property owners to sell up and quit the state, making Victoria's shortage of rental housing even worse. Melbourne landlords are fed up!

Tuesday July 18, 2023

COMMONWEALTH GAMES IN MELBOURNE CANCELLED!

Dan's opening words at his press conference announcing the cancelation;
"This not the time to apportion blame".....seriously?

Saturday July 22, 2023

Sunday July 23, 2023

We saw Oppenheimer at Crown.

"I have become death…
the destroyer of worlds"

Tuesday July 25, 2023

I had a CTCA scan at FMIG. A narrowing of an artery detected. Calcium score now 155 – down from 167.
Lifestyle measures – low dose aspirin (81mg) daily if coronary artery calcium scoring is above 100. A score of zero essentially excludes coronary artery disease in patients over the age of 45.
When we arrived at the intersection of Power Street and Burwood Road was closed off as a pedestrian had been struck and killed.

. . . .

Saturday August 5, 2023

LAND TAX FRICTION TO MASS EVICTION

"The talk of rent caps is rattling many investors, and combined with the stresses of eviction moratoriums, the onerous rental reforms, the interest rate increases, the tougher borrowing hurdles for investors and higher land tax costs – landlords have had enough… Landlords are scrambling to sell up".

Sunday August 6, 2023

St Kilda v Carlton
53 73
Winning streak has Carlton in seventh heaven. Blues reel in fading Saints. Carlton were down 22 points at half time! We are now fifth on the ladder. We were in the bottom four after round 15. What a turnaround!

Saturday August 12, 2023

Janny and I were in Sydney for the City2Surf. Today we took a ferry to Barrangaroo and then another ferry to Manly for lunch.
In the evening we watched the Matilda's play France in the World Cup semi final. We won 7-6 in a nerve jangling penalty shoot out.
At the same time, Kath, Megan, Desie and Leslie attended the MCG to watch Carlton defeat Melbourne by four points. They were also able to watch the Matilda's on the big screen.

Sunday August 13, 2023

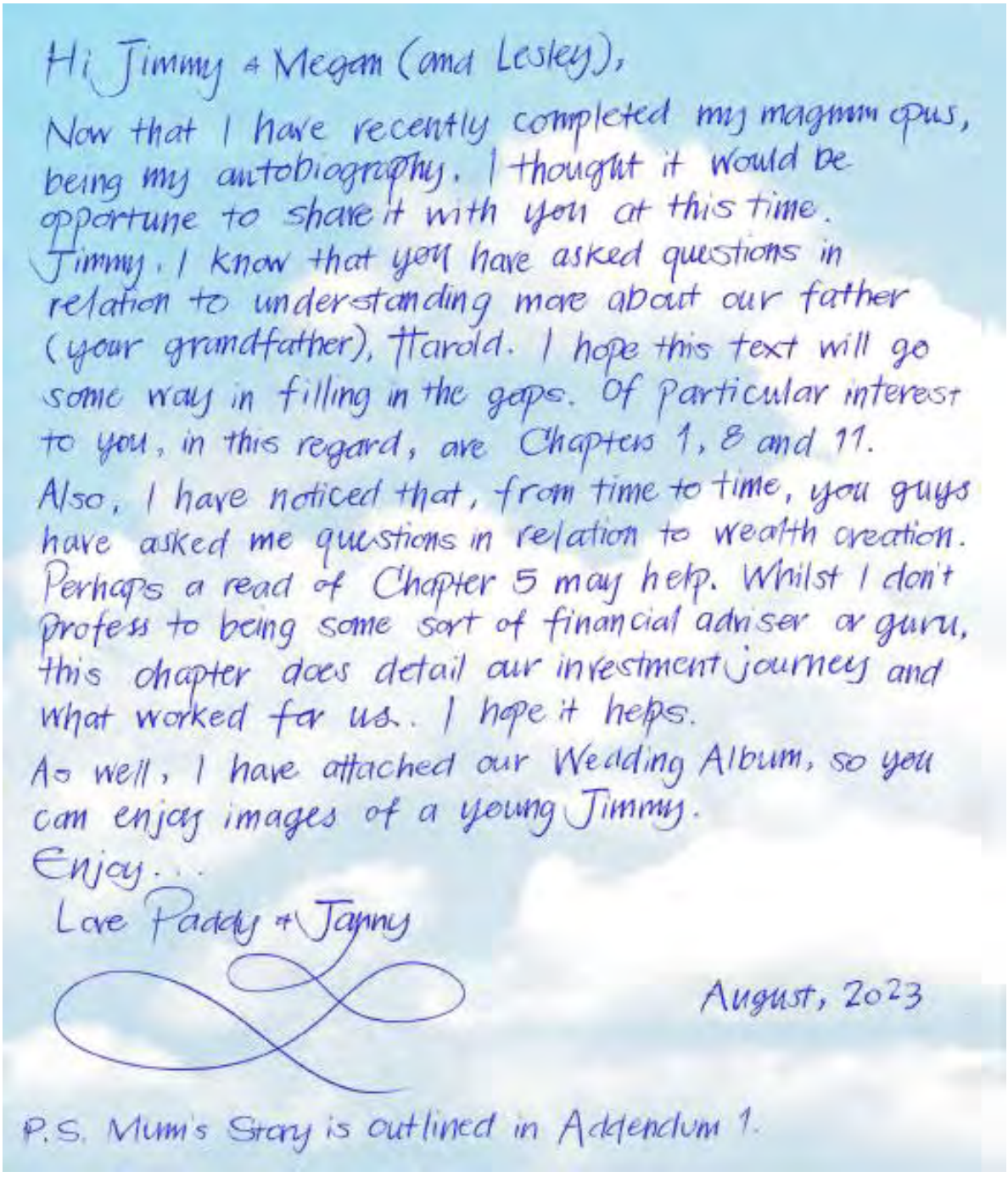
Time ~ 1:23:07
Distance ~ 14.14km
Pace ~ 5.53
Calories ~ 983

Hands down the best fun run in Australia. The streetscapes and resident support is magnificent. It was a struggle getting ready for this run, due to my knee injury, but boy was it worth it! Ultimately, my final run.

Message from C2S immediately after the run;
"Congrats Patrick,
You finished the 2023 City2Surf in a time of 1:23.00
Keep up the training…see you next year".
I suspect that with my knee injury, this was my swansong.

Wednesday August 23, 2023

I lent my autobiography "The Importance of Being" to Jimmy and Megan together with our wedding album. I attached the letter below with the items;



Hi Jimmy & Megan (and Lesley),

Now that I have recently completed my magnum opus, being my autobiography, I thought it would be opportune to share it with you at this time.

Jimmy, I know that you have asked questions in relation to understanding more about our father (your grandfather), Harold. I hope this text will go some way in filling in the gaps. Of particular interest to you, in this regard, are Chapters 1, 8 and 11.

Also, I have noticed that, from time to time, you guys have asked me questions in relation to wealth creation. Perhaps a read of Chapter 5 may help. Whilst I don't profess to being some sort of financial adviser or guru, this chapter does detail our investment journey and what worked for us. I hope it helps.

As well, I have attached our Wedding Album, so you can enjoy images of a young Jimmy.

Enjoy...

Love Paddy & Jenny

August, 2023

P.S. Mum's Story is outlined in Addendum 1.

Made the folowing note in my diary, on the eve of travelling to the United States;

Resferber (noun)
The restless race of the travellers heart before a journey begins –
that tangled feeling of nervous anticipation
and excitement.

. . . .

UNITED INTL
ERNEST/PA CKASHLEYMR Basic Economy
131
Melbourne, Australia to San Francisco
TRAVEL READY
UA 61
MEL-SFO 20
10:05 AM
35D
BOARDING GROUP 4
Boarding Ends 10:40 AM
Flight Departs 10:55 AM
Flight Arrives 8:30 AM
Economy
LRCKX9
A STAR ALLIANCE MEMBER

Thursday August 24, 2023

Flight UA61
Bound for San Francisco
Thursday 24th August, 2023

In flight musings....

I can...
read the Herald Sun,
watch a movie,
listen to Spotify.
I can, if weariness prevails, sleep.
But sometimes, it's nice just to listen to, and engage with, my own conscience.
The thoughts, the images, this cacophony of emotions, using my mind like a projector.
Now at cruising altitude, somewhere over the South Pacific.
I am in this sort of comfort zone, whereby I have this overwhelming sense that it's fair dinkum good to be alive.
The air hostesses....sorry, flight attendants reflect an inclusivity that premeates our so called enlightened society – they are all middle aged.
An overwhelming sense that, by the very nature of us being on this flight, this journey, we are indeed blessed. We are not hamstrung by the vagaries of war or conflict, we are not restricted by physical disability, nor financial head winds. We have capacity and capability. My thoughts are with those who are lacking.
I'm sure I saw Samantha Stosur on this flight. Perhaps, like us, heading to New York and Flushing Meadow. A former US Open champion, she is forever a part of the US Open dialogue and proud history.
The lights in the cabin have gone out. Janny is getting some shut eye. I will now read the Herald Sun and then determine what I do next.

Friday, August 25, 2023

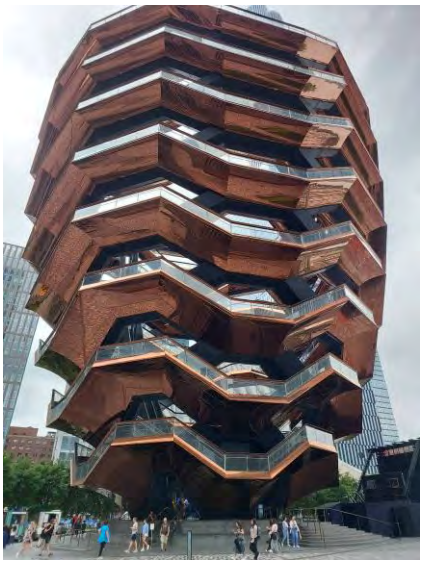
Subject to applicable tariffs and conditions of use.
EXPIRES 01/31/25
3174308945 28908365
For MetroCard Customer Service, call 511 or go to eFIX at mta.info
M1537
Drop something on the subway tracks? Leave it!
NEVER go down onto the tracks, for *any* reason. Your safety is more important. Tell a police officer or an MTA employee. Use a Help Point Intercom.
Be smart. Be safe. Stay off the tracks.
MTA

Grand Central Terminal

Our MetroCard tickets for travelling on the subway. Our first trip was on Line 7 from Grand Central to Mets-Willets (Flushing Meadow)

7

Attended the US Open Fan Zone and was able to download our game day tickets on out Ticketek app.



We travelled on the Subway Line 7 to Hudson Yards from Mets-Willets.
Saw the The Vessel and walked the High Line.

GRAND CENTRAL TERMINAL - Pg. 187

DAY 1 - FRI. AUG 25 (T)

TRAIN TO FLUSHING MEADOW - Grand Central to Mets - Willets Point 31 minute trip. US Open Fan Access area. Talk to ticket box to access tickets. Take in sights and sounds. ☑ ff

- GET FREE WI-FI AT FAN ACCESS
- FROM HOTEL to BROOKLYN BRIDGE ... TAKE LINE 4 SUBWAY from GRAND CENTRAL - 42 ST TO FULTON ST. AND THEN TAKE THE SUBWAY FROM FULTON ST. TO HIGH STREET - BROOKLYN BRIDGE (South side of Bridge) ☐
- At Grand Central or at a subway station, Subway station at GCS serviced by the 4, 5, 6, (7), & S subway lines. TAKE LINE 7 SUBWAY FROM GRAND CENTRAL - 42 ST TO WILLETS POINT ☑
- METROCARDS - $30 UNLIMITED RIDE - 7 DAY PASS ~ TRAIN + BUS ✓ ff
- ENTER AT EAST GATE, USTA BILLIE JEAN KING NATIONAL TENNIS CENTRE
- STATION PRIOR TO METS - WILLETS POINT - 103 ST CORONA PLAZA station. ✓ ff

DAY 2 - SAT, AUG 26

- MUSEUM OF MODERN ART - MoMA PG. 181 ~ 11 W 53rd St btwn 5th & 6th AVES From Hotel - turn right along 42nd to Madison Ave - turn right and walk up to 53rd and turn left. ☑ ff
- CHRYSLER BUILDING - PG. 183 ☑ ff LEXINGTON AVE @ 42nd ST.
- VIEW FROM 3rd AVE & 44th ST. For GREAT VIEW Left from hotel - to 3rd AVE, turn left and walk to 44th ST. NOT OPEN SATURDAYS. OPEN 8.00am TO 6.00pm MON TO FRI.

☑ - SEE MIDTOWN MEANDER - PG. 191 NEW YORK PUBLIC LIBRARY - Rose ✓ ff Main Reading Room. Join a free guided tour from the info. desk in Astor Hall. ff

BRYANT PARK ✓, TIMES SQUARE ✓, ROCKEFELLER PLAZA ✓, GE BUILDING, RADIO CITY MUSIC HALL - Pg. 188 ✓, 2.9km - 3½ HOURS ☑ ff

Saturday, August 26, 2023

[redacted]

MoMA

Saturday 08/26/2023

106161319
9ccd4e33

Your ticket includes
A free same-day film ticket
Free admission to MoMA PS1 within 14 days
$25 off a new membership

Free MoMA WiFi

General Admission
Senior
$18.00
Access our map, audio, and more at moma.org/guide

[redacted]

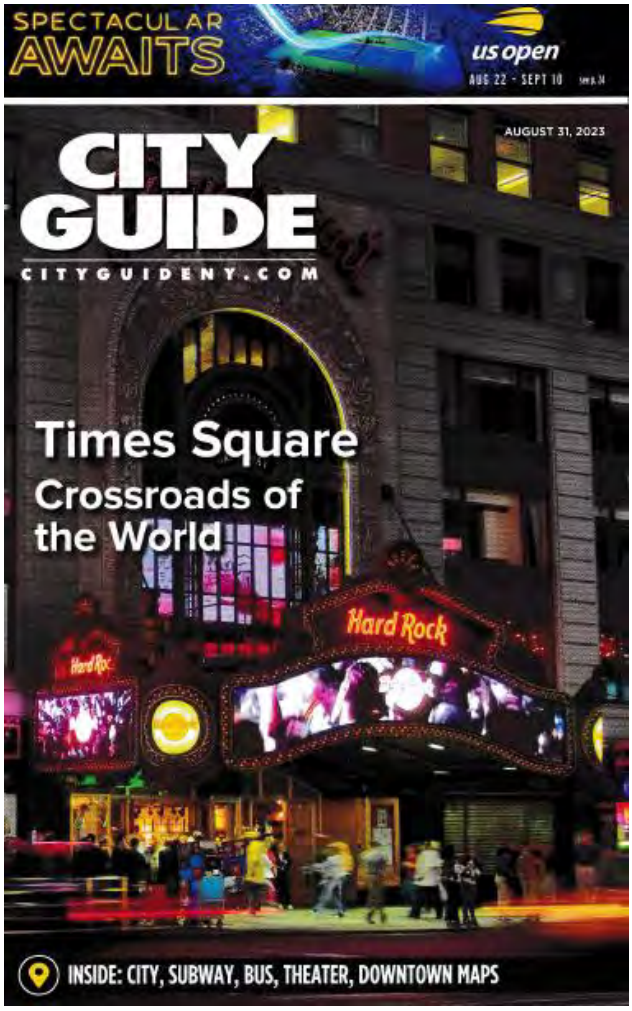
Jackson Pollock's *One : Number 31, 1950*
Viewed at the Museum of Modern Art, New York

On the same day we visited the New York Public Library.
Not as impressive as the Victorian State Library, but nice none the less.

Saturday August 26, 2023

CHRYSLER BUILDING
We took this photo from the corner of 3rd Avenue and 44th Street where we could appreciate the building's slimline profile, gargoyles and and spire in one hit.

The WELCOME note inside the New York City Guide states *"Welcome to New York, the city that never sleeps. You have arrived at the United States' epicenter of culture, attractions, theater, dining and more".*



DAY 3 ~ SUNDAY AUGUST 27

☑ • EMPIRE STATE BUILDING - Pg. 178
E 42nd ST TO 5th AVE ~ TURN LEFT - FOLLOW DOWN TO 34th STREET
TIME : 11.00am (MAP PG. 427)
CHECK IF CITIPASS ALLOWS ACCESS
✓ IN EVENING, POSSIBLY THU, AUG. 31
• LIVE JAZZ THURSDAY TO SAT NIGHTS DAY + NIGHT

☑ • IF POSSIBLE ~ MUSEUM OF MODERN ART
42nd ST TO 5th AVE + TURN RIGHT FOLLOW UP TO E 53rd ST & TURN LEFT
11 W 53rd ST (btw FIFTH + SIXTH AVES)
PG. 181 - FLOATING VISIT

• 4.00am - IS 6.00pm IN MELBOURNE.
3AW APP. FOR FOOTY ☑

☑ MACY'S HERALD SQUARE

☑ PENN STATION

DAY 4 ~ MONDAY AUG. 28 @ 1.00pm

☑ • STATUE CITY CRUISES, BATTERY PARK
TAKE 4 or 5 SUBWAY TRAIN FROM GRAND CENTRAL - 42 ST STATION TO BOWLING GREEN STATION. From there - walk to the Battery Maritime Building to catch ferry. Ticket office located inside Castle Clinton at The Battery. We walk to STATUE CITY CRUISES past Castle Clinton. (T)
• STATION PRIOR TO BOWLINGGREEN STATION ~ FULTON ST STATION
~~Sat Night~~

☑ ▶ TONIGHT ~ TIMES SQUARE - From hotel, turn right, walk along 42nd ST and walk to Broadway / 7th AVE.
Map Pg. 431 ~ Pg. 176. - See DON'T MISS...

• TIME PERMITTING ~ FOYER OF CHRYSLER BUILDING ~ PG. 183 : Peter DON'T MISS... LOBBY, SPIRE, GARGOYLES ☑

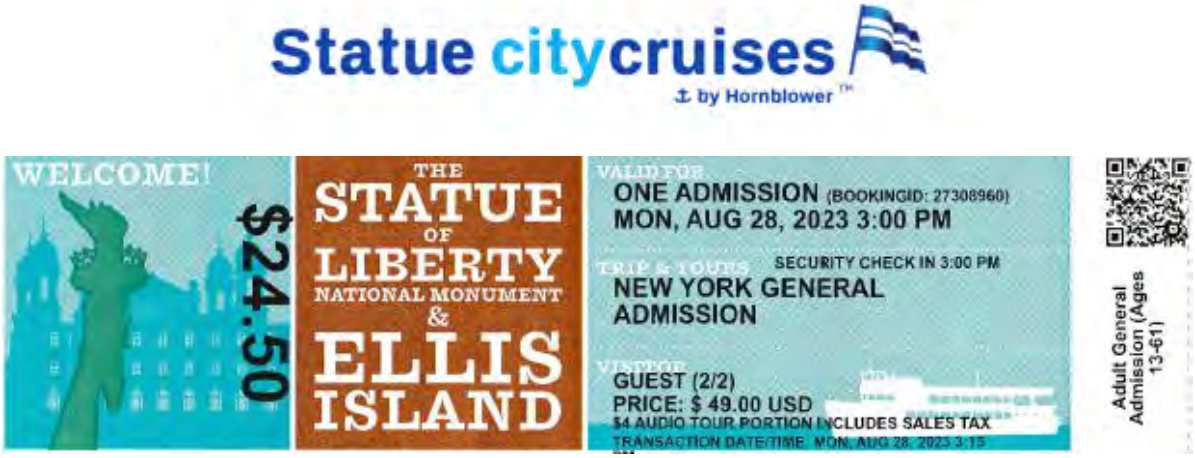
Sunday August 27, 2023

THE
EMPIRE STATE
BUILDING
OBSERVATORY

For many years Janny and I dreamed of visiting the Empire State Building with the movie "An Affair to Remember" front and centre in our thoughts.
Today that dream was realised.

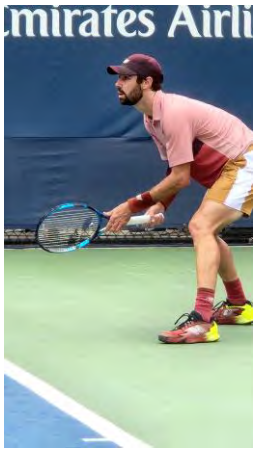
Janny and I on top of the world.
Deborah Kerr's words to Cary Grant in "*An Affair to Remember*" still ring true:
"It's the nearest thing to heaven we have in New York"

Monday August 28, 2023



The New York Times masthead.
"All the News That's Fit to Print"

Tuesday August 29, 2023



A day at the 2023 US Open.
Flushing Meadow. Saw Thanasi Kokkinakis and Jordan Thompson on outside courts. A bucket list day. Many more to come.

1st Round Men's / Women's

Tue · Aug 29, 2023 · 12:00 PM

Arthur Ashe Stadium — Flushing, New York

Get Directions

Sec 334, Row T, Seat 1 - 2

Wednesday August 30, 2023

9/11 MEMORIAL & MUSEUM

The last known photo of the Twin Towers.
8.30am September 11, 2001.

The September 11 Museum was very extensive. Many aspects were extremely moving.

Reflecting Pool – North Tower.
The pools are both striking and deeply poignant.

American Museum of Natural History

Dear PAT ERNEST,

Thank you for your reservation. Your tickets will be issued at a Museum ticket counter when your valid ID, pass, or voucher is presented.

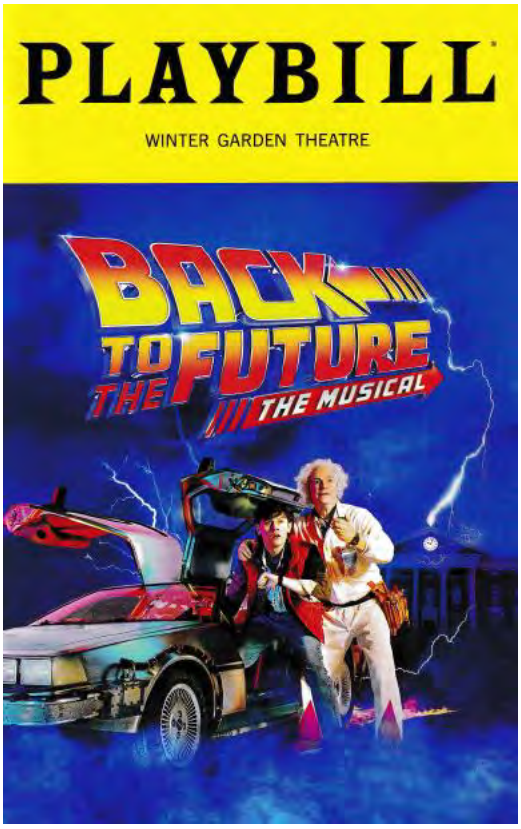
If payment is required, it will be made at the Museum. If you are eligible for special exhibitions, they will be selected at the Museum.

We look forward to seeing you on:

Thursday, August 31, 2023 10:30 AM

Tyrannosaurus Rex

Thursday August 31, 2023



Attended Back to the Future – The Musical on Broadway on
Thursday August 31, 2023

★★★★

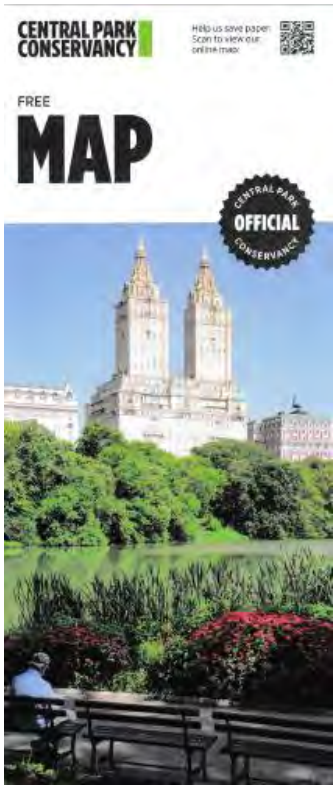
Upon entering the Winter Garden Theatre on Broadway to see Back to the Future – The Musical, we were each handed a copy of the show program PLAYBILL. The pocket size theatre program reminded me of the similar sized footy records we would buy at the footy back in the day. Only difference is the PLAYBILL is free, whereas the theatre programs in Oz are around $30 each! A welcomed surprise. There is a PLAYBILL printed for every show on Broadway and theatre goers have an opportunity to store them in collectible folders. Right up my alley. The show was great as well.

Janny in front of the Winter Garden Theater

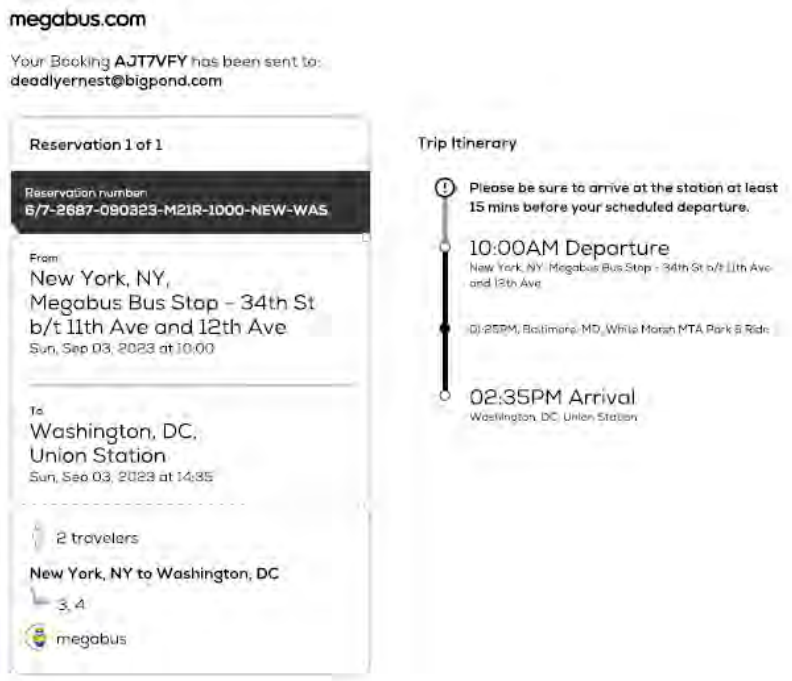
INTREPID
SEA, AIR & SPACE MUSEUM COMPLEX

On **Friday September 1** we visited the Intrepid Sea, Air and Space Musuem Complex located in a WWII aircraft carrier - the USS Intrepid. The flight deck features fighter planes and military helicopters. Also within the museum is the space shuttle Enterprise.

Following this vist and via Pat Cormick's recommendation, we took the Circle Line NYC cruise from the Hudson to the East River and took in many of New York's landmarks.



On **Saturday September 2**, we spent the day at Central Park. We took a bicycle tour and visited many of the Park's highlights, including Strawberry Fields and the John Lennon IMAGINE memorial.


megabus.com

Your Booking **AJT7VFY** has been sent to:
deadlyernest@bigpond.com

Reservation 1 of 1

Reservation number
6/7-2687-090323-M21R-1000-NEW-WAS

From
New York, NY,
Megabus Bus Stop - 34th St
b/t 11th Ave and 12th Ave
Sun, Sep 03, 2023 at 10:00

To
Washington, DC,
Union Station
Sun, Sep 03, 2023 at 14:35

2 travelers

New York, NY to Washington, DC

3, 4

megabus

Trip Itinerary

Please be sure to arrive at the station at least 15 mins before your scheduled departure.

10:00AM Departure
New York, NY - Megabus Bus Stop - 34th St b/t 11th Ave and 12th Ave

01:25PM, Baltimore, MD, White Marsh MTA Park & Ride

02:35PM Arrival
Washington, DC, Union Station

On **Sunday September 3** we caught a pre-booked bus to travel to Washington DC, arriving at the beautiful Union Station and then checked into the DuPont Circle Hotel, in the Embassy district.

Monday September 4, 2023

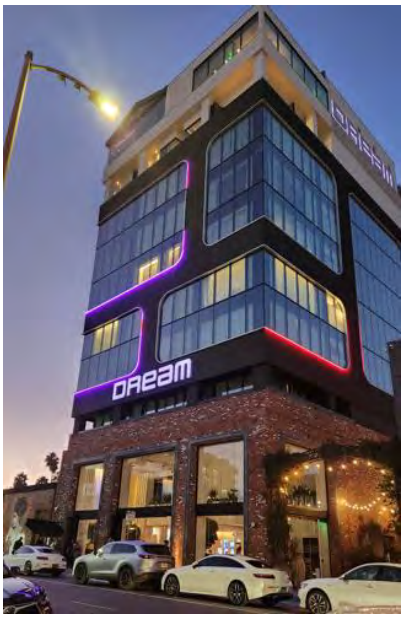
We visited the Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum. It took us a full day to get through all the exhibits, including the Dark Universe in the Planetarium.

On **Tuesday September 5** we embarked on a Discover DC Tour and ticked off all the DC highlights listed below. It was a very hot day and the complimentary water was very much appreciated.

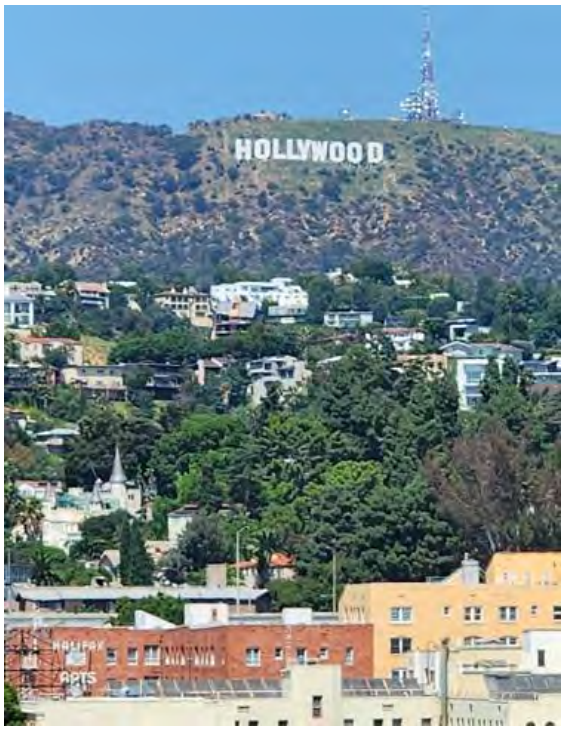
There is no shortage of memorials in DC.
From left: the Jefferson, Lincoln and Martin Luther King memorials.
Other highlights were the World War II and FDR memorials.

WASHINGTON
MON SEPT. 4 - Smithsonian National Air + Space Museum ☑
TUE SEPT 5 - Discover DC Tour
10.00am departure.
☑ WHITE HOUSE
☑ WW II MEMORIAL
☑ JEFFERSON MEMORIAL
☑ FDR MEMORIAL
☑ GEORGETOWN RIVER CRUISE
☑ MARTIN LUTHER KING MEMORIAL
☑ KOREAN WAR MEMORIAL
☑ LINCOLN MEMORIAL
☑ VIETNAM VETERANS MEMORIAL
☑ CAPITOL HILL

WEDNESDAY, SEPT 6
DREAM HOLLYWOOD: 6417 SELMA AVE, LOS ANGELES (HOLLYWOOD)
FLIGHT ARRIVAL TIME: 11:25 am
CATCH A CAB: $70 ~ 85
THINGS TO DO...
✓• Cahuenga Blvd - from Hotel foyer, turn left to Cahuenga Blvd turn left, walk down to Hollywood Blvd - Hollywood Tours and Tickets.
✓• HOLLYWOOD WALK OF FAME... Turn right at HB from Cahuenga.
✓• TCL CHINESE THEATRE and next door KODAK THEATRE.
✓• HOLLYWOOD + HIGHLAND - Multistory Mall / DOLBY THEATRE.
✓• SMALL GROUP TOUR by open-sided shuttle to PARAMOUNT PICTURES et al
• GRIFFITH OBSERVATORY
✓• BEVERLY HILLS / RODEO DRIVE
✓• SANTA MONICA PIER AND VENICE BOARDWALK + VENICE BEACH.
✓• LA BREA TAR PITS
• PINKS HOT DOGS
✓• HOP ON / HOP OFF BUS x 3 days



We flew into Los Angeles on **Wednesday September 6, 2023** and checked into our "art-series" DREAM hotel. The foyer displayed many NFT artworks.



The staff at the DREAM hotel were very helpful and upgraded us to a room with a modest balcony. We had views to the HOLLYWOOD sign and the Griffith Observatory. We were very close to Hollywood Boulevard and the Walk of Fame.
While in Hollywood we used the CitySightseeing bus to check out Venus Beach, Santa Monica Beach, La Brea Tar Pits, downtown Los Angeles and Beverly Hills.

Handprints of the Avengers at the TCL Chinese Theater.

Friday 15 September, 2023
F I R S T S E M I F I N A L
Melbourne v Carlton – MCG 7.40pm

Carlton 11.7.73 d Melbourne 9.17.71
Carlton best: Walsh, Cripps, DeKoning, Cerra, Weitering, Newman

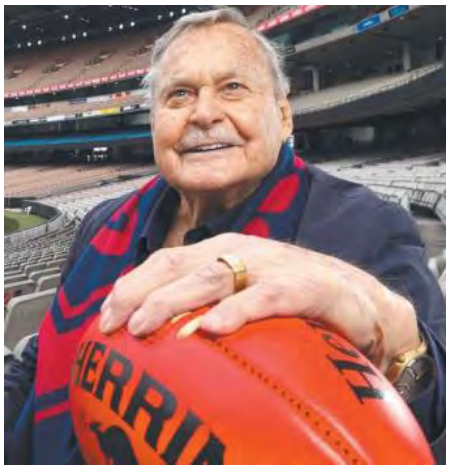
Saturday 16 September, 2023

A SATURDAY REFLECTION….
"It's Friday September 15 at the MCG – a semi final showdown between Melbourne and Carlton. Jeff and I have seats in the Medallion Club. The Dees are favoured to win.
It's the 34 minute mark of the final quarter and we are 2 points up. Jeff and I are begging for the siren to sound. The stressful tension of emotion was unbearable. Then suddenly, the final siren went. We jumped in the air and the roar of the Carlton faithful was of a magnitude that, after fifty years of following the Blues, was the loudest I had ever experienced. At that very moment of joyous rapture I happened to look from our Level 2 seats at the delirious Carlton fans below us on Level 1. I can only describe what I saw as a tsunami of ecstasy, joy, relief and euphoria. A veritable mosh pit of pandemonium. It was as if twenty years of disappointment and frustration was released in this tidal wave of sheer elation. Something Jeff and I will never forget.
With Jeff and me now in our sixties, this game… this club…continues to keep giving".

"And they'll know that they've been playing
against the famous
Old Dark Blues"

Tuesday September 19, 2023, following the 2 point semi final win over Melbourne.

I have not been so exhilerated about a win since the 1999 Preliminary Final win over the Bombers, however I cannot underestimate how angry and disappointed we were in May and June of this year. They were hard to watch!



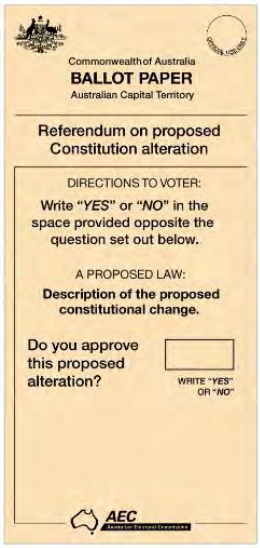
Sunday September 17, 2023
VALE RONALD DALE BARASSI 1936 ~ 2023
A real giant of our great game.

Registration District FARNHAM.

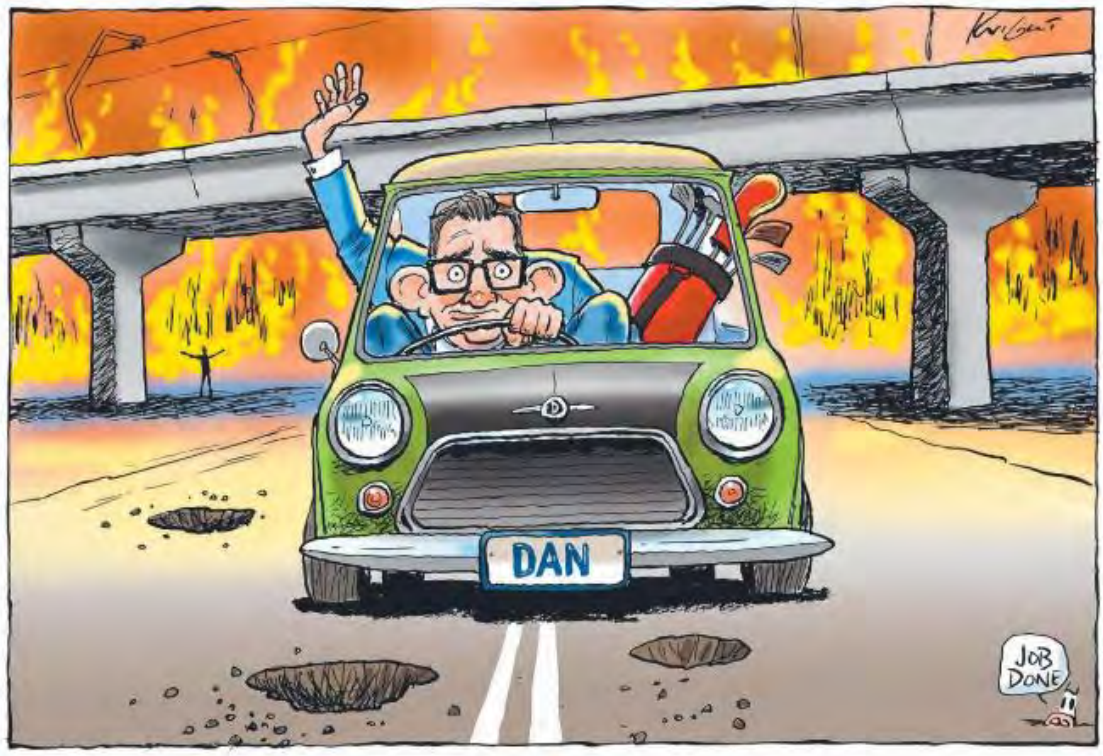
1914. BIRTHS in the Sub-District of FARNHAM in the County of SURREY.

Columns:— 1		2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
No.	When and Where Born.	Name, if any.	Sex.	Name and Surname of Father.	Name and Maiden Surname of Mother.	Rank or Profession of Father.	Signature, Description, and Residence of Informant.	When Registered.	Signature of Registrar.	Baptismal Name if added after Registration of Birth.
216	Fourth August 1919. The Infirmary, Hale Road, Farnham.	Harold Ernest.	Boy	—	Lydia de Burgh, formerly Lakapin a Ward maid, of 65 British Road Aldershot.	—	Lydia de Burgh Mother. The Infirmary. Hale Road. Farnham.	Twenty third August 1919	C. H. Moore Registrar.	

In **September, 2023** our cousin Helen was able to track down an extract of Dad's birth certificate as part of her genealogical pursuits. Sadly it does not identify the name of Harold Ernest's father (my Grandfather). Her search continues.

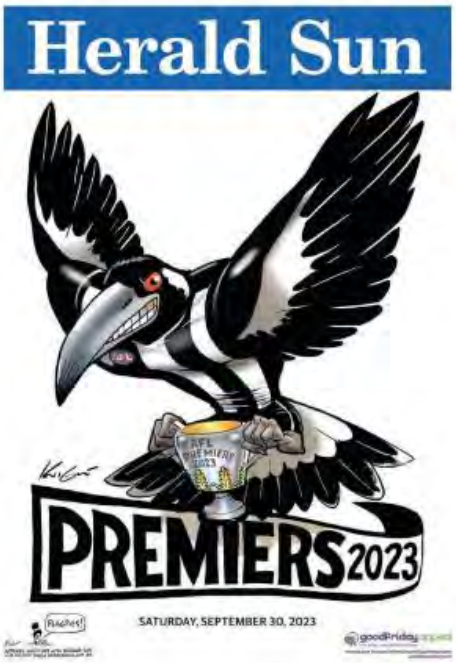


Tuesday September 26, 2023.
Attended AEC training at 7 Pitt Street, Reservior.



Good riddance Dan!

Wednesday September 27, 2023



Saturday September 30, 2023

Collingwood's 16th premiership fairytale came off the back of one of the great modern day grand finals.

The Magpies joined rivals Carlton and Essendon on 16 VFL/AFL flags with a four point grand final win over a gallant Brisbane Lions. There were so many highlights – 21 wins from 26 games; the "Houdini" Pies won three finals by a combined 12 points; Craig McCrae's Midas touch saw him become the club's sixth premiership coach on the same day he had his third daughter, and Darcy Moore received the Cup from his dad Peter as the sons of Peter Daicos – Nick and Josh – capped All Australian seasons.

Janny was very happy!

AEC
Australian Electoral Commission

Started work for the AEC at the Northcote Pre-Poll Voting Centre in High Street Thornbury on **Monday October 2, 2023.**
Referendum to alter the Constitution.

"A proposed law; to alter the Constitution to **recognise** the First Peoples of Australia by establishing an Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander **Voice.**
Do you approve of this proposed alteration?"
This is a double barrelled proposition. I favour the concept of recognising the First Peoples of Australia in the Constitution, but to predicate this with a condition of establishing a voice is where my support fell away.

Sunday October 8, 2023

Janny gives the photographer a wave as we cross the summit of the West Gate Bridge.

For many years I would brag to Janny about my cycling ventures, albeit with a slight tinge of sadness that she could not accompany me. Well, that has all changed now that we have our tandem bike. This "freedom machine" has opened up so many opportunities to trail blaze new frontiers together. Armed with our bluetooth speaker, Spotify and some seriously big playlists (My Ultimate Playlist and My 70's Playlist to name but a few) we can cycle, talk and sing as we peddle together and all the while taking in the sights. Happy days!

On **Friday October 17, 2023** I completed my last day of a two week tenure as a pre-poll voting officer. Today was a long and very busy day. Glad it's over, truth be told.
Notable people to cast their votes in the Northcote PPVC;

Tuesday 10th October
Saverio Rocca and Peter McKenna – Collingwood legends
Wednesday 11th October
Scott Owen – The Living End
Thursday 12th October
Samantha Stosur – US Open Champion
Friday 13th October – Matthew Richardson – Richmond legend
I was able to strike up a conversation with all, which was just wonderful.

Peter McKenna told me that when he played for Carlton they had a bloody good team but a "shit" coach, referring to Ian Thorogood. Lovely bloke.
I shook Scott Owen's hand and thanked him for The Living End enhancing my life and told him I viewed The Living End as Australia's greatest rock back, even better than the mighty Cold Chisel. I said I based this on the volume and quality of music the band had pumped out. I also told him that I believed that their song "The Room" was one of the greatest Australian recordings ever. He did agree that it was a great piece and that it is on their playlist for their upcoming Festival Hall gig. A very good bloke.
I mentioned to Samantha Stosur that I bumped into her at the taxi rank at Newark Airport New York and we had a chat there, which she acknowledged. Very friendly.

Janny and I….delivering democracy.

Possibly the most powerful message to come out of this campaign.

Saturday October 14, 2023
R E F E R E N D U M D A Y

"We need to be one together,
not two divided. That's why
I am voting NO to the
Voice of division"

SENATOR JACINTA NAMPIJINPA PRICE

. . .

Perhaps the YES campaign has ran out of puff?
Time will tell.

7.10pm Saturday evening and while Janny continues her work at the Kew Scout Hall voting centre, I settle in to watch the telecast of the Referendum results on TV. I was quite surprised to discover that most, if not all commentators were, at that early stage, concluding that the YES campaign was doomed. By 7.30pm it was patently clear that most states were voting NO.

Later that evening Anthony Albanese spoke at his media conference and following his speech, was asked what he believed went wrong.
He mentioned that referendums historically are not successful when there is no bipartisan support. I nearly fell off my chair! Surely he could have consulted with Opposition Leader Peter Dutton and confirmed that the Liberal Party were planning to support the NO cause, and consequently not proceed with the referendum, which by the way cost taxpayers $400 million dollars. This referendum was doomed before it started, and Albo knew it!

Sunday 15 October, 2023

The Voice has been defeated with a strong "NO" vote in every state, including Victoria.

In voting NO to the voice,
Australians voted Yes to unity,
Yes to equality
and Yes to our Constitution remaining colour blind.

Saturday October 21, 2023

As I was waiting for Janny to get ready for our Paul McCartney concert, I took the opportunity to flick through the Paul McCartney biography MANY YEARS FROM NOW. I stumbled on page 465 and read the following;

I got this idea for a song "Hey Jude" and John and Yoko had come over to visit and listening to it as I played it to them. When I got to the line "The movement you need is on your shoulder" I mentioned that "I'll change that - it's a bit crummy". I was just blocking it out and John said "You won't you know. That's the best line in it!" That's collaboration! When someone's that firm about a line that you're going to junk and he says "No, keep it in". So you love that line twice as much. When I'm singing it that is when I think of John…it is an emotional point in the song.

I'm close to declaring this concert to be the best I have ever attended. The sound and production quality was elite. And not to mention the setlist. In particular the John Lennon penned Beatles song *Being for the Benefit of Mr. Kite*, which in my opinion is a very complex song musically, was performed precisely and did not miss a beat….remarkable. All this, mind you, from a bloke who is 81!

An emotional magical mystery tour that I will never forget.

★ ★ ★ ★ ★

Paul McCartney's Got Back tour set list;

- Cant Buy Me Love
- Junior's Farm
- Letting Go
- Got to Get You into My Life
- Come On to Me
- Let Me Roll It
- Getting Better
- Let 'Em In
- My Valentine
- Nineteen Hundred and Eighty Five
- Maybe I'm Amazed
- I've Just Seen a Face
- In Spite of All the Danger
- Love Me Do
- Dance Tonight
- Blackbird
- Here Today
- Lady Madonna
- Jet
- Being For The Benefit of Mr. Kite
- Something (a tribute to George)
- Ob-La-Di, Ob-La-Da
- You Never Give Me Your Money
- She Came In Through The Bathroom Window
- Get Back
- Band on the Run
- Let It Be
- Hey Jude
- I've Got a Feeling (duet with John Lennon)
- Helter Skelter
- Golden Slumbers
- Carry That Weight
- The End

I emailed Pat Cormick in Canberra to give him an update on progress regarding the acquisition of my Coronavirus journal at the National Library of Australia and to mention that we attended the Paul McCartney concert. His response follows;

"Thanks also for your reflection on the "Got Back" concert. I wish I had been there. As a twelve year old in Brunswick in 1964, with basically no dough and lacking the nous on how to get highly sought after tickets, I missed seeing the Beatles at Festival Hall; one of my few regrets in life. All the reviews I have read before and after his latest show rate it as an exceptional and memorable experience, just as you experienced.

I saw his tribute to George on telly in 2002 where he started "Something" on ukulele with the band coming in gradually to a full sound. I found that very moving and I know he does it in his current show, with probably the best group of musicians in the world backing him. I'm sure it also made a big impression this time around.

Also, the virtual duet with John Lennon, thanks to Peter Jackson stripping out the vocal from the Rooftop Concert, would have been an incredible and surreal experience. And all this from a bloke who is 81 and proved again he can still do it, like at last year's Glastonbury where he and his band were rated the best performance of the festival".

Tuesday 24 October, 2023

I had just completed and submitted a biography for Kwai. I received this email from Normin – MannaCare Volunteer Coordinator;

Hi Pat,

Please see feedback received from Kwai's daughter Priscilla. Thank you.

Hi Normin,

Thanks for your help to arrange mum's bio compilation. I showed her this morning, she is very happy to see it.
We are very appreciated Pat's great effort to put all together for mum. Please say big thanks to him.

Best regards
Priscilla

Regards,
Normin Suleman

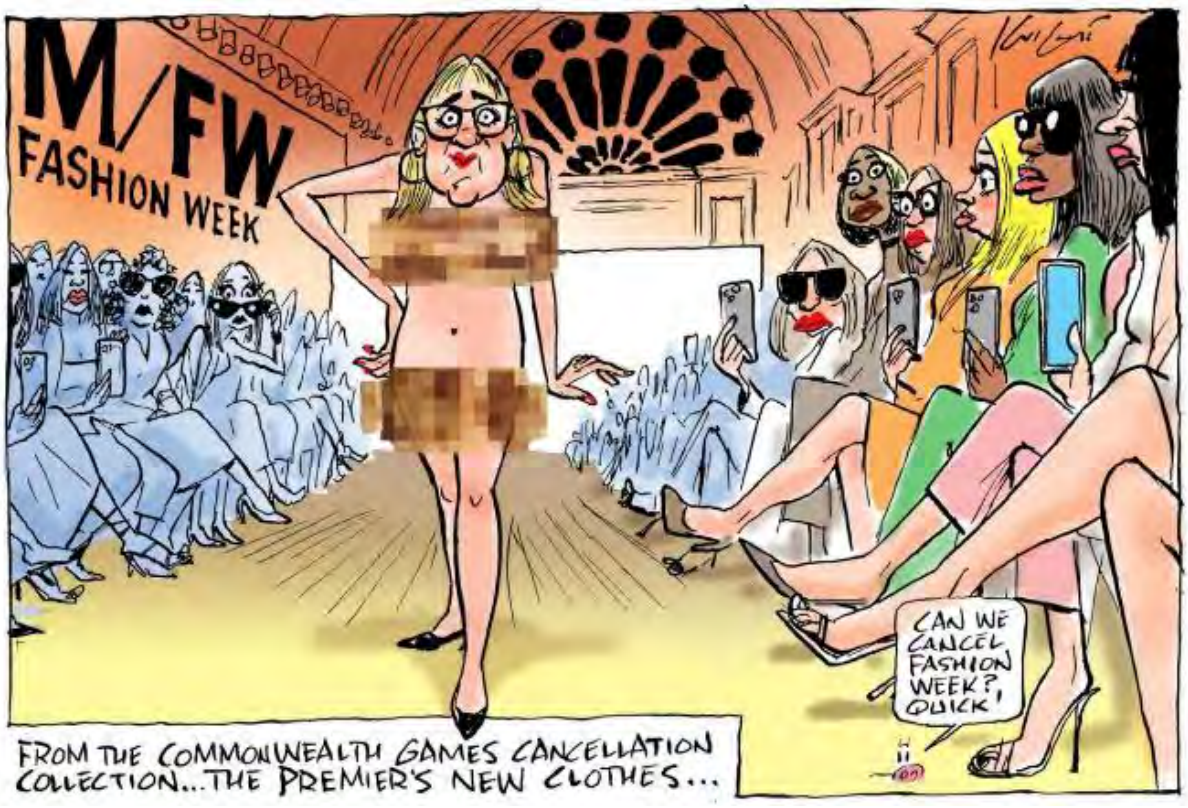
Community Engagement Lead
P | (03) 9856 1224
E | normin.suleman@mannacare.org.au

MannaCare
WIDER CHOICES FOR OLDER PEOPLE

THE BIG SHOW

ODI WORLD CUP – INDIA

Glenn Maxwell blasts 100 off 40 balls at the World Cup in India, setting the record for the fastest 100 in a One Day International. Eventually out for 106. That's why they call him "The Big Show"!

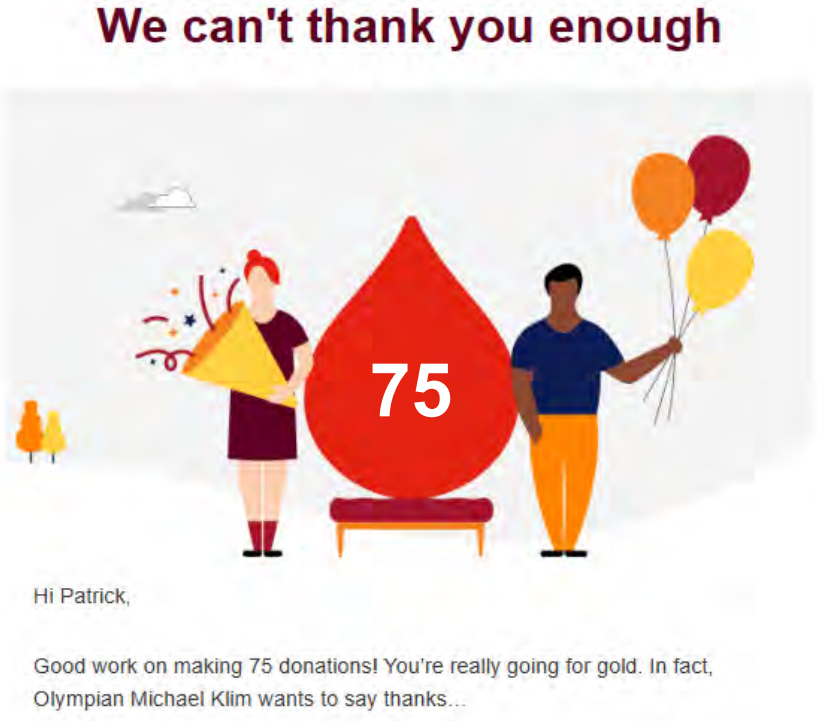


This cartoon appeared in the Herald Sun on **Tuesday October 24, 2023.** Mark Knight was roundly criticised and accused of sexism. He explained that this image is a parody of The Emperor's Clothes and it was about the position rather than the person and would have drawn Dan Andrews in the same fashion if he was still in power.

The Age – Wednesday November 1, 2023
Difficult to see a solution to this mess. Deep seated hatred.

Friday November 2, 2023

Amazingly, The Beatles have released a new song and it is their last. In 1977 John Lennon was working on a song that was never quite completed. In 1994, Yoko Ono passed the song, on a cassette, to Paul McCartney, in the possibility that he and his fellow Beatles Ringo and George, could finish it off and release it as a Beatles song.
Unfortunately at the time the technology was not available to separate John's vocals from the piano playing, thus rendering the vocals as grainy and unusable. Fast track to 2022 and with the advent of technlogy and filmaker Peter Jackson's work on the movie "Get Back", they were able to successfully isolate John's voice on the track, opening the door for George's pre recorded guitar piece with Paul's bass guitar and Ringo's drums to complete the song. Today, November 2, 2023 the song "Now and Then" was released. A true Beatle's song with contributions from all members.



Also on **Thursday November 2, 2023** I donated plasma for the 75th time.
I received this email (above) from LifeBlood to mark the occasion.

Australian Red Cross Lifeblood

Tuesday November 7, 2023

T H E B I G S H O W (A C T I I)

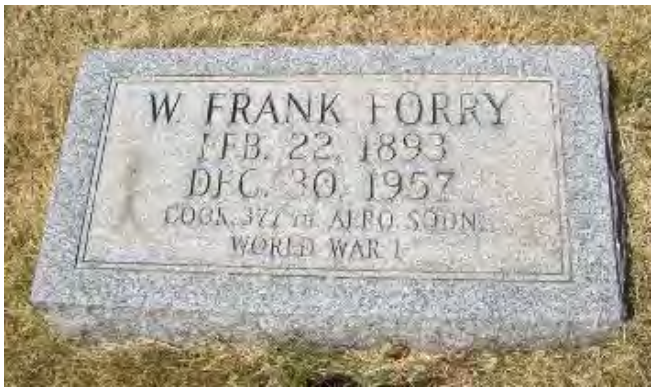
Glenn Maxwell defied intense pain to play one of the greatest innings in history and pull off the mother of all heists in a World Cup epic against Afghanistan in Mumbai.

A cramping Maxwell (201 from 128 balls) could hardly walk, let alone run.

Chasing 292 for victory, Australia were 7/91 at one stage!

The Big Show just got bigger. Perhaps the greatest innings of all time.

★



Tuesday November 7, 2023

This could well be the grave of my grandfather (Harold's father).

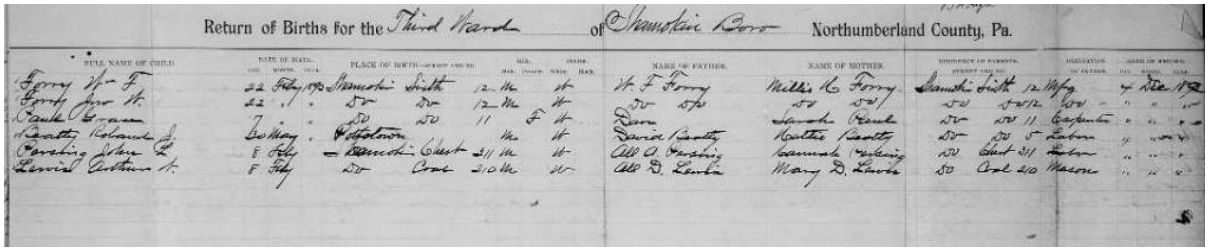
W I L L I A M F R A N K F O R R Y

COOK 377TH AERO SQDN

WORLD WAR 1

US Army Service Number 965393

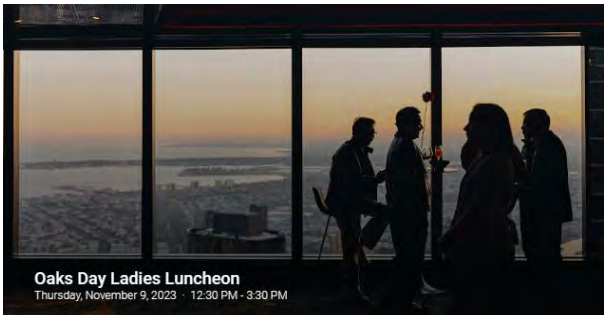
As part of cousin Helen's extensive genealogical work, she has uncovered divorce papers that point out that the father of Lydia's child allegedly was William Frank Forry of West Reading, Berks, Pennsylvannia, USA.
A significant revelation. A watershed moment.


Return of Births for the Third Ward of Shamokin Boro Northumberland County, Pa.

This birth certificate extract shows that grandfather William Forry has a twin brother – John William Forry.

William Forrey's brothers (left) and his parents.

Thursday November 9, 2023



Janny and I attended the Oaks Day Ladies Luncheon at Eureka 89 on the 89th floor of the Eureka Tower, Southbank. Breathtaking views.

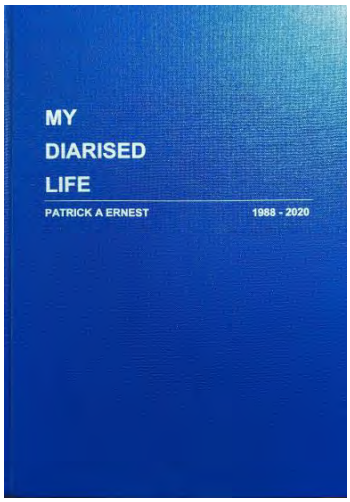
Friday November 10, 2023

"If it is to be, it is up to me".

RONALD DALE BARASSI

Janny and I attended the State Memorial Service for the legendary Ron Barassi at the MCG. It was a warm day with a forecast top temperature of 31^0 C. Ron could not have planned it better.

Later that afternoon Janny and I travelled to Caulfield to pick up my latest completed book, *My Diarised Life*. On the way there along Hawthorn Road we heard that there was trouble brewing between Palestinians and Jewish citizens near the Burgertory restaurant at the corner of Glenhuntly Road. The restaurant had been firebombed earlier in the day. As we got close to our destination we saw many people milling around the burnt out restaurant with numerous police on hand. I asked Julian at Whites Bindery what was going on and he filled us in on all the drama that was transpiring in the area.



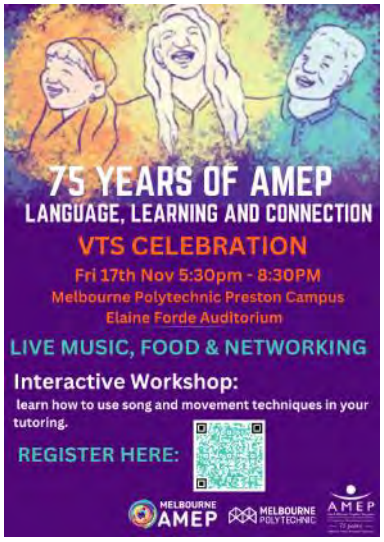
My latest printed and bound book, My Diarised Life. I was really happy with the print quality and the bound cover. The book chronicles my non-work related diary entries and inclusions from 1988 to 2020. My intention was to have the book resemble a diary which I believe was achieved.

Wednesday November 15, 2023

THE WORD OF THE YEAR 2023

Matildas

The Matildas have been sensational this year.
Pictured here after defeating France 7-6 in a penalty shootout.



Friday November 17, 2023

I attended the 75 Years of AMEP / VTS Celebration at Melbourne Polytechnic's Preston Campus. It was a good opportunity to network with my fellow Tutors and share our experiences.

Group photo with some of my fellow AMEP Tutors and Coordinator Gloria Gu – second from right.

Monday November 20, 2023

Travis Head century drives Australia to World Cup glory over India

Travis Head's greatest innings propelled Australia to what may be their finest moment, a World Cup triumph over raging hot favourites India in Ahmedabad.

Aussie team celebrates their inspirational win overnight.
Paddy Cummins holding the trophy.

Head scored 137 from 120 balls with 15 fours and four sixes, his second century of the tournament, as Australia played brave cricket, overcoming early jitters to win by six wickets with 42 balls to spare. Australia finished on 4-241 after a brilliant bowling and fielding performance saw India bowled out for 240.
Head also took a remarkable running, diving catch to dismiss Rohit Sharma for 47, who at the time was on fire and threatened to help India to a massive score.

Captain Pat Cummins proved a brave and decisive leader, continuing to take the game on after Australia lost their first two matches and were threatened with an early exit. They won their next nine straight.

To overcome previously unbeaten India so comprehensively in conditions tailor-made for the home side was one of the great achievements in 146 years of international cricket.

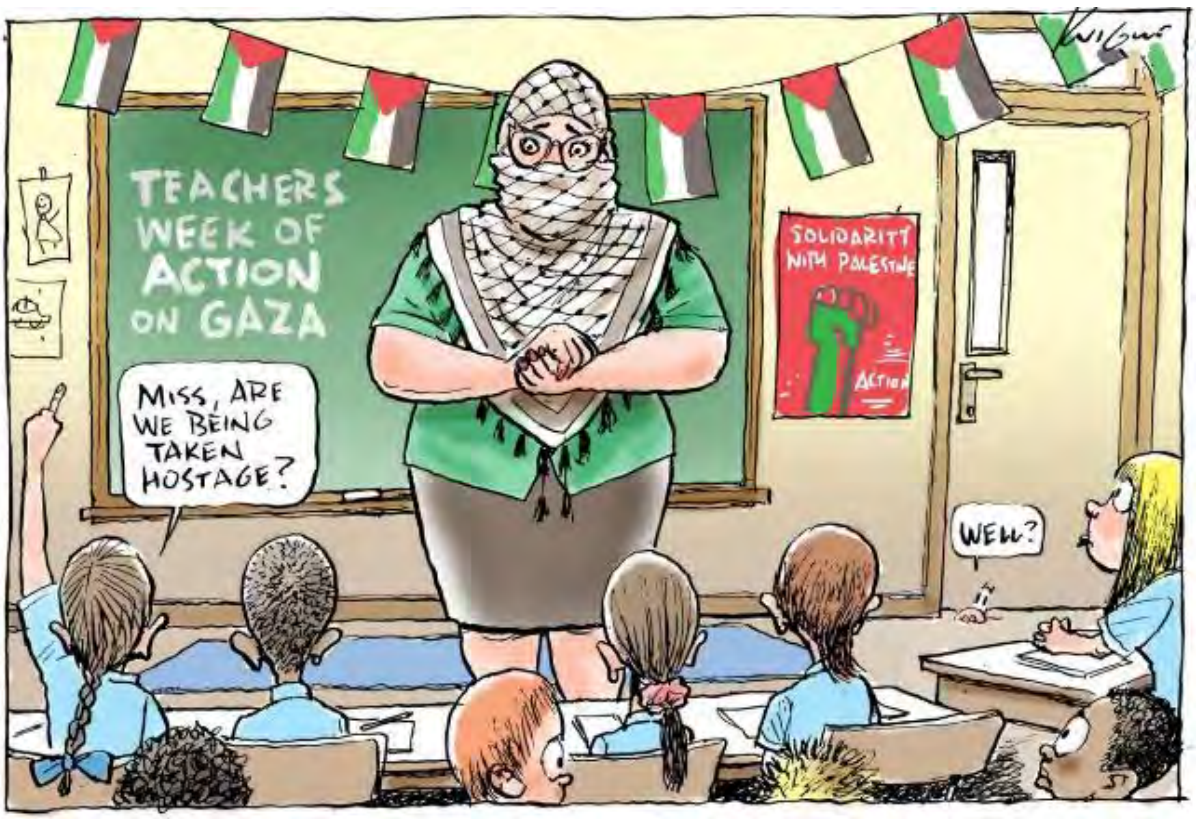
Wednesday November 22, 2023

On this day 60 years ago – John F. Kennedy assassinated.

Thursday November 23, 2023

Today I had an appointment with LifeBlood to donate plasma. Janny and I spent the morning at the State Library and then made our way down Swanston Street for lunch and we stumbled on an eatery called Crossways. The food looked good and at $7.50 (all you can eat!) it was great value. I commented to Janny that the people serving us reminded me of the Hare Krishnas, who, back in the day (1970's), would congregate in groups and sing and chant through the streets of the city. I grabbed a business card from the counter and turned it over to reveal the Hare Krishna chant. The meal was great and the chant on the back of the card brought back memories for both of us.

Tuesday November 28, 2023

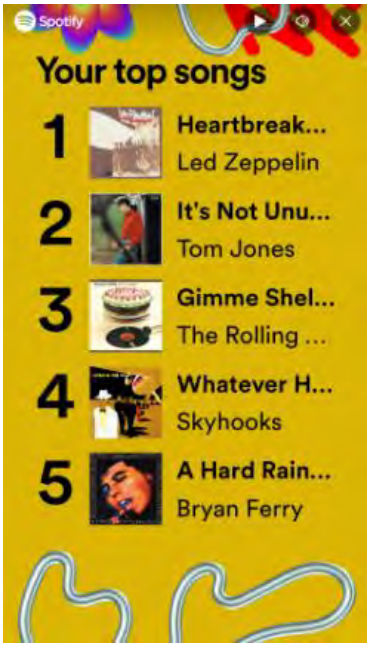


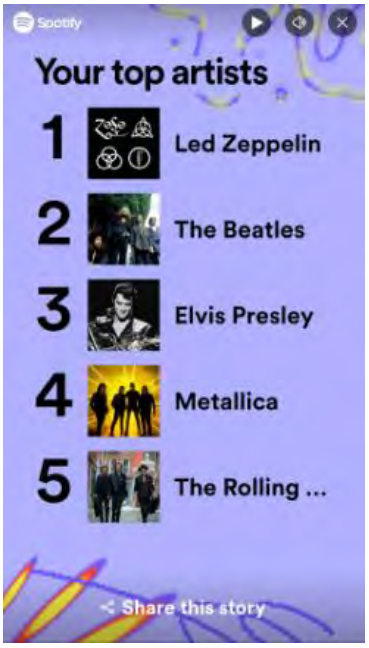
Teachers are paid to teach, not pontificate.
Inflammatory and divisive.

Thursday November 30, 2023

Today is the day that Spotify release their much anticipated "Wrapped" summary of our listening habits over the last 12 months, to which I hastily and excitedly unwrapped. I was made aware of this through Ross Stevenson on 3AW this morning.

Our Spotify account was summarised by the following;





Friday December 1, 2023

Today is Neil Mitchell's final day on radio 3AW. He has been broadcasting his morning program for 33 years. Coincidentally, Peter Hitchener signed off from weeknight news reading last night.

Friday December 1, 2023

Over the last two months I have been interviewing Marie Callaghan at MannaCare's Melaleuca Lodge in order to create her Biography.
I submitted a draft to MannaCare yesterday, Thursday November 30, 2023.
Marie was a delight to interview, as she was so positive and warm.
Marie's was an interesting and diverse journey.

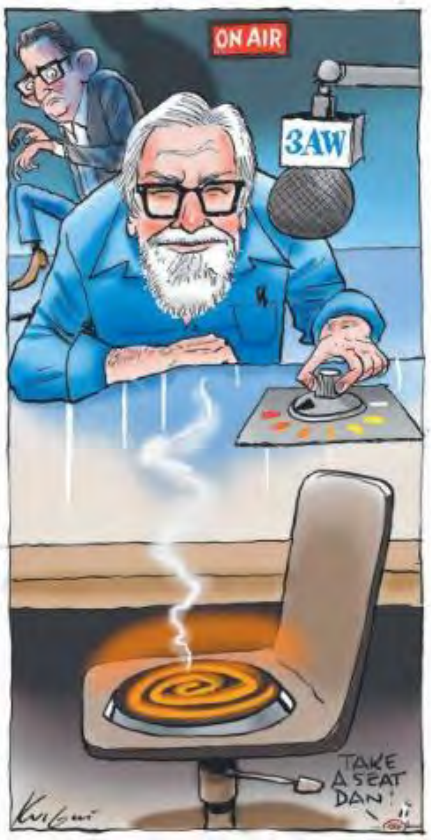
Hi Normin,
Looks wonderful.
I have printed it in colour.
Thank you to Pat for all your hard work in compiling this and time spent with Marie. I know that Marie has really enjoyed the experience.
I will provide a copy of this to Marie today.

Thanks,

Kind Regards,

Saskia Hannink

Saturday December 2, 2023



Neil Mitchell had this approach of turning up the heat on all and sundry, particularly politicians.
Obviously Chairman Dan took umbrage to this approach and blackbanned Neil Mitchell's program, which was a shame as I would have loved to hear Neil grill the Premier during Covid lockdowns. The Chairman would have really been in the hot seat.

Sunday November 3, 2023

Janny and I attended Village Doncaster to see Napoleon with Joaquin Phoenix.
His military campaigns cost 3 million lives.

"Fortune has abandoned me"

Tuesday November 5, 2023

A Tuesday reflection....
It would appear to me that Iran is getting Hamas, Hezbolah and Yemen's Houthi rebels to do all their dirty work in relation to the current Israeli/Palestinian conflict. Just simply supply them with arms and know-how, sit back and watch the carnage unfold.

Sunday December 9, 2023

The Ernest Family Christmas was held at Jeff and Janine's home in Doreen. Janny and I picked up Pat and Robyn Cormick from their hotel at the Windsor Hotel. It was a wonderful day save for the inclement weather. Gary was in attendance and we had a visit from Bruce Maher, which was a pleasant surprise. Sadly, Stewie and Karen couldn't attend due to contracting Covid.

Standing – Johnny, Jeff, yours truly, Bruce Maher and Alan,
Seated – Pat, Janny and Robyn

I received this lovely message from Pat and Robyn on **Sunday December 10, 2023.**

I responded with the following;

"It was an absolute pleasure. We had a wonderful day made all the better by spending quality time with you guys.
With all our love, Paddy and Janny"

Monday December 11, 2023

Today we received this Certificate of Appreciation from the Australian Electoral Commission with a note;

"As a member of our temporary workforce for the 2023 referendum you played an important role in helping to deliver democracy to Australians.
I want to extend my sincere thanks for helping us to deliver the first referendum in 24 years".

Tom Rogers
Electoral Commissioner

Tuesday December 12, 2023

Janny and I attended the MannaCare Christmas morning tea.
It was a lovely function and following this I visited Marie Callaghan at the Lodge to finalise her biography.

Wednesday December 13, 2023

While walking to Lifeblood in the city to donate plasma we encountered this Palestinian support protest group outside ZARA in the Bourke Street Mall. Clearly they have forgotten about the atrocities committed by Hamas in Israel.

Wednesday December 13, 2023

Last Saturday cousin Gary kindly offered me free tickets to this gig in St Kilda next Australia Day. I spotted this billboard in Princess Street Kew and took a photo of it. Gary asked me to send a reminder message to him regarding the tickets which I did together with the image of the billboard.

Saturday December 16, 2023

HEAVEN FORBID IF WE MENTION THE WORD "CHRISTMAS"

Local councils around Melbourne seem more interested in supporting Palestine and climate change than picking up our rubbish and fixing our roads.
It now appears that the Stonnington Council has cancelled Christmas. They are petrified of getting certain members of the community off side. Why do we continue to pander to the WOKE minority? We all need to stand up and embrace our culture instead of keeping second rate agitators motivated.

Has secretive Banksy left his mark on a Caulfield mural?

Sunday December 17, 2023

To those reading this text, it has, in all likelihood, been printed and bound at White's Law Bindery in Caulfield, together with all my other texts and Joyce's biography. It was interesting to read that their premises has a Banksy mural.

Did Banksy pay a visit to Melbourne?

Art enthusiast Jordan Weizman said he spotted what he believed to be a Banksy artwork on his way to work on Thursday.

The work is an addition to a longstanding mural above the White Law Bindery Printers shop in Glen Huntly Rd,Caulfield.

Whites Law Bindery in Caulfield.
My book binder of choice.

Monday December 18, 2023

We received our Carlton Football Club Membership Pack for the 2024 seaon today.

Wednesday December 20,2023

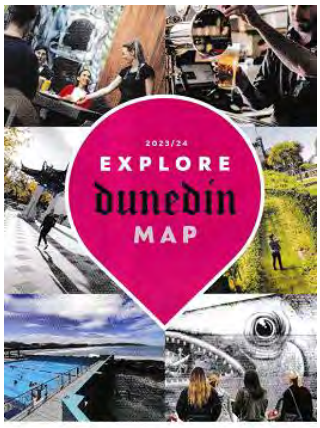
At last….this New Zealand cruise was cancelled in December 2020 due to the pandemic. See Coronavirus Journal page 131. We depart today for our 13 night New Zealand cruise, which will take in Christmas and New Years celebrations.
My journal notes follow.

Across The Ditch
New Zealand Cruise – December 20, 2023 to January 2, 2024
Wednesday, Thursday and Friday at sea.

Saturday December 23, 2023
Arrived at Fiordland National Park at 7.00am.
After witnessing this magical landscape I now realise why New Zealand is described as;
"The Land of the Long White Cloud"

It was as if we were in a scene from "Lord of the Rings". A mystical, magical landscape of suspended clouds, misty mountains, waterfalls and snow capped peaks. The weather was clear and pleasant. We were indeed lucky . In fact the afternoon weather was warm and many passengers were sunbaking.

Sunday December 24, 2023



As opposed to yesterday, our arrival at Port Chalmers was wet, grey and drizzly. Janny and I went for a stroll around the charming Port Chalmers in our wet weather jackets. We walked up to the town lookout where we had panoramic views down onto the port and the Grand Princess.
In the afternoon we emberked on a tour of Dunedin and the weather was fine and sunny.

Monday December 25, 2023
Christmas Day at Sea. We enjoyed a lovely Christmas lunch and dinner on ship.

Tuesday December 26, 2023

Arrived at Wellington at 8.00am. We did the Wellington City Drive tour and were dropped off at the bus terminal so we could do our own walking around the city. We hopped on the cable tram which took us up to the Botanical Gardens. We did some shopping and then caught the shuttle bus back to the ship. We saw the worlds steepest street – Baldwin Street.
Boxing Day Test delayed due to rain.

Wednesday December 27, 2023
At Sea. Watched some cricket, played some scrabble, did some reading and relaxed. That evening, at around 2.30am, I awoke to see a light outside our balcony. I immediately thought that I may have left the balcony light on. On closer inspection I realised that the light was a full moon. The ocean was calm resulting in the most mesmerising moon light glistening on the water. An amazing sight. Not something you see every night.

Thursday December 28, 2023 – Tauranga
We did the Maori Cultural Highlights tour. The Maori's were very kind and generous people. An enjoyable tour. Tauranga is a ery nice place – we could easily live there. Adjacent to Mount Monganui, it feels like Sorrento. Nice shopping district. A front beach for families and and a back beach for surfers.

Friday December 29, 2023 – Auckland
Took in our arrival at Auckland at 6.00am. The port is right on the doorstep of the CBD. This is a seriously large city with many large buildings, with Ernst Young, Pwc, and ANZ all visible. We got up early and went for a walk along the main street, being Queen Street.

Then at 11.10am we embarked on the Auckland City Highlights tour – visibility was limited as it rained for most of the tour – but interesting none the less.

Saturday December 30, 2023 – At sea in the Pacific Ocean
Reading, writing and crosswords.
A Saturday Essay – Heavenly Ponderings

Most religious institutions would have you believe, on a faith based level, that by being a good Christian, Heaven awaits you at your time of judgement...or Valhalla or Nirvana for that matter, depending on your spiritual persuasion. I see Heaven as an important part of the contract one makes with their religious institution. A place where one retires following a life of dedicated service to humanity. What then would Heaven look like....what does one do when one gets there to pass the time away? Indeed do religious inststutions endeavour to articulate what life in Heaven looks like? You think they would, considering Heaven is such an important part of one's faith. After all it is "Our Father who art in Heaven".
In Heaven, can you continue to watch or follow the AFL or the EPL, the next Ashes series or the Olympics? Can you eat your favorite foods or dine at your favorite restaurant? Can you once again take up your sporting pursuits that you long ago gave up due to father time?
My belief, or theory, is that if you are deemed worthy of admission into Heaven, everything you know, or you think you know, is dissolved. You would be on such an elevated state of actuality that the things you coveted in life on Earth would no longer matter. They would become meaningless. What that higher level of existence would look like is the mystery of Heaven. I believe the passage of time in Heaven would be totally different and foreign to our current understanding of time. We are limited to our comprehension of time being days, months, years, changes of seasons and so on – all framed by our getting of wisdom and the inevitable aging process. In Heaven an Earthly lifetime may pass in the blink of an eye, millenia after a couple of weeks and so on. The concept of time is not very well understood, or limited to what we know in the living world. But when you look at the universe we live in, our lives transpire in a mere millisecond in relation to a universe that is widely believed to be 13 billion years old. Scientists date planet Earth at around 4 billion years old, and its ultimate demise will occur with the demise of our Sun, in another mere 6 billion years. If we were to assume that mankind has domain over planet Earth for 20,000 years, of which we are now at the 2,000 year mark, our existence, as at a point in time within a 10 billion year planetary existence is a very brief time period indeed. Currently Heaven is receiving worthy Earthlings. This will cease with the demise of human kind in the future. We

may find that after a period of not receiving souls into Heaven, suddenly a new generation of worthy souls may start arriving. That passage of time or hiatus may represent a period of time equivalent to billions of years, whereby another planet Earth type planet has evolved and Jesus Christ is sent to that planet to deliver hope, and the process starts all over again.
What we do or or how we spend our time in Heaven is and will continue to be the great mystery, but one thing I am confident of is that we won't be thinking about what we were missing on Earth and we certainly won't know boredom.
Conversely, it may very well be that there is no heaven. Media mogul Kerry Packer, upon being revived from a near fatal heart attack, commented that "there is no heaven – I've been to the other side and believe me, there's nothing there – just darkness". This may be true, but for Janny and I this would in no way diminish our commitment to being nice human beings and in doing so, hopefully the rest will take care of itself.

Pat Ernest
Saturday December 30, 2023

Sunday December 31, 2023

N E W Y E A R S E V E
2 0 2 3

All in all a delightful year.
Lots of travel, two books published and eleven out of thirteen goals for the year ticked off.

. . . .

Sunday December 31, 2023

Farewell 2023

2024

Monday January 1, 2024

This year of Our Lord 2024 started with Janny and I on the cruise ship Grand Princess sailing on the Tasman Sea as we return from a 13 night adventure around New Zealand. Unfortunately my left knee continues to give me grief. Upon making landfall I shall make an appointment to see my GP, as affirmative action is required.

Thursday January 4, 2024
Saw Dr. Schulberg and he referred me to FMIG for an MRI on my knee.

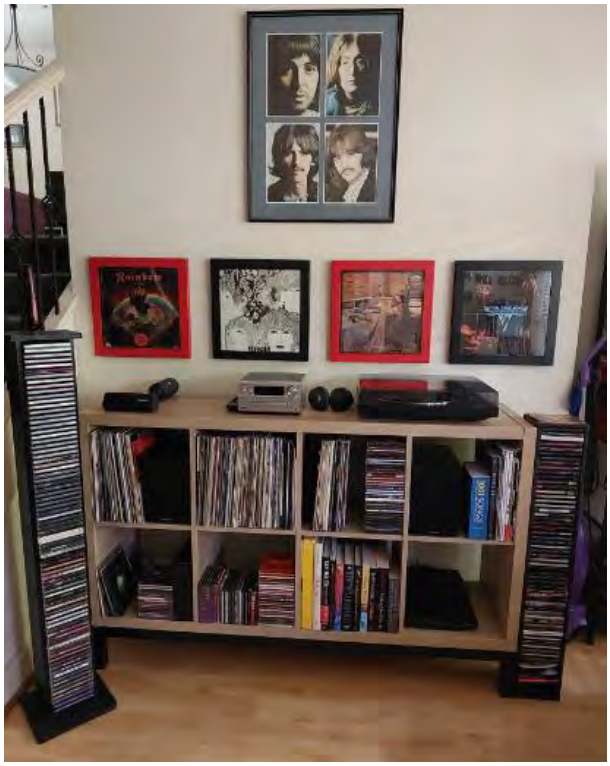
Thursday January 11, 2024
Follow up appointment with Dr. Schulberg to assess what options are available to remedy my knee. Ultimately my goal is for my knee to be pain free.
Dr. Nitin Gupta concluded the following when asessing my MRI;
1. Severe medial knee joint space osteoarthritis
2. Small partial thickness tear in the posterior horn of medial meniscus
3. The reconstructed ACL appears intact
My options are;
Pain management
- GLAD physiotherapy program
- Glucosamine with chondroitin
- CT scan to inject Euflexxa
- Cortisone injection, but then rules out surgery for a period
- Anti-inflammatories

Surgery
- Arthroscope
- Partial knee replacement
- Full knee replacement

I am scheduled to see Dr. Nathan White on February 1.

As I reflect on these developments relating to the state of my knee, all I can do is celebrate what has been essentially a 50 year running career. I'm talking footy, basketball, tennis, long distance running, distance cycling and triathlon. On many occasions, during my splendid isolation of running, I would thank my legs for carrying and supporting me throughout my long and sometimes punishing sporting life. My forthcoming knee surgery may very well spell the end of my sporting pursuits, but I consider myself blessed to have been able to consistently participate over this period and to achieve so much. I need to consider that I ran a marathon at age 51, ten years after having a knee reconstruction!
Refer to my autobiography Chapter 13 – The Importance of being a Sportsman.

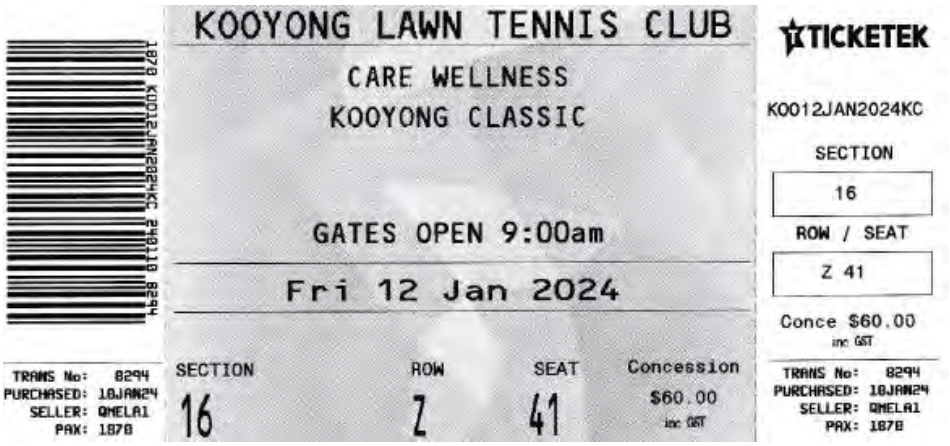
On the same day I restructured our home music centre so it is now fully integrated. Bluetooth connectivity via the SONOS Roam, JBL Flip and Sony headphones. This is complimented by a Sony turntable and a Panasonic CD player. Playback of the turntable is through the CD player speakers. We now have full access to our vinyl record and CD collection. What a joy it has been reconnecting our vinyl record collection. IKEA storage shelf for LP records allows full access to all albums. Music books and CD's are also stored here together with wall mounted record cover display frames. Our musical Nirvana.



Reconnecting with our CD and LP record collection

Friday January 12, 2024

Janny and I attended the Kooyong Classis.


KOOYONG LAWN TENNIS CLUB
CARE WELLNESS
KOOYONG CLASSIC
GATES OPEN 9:00am
Fri 12 Jan 2024
SECTION 16
ROW Z
SEAT 41
Concession $60.00 inc GST
TRANS No: 8294
PURCHASED: 10JAN24
SELLER: QMELA1
PAX: 1878
TICKETEK
K0012JAN2024KC
SECTION 16
ROW / SEAT Z 41
Conce $60.00 inc GST
TRANS No: 8294
PURCHASED: 10JAN24
SELLER: QMELA1
PAX: 1878

Monday January 15, 2024

Janny and I had a splendid day at the Australian Open. We couldn't help but compare our hometown Slam to that of the US Open, which we attended last August, in New York. You may accuse us of hometown bias but for sheer entertainment, facilities, atmosphere and spectacle, the AO leaves the US Open well and truly in its wake. The Happy Slam again lived up to its name.

Friday January 19, 2024

Twenty years ago today David Hookes was fatally felled at the Beaconsfield Hotel. I took it upon myself to revisit my book "REMEMBERING HOOKESY" which I purchased 19 years ago.

"Cricket crowds remembered David Hookes fondly; he was always likely to produce a burst of spectacular shot making that left the fans with a wonderful memory to take home. Magically, he belted five fours in a row off the England captain Tony Greig in the unforgettable 1977 Centenary Test at the MCG and he once scored a century off 34 balls".

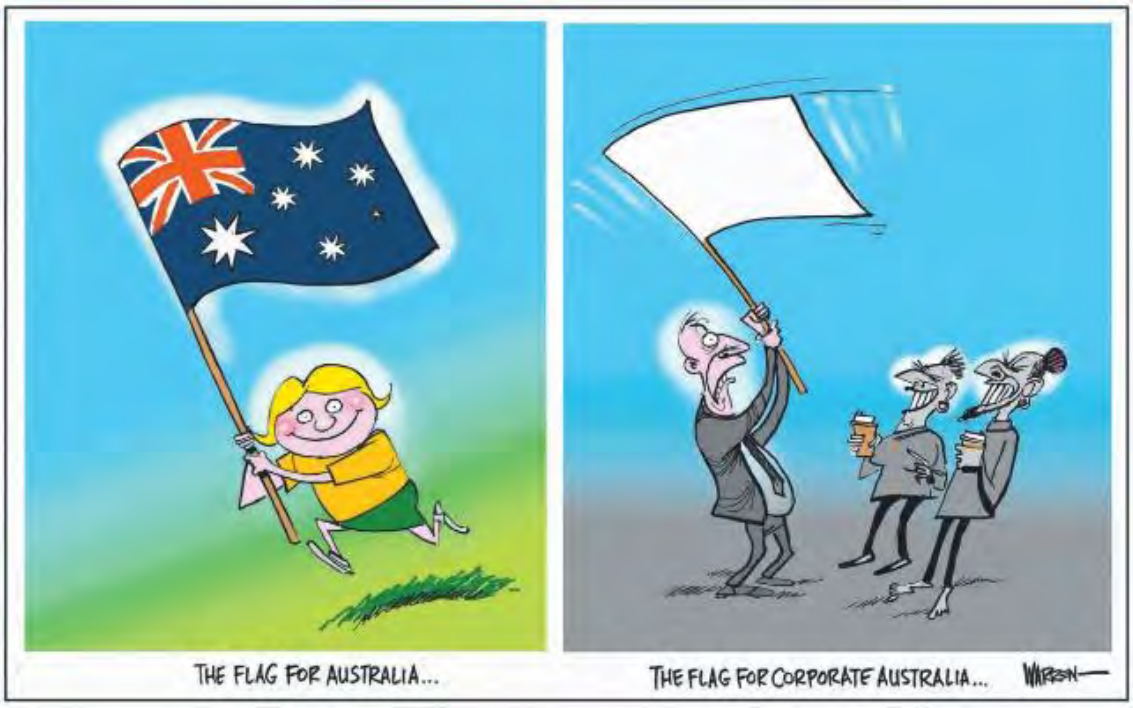
Sunday January 21, 2024

In the City – returning home via our 200/207 bus, we could not embark at our normal bus stop at the corner of Swanston and Lonsdale streets due to ongoing Palestinian protests. We had to walk to the Queensberry Street bus stop on Lygon Street. This arrangement is in place every Sunday between 1 – 4pm until further notice.

Wednesday January 24, 2024

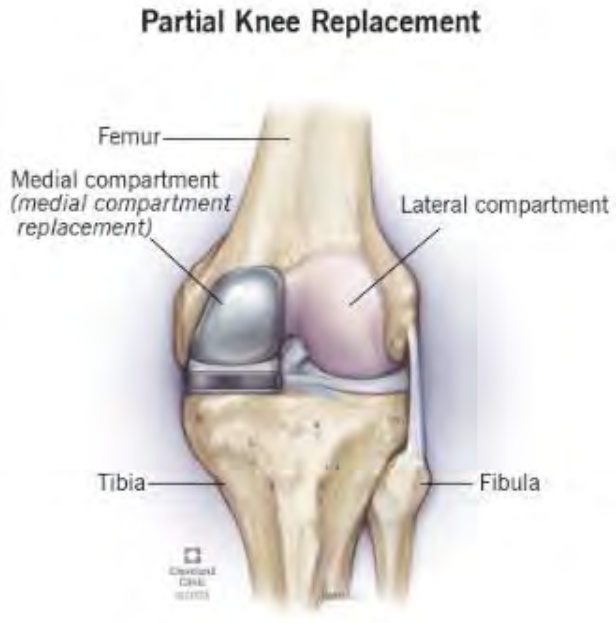
Today I presented MannaCare resident Marie Callaghan with her biography.
Photo taken by Janny.
Marie was delighted with the final print and was very grateful for it.
This biography was quite challenging as Marie's recall of key dates in her life were sketchy at best, but we prevailed and eventually were able to piece her story together.
Marie is a charming resident and I have never seen her have any negative remarks about anything.

Wednesday January 24, 2024



The controversy surrounding Australia Day continues.
I tend to think that January 26's days are numbered as Australia Day. Many label this day as Invasion Day.
"Australians **all** let us rejoice", being the opening line to Advance Australia Fair, will never be achieved while January 26 is retained as Australia Day.
My pick for Australia Day is **September 15**. This was the day Cathy Freeman lit the Olympic flame to open the Sydney Olympic Games in 2000.
In my opinion there has never been a moment in Australian history where all Australians were united with pride and patriotism, particularly in light of the fact that a proud indigineous woman lit the flame, at the dawn of a new century.

Thursday January 25, 2024



My left knee continues to give me grief. I am scheduled to see surgeon Dr. Nathan White on February 1.
One option is to have a partial knee replacement, which I have been researching. Incidently Jeff has the identical injury to me, but in his right knee. Both Jeff and I have had ACL reconstructive surgery on our affected knee's.

Also known as medial compartment replacement.

Friday January 26, 2024

Hands down the greatest country on Earth.
I am forever grateful for everything this majestic country has gifted me.
Thanks Mum and Dad for relocating our family to this great country – and the icing on the cake – settling in Melbourne.

Janny and I caught the 200 bus into the city, had a cappucino in Swanston Street and then made our way to the Shrine of Remembrance for the 21 gun salute. We then had a drink at Transport in Federation Square in a position which allowed us to look over Princes Bridge to Southgate and the former site of AW Allen, where Dad and Johnny et al worked, which always give me a warm, sentimental feeling.
We then made our way through Federation Square to Swanston Street but our progress was thwarted by thousands of protesters who descended on the corner of Swanston and Flinders Streets. This was a mega protest involving those who were protesting "Invasion Day" and those who were protesting against the "genocide" of Palestinians in Gaza. We saw many signs stating "from the river to the sea" with the Aboriginal flag under it. I made the comment to Janny "how are we going to get through this?". After 10 minutes of squeezing and jostling through the madding crowd, we finally were able to see daylight.

Massive Australia Day protest in the heart of the city.

Friday January 26, 2024

Jeff was able to get a couple of tickets to see Rose Tattoo and the Prince Bandroom in St Kilda. They were supported by the Cassanovas and Electric Mary.
We had dinner at Abbey Road in Ackland Street prior.

The "Tatts" at the Prince Bandroom

Saturday January 29, 2024

On Saturday January 27 Jeff, Janny and I visited Helen and Nevil to view and take possession of Helen's geneology research documents. Helen has completed a power of work and compiled ten folders of research material. The most compelling document she acquired was the divorce document between Henry DeBurgh and his wife Lydia (Dad's mother), confirming that William Frank Forry is Dad's father (my grandfather).

Jeff, Helen, Janny and me

Sunday January 28, 2024

I decided to send Helen a thankyou note for all her good work;

Hi Helen,
I would like to again thank you for all your efforts and dogged determination to reveal our family history. Following this I would like to offer my services and pen your biography. We could schedule a time on a weekly basis at your place to document your story. I would then, upon completion, arrange its printing and book binding (at no cost to you). It's the least I/we could do.
Once again thank you.
Cheers,
Paddy
P.S. Let me know if you want to engage my services.

Monday January 29, 2024

Hopefully by weeks end, the key health information that I seek will be revealed. I have submitted a blood test and will see my knee surgeon on Thursday, February 1.
To say that I am a bit edgy is a gross understatement.
The two outcomes that I seek are;

1. LDL cholesterol at or around 1.8mmol/L. This would mean that I won't need to take statins, and all their potential side effects. It would also confirm that my lifestyle changes are working and effective.
2. My knee surgeon confirming that I am a candidate for a partial knee replacement. My knee is really giving me grief and all I want to be is pain free.
   Achieve these two outcomes and it would, without doubt, be a very Happy New Year.

Wednesday January 31, 2024

Attended Kew Junction Medical Centre to see Dr. Schulberg regarding my recent blood test. The results were very disappointing;

Cholesterol	LDL-Cholesterol	LPA Lipoprotein
5.5 (was 4.2)	3.5 H (was 2.5)	0.52 H (target <0.30)

Dr. Schulberg concluded that the LPA reading means that I have a genetic predisposition for heart disease. I was shattered. This basically means my cards were "marked in advance" at birth. Not the news I wanted to hear. I really believed that I was doing all the right things with my diet. I immediately commenced taking statins.

Thursday February 1, 2024

Visited Dr. Nathan White at the Melbourne Knee Centre in Kew. After examining my knee, he concluded that I am a candidate for a partial knee replacement. We agreed to surgery and for it to take palce at Epworth Eastern in Box Hill on April 15. I then spent some time with his Nurse Sheree, who gave me an information pack and a checklist of all the items I need to do. Top of this list was to check that our private health cover with

Bupa covered the surgery item number 49517. Unfortunately it didn't. I then emailed Sheree of this and her response was as follows;
Hi Patrick,

This is very unfortunate for you.

Unfortunately if the heath insurance doesn't cover you for joint replacement it becomes a very expensive process. The hospital estimate is around $20,000 on its own, because it includes the actual prosthesis that your health would cover as well as the theatre fees and accomodation for 3-4 nights.

In conjunction with the surgeons fees, assistant surgeon, anaesthetist there is other accounts such as pathology, physiotherapy radiology and pharmacy. You are probably looking at between $25,000 to $30,000.

Let me know if you would like me to organise a quote for you, or if you would like to, if you can increase your health insurance policy and wait 12 months for your joint replacement.

Kind regards Sheree

Sheree Merton / Practice Nurse
Park Clinic Orthopaedics & Melbourne Knee Centre
7 Studley Ave, Kew VIC 3101
P: 03 9853 5981 | Fax: 03 9853 5251

BURY MY HEART AT WOUNDED KNEE

Dee Brown

Thursday February 1, 2024

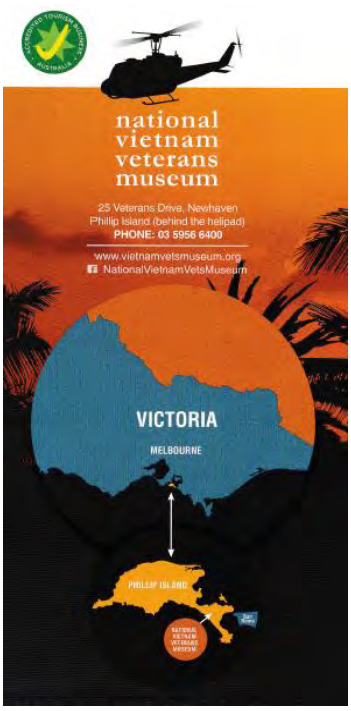
Currently in the wars.....
I strained my shoulder at the gym on Tuesday and it has been giving me terrible grief, but the pain is subsiding. The sling helps.
Also have the knee brace on to give it stability while I wait and decide how and when I get it repaired.

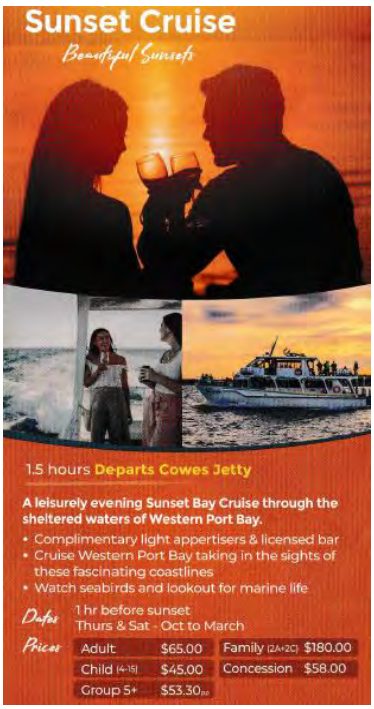
Friday February 2, 2024

Janny and I visited Bupa Northland and spoke to Tanya. She was very helpful and we increased our health cover to include joint replacement and cataract surgeries. I will now have to wait twelve months to be able to access this cover, but from a financial point of view, we stand to save thousands. I just need to manage the knee carefully for the next year. All going well I will have my partial knee replacement in February 2025.

February 4 to 9, 2024

Janny and I travelled to Phillip Island for a 5 day break.





While at Phillip Island we visited the National Vietnam Veterans Museum, the Penguin Parade, Churchill Island, the Koala Conservation Reserve, Swan Lake, Pyramid Rock, The Nobbies and had a Sunset Cruise from Cowes Jetty. We stayed at Amaroo Park, which was walking distance to Cowes town centre. The Penguin Parade Visitor Centre was quite an impressive structure, opened in 2019.

. . .

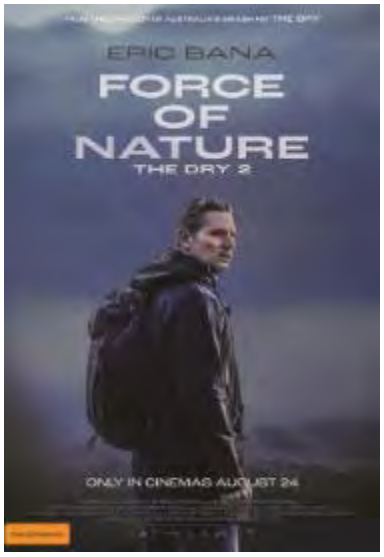
Saturday February 10, 2024

Janny and I are currently watching the ABC documentary NEMESIS. The three part series concentrates on the period of government under Tony Abbott, Malcolm Turnbull and Scott Morrison. Not too dissimilar to the Rudd/Gillard years. No wonder a good many in the electorate are disillusioned with mainstream politics. Compelling viewing.

We Australians are governed by a bunch of dangerously self-absorbed, out of touch egomaniacs motivated by self interest. Public service and the ambition to make Australia a better place runs a poor second to personal ambition.....doesn't matter which side of politics.

On this day in 1986 I commenced my 33 year tenure at Diver Consolidated Industries.

It is difficult to comprehend that "Sleepy Joe" intends to contest the next presidential election in November.



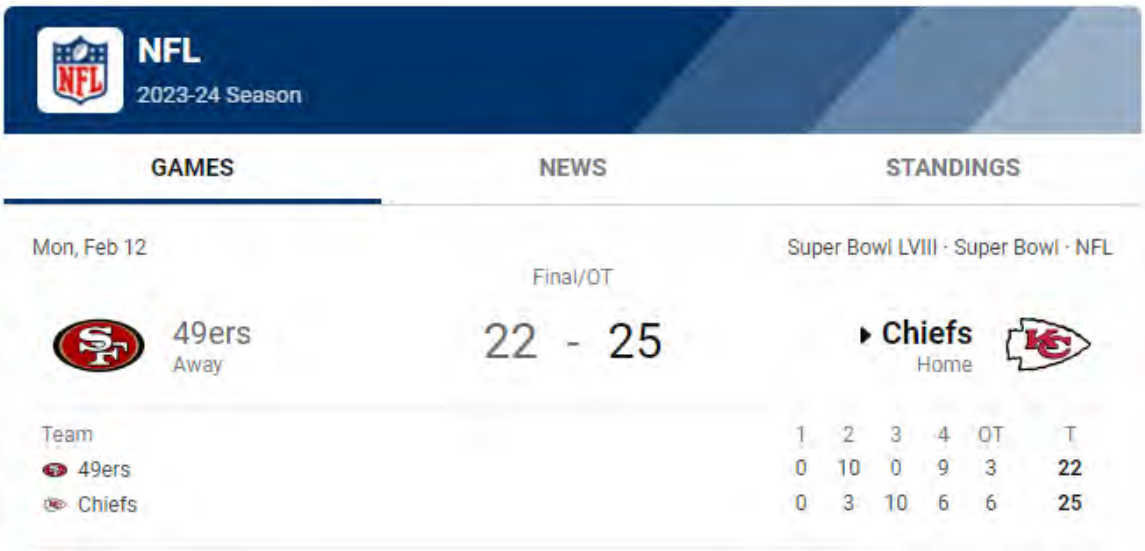
Sunday February 11, 2024

Janny and I saw Force of Nature (The Dry 2) at the Rivoli, Camberwell.
Prior to this we strolled through the Camberwell Market, checking out LP records.
Movie was set in the Victorian high country.

★ ★ ★

Monday February 12, 2024

We watched Superbowl LVIII this morning.
There was more interest in Taylor Swift's appearance at the game to watch her beau "tight end" Travis Kalce!
Thankfully the game was close and scores were level after full time.
Not exactly a great spectacle – too many stoppages, time outs and ad's.



Wednesday February 14, 2024
Valentines Day

Today Janny and I pedalled our tandem bike into town and dined at +5 restaurant at South Wharf. We navigated the new Walmer Street bridge upgrade which made manouevering the tandem a lot easier. We also took the Yarra north bank which allowed us to cycle along the floating pontoons adjacent to the Monash Freeway and crossed over to the south bank via the Morell Bridge. Delightful.

Thursday February 15, 2024

Wild storms lashed our city on Tuesday, flattening electricity transmission towers and leaving thousands of homes and businesses without power.
Meanwhile Melbourne is gripped by Taylor Swift mania. She is playing three blockbuster concerts over the next three nights at the MCG.

Tay Tay beware – this bloke clearly has some anger management issues.
Just ask coach Andy Reid.

Friday February 16, 2024

H A P P Y B I R T H D A Y J A N N Y

For Janny's birthday we had lunch at Elwood Bathers.
This venue (formerly known as Sails) is one of our favorites and we have lots of great memories at this establishment. Meals by the beach windows, birthday celebrations for Aunty Ina and completing triathlons around the adjacent parklands and beach paths.

Sunday February 18, 2024

Janny and I spent Sunday strolling the streets of St Kilda for the St Kilda Festival. We had lunch at Beachcomber I on the beach and then visited retro upstairs vinyl record store Eclectico in Ackland Street, where I uncovered the Joe Cocker album Cocker Happy, which Jeff has been chasing for a fair while. As an added bonus I only paid ten bucks for it.

Monday February 19, 2024

I have just completed reading this biography by Lou Richards.
A great read. I have fond memories of Lou on World of Sport and League Teams in the 70's and 80's. Together with "Captain Blood" Jack Dyer, Bob "Woofer" Davis and all the other WOS presenters, they were the trailblazers for the footy media landscape we see today. His nickmanes of various VFL players such as The Flying Doormat, The Galloping Gasometer and Lethal Leigh are legendary. Louie the Lip also had a long career as a writer for the Sun News Pictorial.

Monday February 19, 2024

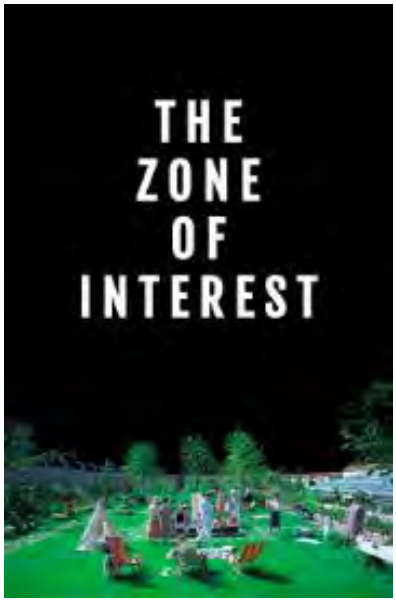
The true face of heroism.
Alexei Navalny's death in a Russian gulag has been described as "sudden death syndrome" by the Soviet Union….I call it murder.

Wednesday February 21, 2024

A very busy day on the volunteering front.
At 10.00am I will be meeting a new English learning student (Mosi from Iran) at the State Library.
Then at 1.30pm I will be donating plasma at Lifeblood – my 78th donation.
Afterwards Janny and I will meet fellow VTS volunteers for a coffee and chat at Time Out at Federation Square.
Gloria Gu with Janny and me.

Sunday March 3, 2024

Putin's new Soviet Russia is of grave concern.
"Back in the USSR".



Sunday February 25, 2024

We saw this movie at the Nova Carlton.

As the Operations Manager in a manufacturing plant, I was constantly looking at ways of improving efficiency and increasing productivity as part of my career development. Rudolph Hoss also pursued the same goals in his role as Commandant.

See no evil,
Feel all evil.

This is what it's like to live in a Garden of Eden, located at the Gates of Hell.

Tuesday February 27, 2024

On this day I received an email from Leah Wilson, Program Manager – Covid 19 Oral History Project at the National Library of Australia.

Dear Mr Ernest,

I write to you from the Curatorial and Collection team at the National Library of Australia, where I am Program Manager for the Australian Responses to COVID-19 Oral History Project. I was recently speaking with my colleague Jemma Poche, who mentioned your wonderful Coronavirus Journal which recently came into the collection, and so I thought I would reach out to you about this project.

As such, it is with great pleasure that I attach a letter from Dr Barbara Lemon, Director of Curatorial and Collection Research at the National Library of Australia, inviting you to be interviewed for the National Library's Australian Responses to COVID-19 Oral History Project. By way of a bit of background information, our oral history interviews usually take a whole of life approach (even when they are conducted under a particular project like this one) and so we thought that it would be a wonderful opportunity (should you be interested in participating) to provide some further context to, and reflections on, your journal and pandemic experience.

I responded back to Leah that I am interested in participating in the project.

I read an article online about shares you should buy and hold forever, which included the following;
ARGO, AFIC, COCHLEAR, TRANSURBAN, W.H. SOUL PATTINSON and WESFARMERS
All these stocks are in our portfolio, amongst others.

Monday March 4, 2024

In my autobiography, I devoted two chapters to my passions for music and footy. As a young man I would buy and play LP vinyl records and watch the

Footy Replay and World of Sport on a Sunday afternoon. To support these passions nowadays, we are subscribed to Spotify and Kayo. These streaming platforms allow me to continue to indulge in these pursuits.

Spotify for music and playlists and Kayo for footy, cricket etc.

Thursday March 7, 2024

Janny and I booked a night at the Sofitel in Collins Street – our favorite city hotel. That evening we attended the "opening night" of WICKED at the Regent Theatre. We booked our tickets many months ago for my birthday, not realising that we were attending the opening night of the show. A very impressive theatrical experience.

★★★★

After having breakfast at No. 35 at the Sofitel, we took a tour of the Parliament of Victoria and the Old Treasury Building Museum.

Friday March 8, 2024

Carlton's 2024 campaign begins this evening. We head north to Brisbane to tackle the Lions. Most pundits tipped Brisbane to stitch up the Blues. We haven't beaten Brisbane at the Gabba in 10 odd years and the Lions have won their last 13 games straight at the "Gabbatoir".

Saturday March 9, 2024

BLUES' MIRACLE WIN

CARLTON OVERCOMES 46 POINT DEFECIT TO WIN BY A POINT

Last night we left no doubt about our premiership credentials.

Down by 46 points early in the second quarter, we came back from the dead to win

13.8.86 to 12.13.85

Lots of Carlton supporters in one section of the stand dressed in Blues Brothers costumes, complete with hats – looked very impressive.

Wednesday March 13, 2024

Janny and I saw the play Gaslight at the Comedy Theatre. The movie version, starring Ingrid Bergman, Charles Boyer and Joseph Cotton is one of our favourites. The plot for this play was slightly different to the movie but very interesting, nonetheless.

Saturday March 16, 2024

Jeff and I did some minor landscaping of our property in Greenvale. I travelled to Jeff and Janine's and upon arrival we loaded some rocks into the back of Jeff's ute and then headed off to Verona Street. We dropped off the garden tools and rocks and then picked up ¾ of a metre of wood chips from a garden supply business on Somerton Road. Pictured is Jeff having a well earned drink next to part of the garden that we landscaped.

Sunday March 17, 2024

HAPPY 34th ANNIVERSARY
HAPPY ST. PATRICK'S DAY

Janny and I celebrated our 34th Wedding Anniversary by having lunch at COPPERWOOD in Lygon Street. After lunch we caught the bus down th the State Library where we took in the Melbourne OUT LOUD exhibition. A great trip down memory lane with photo's from the 1970's and 80's.

Melbourne Out Loud: Life through the lens of Rennie Ellis

Following this we went and had a drink at the Rooftop Bar at Curtin House in Swanston Street and then we walked along the Yarra Promenade, taking in Southgate and Crown, where many pop up booths were on display for the Formula 1 Grand Prix.

Tuesday March 20, 2024

Jetstar flight to Bali is forced to turn back mid-air after passenger 'went loopy and banged on the cockpit door'

By MAKAYLA MUSCAT FOR DAILY MAIL AUSTRALIA
PUBLISHED: 17:27 AEDT, 18 March 2024 | **UPDATED:** 23:43 AEDT, 19 March 2024

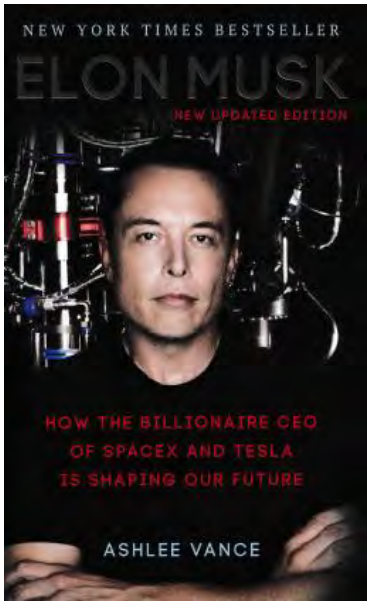
On the eve of our flight to Bali on Friday, JetStar flight JQ43 was turned back. Thank God this sheila won't be on our flight.

Friday March 22 to April 1, 2024

Janny and I jetted off to Bali this morning and checked in to the Double Six Hotel in Seminyak.

The following is a collage of images taken during our holiday.

Some of the many beach bars and surf shops between Jl Melasti and Jl Arjuna



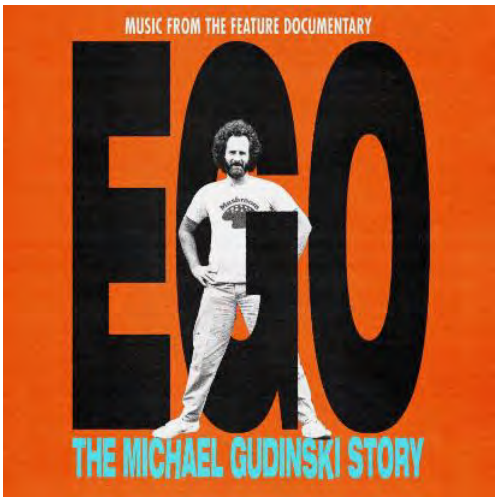
While in Bali, I commenced reading the book ELON MUSK. I have always been fascinated with him and how he has achieved so much. I wanted to understand his background, skills set and capacity to get things done. I needed to get inside Elon's world.
The one thing I have concluded is that Elon knows how to back a winner. He didn't create the PayPal system, nor did he design and develop lithium ion battery technologies to power electric cars. What he did do was fund individuals to allow these businesses to flourish and meet their potential.
SpaceX, however was his baby. A true entreprenuer and audacious businessman.
Classic line in the book...."*Hey guys, I think we can build this rocket ourselves".*

Saturday April 6, 2024

Carlton played Fremantle at the Adelaide Oval for the Gather Round. We won by 10 points in what could be described as a controversial win. Late in the game and two points down, a kick into our forward line was marked by Matt Cotterell. The Fremantle players remonstrated that the ball was touched off the boot. Cotterell went back and kicked the goal, giving us a 4 point lead. The Fremantle palyers continued to remonstrate and the umpire, citing umpire abuse, paid another free kick to Carlton in front of goal. Matthew Kennedy goaled for a 10 point lead – game over!

Can be a long drive home for the vanquished,
as we experienced last year.

Tuesday April 9, 2024



Tonight we watched the documentary EGO – The Michael Gudinski Story. I was particularly interested in Mushroom's early formative years and the release of the Skyhooks album "Living in then 70's", which essentially kick started Mushroom Records.

Sunday April 14, 2024

In Australia we don't have mass shootings…we have mass stabbings!

At the Westfield Bondi Junction a crazed bloke went on a stabbing frenzy, killing six people. Once again people with mental health issues has come into the spotlight. How many other people in the community with mental health issues and possibly substance abuse concerns are out there, on the verge of committing these heinous crimes? Are they evil and wicked or not guilty by way of mental impairment?

Westfield Shopping Centre – Bondi Junction. Immense courage!
It was fitting that a woman took down the perpetrator, considering that women were targeted.

Monday April 15, 2024

Janny and I took the tandem bike for a ride and we explored the back streets of Abbotsford, Collingwood and Fitzroy. There are plenty of hidden gems throughout these back streets, especially the old inner city factories that have been converted to office and residential spaces, not to mention all the vinyl record stores in Johnston and Smith Streets. All this hidden in plain sight only 10 minutes away from where we live.

Tuesday April 16, 2024

Double-digit returns are on the cards for super funds this year, with the median balanced option delivering 8.8% for members over the nine months to March 31, according to Super Ratings.

Bruce Lehrmann's defamation case dismissed.
In the Herald Sun he was described as
A CAD, A RAPIST AND A LOSER
Personally, I don't think he raped Brittany Higgins. I believe that everything they engaged in was consensual, and in that context, he may have grounds to appeal.
Of course this will depend on how savage a mauling he copped in the lions den.

Wednesday April 17, 2024

Life has this habit of throwing up little and welcomed surprises. As noted earlier, I purchased an old LP vinyl record of Joe Cocker's "Cocker Happy". Today as I placed the record back into the cover sleeve, I noticed a flyer within. It invited buyers to post the flyer to Festival Records in order to receive a "comprehensive" free L.P. catalogue of over 700 top selling albums. All you need to do is affix a 12¢ stamp where indicated and post it to Pyrmont, NSW. A fine collection of artists are listed.

FREE

FESTIVAL L.P. CATALOGUE

PLEASE POST THIS ORDER FORM COMPLETE

Festival Records proudly present this comprehensive free catalogue of over 700 top selling albums from world renowned artists. These include the greatest overseas and Australian talent such as, Joe Cocker, Herb Alpert & The Tijuana Brass, Creedence Clearwater Revival, Cat Stevens, Elton John, Shirley Bassey, Mendy Saddington, Blackfeather, Sergio Mendes & Brasil '77, Bee Gees, Freda Payne, Carole King, Burt Bacharach, Chain, Sandy Scott, Dionne Warwick, Ronnie Burns, Waldo De Los Rios, The Ventures, Reg Lindsay, Carpenters, Francoise Hardy, Billy Vaughn, Don McLean, Johnny Cash, Barry Crocker, Ferrante & Teicher, Slim Whitman, Johnny Rivers, Free and Jamie Redfern plus top-selling original cast and soundtrack albums and a superb selection of classical and semi-classical releases.

This super talent is made available for your enjoyment by the association of Festival Records with leading recording companies throughout the world, our own Festival studios and Australian associated companies.

Choosing a new album is an exciting adventure.....this free catalogue is designed to enable you to select your favourite artists and their albums in the comfort of your own home.

Festival Records are proud of their product – each and every pressing is of modern manufacturing technique. Strict quality control of the finished product guarantees perfect reproduction.

THIS IS HOW YOU GET YOUR FREE CATALOGUE

AFFIX A 12¢ STAMP WHERE INDICATED

place in an envelope and post it to;–

FESTIVAL CATALOGUE
P.O. Box 16,
PYRMONT, 2009 N.S.W.

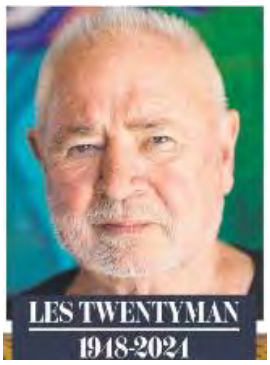
PLEASE RETURN THIS ORDER FORM COMPLETED

P.T.O.

Flyer I found within the "Cocker Happy" album sleeve.
I'm particularly fond of the sentence;
"Choosing a new album is an exciting adventure".
I couldn't agree more. I am just as excited now as I was 50 years ago as a twelve year old!

Wednesday April 17, 2024

From politicians to rock and footy legends, mourners flocked to St Patrick's Cathedral to farewell veteran youth worker Les Twentyman. I received a message from Jeff alerting us that Gary was in town for the State Funeral.

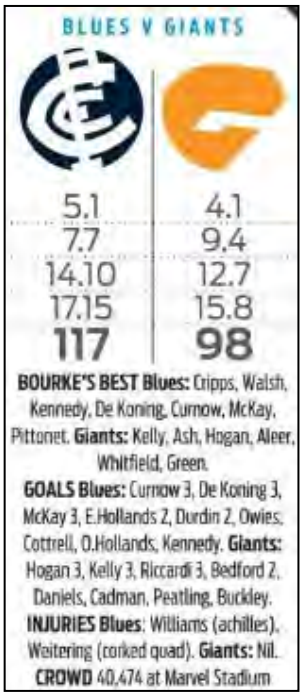


Thursday April 18, 2024

Donald Trump has the temerity to lable Joe Biden "Sleepy Joe"
You would think that being the centre of a criminal trial would be enough to keep The Donald awake. But it seems even consciousness was too much to ask of him.

Saturday April 20, 2024

Just as Greater Western Sydney looked to be on their merry way to a 6-0 start to the season, Carlton's two headed monster roared to life with an almighty third-quarter blitz to drag the Blues back into the pack. The pair piled on five consecutive goals in only six minutes to fire the Blues to a stirring 19 point win at Marvel Stadium.
A great win by the boys, who really stood up when it counted against an undefeated team.


BLUES V GIANTS

5.1	4.1
7.7	9.4
14.10	12.7
17.15	15.8
117	**98**

BOURKE'S BEST Blues: Cripps, Walsh, Kennedy, De Koning, Curnow, McKay, Pittonet. **Giants:** Kelly, Ash, Hogan, Aleer, Whitfield, Green.
GOALS Blues: Curnow 3, De Koning 3, McKay 3, E.Hollands 2, Durdin 2, Owies, Cottrell, O.Hollands, Kennedy. **Giants:** Hogan 3, Kelly 3, Riccardi 3, Bedford 2, Daniels, Cadman, Peatling, Buckley.
INJURIES Blues: Williams (achilles), Weitering (corked quad). **Giants:** Nil.
CROWD 40,474 at Marvel Stadium

Sunday April 21, 2024

Sadly Aunty Rosemay passed away at Embracia at 1.30pm. Janny, Kath, Amanda and Savahannah were in attendance.

Tuesday April 18, 2024

Today I attended the new narrm ngarrgu library at 141 Therry Street Melbourne, adjacent to the Queen Victoria Market. I was there to meet with Dr. Nicolette Snowden as part of the National Library of Australia's COVID-19 Oral History Project, Curatorial and Collection Research. The oral history project has been designed to capture the impacts of the COVID-19 pandemic on Australian lives and society. The project aims to capture experiences across urban, regional, rural and remote Australia and to ensure that the diversity of the Australian population is well represented. I was selected to participate due to my book, A Coronavirus Journal, being gifted to the National Library of Australia. The interview spanned over two hours and covered many aspects of my life, background and perspectives relating to the pandemic.

Wednesday April 24, 2024

The above photos were taken by Dr. Nicolette Snowden yesterday and sent to me today, with the photo on the far left to be submitted to the National Library of Australia archives to accompany my oral presentation.

Good Morning Patrick,

Thank you again for doing yesterday's interview. I'm delighted your story has made its way to the NLA archives.

Dr. Nicolette Snowden

Thursday April 25, 2024

Jamie Elliott soars over Essendon's Ben McKay to take a screamer in front of 93,644 fans.

A truly great game of footy, where lead changes were commonplace, and when you see a speccie like that, it restores your faith that great marks are still possible. There's nothing more exciting in sport than witnessing marks like this.

However, what happens when a player is concussed when a player jumps on his head to take a hanger?

L E S T W E F O R G E T

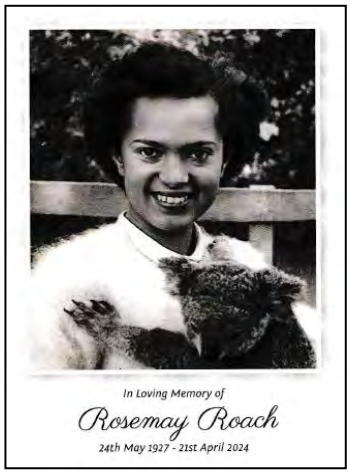
Up there Jamie (Billy) Elliott…you beauty!

Sunday April 28, 2024

Janny and I attended a State Library tour arranged by AMEP, attended by my fellow tutors. Great insight into the history and wonderful spaces at this very special part of Melbourne.

Monday April 29, 2024

Aunty Rosemay's funeral was held today at Simplicity Funerals Thomastown at 10.00am.



The many delightful faces of dear Aunty Rosemay.

Great photo of the Anderson clan having dinner at Jeff and Janine's, who are the greatest of hosts. Taken the evening before Aunty Rosemay's funeral.

Tuesday April 30, 2024

Tuesday ponderings….
Tesla's share price has dropped a fair way of late, due to increased competition from China (think BYD et al), future growth projections and model release delays.
Perhaps the name TESLA can be scrambled…..

FROM

TESLA

TO

STALE

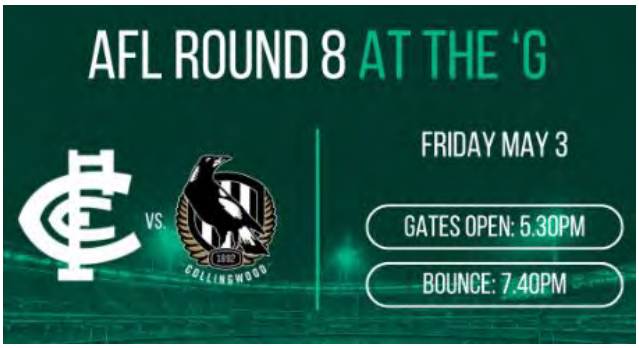
Time for some Elon magic….and coincidentally it looks like he found some in China today.
(Elon Musk strikes agreement with authorities to access Chinese mapping and location software, to enable driverless cars to become a reality).

Thursday May 2, 2024

Charges dropped over quarantine saga

No one will be held criminally responsible for a COVID-19 outbreak from hotel quarantine that led to the death of 768 people and one of the world's longest lockdowns, after a case against the Victorian Department of Health collapsed.

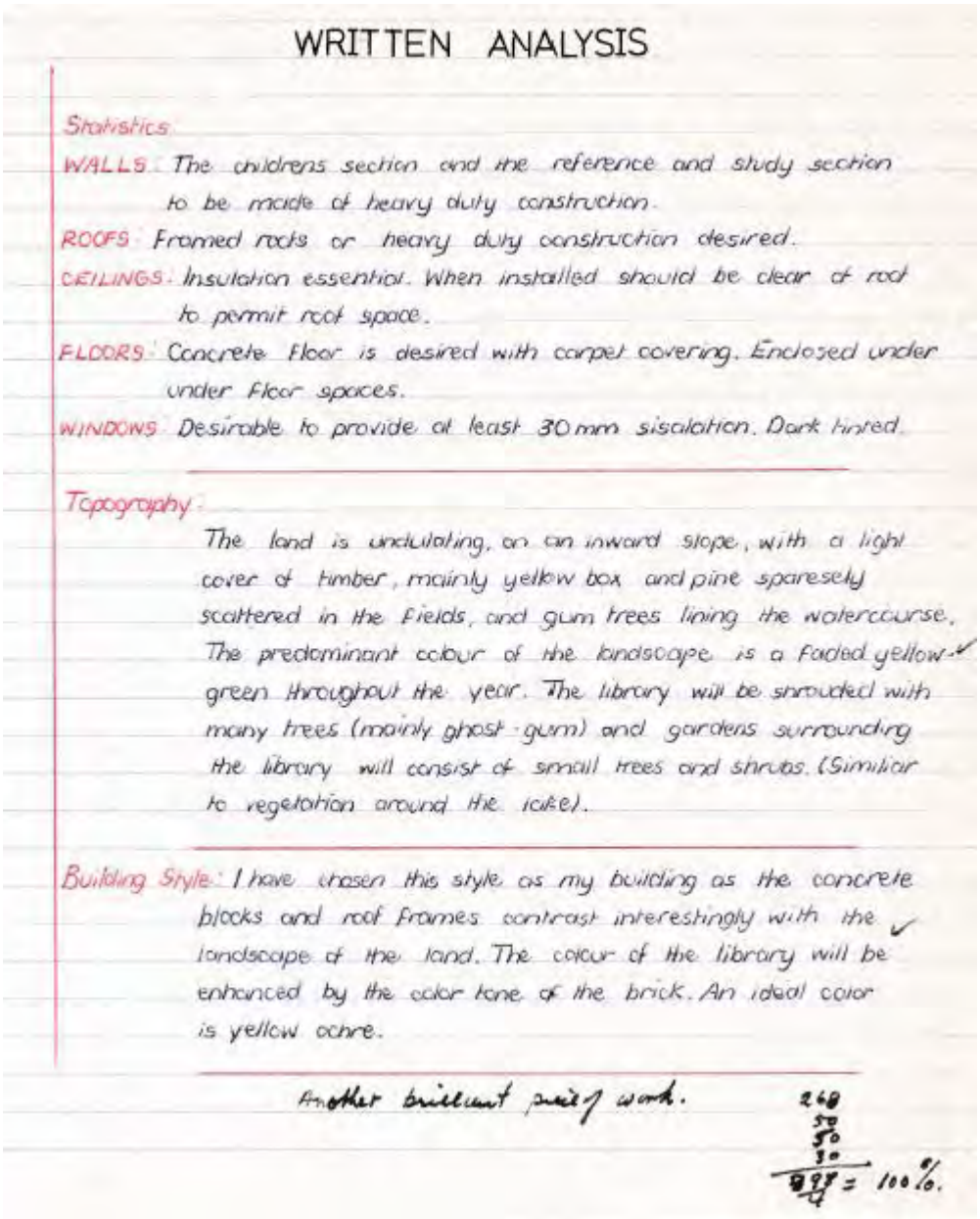
Friday May 3, 2024



For Janny and I, one of us would leave the ground this evening without a grin on their face.
Unfotunately, it was me (and Jeff).

Wednesday May 9, 2024

It's amazing what you stumble on when you start fossicking through your old documents and notes. I found a school project for the subject of Graphic Communications that I submitted in 1977. It involved coming up with building project using monies donated by a philanthropist named Henry Jacobs. I proposed a community library. My written analysis and mark is listed below. Without doubt my strongest subject in Form 4 was graphic communications. Now in retirement, my passion for graphic communications and presentation can, I believe, be seen in my books and diary entries. Presentation is everything!



WRITTEN ANALYSIS

Statistics

WALLS: The childrens section and the reference and study section to be made of heavy duty construction.

ROOFS: Framed roofs or heavy duty construction desired.

CEILINGS: Insulation essential. When installed should be clear of roof to permit roof space.

FLOORS: Concrete floor is desired with carpet covering. Enclosed under under floor spaces.

WINDOWS: Desirable to provide at least 30 mm sisalation. Dark tinted.

Topography:

The land is undulating, on an inward slope, with a light cover of timber, mainly yellow box and pine sparesely scattered in the fields, and gum trees lining the watercourse. The predominant colour of the landscape is a faded yellow-green throughout the year. The library will be shrouded with many trees (mainly ghost gum) and gardens surrounding the library will consist of small trees and shrubs. (Similiar to vegetation around the lake).

Building Style: I have chosen this style as my building as the concrete blocks and roof frames contrast interestingly with the landscape of the land. The colour of the library will be enhanced by the color tone of the brick. An ideal color is yellow ochre.

Another brilliant piece of work.

268
50
50
30
398 = 100%.

Another brilliant piece of work.

268
50
50
30
398 = 100%.

Wednesday May 9, 2024

Janny and I rode our tandem bike to Studley Park Boatsheds for a drink and then continued along the Yarra to Richmond. It was a beautiful sunny afternoon without a breath of wind. The river was like a mill pond, allowing us to witness some striking autumnal tree reflections on the water. I have never seen the river as still as this. Yet another highlight of our bike riding odyssey.

Thursday May 10, 2024

The great philosopher Kenny Rogers once sang "Youv'e got to know when to hold em, know when to fold em". This mantra holds true for Janny and I when it comes to property investing. As retirees, income is a blessing; outgoings a curse. We have held our properties long enough – it's time to cash in our chips. The holding costs are problematic, even more so now that the State Government has slugged property investors with higher land tax levies to pay down the burgeoning debt in Victoria. Our recently received land tax bill is well over $4,000. It's Time!

Pallas of Dreams

STATE BUDGET 2024

"When $25 million a day
is projected to fly out the door
in interest payments alone,
it's clear that something's got to give".

Monday May 13, 2024

REVIEW ALL YOUR REAL ESTATE
Liquidate all real estate holdings that are not generating income or *enjoyment*.
This seems obvious, but there's a hoarding instinct we may have to overcome.

Wednesday May 15, 2024

We are dusty old Boomers.
Shallow conflict thrives in social media echo chambers where algorithms amplify controversy and reaffirm prejudices. Australia is not immune to the politics of division, and the animosity towards Boomers represents the kind of manufactured groupthink we must all guard against.

An intriguing murder case commenced today.

An accident or murder most foul?

Monday May 20, 2024

Dozens of police on horseback and specialist units were called to combat ugly clashes between protesters, amid violent scenes which led to six arrests.

Today is the start of National Volunteer Week and Janny and I attended a breakfast function at MannaCare this morning. We were given certificates of appreciation and a thank you card, and the message within the card read;

Behind every successful organisation, there is
an extraordinary volunteer team. Our many
praises to the team of volunteers!
Thank you for your professionalism and exceptional work.
We couldn't have done it without you!
Romi Mathieson – COO

My childhood was a lot simpler.
You have to feel for parents of today. What are these kids being exposed to in the rabbit hole? How will it shape their future?

Monday May 20, 2024

A Monday reflection;

Opinions are divided
Protest rallies aplenty this May
The police are kept busy
And leaving our streets in disarray.

Can we make a difference
to shape Isreali policy?
To think we can prevail
is sheer and utter fallacy.

It's great to be Australian,
To live in our isolation bubble,
But not so much in Gaza,
Where neighbouroods are now in rubble.

The keffiyah scarf is draped
for Palestine to be free
As they walk and chant among us
"From the river to the sea".

And throughout all this,
Our anguish takes its toll,
And a terrorist group rejoices....
...having achieved its ultimate goal.

Tuesday May 21, 2024

Janny and I will be attending the "Opening Night" of Sunset Boulevard this evening.
For a second time this year, we will be attending the opening night of a theatre show. Back on Thursday March 7 we attended the "green carpet" opening night of "Wicked".
The casting of Sarah Brightman was, in my opinion, a mistake. Her voice was too operatic and difficult to understand. Apart from this it was a good production.

★★★

Full page advertisement in today's Herald Sun

Thursday May 23, 2024

Notable quotes and thoughts assembled today;

The horse that never stops trying is the one called self-interest"

"I've been blessed to be under his warm shadow my entire life"

Being Jeff's younger brother

Friday May 24, 2024

And another thing.....

Dutton's nuclear promise and feedback...

Who do you believe regarding the costs of nuclear power? A former policeman or a team of CSIRO scientists?

Dutton to name nuclear sites (*The Age*, 23/5). That's one way to tackle the escalating house prices.

Nuclear power? In 'Yes, Minister' terms, Peter Dutton has made a courageous decision and has grasped the political hot potato with both hands.

Saturday May 25, 2024

It looks like Victoria's State debt's gonna remain a problem

Talk about Labor pains!

Sunday May 27, 2024

This morning Janny and I went to the Box Hill Record Fair. We purchased the following LP records;

The excitement of finding long lost and coveted records can never be undervalued.

Monday May 27, 2024

We saw FURIOSA – A MAD MAX SAGA at Doncaster.
This movie is a prequel to the superb FURY ROAD. A very hard act to follow, but it certainly held its own.
My verdict;

★★★★

Tuesday May 28, 2024

When it comes to heavy metal, it is with a heavy heart that I regard myself as a thinking man's metallurgist.

Wednesday May 29, 2024

I entered a competition to win a holiday to Japan with Inspiring Vacations. In 25 words or less, write why you would like to travel to Japan;
"From the hustle and bustle of Tokyo, to Mount Fuji , the Bullet Train and historic Kyoto, who wouldn't want to go.

Wednesday May 29, 2024

Last night a SKY News program aired on the subject of antisemitism, called NEVER AGAIN. It was hosted by the former Member for Kooyong – Josh Friedenberg. This program highlighted the divisions in our communities regarding the current conflict in Gaza and revealed that a huge undercurrent of antisemitism has always existed in Australia and has now bubbled to the surface, for all to see. This documentary was quite emotional at times.

My Wednesday thought;

"Our investment journey has ultimately allowed us to bury our snouts in the trough, and not feel any sense of guilt whatsoever".

Janny and I took the 207 bus to the city today to donate blood and plasma. Emblazoned on a vacant and graffiti laden shopfront in Johnston Street was a "Rent Is Theft" poster. I would not be surprised if the Greens were behind it.
It is quite surprising and baffling that there is a cohort who actually believes this or that this message may resonate with some.

Thursday May 30, 2024

Today I inquired about an exhibition by Andrew Fyfe, a well known cartoonist, titled MARVELLOUS MELBOURNE. Unfortunately the exhibition has completed its run, but I was able to view his prints on-line. The exhibition comprises a collection of 14 limited-edition fine art prints encapsulating the essence of Melbourne through his whimsical lens, portraying familiar streets, iconic buildings, and social satire with a distinctive twist.

UMBRELLAS

Centre Place – our favorite Melbourne CBD coffee spot

FLINDERS STREET PUFFERS
Gone are the Craven Filters and in are the puffer jackets and phones

BAGS
The Paris end of Collins Street getting a reality check

SCOOTING DOWN THE YARRA
Go-Boats navigating a minefield of dumped Lime e-scooters – Cheers!

Friday May 31, 2024

At 7.10am we heard on 3AW that Donald Trump was found guilty of falsifying business records in the first degree regarding hush money payments to Stormy Daniels.
G U I L T Y O N A L L 3 4 C O U N T S

"This was a disgrace. This was a rigged trial. The judge was conflicted and corrupt".

Donald Trump following the verdict

Janny and I checked into the Victoria Hotel in Little Collins Street and in the evening attended the Comedy Theatre to see The Odd Couple. Todd McKenney, strangely enough, reminded me of Tony Randall's portrayal of Felix Unger. He really nailed it. Shane Jacobson was also impressive, although on occasion his Aussie accent came through.

★★★★

Saturday June 1, 2024

The orange prison garb will match his complexion

Monday June 3, 2024

Now that Uber is now accessable by phone, Janny and I decided to create an account and we booked our first Uber for 5.30am June 25, to take us to the airport.

At last! We will be able to watch twins Harry and Ben McKay play against each other for the first time on Sunday in the blockbuster Essendon v Carlton game at the MCG.

Saturday June 8, 2024

It appears to me that every morning we wake up to the same two news stories.

One of them is the news that another tobacco shop has gone up in flames as part of a illegal tobacco war that is engulfing Melbourne currently. To date sixty five tobacco shops have been torched.

The other recurring story relates to a group of young teenagers being apprehended for driving at crazy speeds in a stolen car. These miscreants range in age from 13 to 15.

Where has our Australia gone?

In the Herald Sun this morning Steve Price pondered this question.

"We need to have a debate in Australia on whether we are the Lucky Country. If we are not prepared to talk honestly about where things are going, we will end up somewhere we don't want to be. Are we sadly heading down the same road as the U.S. and even the U.K."
"How can we possibly be proud of our Lucky Country if we are constantly told we are a bunch of greedy racists who stole what we have and should feel guilty about it"

Saturday June 8, 2024

I am fast becoming increasingly uncomfortable with my place in Australia. As a baby boomer, property investor and self funded retiree, I feel like I am being shamed into a sense of guilt, in that I have achieved so much. I feel like I am responsible for climate change, high house prices and deep seated racism. Why is it becoming increasingly difficult to embrace Australian patriotism?

One thing I can confirm is this. Us Baby Boomers always believed that we could progress beyond the standard of living that our parents achieved. Our parents in particular brought us up in public housing and they wanted us to achieve more than them. We have successfully done this, where we own our own home, have a property portfolio and a superannuation balance that has allowed us to be self funded, thus avoiding a retirement on welfare. The question is can the next generation surpass us? The average mortgage today is $625k. Is home ownership a realistic dream? Not to mention wealth creation goals.

Monday June 10, 2024 – The King's Birthday Holiday

Carlton defeated Essendon last night.
15.6.96 to 9.16.70

Monday headlines…
"THEY'RE COMING! BLUES SURGE INTO SECOND SPOT AND ARE NOW THE CLEAR FLAG CHALLENGER TO THE SWANS".
"DON'T ARGUE…..BLUES ARE REAL DEAL".
"TDK DOES AMAZING THINGS TO BLUE SYSTEM".

Monday reflections….

It seems that every morning we wake up to the same news story.
Another tobacco shop has gone up in flames as part of Melbourne's on-going tobacco arson wars.
A group of teenagers have been arrested after a high speed police chase across the streets of Melbourne, reaching speeds of up to 180kph. The ages of the arrested teenagers – 13 to 15 years of age.

Four Israeli hostages have been freed by Israeli Defence forces on Saturday. Israeli citizens both in Israel and across the globe chanted and danced upon

Monday June 10, 2024 – The King's Birthday Holiday….continued

hearing the news. …yipee! Incidently 274 Palestinian civilians were killed during this military operation. There in lies the fundamental problem.
Executive Council of Australian Jewry co-chief executive Alex Ryvchin said "For so long we hoped and prayed they would be home and safe. Right now is a time to celebrate because life has prevailed over death". Seriously? 274 Palestinians for four Israeli's? It appears that these Palestinians have simply been written off as collateral damage. Surely the Israeli's can display some humility amid a terrible human tragedy. This was not the time for chanting and dancing.
Disregarding the politics of this conflict, this is yet another example of **the shame of humanity.**

The Gregory Lynn murder case.
Janny and I have concluded that Greg Lynn is guilty of murder for the following key reasons;
Firstly, on the balance of probabilities, two people being **accidently** killed during his confrontation with Russell Hill and Carol Clay is very low. The assertion that Carole Clay was accidently shot when the shotgun was discharged and that Russell Hill died when he fell onto his knife during a scuffle appear highly unlikely.
Secondly, some months after Greg Lynn disposed of the bodies, he returned and burnt the bodies, We believe that his intention was to destroy the remains so that the cause of death could not be established. This would help his case that their deaths were a terrible accident and murder could not be proven.

Tuesday June 11, 2024

I don't envisage that his statue would last long. It might go the way of the Captain Cook or King George V statues (think decapitations). Mind you, I suspect Chairman Dan would feel quite comfortable being smeared in red paint.

Monday June 17, 2024

Move over Jamie Elliott – Bobby has bumped you out of contention for Mark of the Year.
The most remarkable aspect of this grab was that Bobby landed perfectly on his feet – almost like an elite gymnast dismounting from the parallel bars.
It appears to me that if you have plenty of "tatts" and you play for Collingwood, the sky's the limit.
By the way, Collingwood won by a point, after trailing by 52 points! An amazing win.

The National Library of Australia contacted me today to provide audio files of my Oral History interview with Dr Nicolette Snowden. Janny and I listened to the interview and Janny, in particular, really enjoyed it.

Dear Patrick,

Thank you for your very generous participation in the National Library's Oral History interview program.

A copy of your interview may be downloaded at the link below:

https://nlaaus.sharefile.com/public/share/web-s15dc46d3f93447738f26ef34c457eca9

Please note that the interview must be downloaded and saved within 180 days or the link will expire. Please feel free to contact spats@nla.gov.au if you have any technical issues

Kind regards,

Natalie

Natalie Fairhurst | Senior Library Officer Technical Aquisitions

02 6262 1046 | nfairhurst@nla.gov.au | National Library of Australia

The National Library of Australia acknowledges Australia's First Nations Peoples – the First Australians – as the Traditional Owners and Custodians of this land and gives respect to the Elders – past and present – and through them to all Australian Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander people.

NATIONAL LIBRARY OF AUSTRALIA

Parkes Place Canberra ACT 2600 Australia
T +61 2 6262 1111
nla.gov.au

Wednesday June 19, 2024

We attended the play The Woman in Black at the Athanaeum Theatre. Very engrossing.

★ ★ ★ ★

Friday June 21, 2024

Carlton's rainbow connection as fans help lead the Blues to pot of gold and revival as an AFL superpower

Shannon Gill
CODE Sports

Brian Cook has seen the very best in football as the CEO in premiership success at West Coast and Geelong, yet the ferocity of the Carlton crowd roar was something he'd never experienced.

"First coming to Carlton, the noise that was generated in those first few home games in 2022, it gave me goosebumps, it still does in fact," Carlton boss Cook tells CODE Sports.

"We had reached 81,302 members that year off the back of winning just 11 games in the previous three seasons – that was remarkable to me."

The supporter base was never quite sleeping, but this year the Blues are flying and their army is marching in numbers we've seen before.

The fans are leading a club revival. Another 80,000 are tipped for today's clash with Geelong, to add to the four 80,000-plus crowds it has played in front of this season.

Carlton has played in four of the top seven-attended AFL games this season, its average crowd and average home crowd in the home and away season are the best in the club's history (up 7000 and 6000 per game respectively). It will likely take this season's league lead from Collingwood on those numbers this weekend.

Most staggering is that stretching back to 2023, Carlton's last 10 games at the MCG have averaged 81,713.

"To average that MCG number for such a long stretch of time, that speaks to much more than just winning games of football," Cook says.

"What it says to us, and Vossy has said this before also, our members and supporters have a real connection to the way their team goes about their football."

Previously that connection was sometimes seen as a millstone when it came to making clear-headed decisions to lift the Blues out of two decades of mediocrity. For a long time, Carlton and patience were as compatible as oil and water.

"Passion in football can work both ways, depending on whether you are winning or losing," Cook says.

"However what I've observed is a shift somewhat to our connection between our supporters and their team no longer solely dependent on one result on the weekend.

"I really want to credit our supporters and players for embracing that humility piece that our club has now started to wear, as a trademark we live by at Carlton."

Excuse me, Carlton and humility?

"Pig's arse," as the most infamous exponent of Blues arrogance, John Elliott, would once say.

Yet this is the subtle reworking of the Blues that coach Voss has been instrumental in, says Cook.

"We've lost games this year, we've won games but the belief and perspective has remained, there has been a level-headedness, an understanding of the bigger picture," the CEO said.

"Whether that's the excitement and athleticism of certain players, the combative and contest nature of others or even, which I love, the celebration of the role players in our team who are now getting as much love and adoration over the fence as the more senior players."

It loses nothing on noise and passion, but it's a very different approach to the Elliott-exceptionalism era. That support has been converted into 100,000 members for the first time ever this year, adding to what is a rapidly improving bottom line.

The mid-year resurgence of 2023 helped contribute to $23m in revenue from its supporters through membership, gate receipts and merchandise.

"Carlton is in a stronger position financially now, which is great and as we know you do need that to help you chase success," Cook says.

"However, more importantly, we're receiving feedback that despite this growth, Carlton people are feeling more integrated, more included."

CODE SPORTS
Go Full AFL
Read more at

Off the field the Blues are kicking goals. Their values and culture are aspects of the club that make me very proud to be a Carlton member.
"Members and supporters have a real connection to the way their team goes about their football".

Monday June 23, 2024

Janny and I visited Dixon Recycled Records in High Street Northcote yesterday. I spotted a record that I've been chasing for a while – Black Sabbath's Mob Rules. This is the second Black Sabbath album with Ronnie James Dio and is a beauty. It also came with a bonus vinyl disc with live tracks.

Text from the album inside cover: *I listen to "Heaven and Hell" and "Mob Rules" occasionally these days, and they're really refreshing, Iommi says. The band was just really tight. And even to the last day with Ronnie, we made everything to be the best we could. It was always excellent.*

Monday June 24, 2024

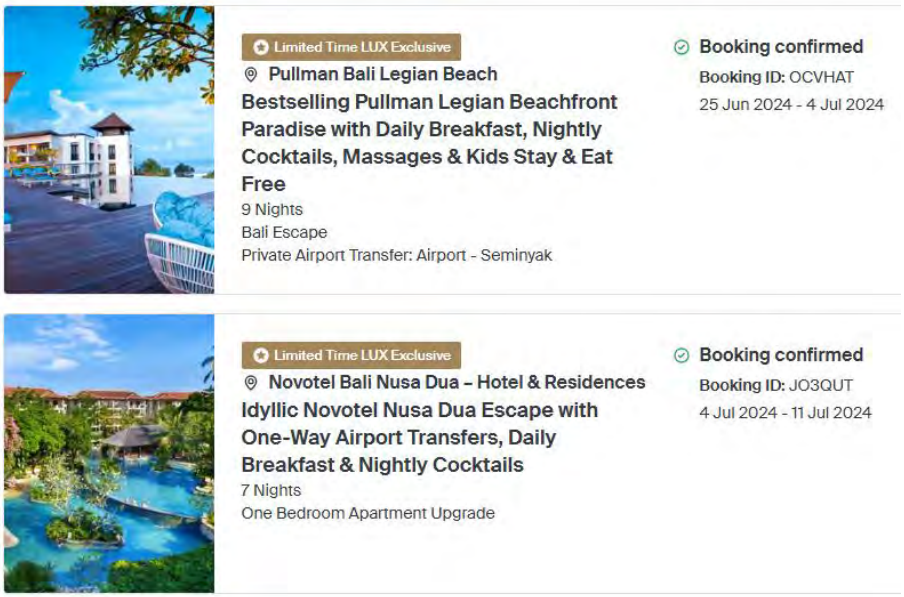
I have just received my latest blood test results;

S CHOL: 4.2 S LDL-CHOL: 2.1

As the bad LDL cholestrol is at 2.1 and the target is 1.8, Dr. Schulberg recommended increasing my dose of statins from 10mg to 20mg. Whilst I am slightly reticent about the side affects of such medication, I need to acknowledge that this is about risk mitigation, as I have a pre-disposition to cardiovascular disease.

Jerry Seinfeld is playing to packed out crowds in Melbourne, but had to deal with some unwanted heckling and addressed them thus;

"Listen, you and I are in the same business. Our business is to get people to see things the way we see it. The problem is you're in the wrong place. Do you hear how well I'm doing? You're paying good money to attend and giving money to a Jew!"



Tuesday, June 25, 2024

Janny and I jet off today for our winter getaway to Bali. We will meet up with Kath, Jeff, Janine, Ryan, Casey and others.

Tuesday June 25, 2024
My in-flight thoughts….

We are at 30,000 feet on our way to Bali. It's 2.09pm Melbourne time. We arre on an Airbus A321-NEO. This aircraft represents the latest in state-of -the-art budget air travel. The fusilage consists of a single aisle with three seats either side.. We are at the furtherst most rear seats of the plane. Behind us are the lavatories. A wave or log jam of fellow travellers congregate adjacent to me to get access to the "Gene Tunnies" and then abates, like the ebb and flow of the tides. It's impossible to sleep as the milling crowd buffet me in my aisle seat, while the cabin crew behind us chat away like squaking cockatoos in a gum tree. To make matters worse there are no entertainment screens provided, so we can't watch movies etc. As I mentioned, this is budget flying at its saddest. I have completed reading the Herald-Sun, front to back and have knocked over the crossword. I wonder if we can get WiFi on this flight? If so I could fire up Spotify.
We spent last evening at Kath's and this morning our Uber arrived right on time at 5.30am. His name was Sisile and he drove a Kia Rio. He was a dark skinned chap and I asked him his nationality to which he replied French. I then asked him if he was from Mauritius – turned out he was.
Now for that Wi-Fi connection…. Success! Now to connect to Spotify…yes, you beauty – now listening to BTO – Not Fragile. Meanwhile the buffering of passengers against me continues. I can only hope that our return flight is on a wider bodied Boeing aircraft with two aisles and entertainment screens.

Arrived in Bali at the Pullman Legain hotel. A large sprawling complex. We were, as requested, placed in Room 1512. Rang Jeff to let him know we had arrived. I confirmed with him that Kath, upon arriving in Bali tomorrow, will swing by our hotel in her cab to pick us up and then we will proceed to Shambala. Janny and I had dinner at Sheppy's and watched 1970's music video's on one of the many TV's.

Wednesday June 26, 2024

Upon arriving at Denpasar airport, Kath was hoodwinked by a dodgy taxi driver who duped her into a $50 taxi ride. Upon arriving at the Pullman, I bartered him down to $45 and sent him on his way. We then caught a Bluebird metered taxi and arrived at Shambala, which was located within a very narrow gang. We had drinks at the villa with Jeff, Janine, and clan. Also had a swim in the pool. Then got changed and went to the local sports bar to watch Game 2 of the State of Origin series at the MCG. NSW thumped Queensland 38-18. Emma's boyfriend Vincent a very impresive young man.

Thursday June 27, 2024

Janny and I had a relaxing pool day at the hotel infinity pool. During the day I made a trip to Mozzarella's restaurant to book a table for five for Saturday night's Beatle's show. I commandered a motor scooter to take me to the restaurant and to a convenience store to get more Bintangs.

Friday June 28, 2024

Jeff, Janine and Kath checked out of Shambala and checked into a hotel at the back of the Pullman called 14 Roses. They then came and joined us at the infinity pool at the Pullman for a lovely afternoon. That evening we had dinner at Lemongrass on Melasti.

Saturday June 29, 2024

Jeff joined me at 6.15am for a Legain Beach walk. Later, Jeff, Kath and Janine joined us at the Pullman lower pool for the day and then we had dinner at Mozzarella's and The Beatles show. While at the pool Janine and me booked our Ubud bicycle tour.

Joe Biden is fighting for his political life following a dismal performance at the first debate of his re-election campaign. Jeff and I went for a walk along the Legian beach walk and Jeff filled me in on the train wreck presidential debate where Joe Biden's performance did nothing to quell fears about his age and cognitive ability to lead his country.

"The question every voter should
be asking themselves today
is not whether Joe Biden can survive a
90 minute debate performance,
but whether America can
survive another four more years of
crooked Joe".

Donald Trump

Sunday June 30, 2024

Jeff and I walked the beach walk to Kuta at 3.15am. Later we met at the Pullman foyer and caught a cab to the swish W Hotel in Seminyak for their Sunday Brunch. Upon arrival we were greeted with welcome champanges. I suspect you are only entitled to one champange each, but they served us two - we were very polite and I spoke some Bhasa Indonesian to them - always goes a long way towards extra service, especially if you say "sing ken ken"...which means "no worries". We then made our way down to the dining area

overlooking the resort pools and the beach and on the way we were greeted by a procession of cheering and chanting, drum beating and singing staff members. It was quite an entry. Food was magnificent. A lovely experience. Jeff and me departed early, made our way to the foyer and requested an electric cart to take us to the street and the end of the hotel's long, bamboo festooned drive. We then made our way to the Winx Sports Bar to watch the second half of the Richmond v Carlton match. The Blues had a terrific third quarter to set up another impressive win. Cripps again brilliant and may well be on his way to his second "Charlie".

Monday July 1, 2024

We again met at the Pullman foyer and at 7.15am daparted for our Ubud bicycle tour. On the way we picked up an Italian couple. The bike ride was great. Janny and I cycled on a tandem. The bike was a bit rough and ready and the gear changes were a bit hit and miss, but we got through it OK, despite the rain. Followed the ride with a lovely Balinese lunch in an Ubud homestay. The drive home was marred by terrible traffic congestion. And I thought Melbourne was bad. It's almost becoming time prohibitive to travel from Legian/Seminyak to Ubud. Perhaps there are too many tourists/accomodation providers in Bali. Is there a limit on how many are allowed into Bali at the one time? At $50 Visa on Arrival payment per person, I would think that the Indonesian Government would be very reluctant to cap numbers entering Bali. Oh, and don't forget the new $15 tourist environment levy as well!

Tuesday July 2, 2024

Janny and I went for a walk to Kuta, while Jeff, Janine and Kath went shopping at the Bintang Supermarket. Upon return they met us at the Pullman lower pool. During this time I went to the foyer and arranged a booking for five at Poppy's Restaurant in Kuta that evening, although Janine was suffering from Bali Belly. We walked to Poppy's and it was a lovely evening.

Wednesday July 3, 2024

I met Jeff at 6.15am in the Pullman foyer where we hired two bicycles.
We rode to the airport and large statue and then cycled back to the Double Six beach. Jeff was a trooper as he cycled on despite having a dose of Bali Belly. We had a bit of rain that day. Jeff and Kath joined us under the umbrella's at the Pullman lower pool. That evening Kath, Janine and Jeff joined us for pre-dinner drinks in our room and then our Italiano themed dinner at the hotel. Janine couldn't eat and Jeff was confined to soup, as they were both suffering gastric upsets. Later in the evening Kath succumbed to the "belly" and had to make a beeline to the Gene Tunny.

Thursday July 4, 2024

Janny and I checked out of the Pullman at midday. Jeff, Janine and Kath were there to see us off. We took a small SUV for $24 or 240,000 IDR to the Novotel Nusa Dua. Upon checking in we went for a walk to the street merchants and found a couple of restaurants that braodcasted AFL footy. That evening we had dinner at Cockatoo's Restaurant.

Nusa Dua is a gated compound full of large resorts. It's a vast and manicured place where we were able to leave the rest of the island behind. Gone are the street vendors, hustle, bustle and engaging chaos of Legian, Kuta and Seminyak. The roads aren't clogged and the footpaths are in good condition. A little respite from the chaos.

Friday July 5, 2024

I got up early for my early morning walk . I asked Reception how to get to the Mulia hotel. He gave me very good instructions and I found it easily. A huge, sprawling property. It has a huge pool at the front of the property, adjacent to the wedding chapel. This is not a swimming pool, rather I suspect it is there for aesthetics and to enhance wedding photo's.

The rest of our stay at the Novotel Nusa Dua consisted of pool and beach days and massages in the the resort and at the beach. On one day Janny and me walked along the beach to the Mulia Hotel and had a dip in their pool. The pools at the Mulia are jaw dropping, resplenden with rows of monolithic statues.

On one morning I hired a bicycle and rode along the beach promenade to the Grand Mirage hotel, which is close to Tanjung Benoa. The promenade path is, at certain points, blocked by large steps and I had to pick up and carry the bike over, which detracts from the journey.

We dined at a small beach restaurant on a couple of evenings and befriended a resident small dog that had an injured hind leg. Janny brought a chicken meal and fed the dog chicken.

Thursday July 11, 2024

A Melbourne Airport taxi dilemma

We arrived at Melbourne Airport and then attempted to find the taxi rank to get our lift to Kath's. Upon exiting, we saw a large and well organised UBER rank. We then followed the Taxi signs. We walked a great distance and on the way two taxi spruikers tried to garner our business. We asked how much for a fare to Reservoir, to which they responded $85. We responded by saying we would continue walking to find the taxi rank. They then replied that there is a long wait for a taxi. We continued our pilgrimage. We finally found the taxi rank - well away from our initial exit point. What we found was a disgrace. It was a confusing and chaotic scene. There was no official to control the flow of taxi's and passengers. We naturally thought that we need to go to the head of the line of taxi's, however people behind us were getting into taxi's well before the lead taxi. We finally found a taxi - a Toyota Camry, but he said he couldn't fit in our luggage, opening his boot to display that the boot space was limited due to the presence of an LPG tank. I said to him "mate your at the airport - don't come here if you can't accommodate luggage". We kept walking and we saw a blue SUV at the head of the queue. We asked him to take us to Reservoir. He said no, there is someone else he needs to take, pointing in a direction further down the line. A nearby security bloke immediately got on his two-way radio to report this driver as refusing a fare and pointing to us saying he had eye witnesses to this. We then found another taxi driver, also in a Camry, and was helpful and happy to take our trip. He immediately said that the driver who refused

our fare has mental health issues and sits at the head of the queue every day and often refuses fares.
All this provided us with an interesting insight into how broken the taxi system is, particularly at the airport.

Saturday July 13, 2024

Shining a light on Cripps' champion qualities

Our inspirational captain, Paddy Cripps, plays his 200th game today against the Western Bulldogs at Marvel Stadium. Carlton's recruiters in 2013 nicknamed him "The Extractor". All he needs now is to become a Premiership Captain, to cap off a magnificent career. I kind of feel that this is his destiny....time will tell.

Footnote.....pity they couldn't win for Crippa!

A cognitive master class

At the NATO Summit in Europe, Joe Biden again proved himself to be king of the gaffes. Surely he now needs to stand down. Surely his family, or indeed the Democrats could tap him on the shoulder.

Sunday July 14, 2024

A new iconic imamge

We woke up this morning to the news that Donald Trump had been shot at a party rally in Pennsylvania. This photo of a defiant Trump, with face bloodied straight after the shooting and beneath the American flag, will no doubt end up on banners, tee-shirts, mugs and other assorted merchandise paraphernalia. This will supercharge his election campaign, bring in millions of dollars from merchandise sales and guarantee his re-election as President of the United States. I mean, lets face it, Sleepy Joe isn't exactly setting the world on fire.

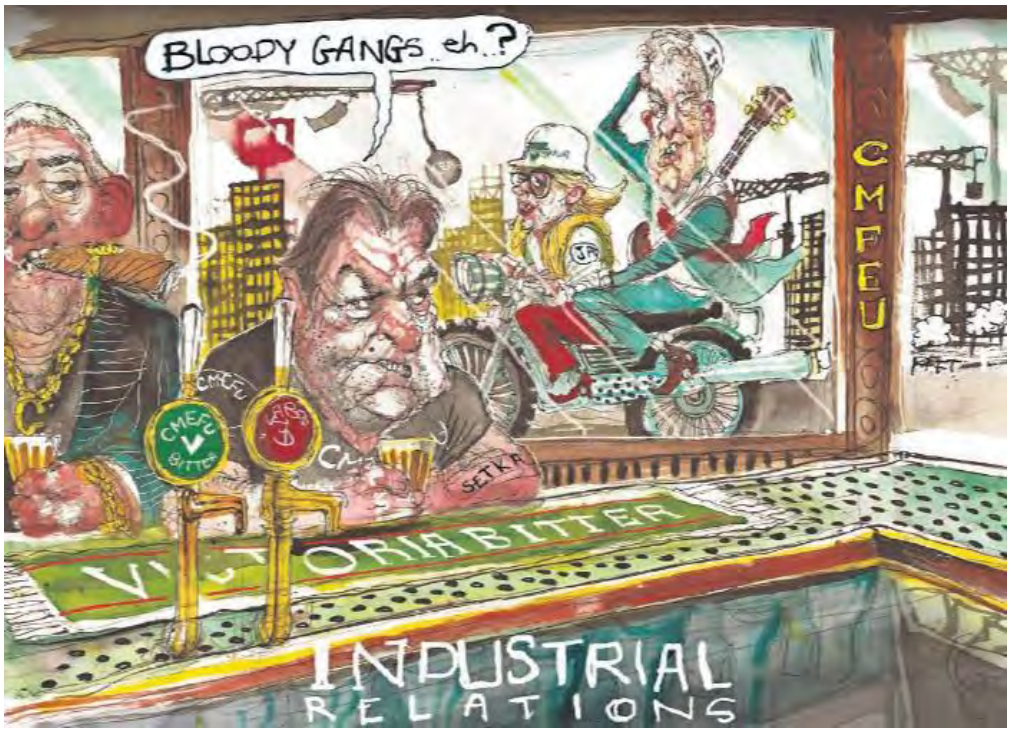
★★★

Janny and I saw "A Quiet Place Day One" at the Rivoli. Frodo the cat was the star of this flick.

Monday July 15, 2024

A close race for the Presidency?
Hey Joe....you don't have to be dead to be stiff!

Tuesday July 16, 2024



The CMFEU is accused of intimidation and hiring criminals for key Union positions, particularly from outlaw motorcycle gangs.
Victoria is very Bitter

ASX tops 8000 in global market rally

Australia's sharemarket made history by closing above 8,000 points for the first time buoyed by hopes that the US is on the cusp of cutting interest rates. CBA records a record high of $132.

Monday July 22, 2024

Biden pulls out of US election race, endorses Harris to take on Trump for presidency

Wednesday July 25, 2024

Is Kamala Harris destined to be the next President of the United States? I reckon "The Donald" is feeling a tad nervous. No doubt his attack campaign will commence in earnest.

To see what can be....
Unburdened by what has been.

Kamala Harris – VP

Saturday 27 July, 2024

Jess Fox has been described as the "Don Bradman" of kayaking.
An apt description.

Sunday 28 July, 2024

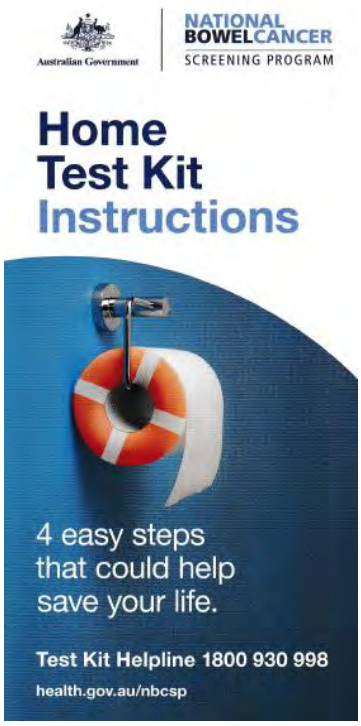
This movie is not for the faint hearted. We saw LONG LEGS at the Jam Factory.
It was so sad to see first hand the decline of the Chapel Street district, particularly the Jam Factory, which resembled something out of a post apocalyptic, dystopian world. All shops shuttered and the facility desolate. It was not much better along Chapel Street. Janny and I have fond memories of this precinct being vibrant, busy and buzzing and we were frequent visitors.

★★★★

Monday July 29, 2024

Jess Fox wins the K1 gold medal overnight in Paris. She qualified eighth to scrape into the final. Being eighth she had to do her run first, but set a blistering time. She then had a nerve wracking wait as the seven other competitors went through their paces, and all falling short of Jess's time, allowing her to claim the gold medal – truly inspirational.

Wednesday July 31, 2024



One of the benefits of being an Australian is having access to a superb health system. Every two years the Department of Health send all Australians over the age of 50 a free bowel screening test to check for the early signs of bowel cancer. Bowel cancer is one of the biggest killers in Australia and as a consequence, this screening program has been implemented. How many other countries have a similar program? Sadly, and somewhat foolishly, many people disregard the screening test and throw it out!
I completed my second sample this morning and will post it to Sonic Healthcare today.

On the envelope reads;
WHAT'S IN HERE COULD SAVE YOUR LIFE - AND IT'S FREE AND EASY TO DO

Just another reason why Australia is the lucky country.

There have been whispers that Albo migh call an election for this December. This might be the case as the AEC have contacted Janny and me for expressions of interest to participate in the next federal election.

Janny and I will attend our first shareholder meeting this evening at ZINC in Federation Square. It is something I have always wanted to do and as retiree's, we can now make it happen. We have held shares in WH Soul Pattinson for many years.
This meeting was catered for and upon arrival we were greeted with hours douvres and red and white wine. I recognised Chairman Robert Millner milling around the crowd, together with Alan Kohler, the ABC's financial commentator, who chaired the meeting.
I just had this feeling that after all those years of working and squirilling away money in our superannuation had come to this - the opportunity to relax, have a lovely glass of shiraz and enjoy the spoils of our investment journey. SoulPatts have been a good investment choice, with strong capital growth and regular dividend payments.
Purchased in 2016 for $15.70 – now $34.53.

Friday August 2, 2024

Janny and I made the call to move away from Telstra to Optus, in an affort to reduce our telco costs. A new modem will arrive next week. I hope this is a good decision.

Saturday August 3, 2024

Welcome to the Club, Pendles.
Pity Carlton couldn't spoil the party for his 400th.

Monday August 5, 2024

"Rock music is more than a genre, it's an attitude, a spirit of rebellion that transcends time and space, a hard hitting commentary of modern youth culture wrapped in irresistable guitar riffs and clever lyrics".

Tuesday August 6, 2024

"Living on Earth may be expensive
but it does include an annual free trip around the Sun"

ASX plunges to worst day since 2020 on US fears

$100bn gone in a day

BLOOD ON THE FLOOR

On Tuesday July 16, our sharemarket hit record highs of 8000+ points, however yesterday it plunged down to 7649.6 points, down 3.7%. It's our worst session in four years and is on the back of recession fears in the US.
The carnage was worse in Japan, with their NIKKEI dropping a staggering 12.4%.
The US have been spooked by worse than expected unemployment figures, sparking concerns that the world's largest economy is not as strong as previously thought.

Friday August 9, 2024

Australia has 18 gold medals thus far in the Paris 2024 Olympics. China has 29. To put this in context, we have won gold for every 1.24 million citizens, whereas China's gold medals have come for every 56 million citizens.
Per capita, Australia, with a population of 26 million, is head and shoulders above all countries in these Olympics.

A Friday prophecy

I am now going to make a startling prediction – Carlton will win the 2024 premiership. We will embark on a 7 game winning streak and claim this year's flag. Nothing wrong with being optimistic, hopeful, positive and bright.

Sunday August 8, 2024

A Sunday prophecy

It is my sad opinion that AFL footy, and other physical contact sports, will no longer exist in around 30 years from now. Head knocks, concussion, early onset dementia, alzheimer's and chronic traumatic encephalopathy (CTE) are all conspiring to shut the game down. I believe insurance companies will no longer cover sports from head impact injuries and with the growing amount of claims against the AFL, and now local footy clubs, a perfect storm of matters is brewing that will ultimately see the games demise. Mum's and Dad's will also shy away from allowing their kids to participate, in the unlikely event that local clubs still exist. We shall enjoy and celebrate our great game while we can, because I truly believe it is on borrowed time.

Our greatest gold medal tally at the Olympics, with 18 gold.
Can you spot the duck?

Sunday August 11, 2024

Carlton played Hawthorn at the MCG today. The Blues were handing out "bobble heads" of Adam Saad and Ang Christou, which Jeff and I gladfully claimed. There was plenty of enthusiam and expectation about the game, coupled with a great vibe and the weather can best be described as a beautiful sunny, warm day. The game started at 1.10pm and it all went downhill from there, with Hawthorn flogging us by 72 points and just like that – WOOF! – we tumbled out of the eight.

Monday August 12, 2024

Janny and I rode our tandem bike to Princes Park to buy some Carlton items for Jeff. We saw club historian Tony DeBolfo in the Café 1864.
We then rode to Southbank and saw Carlton great Ken Hunter, whom we had a chat with. A true gentleman.

Saturday August 17, 2024

Apparently there is a clause in the media rights contract with Foxtel and Network Seven. It centres around the recruitment of on-air talent. Most of the media knew nothing about what's called a "social inclusion" clause and it's unclear for how long it has been there.

So, here we go, not content with embracing every woke cause from the Voice to welcome to country and renaming their teams with Indigenous names that make no sense to anyone, the AFL Commission now wants a say on who commentates the game.
Not only want a say, it's a contractual clause. They want diversity in commentary.

Well, at least big Rexy was on the right track, bringing some operatic exuberance and inclusion to the commentary box.

The Blues have been decimated with injuries and travel to Perth for a big clash with the Eagles at 4.30pm tomorrow.

Sunday August 17, 2024

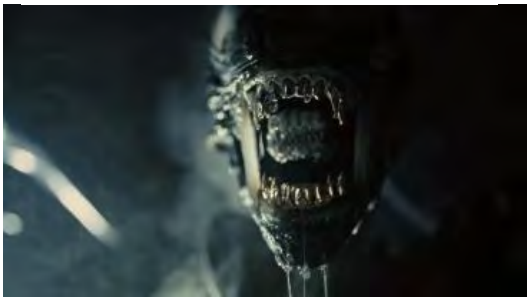
Janny and I travelled to the Camberwell Market today and I purchased the Mike Oldfield LP TUBULAR BELLS, an iconic album that's close to my heart. Great memories of 1974. The following is printed on the back of the album cover;

"This stereo record cannot be played on old tin boxes no matter what they are fitted with. If you are in possession of such equipment, please hand it in to the nearest police station".

Following our market visit we walked over to the Rivoli Cinema to see the much anticipated ALIEN ROMULUS. Since 1979 I have been engrossed in this movie franchise, with ALIENS being my favourite. From my perspective, this movie represents a return to the core ALIEN terror genus that has been missing for a while. A great movie.

"I can't lie to you about your chances.....but you have my sympathies".

Science Officer Ash



★★★★

A good day overall with Carlton flogging a hapless West Coast in Perth (a Cripps masterclass) and the joy of watching Sam Pang again nail the MC gig at the Logies.

Monday August 19, 2024

On Monday May 20, Janny and I attended a morning tea function at Mannacare to celebrate National Volunteer Week. I asked Normin to forward to us the group photo and it arrived this morning.
We are pictured with a fellow volunteer, the local council member and Normin, our volunteer coordinator.

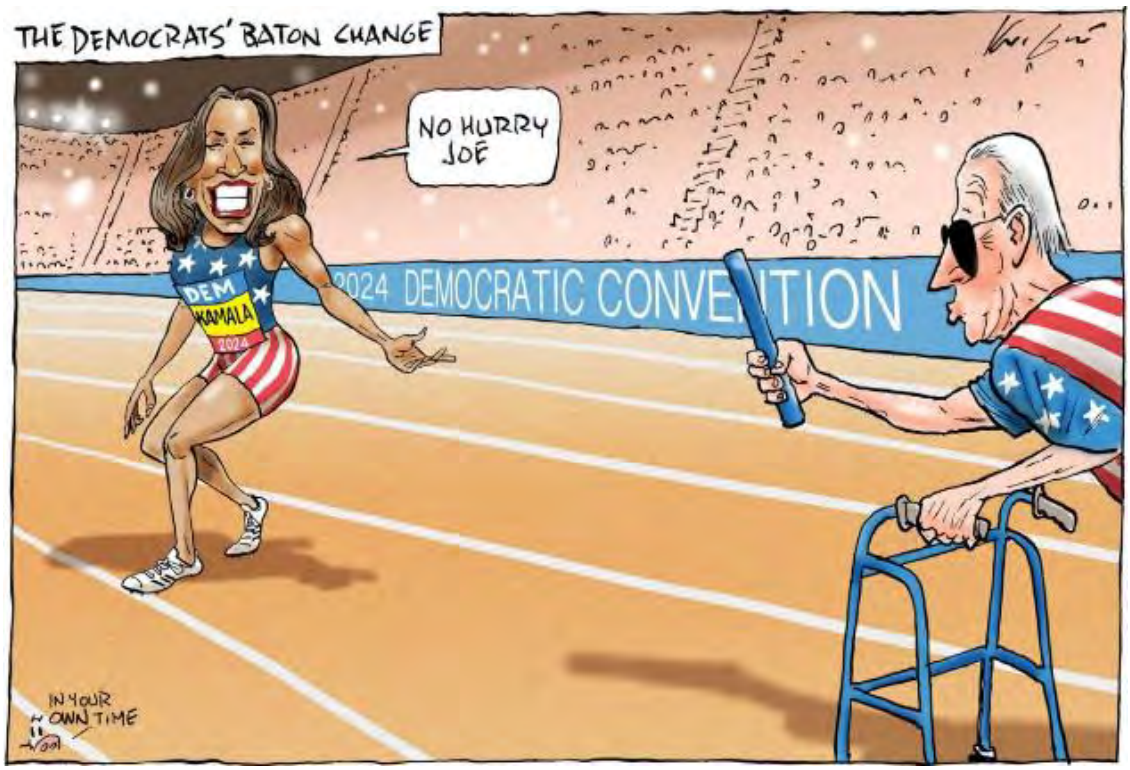
The theme of National Volunteer Week 2024 is;

Something for Everyone

Wednesday August 21, 2024

"Service to others is the rent you pay for your room here on Earth"

Muhammad Ali



Kamala, they're all yours.
Emotional Biden passes the baton to Harris.

Monday August 26, 2024

Today Janny and I will confirm our next big holiday journey, to Egypt for the Pharaohs and Pyramids 12 day cruise, scheduled for October, 2025.

VIKING

Imagine the wisdom and skill of the Egyptians dating back thousands of years. Hieroglyphics send us a 5,000 year old postcard. The pyramids and the Great Sphinx, a wealth of statues, sculptures, obelisks and murals still standing, mystifying the modern-day with their unique magnificence.

Blues lose, but win too

The Blues have qualified for this years finals after Port Adelaide got us out of jail by defeating Fremantle at Optus Stadium in Perth in the final game of this year's home and away season. Some three hours earlier St Kilda pulled off a nail biting win againt us by two points and we then watched in nervous anticipation to see whether Port could roll the Dockers.
They did and the Blues scraped in to the final eight. Thank you Port. Carlton now travel to Brisbane in a fortnight to face the Lions in an Elimination Final.

We have a pulse…
Port Adelaide Power successfully resuscitate Carlton's season.

Wednesday August 28, 2024

Carlton coach Michael Voss has been hailed a "true blue hero" after stopping an alleged car thief.

You just can't keep the Blues out of the news.

Two days after the Blues scraped into the finals, Voss was waiting for his morning coffee at the Barton Milk Bar in Hawthorn when two hoons crashed a stolen luxury Mercedes opposite the café.
The three time premiership captain rolled back the years with a chase down tackle on one of the hoons, a 16 year old boy, pinning him down until the police arrived.
Officers made a stark discovery of a large knife stashed in the boy's trousers.

Vossy – a super hero on and off the field.

Friday August 30, 2024

"Writing can be a means of self-understanding and healing".

Today I loaded up the Santa Fe with lots of cleaning and painting accessories to help us with the refurbishment of our Ashley Street investment property. The tenant will be vacating the property today and we need the unit in pristine condition for sale.

Saturday August 31, 2024

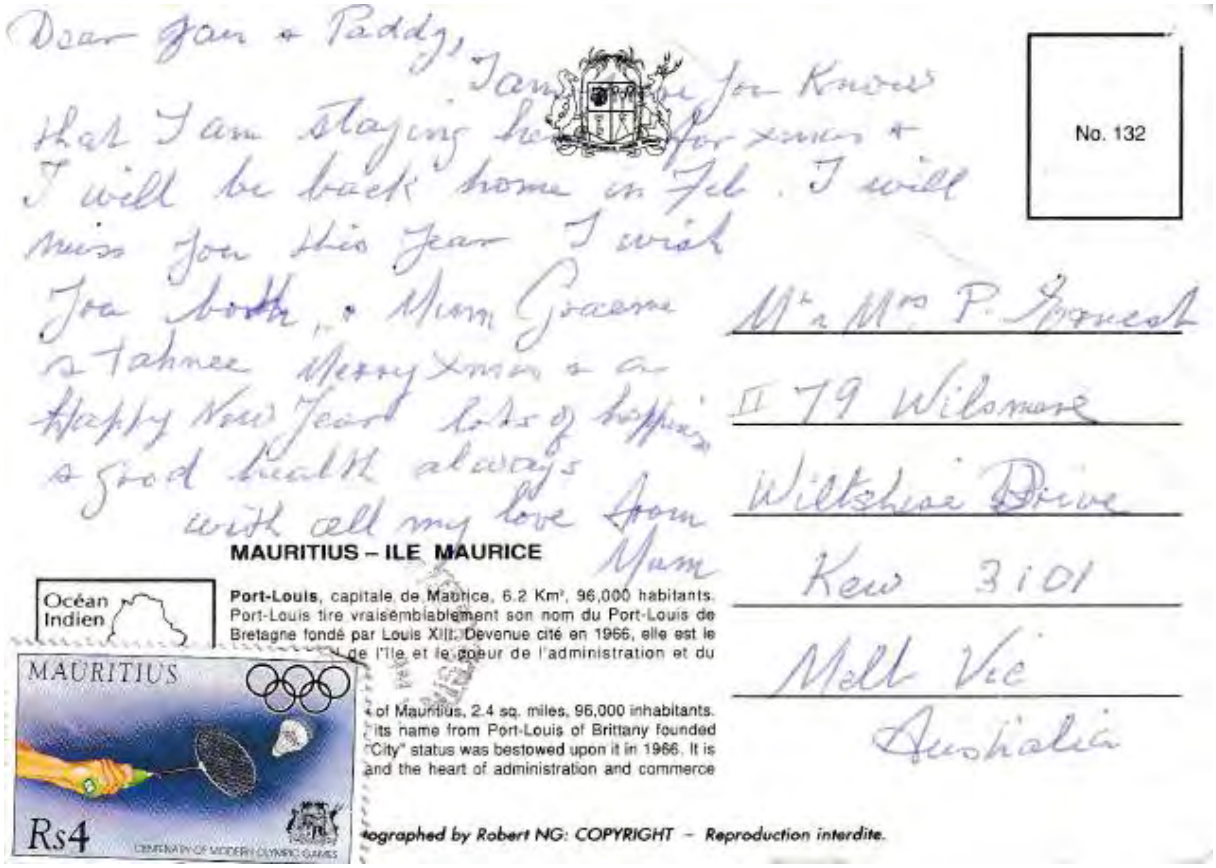
Spring bonanza. More homes are for sale in Melbourne now than any other time since 2018 as investors flee the market. The big sell-off is fuelled bt landlords abandoning investment properties in the face of state government taxes and regulations. Our investment property in Resevoir is now vacant and Janny and I shall commence cleaning, painting and re-carpeting so as to prepare it for sale.

Sunday September 1, 2024

Today is the first day of spring. I could smell the jasmine as I walked to get the Sunday paper this morning.

Librarians to quiz kids on gender. Children as young as five will be asked if they identify as a she, he or they as part of new tax-payer funded guidelines rolled out to public libraries across the state.
Staff and being told to ask children what their preferred pronouns are, to avoid "gender language" and to offer pronoun badges, pins or lanyards as part of a new government-funded Rainbow Toolkit.
Staff at public libraries have been given new guidelines on how to be LGBTQIA+ friendly.

Monday September 2, 2024



Stumbled upon this postcard while rummaging through my bedside drawer. Mum sent this to us while she was in Mauritius, advising that she was extending her stay. Not too sure what year, perhaps the mid 1990's. It was quite heartwarming to read Mum's hand writing. I miss her dearly.

Sunday September 8, 2024

It's been a big week for Janny and me…. We embarked on a cleaning, painting and refurbishment program for our rental property in Ashley Street, Reservoir, as we prepare it for sale. Unfortunately all the painting has taken a terrible toll on my right shoulder. It is causing me untold pain and I now have it in a sling. Luckily we had great support from Kath and Jeff yesterday, who helped with the final coat of paint, attached a new toilet roll holder, cut up the yukka's, Gerni'd the back yard and garage and sanded and stained the front step. We are grateful for their help. The carpet will be laid on Wednesday and on Thursday the marketing campaign will commence in earnest. A big thank you to Janny and her hard work throughout the week. I now must focus on getting my shoulder fixed, especially managing the pain.

Speaking of pain, the Brisbane v Carlton elimination final was, in the words of my brother Jeff, "a train wreck". At the 24 minute mark of the second quarter Brisbane were 9.6.60 and Carlton were zero, zilch, nishto, nothing! We hadn't registered on the scoreboard! We had a nice comeback in the third quarter but it was too little too late, with Brisbane running out victors by 28 points. Mothballs for 2024.

In my opinion Carlton has four main deficiencies – firstly, our skills are not at a level that will trouble the top teams. Our foot skills are terrible, especially trying to hit a target in the forward line. Secondly, our decision making is poor as we often handball to a player who is not positioned well and is subsequently tackled or dispossesed. Thirdly, we don't have the small forwards needed to kick winning scores and finally, our bottom six players are well below what is required to take the next step. I watched the Sydney and GWS qualifying final yesterday, and I couldn't help but think how much our game style is lacking compared to these impressive teams. They are strong in all the aspects I have listed above and are the antithesis of Carlton.

Monday September 9, 2024

Visited Dr. Schulberg to assess my painful shoulder. He prescribed the following medication for the pain;
PANAFCORTELONE 25mg anti-inflammatory to reduce inflammation.
COMFAROL FORTE 30mg – paracetamol for the pain.

I then attended FMIG for scans. The ultrasound operator suggested to me that I have bursitis in the shoulder. I believe it was caused by painting the back fence…see photo above.

Melbourne – the protest capital of Australia….possibly the world!
Don't these jokers have a job?

Tuesday September 10, 2024

We received an email from Carlton President Luke Sayers – I found his following words intreresting as we reflect on a sub par year;

"Eyes may glaze over when you see the word 'consistency' – people may find it dull, boring, cliché.
But it matters. Consistency matters.
And for far too long this club has not paid it the respect it deserves.

That is why, when you walk into our training field at IKON Park, you will see 16 flags hanging from the rafters – yet only one of them, just one, has an AFL logo on it.
What more motivation do we need than that?"

Wednesday September 11, 2024

This morning Janny and I met the carpet layer at Ashley Street. While he laid the carpet, we cleaned the windows and steam mopped the floors. The unit is now ready to be put on the market. It looks quite impressive and we are proud of our efforts as we reflect on how it appeared eight days ago. Tomorrow the marketing campaign kicks off and we will meet Ian Stewart and Jim Dimitropolous at the unit. I am hoping they will be impressed with its appearance.

. . . .

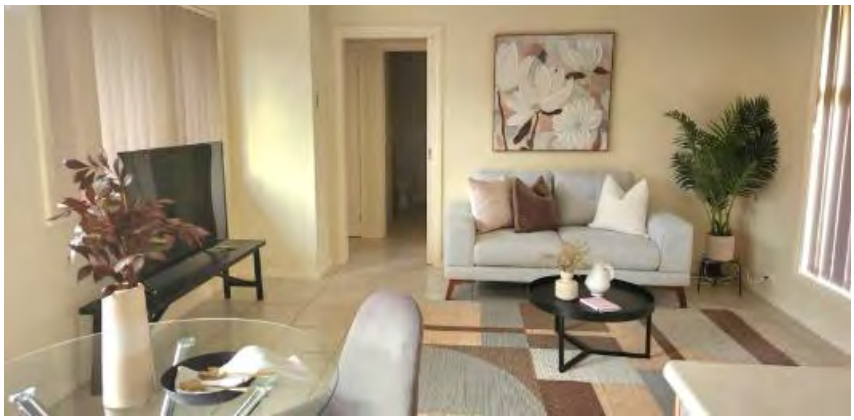
Thursday September 12, 2024

Indeed Ian and Jim were very impressed with the appearance of our unit. We agreed to arrange for property styling to enhance the appeal of the unit.

Selling agent for our Reservoir property

Sunday September 15, 2024

We had our Reservoir unit stylised as we believed it would maximise its sales potential. When considering styling, Janny and I didn't want any regrets about maximising our opportunities to get the best result possible. At least we can say we left no stone unturned.



Sunday September 15, 2024

Setting the scene….we hope. The following article was observed in the Sunday Herald Sun today in the property section.

An oasis of dreams

Villa sells for $50K over hopes

A cosy Coburg villa sold for more than $50,000 above the reserve price at auction on Saturday.

The two-bedroom dwelling, at 4/58 Munro St, was offloaded for $757,000 after having $620,000-$680,000 price hopes.

Two bidders went head-to-head for the property, with offers starting at $650,000.

Bids rose between the two vying groups in $10,000, $5000 and even $1000 instalments until the villa was sold. The reserve price was $700,000.

"In the north, units, if they're close to public transport and the shops and have some sort of renovation, they're still performing really, really well," Mr Calik-Houston said.

"Anything that doesn't have that accessibility isn't doing as well."

Similiarities to our Reservoir property;
Price range: $540,000 – $570,000
Reserve: $600,000?
Achieving $650,000 would be fantastic. Is it possible?...time will tell.
Also noted in the same article;
"In the north, **units**, if they're **close to public transport and the shops** and have some sort of **renovation**, they're still performing really, really well".
Our Reservoir property ticks all the boxes.

Friday September 19, 2024

I received this email today from Dr. Nicolette Snowden;

Patrick Ernest interviewed by Nicolette Snowden for the Australian responses to COVID-19 oral history project.

Hello Patrick……Happy Friday.

I was looking through the National Library archives today for a different research project I'm working on, and can you imagine how delighted I was when I found that your interview is now online!

I'm not sure if the NLA has sent you the link, in case they haven't, here's the link: https://nla.gov.au/nla.obj-3334513396/listen.

I hope you are well?

Best wishes
Nicolette

2/29-31 Ashley Street, Reservoir

Chic, Refined, and Perfectly Positioned

Nestled within a modern and meticulously maintained complex, this single-level unit offers an exceptional low-maintenance lifestyle defined by quality, style, and convenience. Ideal for first-time buyers, savvy investors, and downsizers, this residence promises comfort and ease at every turn. Step inside to discover a thoughtfully designed interior boasting two spacious double bedrooms with built-in robes and a sleek, contemporary central bathroom. The open-plan living and dining area flows seamlessly into a well-appointed kitchen featuring stainless steel appliances, including a gas cooktop, perfect for effortless cooking and entertaining. Additional highlights include ducted heating, split system cooling for year-round comfort, and a European laundry for added convenience. The generous private courtyard, complete with an undercover entertaining area and storage shed, provides an ideal space for outdoor relaxation or hosting guests. Completing the package is a secure lock-up garage, adding extra convenience and peace of mind. Perfectly positioned, this property is within walking distance of Reservoir train station and bus services, the vibrant Edwardes Street and High Street shopping and dining precincts, scenic Edwardes Lake, walking tracks, and popular local schools. This is truly a rare find that combines lifestyle, location, and low-maintenance living all in one!

Wednesday September 18, 2024

Today Janny and I headed into LifeBlood in the city for donations. Our bus service terminated at the start of Lygon Street so we then had to walk the rest of the way to the State Library. The reason we were bumped - CMFEU strike action outside Trades Hall. We had to snake our way through this lot.
Union members were handing out flyers with the following headlines;

SEND THE ADMINISTRATORS PACKING!

Shut down all construction sites!

CFMEU members: It's not over yet

Monday September 23, 2024

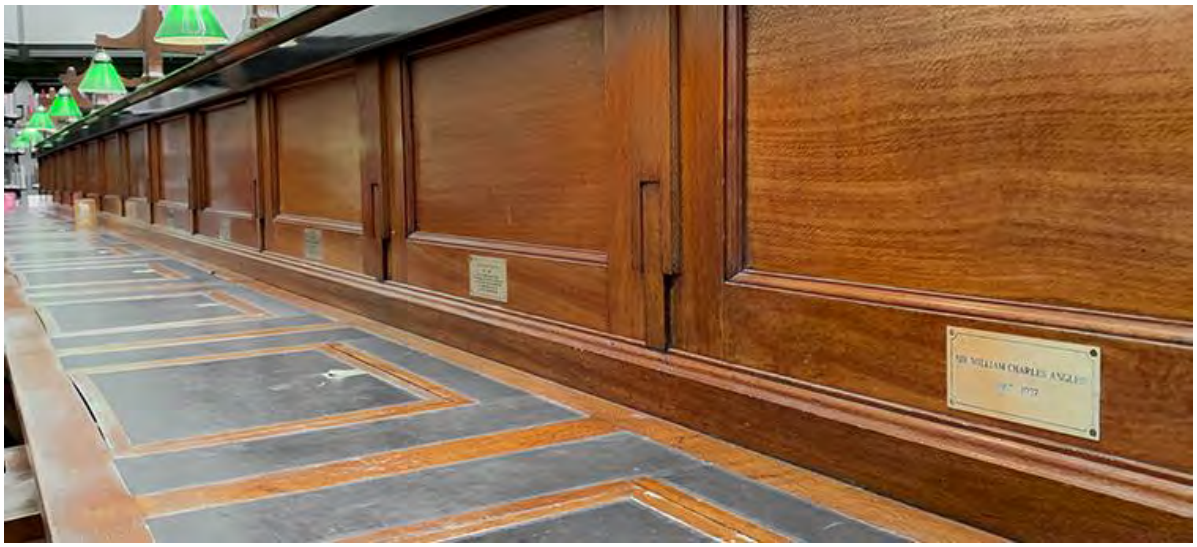
A Monday reflection……

Being retirees, Janny and I have pondered what our legacy will be. Burial versus cremation and what sort of memorial would we establish? We are now considering a different approach. Our methodology wil be to make a donation to the State Library of Victoria's bronze plaque program in the La Trobe Reading Room (under The Dome).

Patrick & Janette
ERNEST

Happiness is finding joy and amazement in small and insignificant things that most people take for granted.

RICK NEST



This would allow us to celebrate a significant event in world history, that being the union of Patrick & Janette Ernest and to express our appreciation towards what we see as the finest public space in Melbourne.
When you walk through the State Library of Victoria, you can't help but feel a sense of being, endeavour, hope, curiosity, care, enthusiasm, history, academia, opportunity, friendliness and optimism, together with everything that is great about being a Victorian and Melbournian. Not sure these sentiments are conspicuously apparent at a cemetery, graveyard or mausoleum. We need to also acknowledge that we do not have children and that that our family cohort have better things to do than visit us post mortem.
One could ask "Is there a better place with which to attach a legacy plaque?" Certainly, from our point of view, not the alternative and more conventional path chosen by most.

. . . .

Tuesday September 24, 2024

A jaw dropping season

Last night Paddy Crippps was awarded his second Browlow Medal. Amazingly, he polled 45 votes, thus obliterating a 100 year old record! The record was 36 votes. He polled 26 more votes than the fancied Marcus Bontempelli! He was voted best afield in 12 games! Clearly he is a vote magnet. Nick Daicos polled 38 votes.

Now the race is on – can Crippa or Lachie Neale become triple Brownlow Medallists? Imagine, for a moment, that next year they tie for the Brownlow and both are elevated to that rare space.

But 45 votes….seriously? I reckon the umpires suffer from a condition I have come to label as the "halo effect". This involves certain players being Brownlow vote magnets – players such as Crippa, Lachie Neale, Chris Judd, Robert Harvey, Nat Fyffe and so on. Once you get your first medal, the floodgates open for you. Nick Daicos will benefit from the halo effect in years to come. Crippa benefited from the halo effect in the extreme, The umpires virtually assume he deserved votes when in fact other players, especially non midfielders, are more deserving. Tom DeKoning and Jacob Weitering spring to mind. But I would never begrudge Crippa of his second medal – he is a true champion.

Imagine if Kouta was a Brownlow Medallist

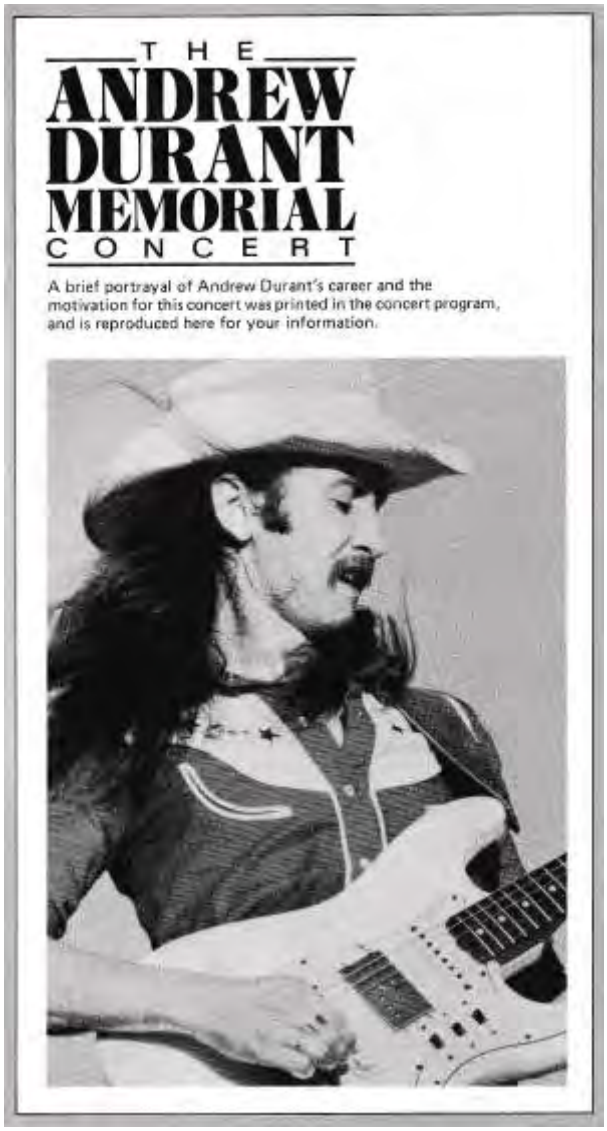
A Tuesday contemplation….

Some have articulated that one of the secrets to happiness is being or having a grateful attitude towards your lot in life. I think that this is part of the reason why I am so happy at the moment, coupled with having a very joyful marriage. More than this I have endeavoured to dig a little deeper in trying to ascertain the origins of my happiness. I have concluded the following;

The "Goldilocks Zone"
I truly believe that a chosen few, born between 1946 to 1964, have been gifted a birthrite of immense opportunity and wonderment. A brief period that is unprecedented in world history, and the likes of which will never be repeated. I call it the "Goldilocks Zone" – a brief microcosm in time whereby those born in this period, commonly referred to as Baby Boomers, were earmarked as the "chosen few". An eighteen year sliver of time within a 10-billion-year existensial Earth timeframe. Those before us and to follow us have missed out. So, what is so special about this period? I dedicated a chapter in my autobiography to the importance of being a baby boomer. This period gifted us with great opportunity and growth. Busineses were booming, particularly in manufacturing and engineering. Even a bum like me could establish a long and successful career on the back of an engineering apprenticeship. Early baby boomers were provided with free university education. Culturally, we will never be exposed to the delights of our politically incorrect upbringing – not a woke politically correct policeman in sight. TV shows like the Benny Hill Show, the Paul Hogan show and Love Thy Neighbour et al kept us entertained. Will future generations produce another Elvis, The Beatles, The Rolling Stones, Led Zeppelin and the vast rich vein of 1970's pop music? I feel that these musicians mined the musical landscape and tapped into the creative tuneful riches which they then shared with us music lovers, so that we could all feast on their success. As with all things, eventually all those riches will run out and I believe that these mines have now been stripped of their riches and only slim pickings remain. We were there when this rich vein of music was released – a lot of it on vinyl accompanied by the most splendid album cover artwork.
Not to mention watching footy at suburban grounds, standing on the terraces and the six VFL games all starting at 2.10pm every Saturday afternoon. It was so important that I embraced these aspects of life in the goldilocks zone, as they have now become important pillars in my happy retirement. As a reflective retired baby boomer, I feel extremely grateful for being born and blessed in this "goldilocks zone".

Tuesday September 24, 2024

Janny today stumbled on this photo taken in Bali recently on a Ubud bike ride. When we stopped for a break our guide showed us a multitude of giant Golden Orb spiders. He placed one on Janny's helmet strap. Janny's always up for a bit of adventure and was happy to accommodate the big arachnid.
I really love this photo of Janny.
As for me with the the great beast…..not so much.


THE
ANDREW DURANT MEMORIAL
CONCERT

A brief portrayal of Andrew Durant's career and the motivation for this concert was printed in the concert program, and is reproduced here for your information.

Wednesday September 25, 2024

This is what gives me great joy as I reconnect with my LP records. I purchased this double live album at the Box Hill Record Fair back in May and upon playing it today, I was pleasently surprised to find within the album sleeve a flyer outlining a portrayal of Andrew Durant's career. He wrote most of the songs on the album and was a very talented singer, guitarist and songwriter.
Sadly he died of cancer (melanoma) at age 25 on May 6, 1980.
Andrew was a member of one of my favorite bands in the 1970's – STARS. They released many great songs, including Last of the Riverboats, Iceman, Back Again and my favorite, Mighty Rock. They also did a mean version of Joe Walsh's Rocky Mountain Way. Notable musicians on the album include Jimmy Barnes, Renee Geyer, Richard Clapton and Brod Smith. A sensationally moving album.
Concert recorded live at the Palais Theatre – 19 August, 1980.

Thursday September 26, 2024

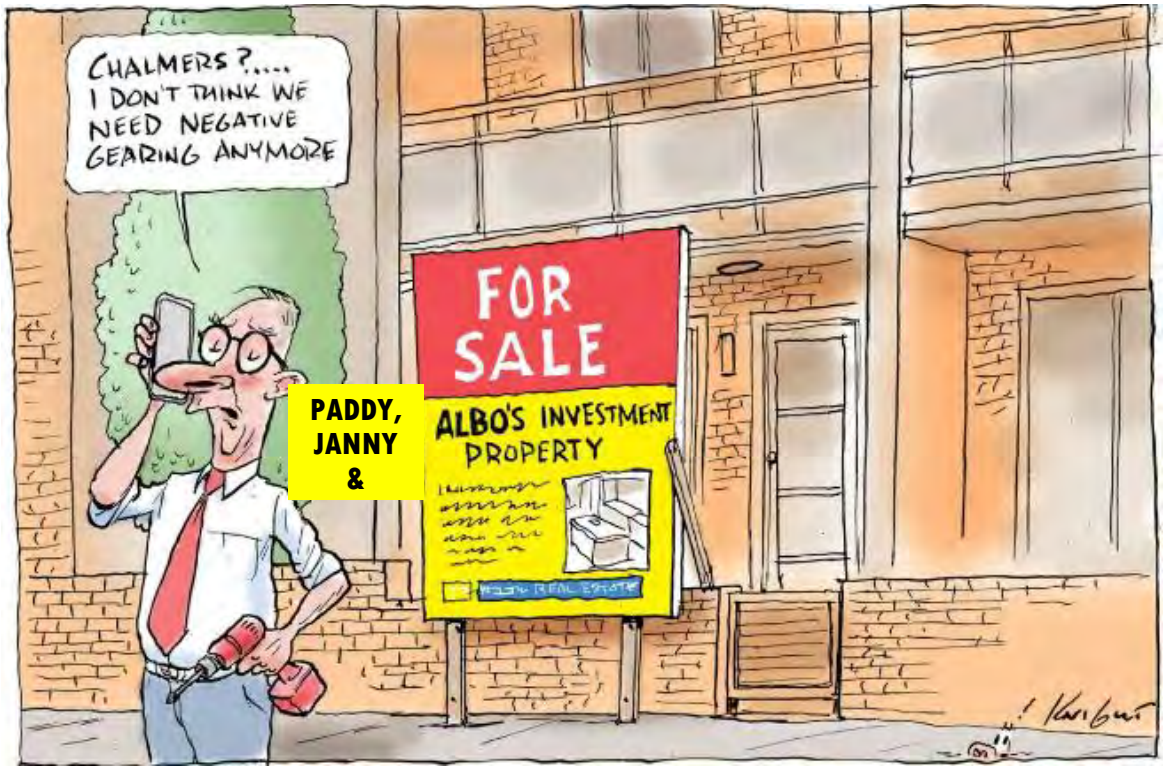
The Albanese government is risking electoral backlash if it pursues the axing or significant winding back of negative gearing and capital gains tax concessions for property investors.
Despite just last week claiming negative gearing changes were not part of the government's agenda, Prime Minister Albanese was yesterday forced to leave the door open to moving the goalposts on property investing.

Negative move on aspiration

Albo is playing with fire

IT'S LABOR'S TAX

Greens, teals to push tax reforms



Janny and I concur, but please steer clear of capital gains tax concessions.

L I O N K I N G S

Saturday September 28, 2024

Grand Final Day
Sydney Swans v Brisbane Lions
The game started well but in the second quarter, the Lions kicked six unanswered goals and from that point were never headed, running out winners by sixty points.
Brisbane have a great team with a lot of quality playes to return to their list. Could be the start of a dynasty.

Tuesday October 1, 2024

While scrolling through and sorting my photo's I stumbled upon this scan, which was a postcard within the Rose Tattoo self titled album released in 1978. It is also the main gatefold photo within the album. This photo, which both Jeff and I love, typifies the raw energy and pub rock ideology of a genuine Aussie hard rock outfit. Back then we were young, working class and eager to lap up all that these hard rock outfits could provide. The "Tatts" were just getting started and this would be the beginning of a long and storied career for Gary. The record that I have was Uncle Dave's, which he gave me when we were helping get his house ready for sale. Not sure what he would have made of "Butcher and Fast Eddy". Just love Gary's air guitar and Pete Wells providing that raw slide guitar riff, synonymous with the Rose Tattoo sound.

Nice boys... don't play rock and roll!
Rose Tattoo circa 1978.

Thursday October 3, 2024

This week 50 years ago a music show on the ABC commenced called COUNTDOWN. Although the musical content was classical pop, it still remains a pivotal program during my formative years. Ian "Molly" Meldrum, Gavin Wood and a plethora of Aussie and overseas acts would host the program. Performances from AC/DC, Dragon, Rose Tattoo, John Paul Young, Sherbet, Marcia Hines, Renee Geyer, Ted Mulry Gang, Hush, Skyhooks, Split Enz, Flowers, Supernaut and others are all etched in my mind. Poor old Molly is struggling with ill health and could not attend a recent gathering to commemorate the occasion. Gavin Wood was the voice of Countdown and stepped in to Molly's role.
Strewth - you know your'e getting old when you start reflecting on anniversaries commencing 50 years ago.

Presently I am battling a debilitating bout of diverticulitis. I have terrible stomach pains and as such on I am on a water/liquid diet.....yum. I will be visiting Dr. Ed Shelton at YARRA GASTROENTEROLOGY in Hawthorn to hopefully help me recover from this disorder.

Saturday October 5, 2024

We spent a lovely evening at Jeff's for dinner with Helen, Nevil and Kath. It was also an opportune time for a book launch. I brought with me Helen's autobiography "NAVIGATING LIFE", spledidly printed and bound by Whites Law Bindery. I have been helping Helen with her book for the last seven months and it is great that this project is now complete. Helen enthusiastically embraced writing her autobiography and provided me with a lot of material about her journey and family history. When requested to reflect on certain aspects of her life journey, she then comprehensively delivered her thoughts which expanded the context of her life. The end result is a book of some 180 pages and around 38,000 words.

Monday October 7, 2024

Last night Paddy Cripps was awarded a record equalling fifth John Nicholls best and fairest trophy, equalling John Nicholls' record.
He was also given the number one ranking in Robbo's much anticipated Top 50 players of 2024.
To quote Robbo;
"There's a few bulls in the AFL paddock, but he is the big kahuna.
He has skill, but it goes to show that will power can be a players best atribute".

Its been a big year for our inspirational captain.

Today I am having a CT chest scan, to monitor a shadow on my lung. The technical term for the shadow is an app. 0.8cm right lower lobe subpleural pulmonary nodule. If it gets bigger, I may have cause to become very nervous.

Monday October 7, 2024

Today marks twelve months since Hamas attacked Israel. Gaza has been absolutely hammered and now Israel is turning its focus on Lebanon and Hezbolah terrorists. Iran is next.

Tuesday October 8, 2024

I visited Dr. Schulberger to discuss my routine CT chest scan.
The good news – the right lower lobe subpleural pulmonary nodule remains stable.
Of concern……"Extensive calcified pleural plaques are noted . The apical aspect of both upper lobes consistent with previous asbestos exposure. Ill-defined groundglass lung opacity is noted at the posterior lateral apical aspect of the right upper lobe consistent with alveolitis.
Review by a respiratory specialist with view to further workup and management is recommended".
Alveolitis is inflammation of the lungs alveoli often triggered by alegens or irritants and is an early sign of interstital lung disease. Causes could be infection, environmental exposures, autoimmune disorders or something of unknown origin.

I will arrange an appointment with respiratory specialist Dr. Michael Sutherland at Epworth Hospital.

Wednesday October 10, 2024

Our investment property in Reservoir sold prior to auction today. Settlement will take place on December 18. Now for St Kilda.

Friday October 11, 2024

At least, when the planet has fried, or civilisation has been washed away by
floods and storms, when nations have been wiped off the map in
endless cycles of righteous retaliation, when their hapless,
homeless survivors fear life more than death we can proudly say;
we stayed silent for social cohesion

Sunday October 13, 2024

Jeff came over to our home today to help me wall mount our new clothes dryer. All was going well until Jeff drilled the first bracket hole mount. The drill hit the hot water pipe behind the wall. There was no stud behind. We incorrectly assumed that the old mounting brackets were fitted to vertical studs, when in fact they were fastened to a horizoantal noggin. I heard Jeff shout out "Oh no". I rushed up to see what was wrong, only to be greeted with water gushing out of the wall. I then ran to end of our block, up the stairs and eventually found the small entry gate into the building wing roof cavity to turn off the water. Thank God it wasn't padlocked!
I then went and saw neighbour Saied across the way from our home and asked for his help. He came over, assessed the situation, called one of his plumber colleagues and, luckliy for us, was able to come over and repair the leak. Jeff and I then prepared a batten by fasteneing the brackets to it and Saied helped us attach the batten to the wall. Jeff and I then hooked the dryer onto the mounting brackets. We were so lucky to be able to have Saied,

his plumber mate and a solid batten with which to mount the dryer. What a day and what a recovery from what was a dire situation!

Monday October 14, 2024

Today Janny and me will be meeting Kate from Metropole at our St Kilda property to receive the keys and carry out a final inspection.
We are hopeful of a good return on this property as its location is ideal and has a high "walkability" rating. It is located in a quiet cul de sac between Fitzroy Street and Ackland Street and is an easy stroll to St Kilda beach, Luna Park and The Palais Theatre.

THE GUILTY PARTY
These jokers have made it the responsibility of property investors to pay back all the billions in wasted and torched taxpayer revenue.

We renewed our Carlton Football Club membership for 2025 and received an acknowledgement email thanking us for re-committing for next year.
STRONGER TOGETHER

Tuesday October 15, 2024

I attended a job interview for a volunteer position of English Tutor - Adult Literacy at Carringbush Adult Education in Church Street Richmond.

Wednesday October 16, 2024

HELEN'S AUTOBIOGRAPHY ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Helen was kind enough to acknowledge my efforts and input towards her autobiography NAVIGATING LIFE. I felt flattered and honoured that Helen inserted such appreciation of my efforts. It is always immensely satisfying to be able to assist with family life stories.

"I would like to thank Patrick Ernest, our cousin, for his assistance and encouragement in writing this book. I would not have had the confidence to start such a project without his support.
By writing this book and the questions that Pat has asked has led me down a path of "reliving some amazing memories" from my childhood that I discovered in undertaking the research. I have always loved history and Patrick's encouragement has helped me gain my passion back. With Pat challenging me and his continued support this book would not have happened. Thank you".

Music is memory. Hearing a song can take you to a place, a feeling, a moment. Guided by one of Australia's most charming and experienced interviwers Zan Rowe, guests reveal a side to themselves you've never seen before.

Take 5 with Zan Rowe is another ABC gem of a program. I often think that if I were a guest on the program, what five songs would I put forward and in particular, how would I articulate how and why these songs have impacted me. The following are my thoughts;

1 **Tom Jones – What's New Pussycat**

No song captures my very early childhood like this Tom Jones classic. Written by Burt Bacharach, it was released in 1965 and was the first song that was imprinted in my memory as a three year old, together with Nancy Sinatra's "These Boots Are Made For Walking". I guess this song kick started my love affair with music when music was in the air.

2 **The Beatles – I Want You (She's So Heavy)**

In 1969 I was a seven year old and music was starting to capture my soul. My older brothers, Johnny and Stewart, were into The Beatles and specifically the White Album and Abbey Road LP's. Amongst the many brilliant songs released on these two masterpiece albums was the hauntingly brilliant John Lennon piece "I Want You" (She's So Heavy) – the last song on side one of Abbey Road. The song has two different guitar riffs played in unison and the pace of the song subtly and gloriously ebbs and flows. It was these characteristics that impacted a niaive seven year old and to this day this song continues to move me.

3 **Led Zeppelin – Whole Lotta Love**

In 1974 and as a twelve year old I heard the song "Whole Lotta Love", the opening salvo on the Led Zeppelin II LP. The song's full throttle riff was thrilling and unforgettable. It had a profound affect on me, to the point where I became essentailly a devotee of hard rock – of aggressive vocals, distorted and riff heavy electric guitars, thumping drums and anthemic choruses. From that point I couldn't get enough of Black Sabbath, Deep Purple, Bad Company and of course Led Zeppelin. A pivotal point in my musical appreciation journey.

4 **Dream Theater – Take Away My Pain**

In 1992 I was introduced to US heavy/progressive rock band Dream Theater. At his particular time in my musical appreciation journey I was somewhat jaded as not a lot had been forthcoming from the heavy rock fraternity over the previous decade. Dream Theater provided a ray of sunshine and restored my faith in the genre. Their 1992 album "Images and Words" providing the prospect of hope for the future. The "Falling Into Infinity" album in 1997 was yet another excellent album and track 8 is a quite moving piece dealing with end of life matters, and in particular made me reflect on the the passing of my father.

5 **The Living End – The Room**

I have always felt a genuine excitement when great Australian bands come along. The Living End had already released two quality albums by the time they released "Modern Artillery" in 2003. The final song – The Room – is in my opinion one of the greatest Australian recordings ever. This song takes you to so many different musical landscapes, rarely stopping in a certain melody and transports you deep into the many various stages of life. It is the closest thing to a true rock epic. Outstanding.
I rate The Living End as Australia's premier rock band.

Saturday October 19, 2024

I read with interest Steve Price's article with the heading "Radio needs shake-up". His comments regarding 3AW's breakfast program was quite interesting;

"The legendaty Ross Stevenson, who can quite rightly claim the the title of the most successful radio broadcaster in the history of Melbourne – bar none – holds the success of AW in his hand.
His breakfast ratings are the highest in Australia and the format keeps being refreshened up and is unique in that it doesn't touch politics at all or cover controversial issues.
Co-host Russell Howcroft, who took over from John Burns, seems like a jolly bloke, but he adds little to the content. His giggling at Ross's remarks is

annoying beyond belief and he sounds like a priveledged Melbourne-supporting toff. Nice bloke, wrong job.
I'd move him out and put regular fill-in Mark Allen – former pro golfer and ex-SEN broadcaster – in the seat. He is smart, has views on social issues that resonate with the AW audience and can carry the show through illness – something Howcroft struggles with".

I concur wholeheartedly.

Are we wealthy? It's about more than just money
Wealth goes beyond financial status, and includes health, relationships, purpose, freedom, time, personal growth and gratitude.

Wednesday October 23, 2024

Lord of the Fries – was he responsible for the recent e-coli outbreak? The Donald will resort to anything to win votes.

It's down to the wire

The U.S. election is tied with two weeks to go, according to the latest polls, leaving Kamala Harris fighting to break the deadlock by picking off Republicans worried about re-electing Donald Trump.

Today I will commence fasting in preparation for a colonoscopy tomorrow at Epworth Richmond Hospital. The procedure will be carried out by Dr. Ed Shelton.
This procedure has been recommended in response to my recent intense stomach pain that I endured for five days in late September. At 5.00pm today I will initiate bowel preparation in order to clear out my system – brace for impact!

Wednesday October 23, 2024

POSTER BOY FOR WASTING VICTORIAN DOLLARS

The Scots famously love a bargain - and Daniel Andrews has certainly delivered them one. Glaswegians are rightly stoked that Victoria's hard earned taxes has given them the chance to host one of the world's most renowned sporting events - for free!

A cardboard cut-out of Dodgy Dan, sporting a kilt and carrying a bag of Victorian cash, in Glasgow - much to the mirth of Glaswegians

Thursday October 24, 2024

This morning I was admitted to Epworth Richmond for a colonoscopy. When I met with Dr. Ed Shelton, is asked if I could also have a gastroscopy at the same time, to which he agreed.
The gastroscopy revealed a short segment of Barrett's oesophagus and will await histology results.

A short segment of Barrett's esophagus with Prague criteria C1M0 is generally considered less serious compared to longer segments. The Prague criteria classify Barrett's oesophagus based on the circumferential extent © and the maximum extent (M) of the Barrett's segment. In this case, C1M0 means there is a 1 cm circumferential segment without any additional tongues or extensions.

While it's less likely to progress to high-grade dysplasia or esophageal adenocarcinoma compared to longer segments, it's still important to monitor and manage it appropriately. Regular surveillance and follow up with your healthcare provider are recommended to ensure any changes are detected early.

The colonoscopy revealed three (5-9mm) sessile polyps in the colon which were removed. There was also a large (>20mm) typical adenomatous sessile polyp in the caecum, which was biopsied. This caecal polyp will need to be removed at a later date. This polyp concerns me.
It was timely that the polyps were removed as these could become cancerous in the future.

If Lydia Thorpe didn't appropriately swear her oath of office, does that mean she isn't properly employed and has to re-pay her salary.
Now that would be ethical.

Saturday October 26, 2024

Karen Chalk celebrated her 60th birthday with a party at her home this evening.
I sent her a message last Monday wishing her a happy birthday and she then invited Jann and I to her birthday celebration, which we accepted.
Karen and her husband John did a splendid job setting up their home for their birthday bash. I was able to re-connect with many former and current Diver employees, including Val Lawton, Paddy Malone, Mick Staff, Nameet Lal and Paula Rodriguez, amongst others.
Re-connecting with Paddy Malone, in particular, was very pleasing, considering he wasn't very happy with my WHS work when I was consulting at DCI in 2021.
I congratulated him on moving past old Roy's years of service record of 44 years and he mentioned he would like to get to 50 years. Sadly, Paddy mentioned that Paul Cleeland wasn't doing too well and he is now in an aged care facility in Ivanhoe, which truly stunned us.
I assured Paddy that we will pop in and see him.
It was also lovely seeing Val and Norm Lawton and sharing stories about our retirement activities, especially our trips to Bali.
This was a very special and enjoyable evening and we thanked Karen for inviting Janny and me to her celebration.

Monday October 28, 2024

Retirement has this funny way of taking you to places and experiences that you never quite expected nor planned for. My English tutor – Loui – invited me to accompany him to the Croydon Zen Buddhist Temple and then to the Warburton Tibetan Temple. I noted the following in my journal just prior to leaving Croydon;
"I am in the front passenger seat of Loui's seven seat Mercedes Benz SUV at the Croydon Zen Buddhist Temple. We have met with Yang Hong (female Monk) and others, where we had Chinese tea. Yang, Loui and I went into the Temple where I lit some sandalwood and Yang showed me how to perform a Buddhist

blessing and Yang then presented me with a gift in a beautifully decorated yellow box. We then travelled to the Warburton Temple".
At Warburton we had lunch and then sat in on a Tibetan Buddhist ceremony. A very interesting experience.

Tuesday October 29, 2024
Today Janny and I attended the CSL Limited Shareholder Annual General Meeting held at the RACV City Club in Bourke Street. The keynote speaker was Director, Dr. Brian MacNamee.

Wednesday October 30, 2024

Today I will be visiting Dr. Michael Sutherland, who is a respiratory physician, at Epworth Richmond. Back on the 7th of October I had a CT Chest scan, which revealed calcified pleural plaques and Dr. Sutherland will be conducting further tests today. I have concluded that in retirement one needs to expect the unexpected, especially when it comes to heath issues. In the last five years the following health conditions have impacted me;
Mild cardiovascular disease, diverticulosis, lung pulmonary nodule, left knee osteo-arthritis and medial tear, right rotator cuff syndrome, lung opacity suggestive of alveolitis, large caecal polyp requiring removal and Barrett's oesophagus. Nine medical conditions. Perhaps procrastination is now my biggest enemy.

The most hotly contested U.S. Presidential election since……the last one.
The Donald certainly makes things interesting.
Better the devil you know?

Today I informed the State Revenue Office of the sale of our Ashley Street unit.
This will, hopefully, reduce our land tax burden.

STATE REVENUE OFFICE VICTORIA

Your duties form is now signed.

Thursday October 31, 2024

Trust lost, economy scarred by pandemic

Australia's trust has been eroded, health systems are struggling and inflation pressures from government pandemic stimulus are still hurting the economy almost five years after the first COVID case was detected, the first wide ranging inquiry into the national response to the virus has found.

The inquiry noted that Dan Andrews "did not clearly explain the evidence that supported on-going enforcement of measures such as prolonged isolation or lockdowns".
An interesting endnote to my book;
A CORONAVIRUS JOURNAL

. . .

Thursday October 31, 2024

This morning we dropped into Blue Cross Residential Care in Ivanhoe and visited former DCI director Paul Cleeland. Paul's cognitive skills were fine, but his physical incapacity justifies his presence in this facility. It was a bit confronting seeing Paul in this condition.

Friday November 1. 2024

Our St Kilda apartment is currently listed for sale by Belle Property.

Light-filled, laid-back and located for lifestyle

For Sale in Conjunction with Ian Reid Vendor Advocates
Hidden away at the end of a quiet cul-de-sac, this top-floor apartment in a boutique block of just seven offers the perfect mix of privacy and bayside pleasure. The light-filled living and dining room is super spacious, with sliding doors opening up to a private, leafy balcony.
The kitchen is tucked neatly to the side. With sleek black benchtops, timber-look cabinetry, and cool grey mosaic tiles, there are also wine racks and laundry taps for added convenience.
Both bedrooms share a bathroom with a shower-over-bath combo for quick refreshes or leisurely soaks. Add in polished floorboards, a heater in the living room, and a car space, and you're all set for easy living.

Saturday November 2, 2024

Regarding the "open for inspection" this morning, we were provided the following feedback;
Six groups today with one interested party. A first home buyer who's family inspected on their behalf last weekend.
The rest decided against the property or were just researching the market.
Hopefully two now confirmed in total with one to hear back from.

Saturday November 2, 2024

We're trembling in our own homes

This is Victoria in 2024: suburban homes plastered with security cameras and alarm systems, young teenagers pinching cars and terrorising residents, gangs armed with deadly machetes and knives murdering each other on suburban streets, courts issuing community orders instead of prison terms because offenders showed "remorse" and young offenders being bailed within twenty four hours to re-offend.

Home invasions – many violent and some deadly – gang knife and machete fights, shopping centre brawls, car thefts and deadly chases involving offenders barely into their teenage years is not the Melbourne we grew up in and indeed not the Melbourne many of us recognise.

All I can say is "thank god Janny and I live in a gated and secure residential complex".

Sunday November 3, 2024

Janny and I saw "VENOM – The Last Dance" at Doncaster today. Definetely the best "Venom" movie of the trilogy.

★★★★

Monday November 4, 2024

Today I attended an English teaching class held at the North Richmond Community Hub. I was there to sit in on Elly Ackland's session to get a feel of how classes are structured and delivered.

I rode my bicycle to the venue and upon arriving was a little bit nervous, as the Hub is within a large group of housing commission towers.

I eventually found the Hub and the welcoming staff were very helpful.

The class attendees were mostly Vietnamese residents and were very friendly and engaging.

Tuesday November 5, 2024 – Melbourne Cup Day

As it was a beautiful, warm sunny day, Janny and I tandem cycled into the city via the Yarra River trail. Part of the trail was closed, so we had to detour via River Boulevard, at the rear of IKEA (the old Vickers Ruwolt site). It was yet another voyage of discovery. We came across the Royston Hotel and Veneziano Coffee Roasters, which is housed in what was a large old factory in Richmond – a throwback to Richmond's heavy industrial past. Where would we be without coffee roasters and barrista's. Old factories are now re-birthed as coffee roasters or beer brewers.

Wednesday November 6, 2024

Who will break the deadlock?

Knight's Choice wins the 2024 Melbourne Cup.

Thursday November 7, 2024

TRUMP – YOU'RE RE-HIRED!

HE'S DON IT AGAIN!

TRUMP WAVE IS A DON DEAL

He's back: Stunned Democrats watch in horror as the convicted criminal triumphs

Americans have repudiated the "wokification" of politics.

Friday November 8, 2024

Oops – what a Ruddy mess.

PET Scan Result

At 11.20am Dr. Sutherland (Respiratory Surgeon) rang me regarding my recent PET scan of my lungs. He indicated to me that the affected tissue is not active and did not light up, which is good news, although he did mention that it woiuld be wise to carry out a broncoscopy of the lesion and it will need to be monitored. To be performed by Dr. Barton Jennings.
He did notice however a "hot" spot in the large bowel, which appears to be active. I mentioned to Dr. Sutherland that I had a colonoscopy two weeks ago which indicated a large (>20mm) typical adenomatous sessile polyp in the caecum. He siad that this would be the area of concern and mentioned that he would forward the scan result to Dr. Ed Shelton so that he can discuss this with me on Monday.

Monday November 11, 2024 – Rememberance Day

I have an appointment today with Dr. Ed Shelton regarding my recent colonoscopy. The results have been compounded by my recent PET scan.

Right at 11.00am – at the time that a minute's silence is taken as a mark of respect for the end of the World War 1, I received a call from Robert Murdoch. He informed me that his father David – my boss at DCI and the company financial director, had passed away.
I wrote about David in my memoir "Busy People Make Time";

"On November 20, 1992 David Murdoch asked me to attend an FCAI Quality Circle Conference at the Ford Training Centre – I duly obliged.

The FEDERAL CHAMBER OF AUTOMOTIVE INDUSTRIES
cordially invites
Mr & Mrs R. Murdoch,
to an Industry
Quality Circle Conference
presentations by eight Industry Quality Circles
at Ford Training Centre, 1735 Sydney Road, Campbellfield, Vic.
on Monday, 30th November, 1992
from 9.30 a.m. - 12.30 p.m.
Light Lunch provided
R.S.V.P.: 20th November, 1992
Tel: (06) 247 3811

At the time I looked upon David as a fairly imposing figure and whilst he was the Financial Controller, he was also the chief decision maker and trusted confidant to Ted.
He made a significant contribution to the fortunes of DCI and spent countless hours at the Office. I felt that he was largely misunderstood by many at DCI due to his unobtrusive nature, but I found him to be quite amiable and he always supported me throughout my career".

David and Pauline Murdoch at a Diver Christmas function in the 1990's.

News of David's passing has capped off a fortnght of confronting news regarding pivotal DCI personnel and comes shortly after hearing about and

visiting Paul Cleeland at Blue Cross residential care in Ivanhoe. For a good deal of my working life at DCI, the big three were Ted Diver, David Murdoch and Paul Cleeland. Ted and David have ridden on ahead and Paul's future is at best opaque. I sent a message to Col Linton who responded "Thanks – sad time for the old Diver crew".

Tuesday November 12, 2024

Donald Trump won all the swing states, including soviet occupied Eastern Ukraine.

Today we visited Paul Cleeland. We were concerned about his state of mind and potential suicidal thoughts. It breaks my heart that Paul, who I always felt was so mentally strong and resilient, had fallen to this current depth of despair. So sad. He did, however agree to let me write his biography. Perhaps this will help give him some small measure of focus and purpose.
Paddy Malone rang me and we discussed Paul Cleeland's situation.

Wednesday November 13, 2024

A busy day.....
Today I met with Mary Dearing from Carringbush Adult Education for training and induction. The venue was 108 Elizabeth Street Richmond. It was a wet morning and Janny drove me there. This venue is a large housing commission estate comprising of six large towers. The training and community centres are located on the ground floor of these towers. I can easily and happily feel a great sense of community withing this public housing estate.
During the day Janny and I reviewed and signed off an offer to buy 6/6 Inverleith Court St Kilda at $580k. It was a fair offer, but you know how

these things always pan out – it would have been nicer to have sold it for more.
Also today I created an A5 biography template for Paul Cleeland's book.
I reached out and rang Mark Schreiber and filled him in about David and Paul. I always felt a need to re-connect with Mark, and in doing so, it gave me a great sense of satisfaction and fulfillment. Hopefully we will catch up with him soon, whereby I intend to present him with a copy of my DCI memior.
Some time in the afternoon, Mary Dearing rang Brendan at DCI to do a reference check on me for my role at Carringbush Adult Education. She sent me the following message;

"I've just talked with Brendan Fraser and he's given you a high recommendation of course".

That evening Brendan Fraser rang me. That was another joyous moment for the day. We spoke about David and Paul and Mark Fawthorpe. Sadly, Mark has retired but believes that he was pushed out of DCI. I suspect he is not enjoying his retirement. It was always my intention to retire from DCI on my terms and with nothing but happiness and affection towards the company that I dedicated 33 years of my life to. I can fortunately say that I achieved this, as can be seen in my memoir "Busy People Make Time". No bitterness, animosity, regret or ill feeling.

Friday November 15, 2024

While walking along Johnston Street Abbotsford, Janny and I visited one of the many record shops and stumbled on these old classics from Brian Cadd, The Dingoes (Five Times The Sun), Rod Stewart (Atlantic Crossing) and Sherbet's Greatest Hits at Vinyl Space in Collingwood.
I quite like sourcing records which were released back in the 1970's, not re-releases. All these albums were released between 1975 and 1977. The Brian Cadd record, in particular, brought back many memories. A reminder of how talented he was.

Monday November 18, 2024

Trump knows the drill

Fracking magnate and climate sceptic named energy chief

G O D H E L P U S

The List Analysis in the Herald Sun for Carlton displayed the following headline;

EXCUSE TIME OVER

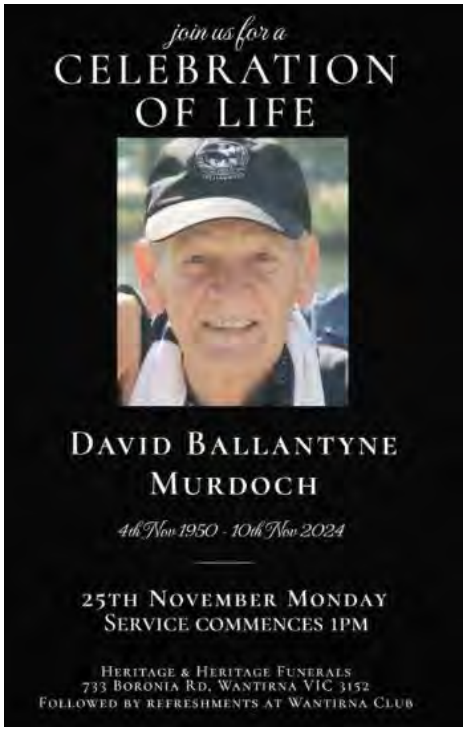
"The only tally more ridiculous than Cripp' 45 votes in the Brownlow Medal was the number on the Blues' weekly injury list updates.
Often it would reach the high teens as the phenomenal Cripps went to war to try to save Carlton's season".

Today I sat in on my first classroom English session with Elly Ackland at the Carringbush training room at 110 Elizabeth Street Richmond.

Tuesday November 19, 2024

CODE BLACK COFFEE ROASTERS

Loui and I embarked on a field trip for his English tutoring by visiting Code Black Coffee Roasters in Weston Street, Brunswick. Yet another old inner city factory conversion to a coffee roasting facility



Tuesday November 19, 2024

Brendan sent me this CELEBRATION OF LIFE flyer for David Murdoch's forthcoming memorial service.
I forwarded it to Mark Schreiber, Ernie Thorneloe, Col Linton, Paddy Malone and Paul Cleeland.
I suspect that this memorial service will be a Diver reunion – current employees and us retirees.

This afternoon I will be visiting Paul Cleeland at Blue Cross and will start documenting his life story. I think Paul is genuinely looking forward to it.

Tonight Sky News is screening THE REAL COST OF NET ZERO, and is anchored by the highly respected Chris Uhlmann. We in Australia appear to be hell bent on achieving net zero, at a terrible economic price, when our contrbution to global warming is 1.1%. I can't help but think of the Japanese quality guru Kaoru Ishikawa, who advocated that businesses should focus on the significant few rather than the trivial many when addressing problems. China (32%), the United States (14%) and India (8%) are the significant few and are the largest contributors to global carbon emissions.

A Tuesday thought….

The dilemma, quandary and predicament of a cashless society.

Friday November 22, 2024

On this day 48 years ago I attended my first ever rock concert. The venue was Festival Hall and the band was Blackmores Rainbow. I attended with my brother Jeff and John Batten.

An excerpt from the concert program and Pat Bowring's newsprint review (Sun News Pictorial November 23, 1976 the following day) is displayed below;

Pot of Musical Gold at this Rainbow's End

Rainbow's performance was excellent. Ritchie Blackmore stunned the crowd with a multitude of brilliant lead guitar solos throughout their entire set.

Through his association with Deep Purple, Blackmore long ago established himself as one of the top "heavymetal" guitarists in the world.

A monstrous electronic rainbow arching high above the stage, had remained dark, but not unseen by the crowd. As Rainbow took to the stage it became a dazzling array of colours dancing across the sky.

"Kill The King", a yet to be released tune, presented the people with a faultless example of what to expect from the band, The sound was heavy and laden with power chords, but never once bogged down.

Loud applause came from the audience as the group broke into "I've Been Mistreated", originally done by Blackmore's former cohorts, Deep Purple. The guitarist appeared comfortable with this one and proceeded to show the rapid spit-fire guitar work that has gained him international respect.

Introduced as a nice medieval-renaissance tune, "Greensleeves" turned out to be a high point of Rainbow's performance.

THE SHOW continued to follow the same power-packed course. Songs such as "Catch The Rainbow" and "Stargazer" brought the fans to their feet.

Though Blackmore continued to be in the spotlight, drummer Cozy Powell, keyboardist Tony Carey and bassist Jimmy Bain never ley the audience forget their presence. They attacked each song with unyielding determination, so necessary for a young group.

When the group got into "Man On The Silver Mountain", off their first LP, the crowd jumped to its feet and seemed to feel this would be Rainbow at their heaviest. This was without doubt their hottest, most rockin' number of the night. Blackmore's fingers became a blur on his guitar as the rest of the band came thundering behind.

Rainbow put on a satisfying show, both audibly and visibly. Words could not do the awesome stage rainbow justice. It has to be seen to be appreciated.

RITCHIE WAS A REAL SMASH

A huge rainbow containing more than 300 colored lamps last night provided the focal point for probably the most spectacular rock show at Festival Hall.

Pat Bowring – Rap Around

In Loving Memory Of

David Ballantyne Murdoch

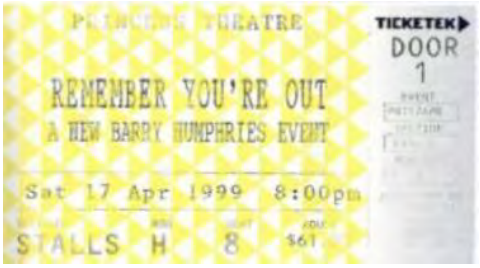
04.11.1950 – 10.11.2024

Aged 74 Years

If I should
go tomorrow,
It would never
be goodbye,
For I have left
my heart with you,
So don't you ever cry.
The love that's
deep within me,
Shall reach you
from the stars,
You'll feel it
from the heavens,
And it will
heal the scars.

Monday November 25, 2024

Today we attended the funeral of David Murdoch. It was not only an opportunity to celebrate David's life, but also to re-connect with many former and current DCI employees – in effect a DCI reunion. Those who attended included Paul Cleeland, Paul Malone, Wayne Spiden, Brendan Fraser, Col Linton, Mark Schreiber (and wife Julie), Ron Signorini, Ernie Thorneloe and of course Pauline Murdoch . It was such a thrill to catch up with this cohort. Brendan delivered a very moving eulogy and spoke from the heart about his mentor. He also mentioned David's love of Barry Humphries and I fondly remember David inviting Jann and I to accompany him, Pauline, Brendan and Vivian for dinner and a Barry Humphries event at the Princess Theatre in 1999. David, Brendan and myself had done a power of work preparing for the transition of DCI's computer system and David acknowledged this by taking us out. Interestingly, Wayne informed me that Mark Fawthorpe was working part time at Total Tooling, working three mornings a week. I can only hope that this role helps him get through what is a difficult period in his life.



In the evening, Janny and I attended the AGM at MannaCare. I had the opportunity to talk to Ross Dawson and Romi Mathieson about the demise of the Biography Program. I pointed out that we need to determine whether their remains a commitment to the program and if so, it may be wise to re-establish the procedural detail to allow it to be ressurected.

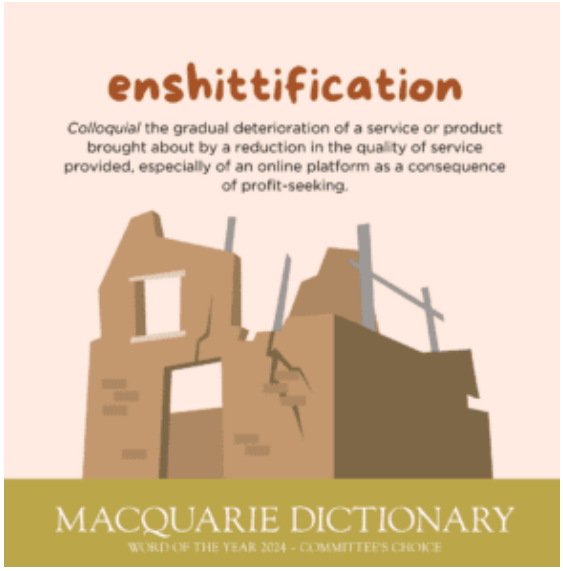
NOTICE OF AND INVITATION
ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING (AGM)

Cassia House
371 Manningham Road, Doncaster.
Monday 25 November 2024
commencing at 6.30pm.

. . .

Tuesday November 26, 2024

Listening to my recently purchased Brian Cadd record, two songs brought back memories of a couple of TV programs that he wrote the theme song for;



MACQUARIE DICTIONARY
Word of the Year 2024
ENSHITTIFICATION
An example of this is Luxury Escapes. Previously they would provide transfers to and from your hotel – Now it's only one transfer, from the airport to the hotel.
Massages were 60 minutes – now 50 minutes. Both are examples of service deterioration.

LUXURYESCAPES

Do you kind of get the feeling that she is on borrowed time?

Wednesday November 27, 2024

COLONOSCOPY II – Dr. Jonathon Tan at Epworth Richmond.
Conclusion: Large caecal adenoma removed successfully via EMR. Bowel preparation was good.
Diverticular disease. Haemorrhoids.

Friday November 29, 2024

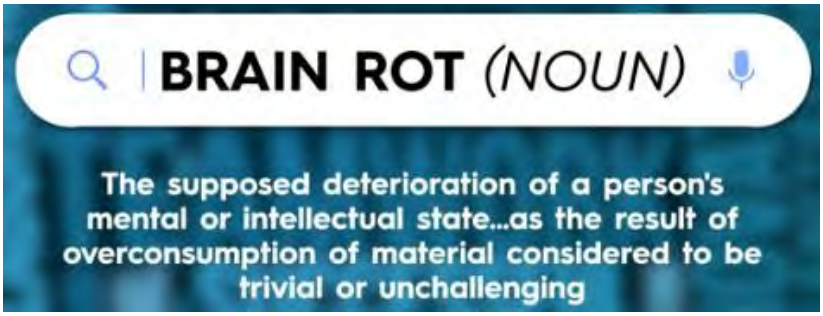
On this day Janny and I joined Jeff and Kath in dumping all Kath's metal scrap at Norstar. It took three trips, using Jeff's ute and a hired cage trailer. Hard work, considering it was a hot day. That evening we had dinner with Joe and Noelene Milner at the Old England Hotel. A splendid evening.

Sunday December 1, 2024

Janny and I spent the day at St Kilda and while at Eclectico and scoping for vinyl records, I found this Vinyl Lovers Tour Guide. A very handy accompaniment for my vinyl record pursuits.

Tuesday December 3, 2024

The Oxford Dictionary's Word of the Year.
Perhaps "doom scrolling" was a credible runner up.



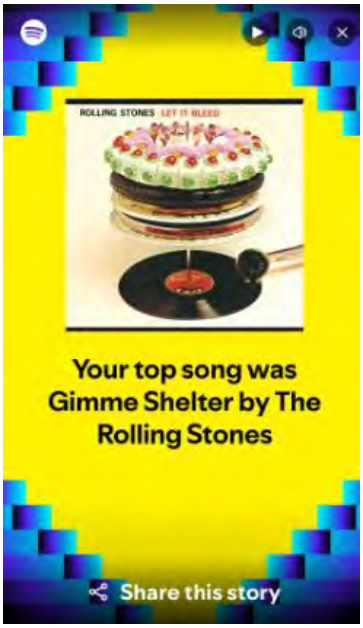
Wednesday December 4, 2024

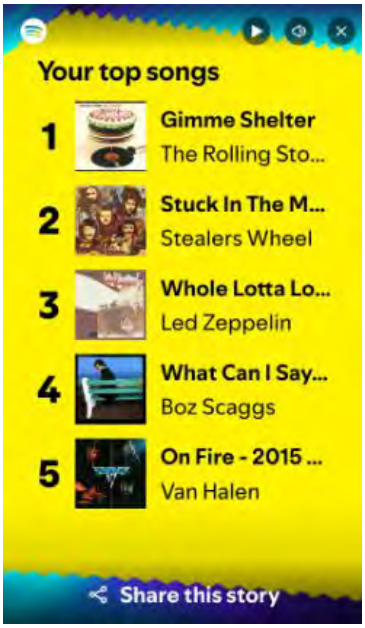
Today I carried out volunteer work at MannaCare, archiving client files and other records. I worked with Denise and also had an opportunity to catch up with Judy Smith and Marie Callaghan. At the end of the day I caught up with Janny and I helped her group with arts and crafts for Christmas celebrations. Overall a good volunteering day with a high level of job satisfaction.

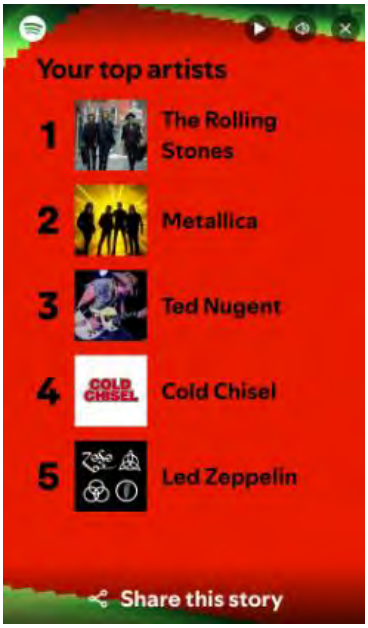
. . . .

Thursday December 5, 2024

Woke up this morning with Ross Stevenson announcing that Spotify had dropped their 2024 Spotify Wrapped summary of our listening preferences over the last 12 months. This is what ruled our listening this year;







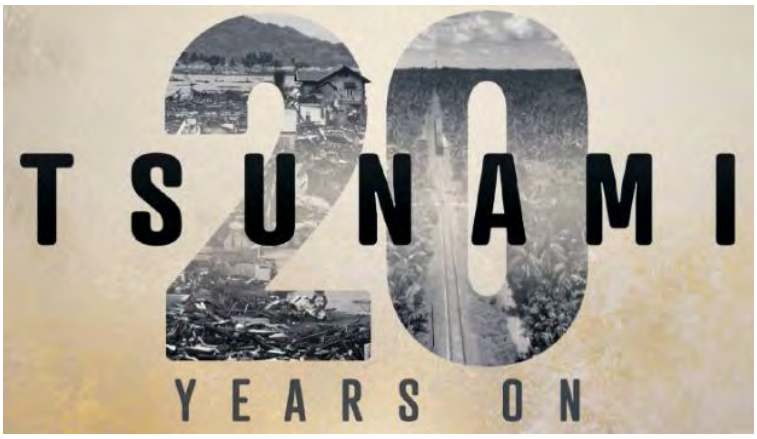
Friday December 6, 2024

Received this as part of the Carringbush Volunteer Newsletter.

Patrick Ernest has joined Elly's 'English for Everyone' class at the North Richmond Community Hub. Here, he is working with student Candy. Patrick is a retired Manager. He also volunteers in an aged care setting, writing residents' biographies.

Sunday December 8, 2024

This evening the Nine network screened a documantary about the 20th Anniversary of the Boxing Day tsunami. Described as one of the biggest natural disasters in world history. Over two hundered thousand dead. The tsunami devestated Phuket and we were scheduled to visit the island the following February, 2005. We rerouted our holiday to Koh Samui instead.



I came across this advertisement below on-line. The movie will be released in IMAX. A bonafide "supergroup" on a super screen. The YouTube ad for the movie has "Whole Lotta Love" playing in the background. Can't wait. The text below was written by Classic Rock Newsletter.

"I cannot think of a single movie that more brilliantly draws you into an artist's story, shows you how their music was made, and makes you experience it as if it were brand new. I know it will be inspirational to young people and legacy-defining for generations to come."

Tuesday December 10, 2024

This morning I attended the Carringbush Students Celebration at Lynall Hall in Highett Street, Richmond. Many English learning students performed with their tutors. It was very uplifting. Afterwards we had coffee across the road at "A Thousand Blessings". I then rode my bike home.
In the afternoon I rode to Blue Cross Ivanhoe to vist Paul Cleeland. I had a very pleasant surprise when Val and Lara popped in. I was so pleased to reconnect with them. Lara provided me with many photo's for Paul's biography.
I rode my bike to both venues. A busy day indeed.

Wednesday December 11, 2024

The Importance of being……there
The importance of being…..
with Janny,
	with Paul Cleeland,
with my students,
	at Lifeblood,
in vinyl record stores,
	at the library,
on the bike,
	at MannaCare,
at Carringbush,
	in Bali,
with Loui,
	with family.

This morning I attended Elly's final English class session with her Wednesday students and end of year lunch. During the session Elly asked me to read a poem to the class;

A World in One Classroom

Our students come to class each day,
From countries far, far away.
Brave hearts and dreams so clear,
Starting a new life right here.

Sharing their lunch with joy,
Different foods we all enjoy.
Delicious meals and happy faces,
Telling stories from other places.

Every day brings such delight,
When new words come out right.
Helping each other learn and grow,
More confident with what we know.

Our hearts are filled with joy to see,
One big Carringbush family.
From near and far,
Each student is a shining star.

There is a profound sense of happiness within the students. They are welcoming and sincere. I enjoy my interactions with them. They represent this glowing vision of hope in an area where many are struggling with addiction.

Wednesday December 11, 2024

At the end of year celebration Mary Dearing gave me a card and a key ring with a guitar attached to it, as her token of appreciation for volunteering at Carringbush.

Thursday December 12, 2024

Retirement has taken me to so many places, many of which I never envisaged to be so wonderful, enlightening and fulfilling. A completely different world to that of my working life. I'm now out of the shadows and in the sunshine.

Tonight Janny and I attended MannaCare's End Of Year Celebration at the Doncaster Shoppingtown Hotel – a great venue and a splendid evening. We caught the 207 bus to the venue, which allowed us to have a few drinks. I met fellow volunteers Mick and Richard, who provide music to residents. Mai, Junko and Denise were also there, along with many other MannaCare staff members. There was a great vibe and all who attended were clearly enjoying themselves. I was lucky enough to win a door prize and Janny won the Volunteer Residential Award 2024. I was so proud of her. Mind you, it didn't really surprise me, as she is an outstanding Leisure and Lifestyle volunteer. Her ability to work with and comfort elderly residents is remarkable and I am so glad that MannaCare acknowledged this.

Janny's certificate stated;

Your dedication, care and commitment has brought comfort and joy, making a lasting impact on the lives of those in our MannaCare family and community.

Janny receiving her
Volunteer Residential Award 2024 from
Romi Mathieson (COO) and Sandy Perri (CFO)

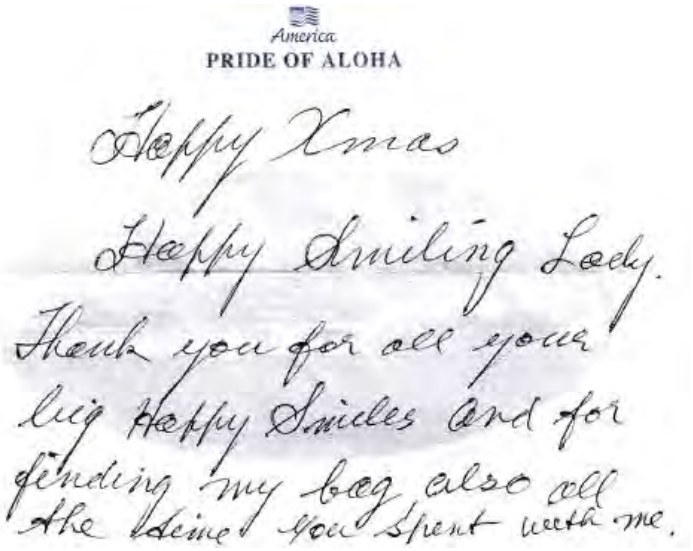
Janny and I with Ryan and Normin

Tuesday December 17, 2024

We finished watching "The Jury - Death on the Staircase" on SBS.
A fascinating look inside the inner machinations of a working jury. It was also an intriguing and absorbing case. In the end the jury found the accused not guilty, however Janny and I found him guilty. We felt that the premise that the victim fell down the stairs was implausible. Too many injuries and the accused admitted that he and the victim had a fight at the time.

Tuesday December 17, 2024

Today Janny and I finished up at MannaCare for the year. I was able to finish archiving at DML with Denise. We received the following messages on the day from Normin and Marie;



Australian cartoonist and poet Michael Leunig dies aged 79

Friday December 20, 2024

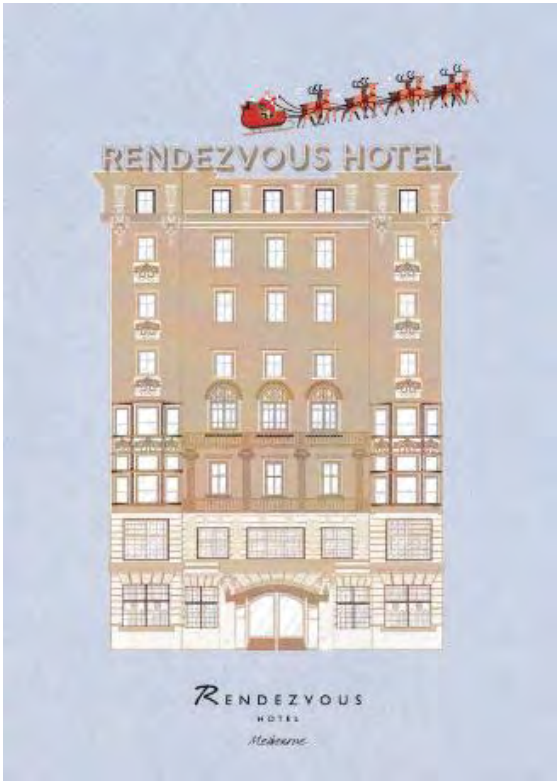
"The pen has run dry, its ink no longer flowing – yet Mr. Curly and his ducks will remain etched in our hearts, cherished and eternal."

So sad to hear the passing of Michael Leunig. His reflective, thoughtful and philisophical poetry and glorious characters will be missed terribly. His work is dispersed throughout my books, as they so accurately captured my feelings and emotions, and on most occasions, were very uplifting, I loved his work creating the album cover for Australian Crawl's 1983 live album Phalanx. Vale Michael Leunig.

Friday December 20, 2024

Yesterday I visited Dr. Jonathan Tan, as a follow up to my colonoscopy on November 27. The good news is that there was no cancer detected.
This good news follows my recent blood test that indicated total cholesterol of 3.9 and LDL cholesterol of 2.0. The numbers are heading in the right direction. A nice way to end the year.
Now I can focus on my arthritic left knee.

Wednesday December 25, 2024
Christmas Day



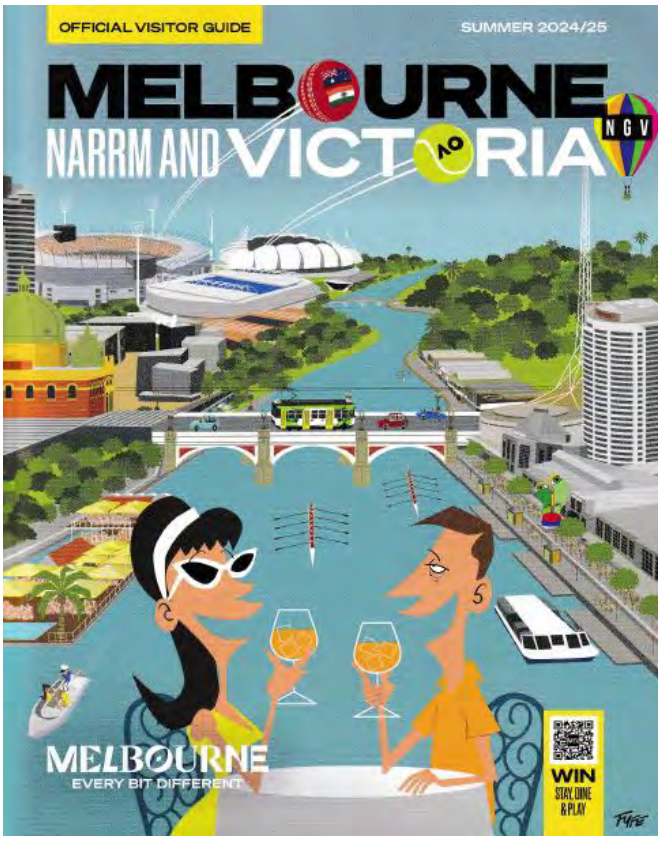
Janny and I spent Christmas 2024 in the City, and stayed at the Rendezvous Hotel in Flinders Street. After checking in we walked across the Yarra to Eureka 89 for Christmas lunch. On the way we saw a few Australian cricketers, namely Sam Konstas, Steve Smith and Travis Head, walking along the Southbank promenade.
Lunch at Eureka 89 was again a delight.

Thursday December 26, 2024
Boxing Day

On this day 20 years ago a tsunami devestated Phuket and other countries. This supermarket was next door to our hotel – The Patong Merlin, and many people perished. The supermarket is submerged below street level, so the occupants had no chance. We met a Thai lady who sold her husband's paintings up on street level. Prior to the tsunami, she had a stall in the supermarket but she was not working on Boxing Day, 2024.

She said she will never again work in the supermarket, and is happy selling from above, on the street. We bought a painting from her, which her husband painted of Krabi in 2013. It hangs on the wall in our dining room.

While in the city recently I collected the Melbourne Summer Visitor Guide. I relly liked the cover, which again highlights the talents of Andrew Fyfe. Titled *Yarra Spritz*, it is one of Andrew's favorite summertime city views. Andrew has grown up, lived and worked in Melbourne all his life. For more of his work and love for Melbourne, refer to pages 141 and 142 of this Journal.



Day 1 – Boxing Day Test

Sam Konstas made his debut for Australia in spectacular fashion. Last Friday selector George Bailey said that Sam Konstas was drafted into the team to "throw something different at India". Well, Sam delivered in spades. Through a series of incredible shot making, he raced to 50 off 52 balls, which included a few "ramp" shots. Usman was playing test cricket and Sam was playing T20! The Boxing Day Test has never seen anything like it. It was his youth and enthusiasm that made the world's best bowler, Jaspirit Bumrah, look pretty ordinary. Amazing!

Monday December 30, 2024

Day five of this Boxing Day Test sees Australia needing to bowl out India for victory and for India to make 338 runs to win. A terrific test match.

Tuesday December 31, 2024
New Year's Eve

Janny and I ventured into the City today for New Year's Eve and had lunch at Time Out in Federation Square. We then popped into ACMI and then wandered up Hosier Lane and stumbled into a street art exhibition titled THE OUTSIDERS Melbourne. I will sign off 2024 with some of the works on display.

Promotional flyer for the exhibition.

Tuesday December 31, 2024

Farewell 2024

2025

Wednesday January 1, 2025

Double digit returns a super end.
Super funds have delivered their third best return of the past decade and their highest since 2001. The 11.5 per cent return is the strongest result since 13.4 per cent in 2021, when equities rebounded from sluggish performance during the Covid pandemic. The best return in the past ten years was 14.7 per cent in 2019.

All Ordinaries	8420.5
ASX200	8159.1
ASX50	8020.8
CBA	$153.25
CSL	$281.58
NAB	$37.10

Friday January 3, 2025

Janny and I took the Port Phillip Ferry to Portarlington for lunch.

Sunday January 5, 2025

Janny and I saw this movie at the Rivoli cinema today. This movie was given five stars by Leigh Paatsch from the Herald Sun. I thought it would be a good movie to check out. He recommended seeing it as cold as you can. "The movie gem you must see" he states.

For us, it was a very uncomfortable movie to watch. Simply put, there was too much "hushmakundi". I acknowledge that we need to "get it" that the subject couple entered into a "commercial arrangement", but it was excessive in the extreme.

★

The path to financial freedom begins by setting out goals and then being willing to make a few sacrifices to achieve it.

Bali beaches, sacrifices and an early retirement

Sacrifice. Make a plan. Give yourself some time. Take on reasonable risk. Retire early. Enjoy.

Monday January 6, 2025

I have been contemplating reaching out to Dr. Robert Forry, grandson of my grandfather Wiliam Frank Forry for some time now. I have hesitated due to the thought that he might consider me some sort of crackpot from the other side of the world. He may consider my assertions, that his grandfather is also my grandfather, absurd. There is also the sensitive subject of adultery. After due consideration, I decided to pen a letter to him – it reads as follows;

10 March, 2026

Dr. Robert Alan Forry
1920 Van Reed Road
Wyomissing, PA, U.S.A. 19610

Dear Mr. Forry,

My name is Patrick Ernest and I have been conducting genealogical research in order to determine who my biological grandfather is and the origins of our family name ERNEST. This may sound peculiar to you at first, but my research has revealed that I am the grandson of William Franklin Forry Jnr. William served with the American forces as a cook (Serial Number: 965393) during World War 1 and while in England met my grandmother Lydie. They stayed together while in England at the Dolphin Hotel Southampton in the period 1918–1919.

Not long after he returned to America, my father Harold was born. Your father Norman and my father would have been half-brothers. Following Harold's birth on August 4, 1919 and after William's departure, divorce papers were lodged in England indicating that the divorce was between Henry De Burgh and Lydie De Burgh & Mr. Forry. The document clearly states;

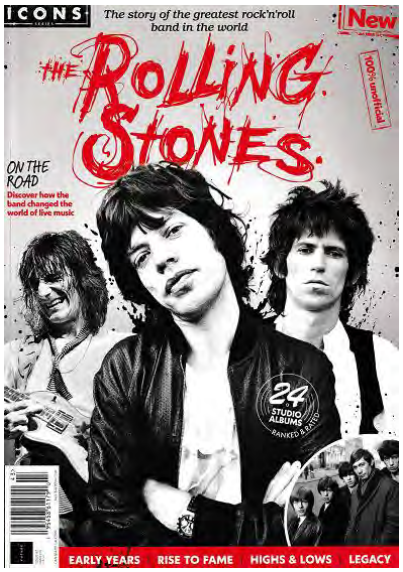
"by consequence, the said Marie Lydie De Burgh was on the 4th day of August 1919 delivered of a male child at The Infirmary Hale Road Farnham aforesaid whereof the said Mr. Forry and not Henry De Burgh is the father".

William's details attached.
Lydie and the infant Harold soon after returned to Lydie's country of birth – Mauritius.

I would be eternally grateful if you could provide me with a photo or two of William. I am the youngest of six children and I am very keen to share with my siblings a photo of our grandfather. I suspect that my father, Harold, was unaware of his father's identity, and the circumstances with which he came into being were kept private and confidential. My father Harold passed away aged 57 in 1976 when I was fourteen. It was only through accessing these divorce documents that the mystery was solved.
Also, it would be helpful to know a little about my grandfather, apart from marrying Grace and having two children – Irene and Norman.
Any assistance to this end would be greatly appreciated.

Kindest regards,

Patrick Ernest
Posted today – it will be fascinating to see what response I receive.



Tuesday January 7, 2025

"*What motivates retirees to keep working….*
Maslow's hierarchy of needs will tell you it's self-actualisation.
That drives you when money matters are taken care of….
In other words the need to express yourself creatively"

I am currently getting into The Rolling Stones and reading a magazine about them, together with listening to their music. I am now actively searching for their 1971 LP Sticky Fingers – rated their best album.
Described as the greatest rock and roll band in the world, I needed to delve into the back story that is the Rolling Stones. I guess it's not a tag that most rock groups would be able to live up to, but with more than 2,000 live shows, a host of iconic and influential releases, over six decades in game and still going strong (although I presume that Charlie would disagree), the Rolling Stones have more than made it their own.

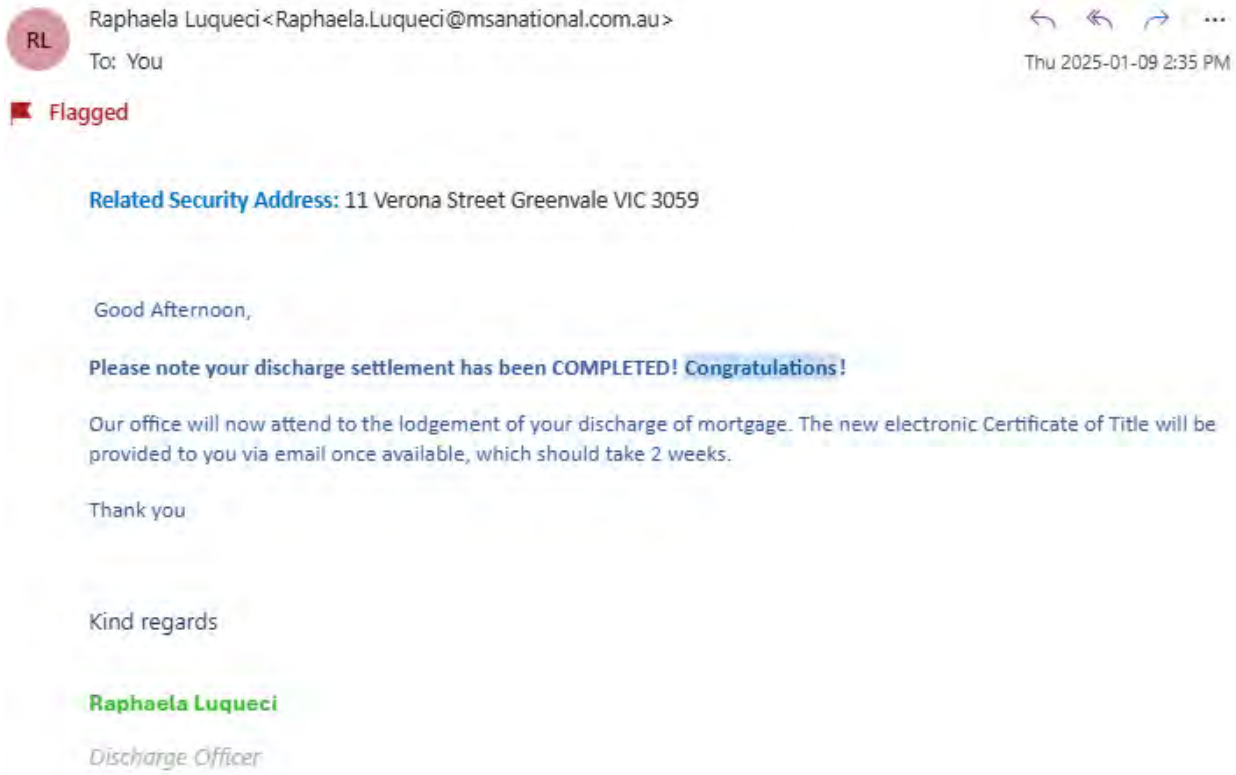
Wednesday January 9, 2025

We attended Beauty and the Beast today. Simply delightful. The props, dancing and visual spectacle of this show was a joy to behold. I felt so blessed to experience it.

The residents of Kooyong are constantly targeted with political brochures. The latest is focused on Monique Ryan.
It asserts that she is;
Weak on crime,
Weak on Union corruption,
Supports higher taxes, and
would back a labor-Greens minority government.

Friday January 10, 2025

This appeared in the January edition of the MannaCare Mail


Raphaela Luqueci<Raphaela.Luqueci@msanational.com.au>
To: You
Thu 2025-01-09 2:35 PM
Flagged

Related Security Address: 11 Verona Street Greenvale VIC 3059

Good Afternoon,

Please note your discharge settlement has been COMPLETED! Congratulations!

Our office will now attend to the lodgement of your discharge of mortgage. The new electronic Certificate of Title will be provided to you via email once available, which should take 2 weeks.

Thank you

Kind regards

Raphaela Luqueci

Discharge Officer

At last!

Monday January 13, 2025

The following update appeared in the summer edition of the Boroondara newsletter;

Update: Kew Recreation Centre

"WorkSafe Victoria has laid charges over the collapse of the steel roof structure at the Kew Recreation Centre. It announced the charges against

the builder ADCO, and its facade contractor, Colab Building Tech, following a two year investigation.
WorkSafe Victoria alleges that it was reasonably practicable to have a competent person check the quality assurance documents provided for an imported steel truss, to ensure that it had been welded in accordance with the design drawings and fabrication requirements".

I took this photo of the collapsed roof of the Kew Recreation Centre from Coles Supermarket in October 2022

From my perspective, as a quality assurance professional, I would expect that the competent person not only check QA documentation, but that other aspects of the sourced product be physically checked to ensure;

- The material meets specified requirements and material test certificates provided,
- There are the correct number of welds, as per specification,
- These weld are located in the correct positions as per specification, and
- The visual appearance of the welds display adequate penetration to welded surfaces.

Also, I would check that the supplier had adequately qualified personnel and checking resources to verifiy correct weld strength and their ability to document this.

Today, January 13, we attended the Australian Open and headed to John Cain Arena where we saw Stefanos Tsitsipas go down to American Alex Michelsen in four sets.

Following this we wandered around Melbourne Park and took in the atmosphere. Definitely the "Happy Slam".

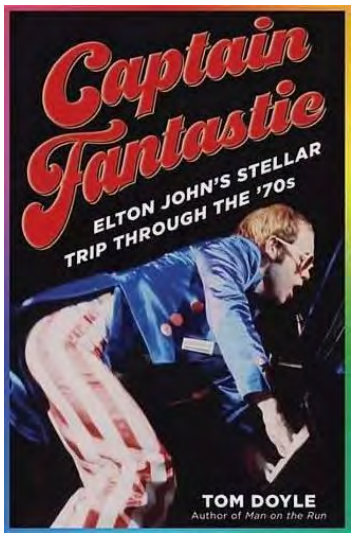
That evening Nick Kyrgios was bundled out in straight sets.

Tuesday January 14, 2025

Today I sent John Cockerell a happy birthday message and asked whether he was aware of Paul Cleeland's predicament. His response;

"Yes I am aware of Paul's situation. Hard to imagine big Paul locked up like that. It's great that you are writing his story, certainly worth telling.
Paul is without doubt the smartest, toughest bloke I have ever known – he was the relentless driving force behind Diver's, and the easy semi-retired life I have now is thanks to that.
I didn't always appreciate him back when I was younger, and not proud of that but it takes a lot to grow up sometimes".

Thursday January 16, 2025



I am currently reading a book about Elton John titled Captain Fantastic – Elton John's stellar trip through the 70's.
I read with interest the following quote from Elton, reflecting on his childhood;
"There is an expression for people like me, who were utterly entranced by the sounds magically eminating from revolving black plastic – It's called vinyl in the blood".

He also described the 1970's as an explosion of incredible creativity.

Friday January 17, 2025

VTS Picnic in the Park
Friday, the 17th of January 2025
Treasury Gardens
11am - 2pm
Bring your lunch and a picnic rug

We attended the VTS Picnic in the Park today. It was quite a good gathering and we met some very committed tutors and students. The Treasury Gardens were a great venue.

Monday January 20, 2025

I received this message below from John Cockerell;
"Bit of a road trip on the weekend, stopped at a museum at the small town of Rupanyip – a bit of everything including this empty box you may recognise".

M O N D A Y R E F L E C T I O N
Looking back on my years at DCI, its not about my achievements or performance, but about the man it allowed me to be.

Monday January 20, 2025

Today Janny and I cut loose and upgraded some of our appliances that were at the end of their useful life – we purchased a SHARP flatbed microwave oven, a Russell Hobbs Quiet Kettle and a Russell Hobbs 4 Slice Toaster. I presume you can guess what color the toaster is.

Tuesday January 21, 2025

PARTY TIME BEFORE DAWN OF TRUMP 2.0

Donald Trump has completed his stunning return to power overnight, taking the oath of office for a second time before signing a blitz of executive orders to unleash a "golden age for America".
But looking over his shoulder is Elon Musk. Perhaps he covets the role of POTUS. The Musk X factor has Trump's inner sanctum worried. I don't think it will end well.

Wednesday January 22, 2025

Word of the moment – EXECUTIVE ORDERS

Donald Trump wasted no time flexing his muscle. He unleashed a wave of executive orders to withdraw from the Paris climate agreement, authorise the military to deport undocumented immigrants, pardon all those involved in the January 6 insurrection and the withdrawl from the World Heath Organisation amongst others, to usher in a "golden age" and a "revolution of common sense". Now for tarrifs!

Surely not? Unfettered exuberance? Unencumbered passion?

Trump in power

One day down. 1459 days to go. Hang in there USA.

George Djoneff, Mitcham

From here on, there will only be two classes of people in the USA. Male and female, rich and poor, friends and enemies. It is so easy to view the world this way as a child.

David Raymond, Doncaster East

Chilling to know that attempted insurrection in the USA is now utterly condonable. There goes another safeguard of democracy in a crumbling state.

Graeme Brewer, Castlemaine

"This administration will only recognise male and female." A dark day for respect and inclusion for gender diversity.

Anne Dynon, Brighton

How will the average American fare with the oligarchs in charge?

John Groom, Bentleigh

It was almost amusing to hear that convicted felon President Trump is going to restore law and order to America. However, he probably won't be too tough on white collar crime or sexual assault, despite his considerable experience in those areas.

Sue Peterken, Berwick

"Give me your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free." Be proud America as the most massive deportation in history is announced.

Gary Bryfman, Brighton

Friday January 24, 2025

We drove up to Maryborough to have lunch with my old work pal John Cockerell. John was keen to read my book "BUSY PEOPLE MAKE TIME" - relating to my 33 years at DCI. It was great to catch up with my old mate. We met at the Maryborough railway station which, suprisingly, is a beautiful, grand old building with a lovely café. Apparently Mark Twain visited Maryborough in 1895 and described the town as "a station with a town attached".

Maryborough's Historic Train Station

Sunday January 26, 2025

AUSTRALIA DAY 2025

Neale Daniher was named the 2025 Australian of the Year. I read with interest his words of wisdom on receiving the gong;

"In my lifetime, I hope we
find the underlying causes of MND,
better treatments, and, ultimately,
a cure.
But beyond that, I hope
to leave a legacy that says this:
no matter the odds, no matter the diagnosis,
we all have the power to choose our attitude,
to choose to smile,
and to do something."

As I have always said – we are all defined by the choices we make.

Diversity, equity and inclusion programs shut down by Donald Trump. An executive order was signed by the Donald standing down all government employees working on the DEI programs.

DEI is finally dying, now it's time to roll up the "Welcome to Country" mat.

This weekend Jann, Jeff and I worked at Kath's, filling up a skip bin and buying items at Bunning's. Jeff and I did some carpentry work on Kath's patio and Jann was busy re-staining the front gates. There still remains plenty of work to get the front house ready. The house is not as yet empty.

During Kath's clean out and packing, she found documents and postcards relating to Uncle Dave. I took interest in this letter of reference for Uncle Dave's tenure at Victorian Railways, dated 26th March, 1965.

TELEPHONE 62 0311
EXTENSION
In your reply please refer to HRB:KW. (55)

RAILWAYS ADMINISTRATIVE OFFICES,
SPENCER STREET, MELBOURNE, C.1.

26th March, 1965.

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN

This is to certify that Joseph Davis LOUIS, date of birth 14.12.29, was employed in the Department as follows:-

16.10.58 to 1.2.59 as Supernumerary Skilled Laborer - Stores Branch.

2.2.59 to 29.3.60 as Supernumerary Station Assistant - Traffic Branch.

and

22.6.60 to 19.7.64 as Supernumerary Station Assistant - Traffic Branch.

20.7.64 to 12.3.65 as Supernumerary Station Assistant - Traffic Branch.- Motor Parcels.

Chief Traffic Manager.

Wednesday January 29, 2025

Yesterday Sam "The Punisher" Abdulrahim was shot dead in High Street, Preston. There have been many attempts on his life and I was starting to think this bloke was bullet proof. Yesterday his luck ran out. The Punisher met his own punishment.

I read with interest "Sly of the Underworld's" article in The Age;

"He had been the subject of more failed hits than a B-grade British boy band".

"A couple of generations ago there was only a handful of paid killers in the underworld, but now there are hundreds of would-be apprentices. It is so popular it should be a TAFE course".

"Following several attempts on his life and having been shot so many times, he had more lead in his torso than the saddle bags of a Melbourne Cup favourite, Abdulrahim remained remarkably upbeat".

Thursday January 30, 2025

I heard on breakfast radio this morning an interesting term that describes doing some task or activity poorly so that you would not be asked to do it again;

WEAPONISED INCOMPETENCE

Friday, January 31, 2025

We saw A COMPLETE UNKNOWN at Doncaster today.
This movie represents a wonderful celebration of music.
Timothee Chalamet was brilliant, as to was Edward Norton.
After growing restless with folk music, Dylan courageously and controversially picked up an electric guitar. The rest is history.
As I say, we are all defined by the choices we make.

Sunday February 3, 2025

Jann, Jeff and me worked at Kath's this weekend, helping her with various tasks to prepare her house for sale. It was quite challenging as the temperature both day's was in the high 30's. We were able to stain the front gates, box up a lot of items for storage, attach timber to cover up gaps on the front porch of the rear property, clean the kitchen, hang a door in the front bedroom and inspect the underneath of the bathroom floor. We achieved a fair bit, but there is still heaps to do. Saied will visit with me on Tuesday to inspect the bathroom and quote to renovate it and Stewart will be pop in on Wednesday to help Kath with support for painting.

Jeff took these photo's of the floorboards under Kath's bathroom.
Saied believes there is water damage but isn't too bad. Good news.

Monday February 3, 2025

The SRL appears to have been infiltrated by BUREAUCATS – rather fat ones. Talk about kitty litter.

Tuesday February 4, 2025

Today Saied acompanied me to Kath's to look at her bathroom and kitchen. He made some recommendations and Kath outlined the scope of her requirements. Saide will now formulate a quote based on this. I am fearful that his quote will be cost prohibitive.

Musical ponderings;
Anyone can make a case for the popular music of their youth. It's something we all feel fiercely protective about. Our youth was unique. Our feelings were deeper. Our profound attachment was more justified. We lived through such a moment as will never be lived through by anyone in quite the same way again.
I made this assertion after I luckily stumbled on the JESUS CHRIST SUPERSTAR two record set at the Kew Salvos. This album was released in 1971 and the role of Jesus was none other than Ian Gillan. This album is a masterpiece and Jann and I have attended three performances of JC Superstar over the years. In the 1992 production, cousin Gary played the role of Herod. Really got the place rockin.

On the way to Kath's today, Paul Cleeland rang me to cancel this afternoon's visit and he did not sound very well. This did not surprise me as Paul had his meeting last Friday with Val, Lara and his doctor to discuss his future. Last week Lara informed me that her Dad was not coming home and that the meeting was to inform him of this. He had always believed that he would be able to return home at some point in the future. How he processes this stark

reality is something we will monitor closely. Truly heartbreaking to witness Paul going through this. We will try and pop in to see him tomorrow. I received this email from Brendan Fraser, following my request for start and end dates for some long term DCI employees, as part of compiling Paul's biography;

Hi Pat,

Yes spoke with Paul today, he does not sound very well, not sure but he mentioned he has started a hunger strike so that they release him from the home?

Paul C 29/4/1966 – 7/7/2006
David 29/11/1974
Bob 24/8/1976 – 21/12/2005
Paul M 30/4/1979
Col 10/11/1980 2/2/2007
Ron 9/7/1984 – 21/3/2012
Ernie 6/1/1986 – 2/2/2007
Wayne 22/3/1993
Myself 29/7/1996
Greg Clarke 15/6/1998 – 20/10/2004

Brendan

Monday February 10, 2025

Yesterday Jann, Jeff, Ryan and I attended "Becoming Led Zeppelin" at Melbourne IMAX. We caught the 207 bus to Lygon Street and had a pleasant Italian lunch. What an extraordinary documentary. Having grown up listening and idolising Led Zeppelin, it was an emotional experience witnessing the genesis of this iconic band. Truly legacy defining. As I have previously mentioned, the Led Zeppelin II album's openining track "Whole Lotta Love" single handedly coverted my musical tastes to the raw power of hard rock – circa 1974. For me it was a cataclysmic shift in musical thinking and appreciation. I was no longer rusted onto pop music.

We were pleasantly surprised to receive a free souvenir book at the cinema.

Monday February 10, 2025

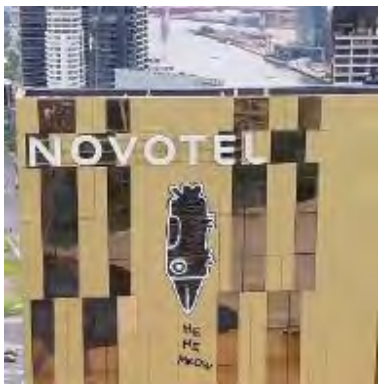
If I was working at DCI, I would have clocked up 39 years service today.

My volunteer work at Carringbush's "English for Everyone" tutoring program resumed today for 2025. I ride my bike to the housing commission towers in Richmond where the tutoring class takes place and when I cross the road from Nicholson Street Abbotsford, across Victoria Street and through Lennox Street, I can't help but think that this spot is ground zero for many "ill at ease" persons who look very much down on their luck. Some individuals are quiet aggressive, swearing and cursing to all and sundry. I witnessed this today. This juncture of Victoria and Lennox Streets is blocked off to traffic (except for bicycles) and is framed by many public bench seats and a small park, thus rendering this pocket as a gathering place. Apart from this I truly love the bike ride.
It should be noted that the drug injecting facility is a mere 200 metres up Lennox Street.

Tuesday February 11, 2025

I don't think those two blokes are on Trump's Christmas card list. Time to roll up your sleeves Albo and perhaps keep Kevin out of sight.

Derryn Hinch was once labelled "The Human Headline".
He has nothing on this bloke. If anything, The Donald personifies American politics in a manner that defines the saying "never a dull moment"
He is signing off executive orders at a rate that may result in him suffering "occupational overuse syndrome".
As an example, the Gulf of Mexico is now The Gulf of America and a tariff has just been imposed on all global steel and aluminium, thus affecting Australia.
Every day we ask the question "what has Donald Trump announced today?".
Talk about upending the status quo. I will watch and log with interest.



Saturday February 15, 2025

I hate graffiti! Across Melbourne a graffiti "artist" has daubed **"Pam the Bird"** on many parts of our city, including trains, buildings and landmarks. Jann and I were stunned to see the bird on the upper section of the NOVOTEL hotel in South Wharf as we drove to Maryborough. Fortunately they have caught the culprit and is currently behind bars, awaiting a court appearance. Now there is a tattooist in Yarraville that is offering free tattoos of Pam the Bird.

Shot tower on the Eastern Freeway and the Flinders Street station clock.

Saturday February 15, 2025

Today we checked into the Pullman Melbourne City Centre for two nights to celebrate Janny's 70th birthday.
We dined at the Blossom Rooftop restaurant which was very memorable.
I gave Janny a Pandora bracelet charm. It contained two hearts, with one inscribed "I fall in love with you every day"

★ ★

I fall in love
with you
every day

★ ★

On Sunday we attended the Comedy Theatre to see "And Then There Were None", an Agatha Christie thriller.

Thursday February 20, 2025

Today we departed for Nusa Dua in Bali, though technically the hotel Grand Mirage is located in Benoa.

Thursday Feb. 20, 2025

IF AFFECTED BY MOTION SICKNESS PLEASE USE THIS BAG

I'm writing my thoughts on this motion sickness bag because I neglected to pack my travel diary. Time to improvise. We are currently on Jetstar flight JQ43 bound for Bali. I am reflecting on all the things that are currently happening in retirement. The rejuvenation of Kath's place continues. We have made good / solid progress and we can now see or visualise how the house will look. It will present quite well when the painting is complete.

Paul Cleeland's bio is continuing well. I think he enjoys my visits as much as I do. It was heartening to see him smile and laugh during my last visit.

Yesterday I met with my fellow biographers at Mannacare - being John and Maureen, together with Normin, Joanne and Deya. I did most of the talking and walked them through a draft process flow of the Mannacare Biography program.

IF AFFECTED BY MOTION SICKNESS PLEASE USE THIS BAG

This was important, as Normin, Joanne and Deya were unfamiliar with the process. It was a very productive meeting. I went home and flow charted the process, then emailed it to John and Maureen for review.

Also, yesterday (Tuesday rather) morning I had a MAKO CT scan and X-Ray on my left knee. Sheree rang me yesterday to schedule a meeting with Nathan White - my surgeon. My biggest fear was that the scans indicated that a full knee replacement was needed. I asked Sheree about this and she replied that at this stage it will be a partial.

We are really looking forward to our stay at the Grand Mirage Nusa Dua. Now signing off at 30,000 feet.

LIFE IS GOOD!

Our stay at the Grand Mirage was surprisingly great. Being all inclusive, we had lovely lunches and dinners with plenty of dining options. I could order as many Bintang's as I wanted and Janny really liked the Bail Comet cocktails. They even restocked the mini bar every day and we had full and free access to it. They had a superb infinity pool which we frequented most days. To the side of the resort, next to the beach was a small, privately owned massage shed and they only charged 100,000 IDR for a one hour full body Balinese massage (about $10 AUD), which is pretty cheap. In Australia you would typically pay between $60 to $80 for a one hour massage. We also indulged in a hotel massage at the Thallaso Spa. Very nice.

Unfortunately on day six of our stay my ears blocked up and I could't hear. I contacted the hotel clinic and arranged for a ear syringe, which did the trick.

Monday February 24, 2025

Another interesting and spectacular sunset in Bali. I took this photo from our balcony, while having a pre-dinner Bintang and listening to Paddy's Ultimate Playlist on Spotify.
The Bali sunsets never disappoint.
It doesn't get much better than that champion.

Saturday March 1, 2025

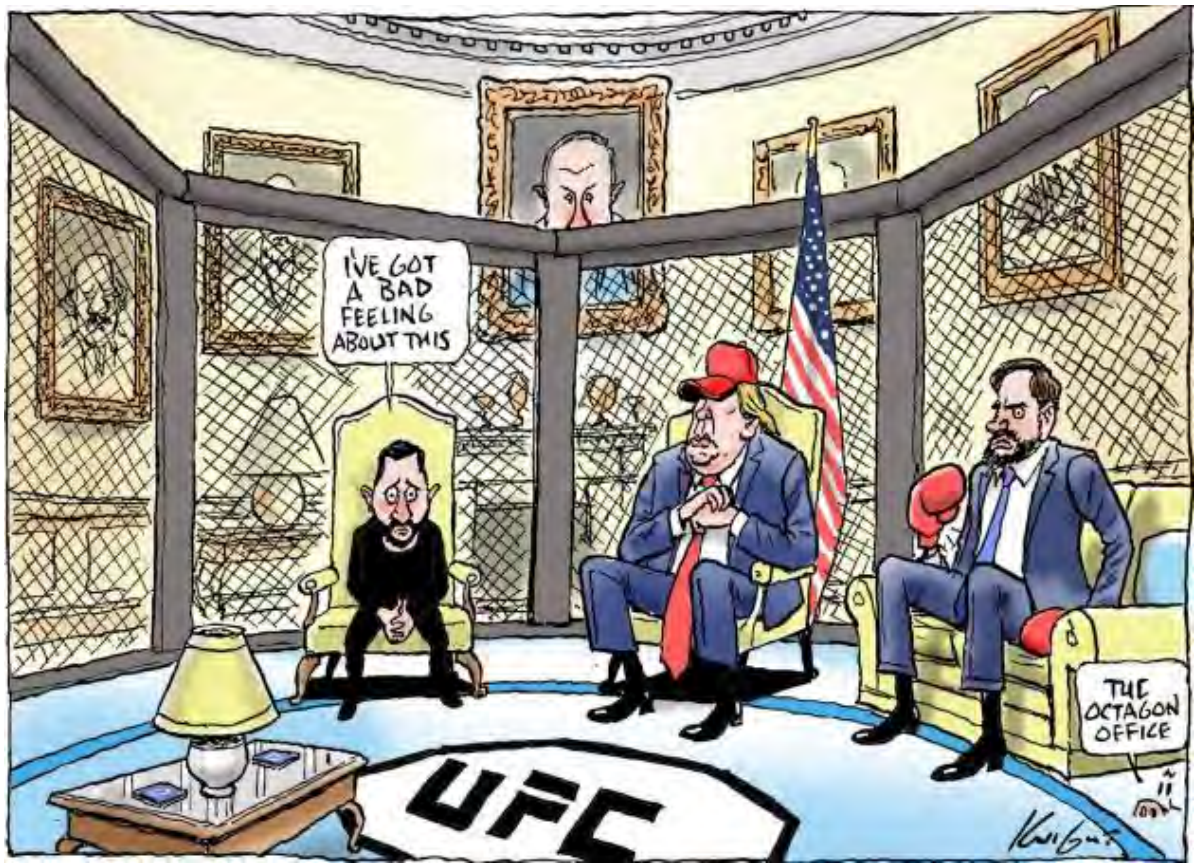
The man tasked with eradicating grafitti from our buildings and other infrastructure is less recognised than Pam The Bird. It's as if this grafitti atrist was giving City of Melbourne Lord Mayor Nick Reece "the bird".
Even his mayoral robe is adorned with Pam - there is no escaping it.
This appeared in this morning's Herald Sun, which focused on the lack of action the newly elected Lord Mayor is accused of. One of the most pressing issues is the removal of grafitti in and around the city.

Monday March 3, 2025

We received our CFC membership packs today.

Here's hoping for a big 2025.

Monday March 3, 2025



N E W W O R L D D I S O R D E R

Tuesday March 4, 2025

Can you believe it! ANORA picks up five academy awards, including best picture and best actress. Let's be frank, half of this movie can only be described as a porno flick. The second half of the movie is entertaining but it was difficult for Jann and I to move past the first half.
How it got an Oscar for best picture is quite baffling.

Thursday March 6, 2025

We spent the day at Kath's continuing work on readying her home for sale. We stained the granny flat decking, laid down pavers and in the evening had a succulent Chinese meal.

Friday March 7, 2025

Today we checked into The Sofitel on Collins Street and had high tea at the Windsor. In the evening we went for a stroll along the Yarra for the Moomba celebrations and scored a free ride on one of the amusements.

FRIDAY MARCH 7, 2025

Melbourne
Melbourne: Weekday Afternoon Tea with Free-Flow French Sparkling at The Windsor
Fri, 7 Mar 2025 • 15:00
Booking confirmed
Booking ID: 9BRDUEVAK-K
Manage booking

Images from my birthday weekend. CFC sent me a birthday email. Brochure from the SOFITEL hotel and our High Tea at 111 Spring Street in the Windsor Hotel.

Tuesday March 11, 2025

Jeff recently returned from Canberra and spent time with Pat Cormick. They stumbled onto a conversation about vinyl records and Pat proceeded to grab out of storage two crates of records. He was keen to give Jeff some of his records and one for me, which was OZ – A Rock "N" Roll Road Movie, featuring Ross Wilson, Graham Matters and Joe Camelleri. Absolutely splendid.

I sent an email to Pat thanking him for the record.

G'day Pat,

I hope you are well. Just caught up with Jeff and he handed me a vinyl record of Oz – A Rock "N" Roll Road Movie. I was delighted to receive it and I can't thank you enough for it. One of my retirement goals was to reconnect with my vinyls records which I had in storage. I am thoroughly enjoying this pastime and I really enjoy popping into record shops and finding gems, such as from artists Brian Cadd, Sherbet, The Dingoes, Joe Cocker, Mike Oldfield and the original UK vinyl release of Jesus Christ Superstar. As can be seen from the attached photo, I have set up my music station with shelving from IKEA and a new turntable and CD player. The picture frames are from JB Hi-Fi and you can slot in records at will. When it comes to

vinyl, for me it's not just the music I looked forward to, but also the album cover artwork - and who doesn't like a bi-fold album cover. And the Oz album is a bi-fold! This album has some pretty handy OZ rockers in Ross Wilson, Graham Matters and Joe Camelleri.

So again thanks for the record - it will take pride of place in my collection.
Give our love to Robyn.

All the best,
Cheers,
Paddy

On another matter, my knee surgeon has confirmed that I require a total knee replacement ilo a partial, which is what I was fearing. However I have been experiencing knee pain on the other side of the knee, particularly when I am cycling. When I think about it, it makes sense to have a total, as I don't want to have a partial, only to return to the surgeon twelve months later with lingering knee pain and having to replace the partial with a total knee replacement.

Friday March 14, 2025

After being 41 points up at one stage, Carlton did everything within its power to succumb to Richmond, finally losing by 13 points. Our team looked every bit the same as last year. To quote "The Who" - "Meet the new team.....same as the old team". There was absolutely nothing that gave me any indication that we can take it up to the good sides of the competition. We are light years away from playing a brand of football that is comparable with GWS, Hawthorn or Brisbane. Even compiling our 41 point lead was unimpressive. It's gonna be a long, painful season! And to makes things worse, we play Hawthorn next Thursday.

Tuesday March 18, 2025

This morning I attended the Carringbush 40th Birthday celebration, held at their new location at 108 Elizabeth Street, Richmond. There was this lovely feeling and sense of community. It was a gorgeous sunny morning, plenty of food, a coffee cart and was very well attended.

Friday March 21, 2025

Not sure what impact all this will have on Australia, but I fear it will not end well.
An unreliable ally.

Donald Trump, the self-proclaimed super negotiator has been played like a violin by Putin. After boasting he would end the Ukraine-Russian war in a day, Trump is not even close to ending the bloodshed rained on Ukraine by a brutal Russian dictator.
Perhaps Trump needs to call Putin's bluff by supplying Ukraine with air support and long range missiles that would give the Russian regime a taste of its own medicine.

Meanwhile, as I await for my knee replacement at St Vincents East Melbourne this Monday, my affected knee is becoming more painful and troublesome. It's as if my knee knows that the end is near.
Today I commenced preparation for my surgery, beginning with applying the Mulpirocin nasal ointment into my nose. On Sunday I commence preparing my skin for surgery using chlorhexidine gluconate skin cleanser.

Friday thought;
When we get to the end of our lives together,
the home we had, the cars we drove, the investments we made, the LP records and footy records
we collected won't matter.
What will matter is that I had you and you had me.

. . .

Saturday March 22, 2025

> Out of control law and order, along with punishing property taxes, should be the political death of this Premier

Clock's ticking for Allen… can't come quick enough.

With all these issues confronting Victorians, including the worst youth crime crisis in history, the building of a multi-billion dollar train line that no-one wants, a tobacco war, rampant corruption in the building industry and a bankrupt economy, what really worries me is that she and her band of incompetent ministers will be re-elected!

Blues' woes exposed

NIGHTMARE SCENARIO LOOMS FOR MICHAEL VOSS AS LIST HOLES LAID BARE

Eighteen months ago, Carlton played the most electric 30 minutes of football in recent memory, blitzing Brisbane in the opening quarter of the preliminary final at the Gabba, before being reeled in. Carlton was supposed to bounce off that disappointment, reload with the mouth-watering Charlie Curnow-Harry McKay forward combination as its premiership window had been thrown wide open.

Instead, the Blues have headed in the opposite direction and, on the evidence of the opening two rounds, seem to be going backwards at a rate of knots.

What is Carlton's game plan? We have no system or structure up forward. We continually bomb it into the forward line and hope for the best. Our back line continually look confused. The only player who can run and carry the ball with speed is Adam Saad – one player! These woes we apparent last year. What has the Carlton brains trust done to overcome these shortfalls? Clearly nothing.

Monday March 24, 2025

Today I was admitted into hospital for my total knee replacement. I have completed all my pre-operation directives and I'm ready to go.

Tuesday March 25, 2025

I am in my hospital room #220 on the second level of St Vincents East Melbourne. I had my total knee replacement yesterday with Dr. Nathan White overseeing proceedings. I made sure that I followed – to the letter of the law – all skin and nasal applications to mitigate any risk of infection. I have had two physio sessions with Aaron. I am feeling some discomfort but not a lot of pain. Had a restless night. Today I have spoken to Stewie, Johnny and Helen and Nevil. Apparently, tomorrow can be a challenging day pain wise, as the anaesthetic dissipates – we will see. Janny came in at 10.00am and it was lovely seeing her face. It is now time to continue my physical therapy, but I am not allowed to overdo it – abbreviated to PT, but I'm sure PT stands for pain and torture.

Wednesday March 26, 2025

Woke up this morning, tuned into 3AW and started my physio/rehab instructions. Bending the leg up while laying down, I feel significant pain through the thigh. I will endeavour to do walking on the crutches every hour. My physio has contacted BUPA to arrange for physio home visits, which will be handy and convenient. I have never in my life taken so many different tablets. I am currently feeling light headed because of the cocktail of medicine I have consumed.

Presently, as at 10.07am, I feel that I am a long way off getting that flexibility or bend in my leg. This morning I ditched the hospital gown for shorts and a tee shirt. Made me feel a lot better. Janny is on her way. A lovely warm face that I am looking forward to seeing. I am taking plenty of walks on my crutches.

Today I had a visit from Loui, my English student and Gloria, my VTS co-ordinator.

My discharge time tomorrow is 9.30am. Bending my knee is quite challenging. I feel pain at the top of my knee and into the thigh.

. . .

Wednesday April 2, 2025

My physio programme continues and Amy, the BUPA physiotherapist, conducted her first visit with me at home. She was very reassuring and commented that my rehab is well advanced. She measured the angle at which my leg could bend at 95° which was very good. I felt that all the work that I had done had been validated.

The AEC sent me two emails confirming employment positions for the forthcoming federal election, slated for May 3. I rang Mia at the AEC, and explained that I would be a no-show due to my knee surgery. She said that she would keep the door ajar in the event that I felt up to participating. I thanked her for this.

Thursday April 3, 2025

L I B E R A T I O N D A Y

Australian commodities, pharmaceutical and beef exporters have been hit with tarriffs of 10 percent after US President Donald Trump announced his new tariff plans today.
Dubbed by the US President as "Liberation Day" for America and "Make America Wealthy Again", he said all countries would face a baseline tariff of 10 percent.
In a list of countries, Australia was 21st with a reciprocal tax, while China faces 34 percent and Vietman 46 percent. In that regard, Australia was let off lightly.
"If you want your tariff to be zero, then you build your product right here in America", he told foreign countries.

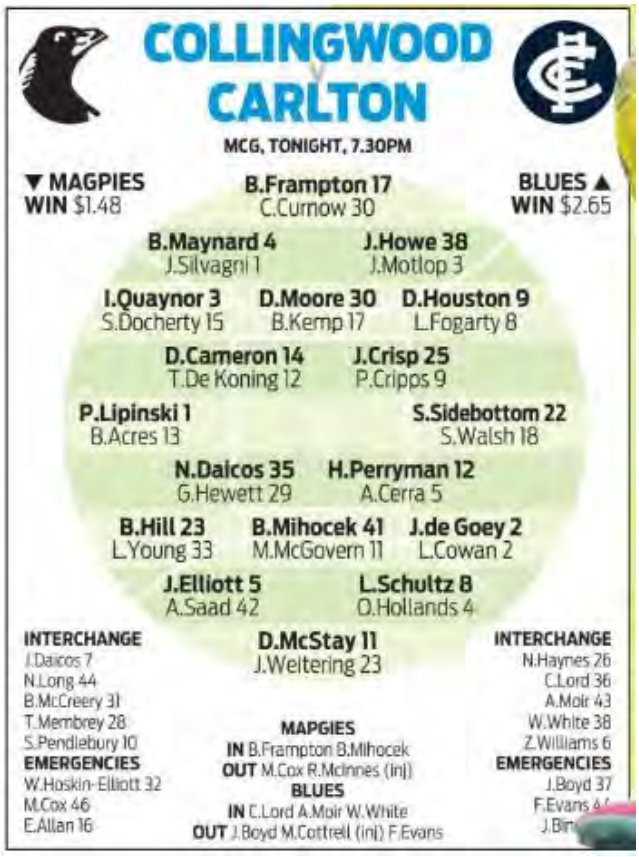
Meanwhile.....a federal election campaign is well underway and Jacinta Allen's state Labor government is so much on the nose that the federal Labor campaign is keeping its distance from our Premier.

Albo would be wise to give Jacinta Allen a wide berth.

Last week Peter Jordan, Monique Ryan's husband, was filmed taking down an Amelia Hamer campaign poster in Camberwell. Both have apologised. The Lib's, always looking for an opportunity, placed these posters adjacent to Amelia's posters.

Thursday April 3, 2025

Tonight the Blues take on traditional rivals Collingwood at the "G". Again Harry McKay has been omitted, due to personal issues. Maybe he is suffering from "performance anxiety", which was a topic of discussion in this morning's AGE.
When Jeff and I attended Carlton's final training hit out before the season proper on March 9, we noticed that Harry McKay wasn't actively participating in the training drills. He was kind of dawdling behind the goals with a footy in his hands. Come game one against Richmond, he had a set shot 20 metres in front of goal and chose to kick around his body....signs of a man lacking confidence. Likewise, perhaps we should also spare a thought for his twin brother Ben, who is copping heaps from the Essendon faithful.



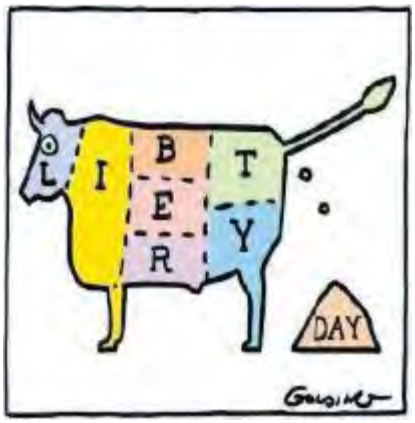
Friday April 4, 2025

As expected, the Blues lost to Collingwood last night to stretch their losing streak to four. Yet another second half fade out. We again led the Pies at half time.
The heading on the back page of the Herald Sun read DEJA BLUES.
I texted Jeff "Another second half fade out. Wer'e buggered now. Zip and 4. We'll struggle against West Coast next week. Jeff's response: DISASTER.
In the meantime, my knee rehab program continues. I am trying to walk up and down our stairs one foot at a time, which is really challenging. It's all about increasing the angle with which my leg can bend. This is recovery day eleven.

Friday April 4, 2025

‘Not a friend’: Trump points steak at heart of long alliance

America faces a recession and a global slowdown that could force the Reserve Bank to cut interest rates within weeks after President Donald Trump upended 60 years of free trade by imposing sweeping tariffs. Our beef exports to the US has been hit with a 10 percent tariff. The ASX and global markets have plunged on Liberation Day.

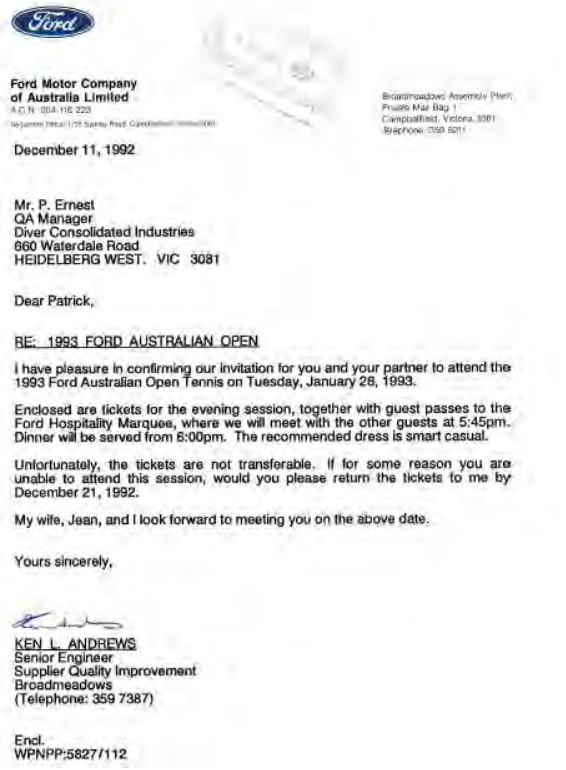


Lady Liberty has had a makeover. So has world trade.
Countries have to "bend a knee" to the Emperor.

Trump’s wild war on trade

Saturday April 5, 2025

Ford marks a proud 100 years in Australia



Ford Motor Company
of Australia Limited
A.C.N. 004 116 223

Broadmeadows Assembly Plant
Private Mail Bag 1
Campbellfield, Victoria, 3061
Telephone: 359 8211

December 11, 1992

Mr. P. Ernest
QA Manager
Diver Consolidated Industries
660 Waterdale Road
HEIDELBERG WEST. VIC 3081

Dear Patrick,

RE: 1993 FORD AUSTRALIAN OPEN

I have pleasure in confirming our invitation for you and your partner to attend the 1993 Ford Australian Open Tennis on Tuesday, January 26, 1993.

Enclosed are tickets for the evening session, together with guest passes to the Ford Hospitality Marquee, where we will meet with the other guests at 5:45pm. Dinner will be served from 6:00pm. The recommended dress is smart casual.

Unfortunately, the tickets are not transferable. If for some reason you are unable to attend this session, would you please return the tickets to me by December 21, 1992.

My wife, Jean, and I look forward to meeting you on the above date.

Yours sincerely,

KEN L. ANDREWS
Senior Engineer
Supplier Quality Improvement
Broadmeadows
(Telephone: 359 7387)

Encl.
WPNPP:5827/112

Ford Australia was an important part of my career development during my years at Diver Consolidated. They were the industry leaders in the area's of quality control and assurance, risk management and environmental committment. It was my role to manage these business systems and Ford were always supportive with training and development programs. DCI were a major supplier to Ford and in fact were Ford's largest hardware supplier. Although I was not employed directly by Ford Australia, they were an important and significant part of my long and successful tenure at DCI. It's always difficult to get my head around the sad fact that we no longer build cars in Australia.

This afternoon Jann and I will be visiting Martin and Teena so I can borrow Martin's mini exercise bike, to help me with my knee rahabilatation,

Monday April 7, 2025

Today marks the two week mark in my recovery from knee surgery on March 24. Each day I can feel an improvement in my knee flexibility and I can now easily walk without crutches. I can now navigate the stairs with confidence.

My reading journey of "Captain Fantastic – Elton John in the 1970's" continues and I'm at that seminal point in the book where Elton and Bernie create Goodbye Yellow Brick Road in 1973.

Ian Beck's artwork cover was of a guy gazing wistfully at a poster on a wall and the idea….sort of epiphany….just gelled. The concept developed a vivid graphic of Elton on a run down city pavement stepping, with platform boots the color of Judy Garland's ruby slippers, into a poster of Oz.

It depicted someone magically passing from a drab environment into a brighter otherworld. As a visual metaphor, it perfectly captured in one colorful image everything Elton experienced in the past four years.

In my opinion this album cover captures, more than any other, the glorious artistic expression that we came to expect with album releases. It's tri-fold artwork gives each song its own unique character. Elton was, at this point in time, at the top of his game both musically and artistically.

Tuesday April 8, 2025

Jann and I are heading to MannaCare today for our annual flu vaccine jab.

MARKET MELTDOWN

Meanwhile, global markets are in free fall as Trump's tariff's start to bite. The main reason for this is the world is extremly worried about the fact that one very unpredictable man has so much influence on world markets. The ASX has plunged 11 percent and who knows what the markets will do today.

The price you pay for earning long-term life changing compound gains is having to stomach short-term uncertainty.

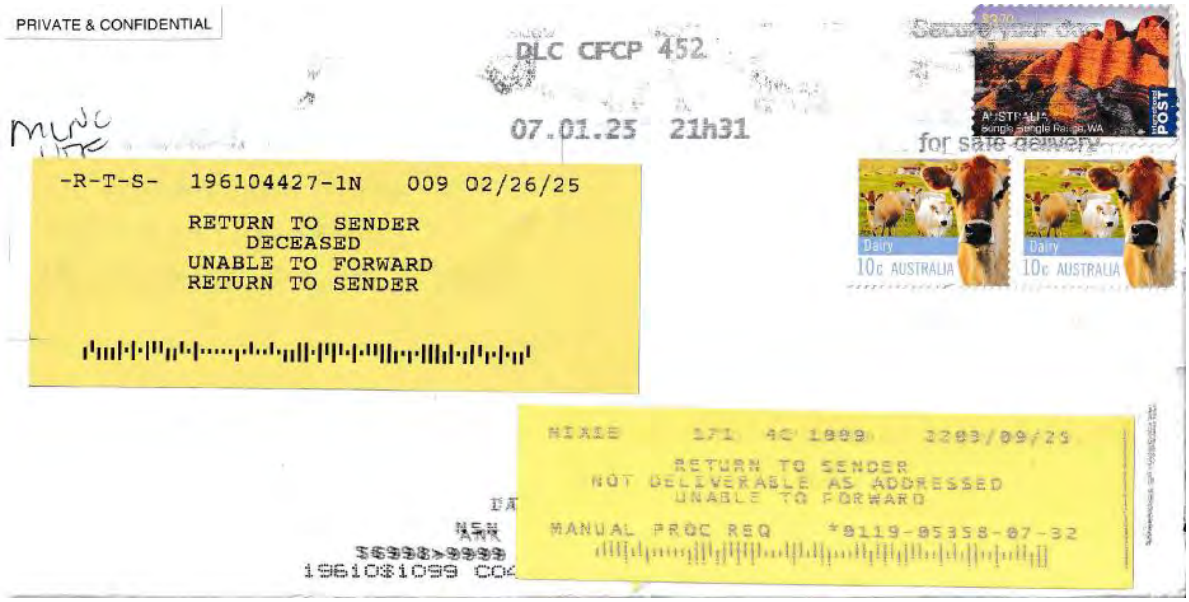
so much for THE ART OF THE DEAL

Trump is making sure the world's attention is firmly glued on him, like a toddler chucking a tantrum.

Why are world markets in meltdown?
In simple terms, it's because investors around the world, and in particular in the US, where almost 80 percent of the US $13.8bn of "wealth destruction" has occurred, no longer believe that Donald Trump's policies will "Make America Great Again". It has now dawned on investors that there are no "wise heads" in or around the White House.

Wednesday April 9, 2025

On the 4th of January this year I sent the letter below to Dr. Robert Forry (see page 215). His father, Norman, would have been my father's half-brother. I received the said letter in the mail today. Marked "RETURN TO SENDER – DECEASED". It had not been opened.



Monday April 14, 2025

Today is day 21 since I had my knee surgery and I am experiencing significant pain. Mind you, I am pushing it hard with my rehab program, Perhaps I should back it off. Yesterday I had an extended session in the gym.
Yesterday Jeff showed me the LP records that Pat Cormick gifted him. I saw Bob Dylan's Greatest Hits, Mighty Kong (later to become Daddy Cool), Masters Apprentices, Santana's Greatest Hits and Mike Oldfield's Tubular Bells, among others. A nice package of records.

Tuesday April 15, 2025

Helen Mefflin is currently recovering from hup surgery, so to help her manage the pain, she is helping me with enquiries relating to the Forry family, as she is aware of my returned letter to Robert Forry.
The following was in Helen's email this morning;

Hi Paddy
Tried doing more research on the Forry trying to find something different and decided to go thru sections of the army.
Hopefully if this is not the correct one they will know someone who can direct me.
Now hoping you don't mind I put your name as it made sense as it's your grandfather who we are trying to
get a photo of for you. Below is what 1 sent so just want to keep you in the loop and researching is helping me with pain control.
I also found a young Edward Forry your cousin. Back row with glasses.
Still waiting on others to answer but decided distant families get wary more likely to get answers from the army. Fingers crossed.
Regards Helen

"MEN OF THE FUTURE." Left to right, FIRST ROW: Douglas Moyer, Frank Pellegrini, Scott Baum, Harry Tobias, Daniel Podgurski, Jerry Schoener, Ronald Schreiner, George Vogel, Richard Waldbiesser, Robert Clouser, Gary Rubright. SECOND ROW: Larry Graeff, Royce Gernert, David Weyandt, Bradford Schaadt, Edward Forry, Leonard Weckel, David Kegerise, Dennis Fronheiser, Robert Klein.

I think Edward is in the back row, second from the left.

Hello
My name is Paddy Ernest and 1 am writing to you from Australia.
I have grown up knowing very little about my grandfather Private William Franklin Forry.
Until doing research and learning a little about him as 1 knew nothing. I would dearly like a
photo /photos of him in the Army or anything that you can share 1 would be eternally grateful.
Just to be able to put a face to the man 1 have researched and gotten to know a little would be priceless.

I am after information about my grandfather Private William Franklin Forry.
Born 22 2/1893 and died 30/12/1957 in Reading PA America.

He lived at 605 Penn Ave after being married and inherited property from his grandfather.

He went to war in Dec 1917 and left America on the Carmania was returned to America on 30 Dec 1918 on the ship Adriatic that left from Liverpool on the 1/12/1918.

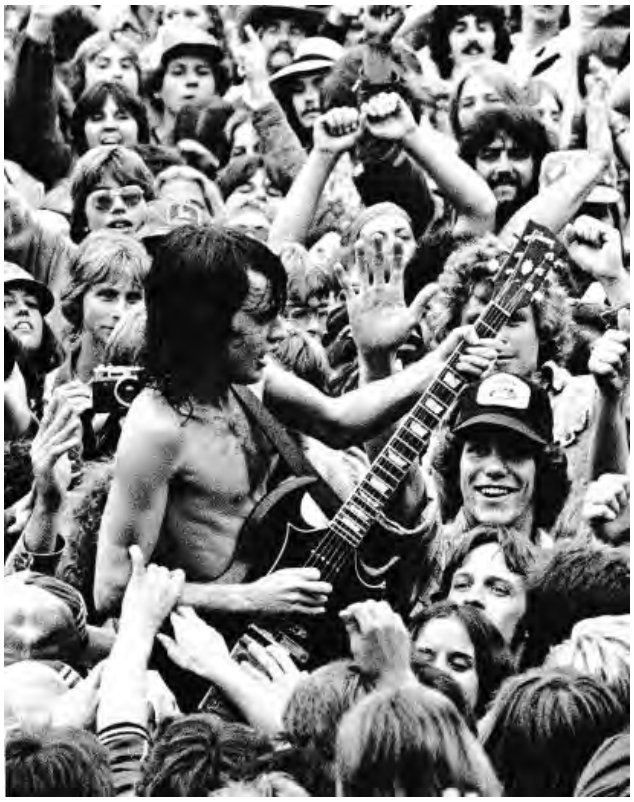
He was in the 377 Aero Squadron. This is stated on his grave stone. And l believe was in 832 aero squadron at the start.
I believe it was at Cook Garden City, Long Island New York when discharged on 3/5/1918.
If you can email whatever information and photos you have is so very much appreciated just to put a face to
my grandfather and know my history would be a blessing.
Or if l am not at the right place please let me know where l can get some information. Here in Australia there is a website
that l can get info but America is so large not sure where to go. Any assistance is appreciated.
Regards
Paddy Ernest

Sunday April 20, 2025

I read with interest this one page message in the Sunday Herald Sun. It was sponsored by a consortium of media outlets, including Seven West and NewsCorp. It's primary message is *So when we see hate, we do not look the other way. We say, NO, not here!* It's a sad indictment that here in our wonderful country, we need full page ad's like this to get a message across that should be patently obvious.

Tuesday April 22, 2025

It is now day 28 since my knee surgery. Whilst my rehab is progressing well, the pain and swelling is still apparent and I continue to take pain relief.



Tuesday April 22, 2025

Reading the Classic Rock magazine, I came across this superb photo of a youthfull Angus Young, shrouded within a high voltage mosh pit of adoring fans. A definitive photo of an Aussie guitar legend at the top of his game.

Celebrating 50 years of high voltage rock 'n' roll – half a century of riffs, rambunctiousness, schoolboy uniforms and some of the greatest hard rock ever created.

LET THERE BE ROCK!

From Angus to Francis…….

VALE POPE FRANCIS – the Pope of the people

Wednesday April 23, 2025

Today Janny and I voted at the Kooyong Pre Poll Centre in High Street, Kew which was the former Australia Post shop.

Thursday April 24, 2025

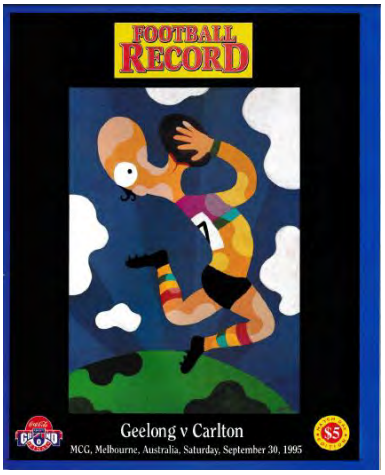
Today I downloaded the latest Dream Theater album on Spotify - PARASOMNIA. It celebrates their 40th anniversary and this is their their sixteenth studio album. It also features the return of Mike Portnoy on drums, and boy can you feel his presence. This album is an epic 71 minute adventure that lives up to its title, which describes disruptive, sleep related disturbances including sleepwalking, sleep paralysis and night terrors. Again, glorious album cover artwork.

I am still experiencing pain in my knee post surgery while I approach the 5 week mark. There is also an uncomfortable clicking sound from the knee cap. I then contacted my surgeon's office to bring forward my next appointment to Monday April 28th.

Friday April 25, 2025

. . .

Sunday April 27, 2025



1995 Grand Final
Football Record

McKay makes spectacular return

Cats' charge too late as Blues ice win

A great win by the Blues. This was a statement match against premiership fancies Geelong with an upset 18 point win.
This game also saw the Blues celebrate the 30 year anniversary of the 1995 premiership win. Seems like an eternity.

Carlton stun the Cats to continue season resurgence

Monday April 28, 2025

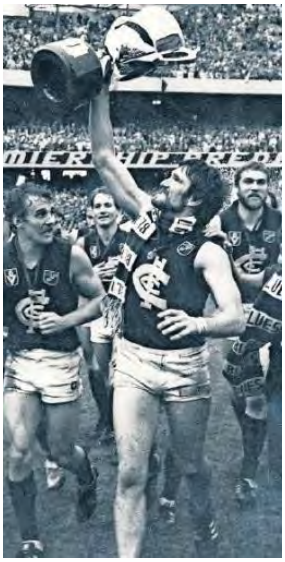
At 4.38pm today Val Cleeland rang me to discuss Paul. I mentioned to her that Paul had put off tomorrow's visit, as he had taken a fall and had sore knees. Val then outlined to me, quite candidly, the challenges being presented by Paul as he comes to terms with being a resident at Blue Cross. You could feel the frustration and emotion in her voice. I said to Val that I fully understood the reasoning behind her and Lara's decision to place Paul into care and reiterated that it is not my job to judge, but to help Paul with his life story and provide him with company, thus making his residency a little bit more tolerable. Jann and I really love and respect Val, and it was nice to hear her voice. I asked Val for Lara's number and then had a lengthy chat with Lara about Paul. I also thanked Lara for the photos she sent me and that many have been inserted into Paul's book, together with a new chapter at the end of the book for a photo gallery. A lot of what Val and Lara confided with me was of a highly personal nature and I am grateful for their forthrightness. We really feel for Val and Lara, as they are in a difficult predicament. Mind you, Paul's situation or quandary is also very challenging for him. He was always such a go-getter and was never still for very long. I can only hope and pray that Paul will wake up one morning and realise that his accomodation is the best thing for him and that he resolves to make his residency the best it could possibly be. Perhaps, in some small way, my weekly visits may help him reach a happy disposition within Blue Cross.

Tuesday April 29, 2025

Boomers can teach us all a thing or two about gratitude

It's easy to forget to appreciate what we have. Gratitude doesn't always come naturally in a world built for rushing, scrolling and comparing, but I've found that people who lived the longest often see the most clearly. That quiet, deliberate optimism is something that I need to carry with me to my grave.

Today I resumed my tutoring with Loui in his Kew home, post knee surgery.



Peter Busustow was flamboyant, outrageously talented and utterly Carlton. Busustow had a confidence and swagger that marked him as a Carlton player before he arrived at Princes Park in the summer of 1980. His father, Bob Busustow, played 20 games for the Blues in the 1950's.
In early 1981, Jeff and I travelled to Glenferrie Oval to watch Carlton play Hawthorn in a practice game. We left that game enthusing about two new players who left an indelible mark on us – they were Ken Hunter and Peter Busustow. We won the flag that year, and the year after, and these two players were pivotal in our successes.
Peter Busustow was "mercurial" and had a real presence. He won goal and mark of the year in 1981.

VALE PETER "BUZZ" BUSUSTOW

....and don't forget the former leader of the Liberal Party and Foreign Minister under Malcolm Fraser, the Colt From Kooyong, Andrew Peacock.
It's all happening in Kooyong – Tower Hotel in the background.

Wednesday April 30, 2025

Fifty years ago - The fall of Saigon. The Viet Cong tanks smashed through the presidential palace gates and a mass evacuation commenced.

MIDNIGHT MESSIAH - PARASOMNIA
strange déjà vu
it's calling me back to my home
this dying soul

Thursday May 1, 2025

Whilst Jann and I were in Northcote, we popped into Dixon's record shop and I spotted these two reasonably priced Elton John records. Caribou has always had a special place in my musical journey and Don't Shoot Me" is an album I have not heard but read about it in the book "Captain Fantastic".
As their friendship developed, Elton often found himself impaled on the sharp end of Groucho's jokes. One night, laughing but exasperated, Elton held up his hands in mock surrender. "Don't shoot me," he protested, "I'm only the piano player."
Elton thought to himself, that's a good line. He stored it away for later.

Jann and I decided to have a coffee and lunch at Ferguson Plarre in the Northcote Plaza. A little old lady made her way to the table adjacent to us. She was to a certain extent hunched over and her well worn shopping trolley was helping her to walk. Her clothes were somewhat tatty and she has substantial chin hairs. She purchased a cappucino and a cookie. She didn't quite finish the cookie and in an orderly and fastidious fashion wrapped the remaining portion into a serviette and placed it in her trolley. By this stage Jann was at the counter ordering our cappucino's and a custard tart. Then a shop assistant from Ferguson Plarre approached the elderly woman, presented her with a full size tea cake and said that a customer had bought it for her. A very kind gesture. I wonder who the benevolent customer was?

Important day for democracy

Saturday May 3, 2025

Early this morning I drove Janny to the Willsmere Road Kew Polling Centre to work as a Polling Officer. Upon arriving I was stunned by the amount of Monique Ryan Teal placards surrounding the voting centre. It was absolutely ridiculous. There needs to be some level of control over political party advertising around voting centres. All it does is create torment and angst among the party volunteers. I also believe the number of volunteers should also be scaled back. You virtually have to run the gauntlet through these highly excitable and sometimes willing and vocal individuals.

Which election?....the State election next year!

Sunday May the 4th be with you, 2025

DUTTON DROWNS IN A RED WAVE

ALBO-EASY

This election embodies a significant shift in the way we perceive the Liberal Party. I'm not sure what they represent anymore and their ideologies are simply not cutting it with the greater electorate. We rusted on Baby Boomer Liberal voters are being cast aside by the demigraphic cohorts that followed us. Our aspirations are now deemed irrelevant. The Lib's have been decimated by Labor, to the point where I wouldn't be surprised if Jacinta's dodgy Labor party in Victoria is voted back in next year.

Sunday May 4, 2025

Meanwhile, the trial of the mushroom cook, Erin Patterson, continues in the Supreme Court in Morwell. Surprisingly, the prosecution will not attempt to prove a motive, and do not have to. The battleground of this trial is intent. The question for the jury is, did Ms Patterson deliberately set out to commit murder? Or was it a horrific mistake? One thing is becoming apparent – Erin Patterson has a propensity to tell lies.

Monday May 5, 2025

Yesterday our email account was hacked and a dodgy email sent to everyone in our contact list. We have been inundated with emails from all and sundry responding to and ringing me about the email, including Pat Cormick, Mary Dearing and Dr. Nicolette Snowdon. To make things worse, we were shut out of our Bigpond account and could not access our emails. First thing this morning Janny and I travelled to the Telstra shop in Northland and re-established our Bigpond account. They were very helpful. I then emailed all the affected contacts to confirm that we had been hacked and to ignore the dubious email.

I am now at the 6 week mark from my knee replacement surgery. The pundits have claimed that knee pain should subside between the 4 and 6 week mark. I can now say that my pain has receded and I am sleeping comfortably and on my side. There still exists are fair amount of discomfort, but his can be managed without too much drama. Last Saturday I did a trial bike ride on my hybrid Shogun bike and had no trouble scaling the Wiltshire Drive hill. Happy days ahead.

Today I resumed English tutoring with the English for Everyone group at Elizabeth Street Richmond, following my knee surgery. Elly was absent so I supported Tracy for the session. It was good to be back in this classroom.

Thursday May 8, 2025

At this present time, 133 Cardinals have locked themselves away in the Sistine Chapel to commence the papal conclave and elect a new Pope. This morning, black smoke billowed out of the Sistine Chapel's chimney, indicating that a result has not been reached.

The holy hush is preceded by an unholy scramble.

Friday May 9, 2025

White smoke emerged from the chimney of the Sistine Chapel, signalling a new Pope had been chosen this morning.
Pope Leo XIV – or Cardinal Robert Prevost becomes the 267th Pope. He is an American pontiff, who was born in the south side of Chicago. There's a song in that.

Popes have always been referred to in Roman numerals. This made me think of my birth year, 1962, in Roman numerals.

MCMLXII

Saturday May 10, 2025

Election credit just delusional

Our illustrious Premier, Jacinta Allen, pulled on her trusty white hard hat and orange hi-viz vest and with a straight face boasted her pet project, the SRL, was a "key reason" that federal Labor won seats in Victoria. She said this with a straight face in one of the biggest gaslighting attacks on the Victorian public ever seen.
Allen appeared not to realise – or is even fooling herself – that standing at a dormant tunneling site bragging about how the SRL helped win the federal election was so insulting, it was simply delusional.

In Trump We Trust.....heaven forbid

Sunday May 11, 2025

While driving to Albert Park, Janny and I made an unscheduled stop into DUTCH Vinyl in Johnstone Street Abbotsford and we stumbled on these three albums in the $10 each collection. All three albums played perfectly and were original releases, with some record cover imperfections, which I don't really mind.

Monday May 12, 2025

I am now at week 7 of my knee rehabiltation. I am still having knee pain. My goal is to resume bike riding, and will ride my bike to Carringbush Adult Learning in Richmond today. If that goes well, I will ride to Loui's home and then to Ivanhoe Grand tomorrow. Blue Cross is now badged as Ivanhoe Grand.

Wednesday, May 14, 2025

Today Jann and I are taking in the matinee session of Jesus Christ Superstar at the Princess Theatre. We have been long term fans and devotees of JC Superstar and our attachment to this, the greatest of all rock operas, spans all the way back to 1973. Janny attended the stage version in 1973 and I distinctly remember the songs released in this period such as "Everything's Alright" and "I Don't Know How to Love Him".
I guess The Greatest Story Ever Told deserves the greatest rock opera ever conceived.

In 1992, a huge Australian concert performance of Jesus Christ Superstar emerged and Janny and I of course attended this at The Tennis Centre - made all the more special by the appearance of Gary as King Herod. The cast recorded and released the 1992 AUSTRALIAN CAST RECORDING HIGHLIGHTS. In my opinion no cast recording is better. John Farnham had the lead role as Jesus - say no more. When you play Herod's Song, it's best to just crank it up!

"Show me there's a reason for you wanting me to die
You're far too keen on where and how and not so hot on why"

GETHSEMANE
(I Only Want To Say)

Jesus Christ Superstar was again released in Australia in 2013. This reimagined arena tour production was very impressive, with Tim Minchin palying the role of Judas. We took Kath to see this and it was at Rod Laver Arena.

The show was set in an a gritty urban landscape, highlighting the struggles of modern day youth. It was a modern edge and focused on recent riots in London and across the country – of total anarchy and an angry mob, with centurions replaced by riot police.

As for today's showing at the Princess Theatre, another superb performance. Perhaps I'm getting old and reflective, but I found the performance very moving and emotional. I was moved to tears on a number of occasions.

Thursday May 15, 2025

WHAT'S THE BUZZ? – TELL ME WHAT'S HAPPENING

I'm lying in bed following breakfast and after a restless night with knee pain and it is 7.40am. My ears focus on the morning rush hour buzz of traffic clogging our arterial roads – motorists desperately endeavouring to get to work or appointments on time. Suddenly, this traffic humm is perforated by the roar of gas igniting flames into hovering hot air baloons, drifting above Willsmere.

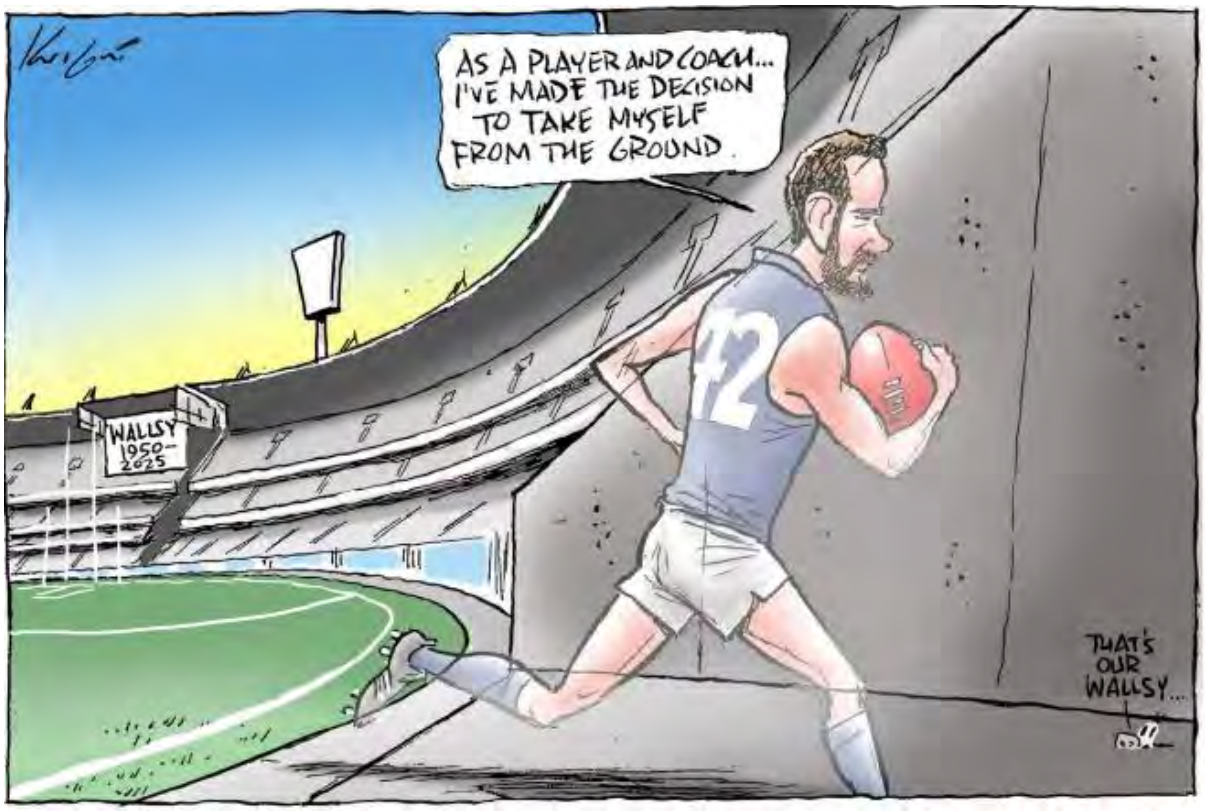
AFL world in mourning over the death of a
Carlton legend

Blues great and AFL Hall of Famer, Robert Walls, has passed away, aged 74, choosing vouluntary assisted dying over a second round of gruelling cancer treatment.

Wallsy was a great Carlton man and I for one am grateful for him delivering the 1987 premiership as coach. He played in three Carlton premierships – 1968, 1970 and 1972.

VALE ROBBIE WALLS
1950 ~ 2025

Friday May 16, 2025



Wallsy decided to check out on his own terms. He met with Mike Sheehan last Saturday for a coffee and to say goodbye, and as Wallsy thanked him for the coffee, he said "I'll get 'em next time" and smiled.

Robert Walls did it all in our great game, never compromised, and benefited all he touched

Wednesday May 21, 2025

Tonight, Janny and I attended Les Miserables at Rod Laver Arena. A very good musical and story. Visually very impressive.

. . .

Thursday May 22, 2025

The best way to find yourself is
to lose yourself in the service of others

MAHATMA GHANDI

This morning I attended Grevillia House's Mens Group and I gave a presentation about Mauritius. I also took part in general discussions on current affairs and was ably assisted by Kellie and Greg. They kindly asked me to stay for lunch. Janny popped in to The Lodge and did her rounds visiting residents. Following this I visited Cassia House and picked up John Benko's photo's - kindly left by Lesley, his wife. I can now complete his biography. I then proceeded to The Lodge, met with Janny and we visited Judy Smith and had a chat with her.

In the afternoon, we attended the MannaCare Volunteer's afternoon tea at Grevillia House, where we connected with Normin and my fellow biographer Maureen Bowman. Certificates of Appreciation and Years of Service certificates were presented and we then indulged in afternoon tea. I received my 5 Year certificate.

Perhaps I am finding myself in the service of others. There is a warm, calming and rewarding feeling that comes with my volunteering pursuits.

Group photo of the Volunteers at MannaCare.
Thursday, May 22, 2025

Monday May 26, 2025

A Monday reflection….

There's been a lot of discussion about the new tax on superannuation accounts over $3M, specifically that its unindexed and that you pay it from unrealised capital gains. Imagine paying, for example, $100 each for BHP shares and then they jump up to $150. You pay tax on the gain, even though you haven't sold the shares. What happens if the shares fall back to $100? Does the ATO give you a refund on what you have paid?
Labor have never made any secret about their hatred of self-managed super funds. Every dollar in an SMSF is one less dollar paying fees to the Labor/Union dominated industry super funds. I suspect this hatred extends to retail superannuation funds as well.

I am now at the 9 Week stage of my knee recovery. I continue to experience knee pain and discomfort. I suspect that this will continue for many weeks to come and will extend into our holiday in Bali, commencing June 14.

I have started the "white diet" for my colonoscopy on Wednesday. Tomorrow I am scheduled to have a CT Chest scan to monitor opacity on the lung - hopefully it is not increasing in size.

Wednesday May 28, 2025

This morning I had my third colonoscopy in seven months. This one was to check whether the large caecal polyp, which was removed last December, had returned.
"Conclusion: No evidence of recurrence at caesal EMR scar." A good result.
My surgeon, Dr. Jonathan Tan, insists that his patients use a bowel preparation product called PLENVU. It is seriously horrible stuff. Dr. Tan has now referred me back to Dr. Ed Shelton, whose bowel preparation product is a lot better.

Thursday May 29, 2025

Today, Karen Chalk, DCI employee and friend, achieves a big milestone by not only clocking up 40 Years of Continuous Service at DCI, but also becoming the first woman to do so.
I messaged her the following;

Good Morning Karen,
Just a note of congratulations on clocking up 40 Years of Continuous Service at DCI. A wonderful achievement, made all the more remarkable by the fact that you are the first woman to achieve this. You are indeed a trailblazer and I am proud to have been able to work with you for 33 of those years. I don't think any female will ever emulate your accomplishment in the future. Again congratulations and I'm sure DCI will mark and acknowledge the occasion well.

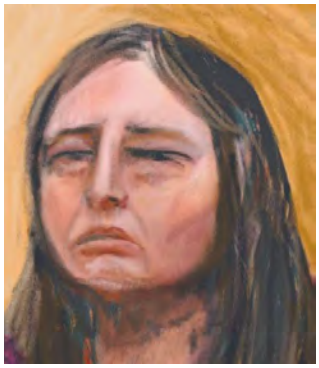
All the best from Pat

US trade court blocks Trump's 'Liberation Day' tariffs

A three judge panel has ruled Donald Trump's Liberation Day tarriffs as illegal and blocked them.
"That use is impermissable not because they are unwise or ineffective, but because [federal law] does not allow it."
What will Trump do now? I have always believed that this POTUS has always harboured plans to control the judiciary.
New acronym;
TACO: TRUMP ALWAYS CHICKENS OUT

Saturday May 31, 2025

Prime Minister Albo likes to remind us that he grew up in a commission house with a single mum.
He is now a multi-millionaire, especially when you think of his unrealised profits he will receive when he retires. He will receive a taxpayer funded pension estimated to be worth $400,000 a year – tax free for life when he leaves Parliament.
And if he passes before his fiance Jodie Haydon, she gets half of that pension, also tax free, for the rest of her life.
A sweet deal indeed. And the PM got this multi-million dollar package because he entered parliament before 2004 and is eligible to receive what's called a defined benefits pension. No wonder so many people want to get into politics.



Tuesday June 3, 2025

The court room sketch of mushroom cook and accused killer Erin Patterson in the Latrobe Valley Supreme Court.

Not a very flattering portrait. On the stand, Erin stated that "she was not feeling very good about herself". I don't think this portrait will raise her spirits any time soon.

UKRAINE INFLICTS "PEARL HARBOUR"

41 Russian jets destroyed in long range drone attack – Operation Spider's Web

Ukraine has destroyed $11 billion worth of Russian bombers in a massive drone attack on enemy soil hailed as "the Russian Pearl Harbour".
In the covert attack, drones were hidden in the roofs of what looked like wooden sheds, which were mounted on trucks and driven close to Russian air bases. Using a remotely activated mechanism, the roof panels opened to release the drones into the air. This mission was planned over the previous eighteen months.
However, Ukraine had better brace themselves, as Putin will rain hell on them for this. Putin has described this as an act of terrorism.

Wednesday June 4, 2025

I well remember this song, Joanne, as a young boy, with it reverberating in my head while at the Preston baths in 1970, but I struggled to determine who wrote the song. I have just determined it's none other than Mike Nesmith. I immediately put it on my Spotify playlist.

In the afternoon Janny and I went to Northcote Plaza and then strolled down High Street, towards Thornbury when we stumbled onto Sonic Rendezvuos Music. I found two albums that were very well priced and that I had been coveting;

The album **Captain Fantastic and the Brown Dirt Cowboy** has been described as the most Beatlesque of all Elton's albums. Without doubt one of the best album covers I have ever seen. It's quite a reflective album and includes a poster, scrap book and lyrics book. It essentially takes a look back at Elton and Bernie's career to date, as at 1975. Interestingly, the record had a note stating that sides 3 & 4 missing, and thus the chick at the record shop sold it to me for 10 bucks. I've since realised that this is not a double album but in fact a single album, therefore nothing is missing. The album's highlight is "Someone Saved My Life Tonight", a highly emotional and touching song. Taken as a whole, from its music to its artwork, Captain Fantastic and the

Brown Dirt Cowboy is Elton's creative high-water mark of the 1970's. The album made American music history by being the first album to debut at number one, and it stayed there for seven weeks.

"The Beatlisms on Captain Fantastic didn't stop with the music. For its cover, Taupin and DJM's David Larkham commissioned the pop artist Alan Aldridge to create a colorful illustrated fantasia that stretched across the record's gatefold sleeve. On the front cover, Elton the silver-mask-wearing superhero sits astride a tipped-over grand piano amid a menagerie of strange, unearthly creatures. On the back, in a continuation of the otherworldly scene, a smiling Bernie reclines in a bubble with his songwriting book while a white dove surreally bearing the face of his wife Maxine, sits on his knee. Above the lyricists head, the band members and Elton's manager John Reid in tow, with a significance that in reflection surely wasn't lost on anyone, fly off into the sky in space age spheres.
Upon its release in Britain on May 19, 1975, it was the most expensive single album released in the country up to that point."

Tom Doyle
Captain Fantastic – Elton John's Stellar Trip Through the '70s

Also scored this – Elton John: Greatest Hits. This album was released in 1974 and I remember it well, as Jeff bought this album that year from the Preston Record Bar in High Street, together with Caribou. A superb set list of songs.

Thursday June 5, 2025

Helen Mefflin sent me an email outlining the dates that William F Forry both arrived and departed from England as part of his war service. The dates were quite compelling and I responded to Helen as per the following;

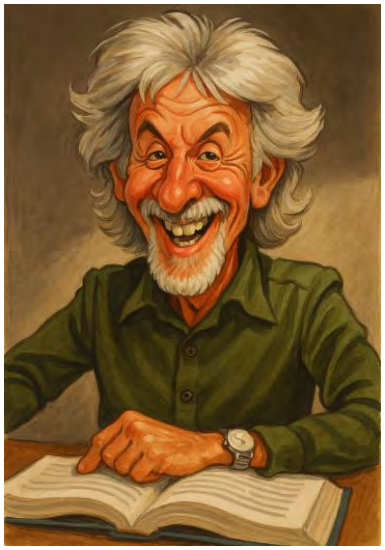
Thanks for the timelines. They reveal quite clearly that William Forry, upon departing England, would not have known that Lydie was pregnant (nor would Lydie I suspect) and this helps to frame the narrative around what was known at the time. For me, this is very important, as we were speculating whether William knew and turned his back on Lydie.

Also, it would be interesting to know how Henry got the information about William and his military serial number, which is documented in the divorce papers. That number is critical in confirming William's identity.

Thursday May 5, 2025

It would appear that a Tasmanian footy team might go the way of the thylacine, which is quite sad indeed.
The competition needs a team from Tassie – the last piece in the puzzle of a truly national competition.

Saturday June 7, 2025



The magic of AI. I set MicroSoft's CoPilot the task of converting my photo above into a caricature and a cartoon style transformation.
This was the result, created in about two minutes.
I then worked with Janny to convert many other photo's into this format.
We had a lot of fun, with Janny laughing enthusiastically.

I guess it was only a matter of time before these two jokers had a falling out.
It's starting to get very toxic.

Note, you can't beat our music

Colin Vickery

I have a confession. I am ashamed to say that when I was a teenager, I was a music snob and did not value Australian pop and rock 'n' roll.

Back in the 1970s I was enamoured with British acts such as Roxy Music, T. Rex and David Bowie, as well as American artist Alice Cooper.

The first LP I bought was The Monkees' debut, released in 1966.

When I got The Beatles' Abbey Road in 1969, at age 11, I thought I was so grown up.

I watched Countdown religiously from its 1974 start, but what got me really excited was seeing the clips and interviews with overseas artists.

But then I had an epiphany.

It was during the Covid lockdowns. With plenty of time on my hands I started to list what I considered the greatest songs of all time.

There was no question about my No.1 – Elvis Presley's In the Ghetto.

But when I thought about others I would put in the pantheon, I came up with Russell Morris's The Real Thing, Daddy Cool's Eagle Rock, and Stevie Wright's Evie, Parts 1, 2 and 3.

Say what? Hang on a minute, if three of my top four songs of all time were Australian, I seriously needed to admit that when I was younger I had a case of cultural cringe.

I had fallen into the trap of believing that this country's music was inferior to anything made overseas.

That revelation led to more soul-searching. I remembered how pumped the Ted Mulry Gang's Jump in My Car and Hush's Bony Maronie had made me feel – every bit as good as Slade and Status Quo did.

And what about AC/DC on a truck down Swanston St playing It's a Long Way to the Top?

Memories came flooding back. – Zoot's version of Eleanor Rigby, Doug Parkinson's Dear Prudence, Brian Cadd's Ginger Man, Colleen Hewett's Day By Day, Spectrum's I'll Be Gone, The Masters Apprentices' Turn Up Your Radio, Chain's Black and Blue, Billy Thorpe and the Aztecs lighting up Sunbury with Be-Bop-a-Lula and Ooh Poo Pah Do.

Truth: Living in the 70's and Daddy Who? Daddy Cool! are classic albums from front to back.

Now I am doing a deep dive into more local music from my teenage years, including by Carson, MacKenzie Theory, Lobby Loyde, Blackfeather, Buffalo and Madder Lake.

Australia, you rock!

Colin Vickery is a Melbourne writer

This article was in the Herald Sun this morning. It resonated with me in that all Colin's revelations essentially paralleled with my life and musical passage. Rather than the Covid lockdowns defining my musical awakening, it was my retirement that allowed me to acknowledge these great musical contributors. Just check my Spotify playlists to validate everything Colin has listed.

Saturday June 14, 2025

B A L I W I N T E R G E T A W A Y 2 0 2 5

Our first stop in Bali was at the Double Six Hotel in Seminyak.
The photo above right was taken from the top of the Arjuna Tsunami shelter building. The entrance doors were open and Janny and I scaled the stairs to the top. The photo shows the various beach restaurants and the DOUBLE-SIX hotel in the background.

Thursday June 19, 2025

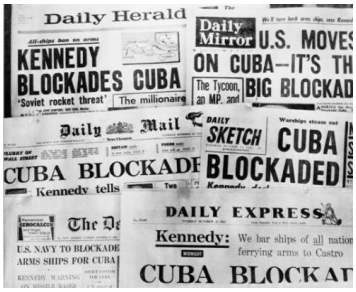
Following our stay at the Double Six, we checked into the ibis Styles hotel in Legian. It was certainly a step down from our first hotel. I mentioned to Janny that they should rename this place "Hotel Tidak" – tidak being Indonesian for "no". Everytime we requested something we were greeted with "no". During our stay we booked a vehicle and visited Semapura (otherwise known as Klungkung), where we visited the Puputan Monument and Kertha Gosa/Klungkung Palace, Bangli, Pura Kehen and Sideman Road.

Wednesday June 25, 2025

The third stage of our Balinese holiday involved checking into The Mulia in Nusa Dua. Without doubt the most luxurious and largest hotel we have ever stayed at in Bali. Staff were super friendly and profesional. Glorious pools and a great beach. Perched on a bluff adjacent to the hotel is a beautiful Pura Gegar temple.
Notable celebrities we spotted staying at the facility were Glenn Robbins, Tony Roche and John Millman.

Wednesday June 2, 2025

As a side revelation, I have just read that **1962**, the year of my birth, 178 nuclear tests were carried out across the world – this remains the highest number ever recorded in a single year. It would be fair to say that a lot was happening during 1962, with the Cold War, the Cuban missile crisis and space race dominating affairs.



Meanwhile, Joshua Brown has been accused of sexually abusing 8 children aged 6 months to two years. There are fears of more alleged victims across 20-plus facilities across Melbourne where he worked. Distraught families have revealed their shock and heartbreak.
Perhaps it's time to consider only employing women as childcare workers. Without stereotyping, but this bloke, with his many tattoo's, looks like the grooming type.

A very powerful and sobering image.
It is now clear and apparent that the Working With Children checking system is not working.
Perhaps the government authorities have been covering their eyes.
I suspect that every parent dropping off their child this morning at their chidcare centre would, understandably, be feeling very nervous.

. . . .

Friday July 4, 2025

Today, whilst foraging through old LP records at an Op Shop in High Street Northcote, I found this;
VENUS AND MARS...ARE ALRIGHT TONIGHT - WINGS
A $2 diamond in the rough.
"Rock on lovers everywhere, because that's basically it"

Saturday July 5, 2025

One of my favorite bands, Black Sabbath, are playing their final show in Birmingham today. Looking at the line up, it will be a mighty concert. Black Sabbath were pivotal in shaping my love of heavy rock. In the 1970's, the only band that owned heavy rock was Sabbath. All the other bands I was into were "hard rock" bands, such as Led Zeppelin, Deep Purple, Bad Company and Thin Lizzy. Black Sabbath were, without doubt, the genesis of heavy metal, and it is fitting that Metallica are on the bill. A legendary band without whom the history of heavy metal would have been drastically different and so much poorer. Tony Iommi is a veritable riff machine and forged heavy rock's finest moments. The first record I ever purchased as a teenager was Volume 4. They will be sadly missed and I would have dearly loved to attend this, their Final Show. As an added bonus, Ozzy will perform some of his solo stuff.

Sunday July 6, 2025

Having watched parts of this concert on YouTube, sadly Sabbath weren't at their best. I guess life is about managing expectations. The opening track, War Pigs, was sadly let down by Bill Ward's out of synch and low impact drumming. Ozzy performed in a black winged seat and appeared to struggle with his co-ordination, which is to be expected for a bloke with Parkinson's disease. Clearly the highlight of the show was Metallica. They played two Sabbath songs - "Hole In The Sky" and surprisingly, "Johnny Blade" off the "Never Say Die" album. Other highlights were "Battery' and "Master Of Puppets".

On another matter, my beloved Blues have well and truly lost their way. We were hammered by Collingwood on Friday night by 56 points and the pressure on Michael Voss is ramping up exponentially. Goal kicking legend Jason Dunstall could barely hide his disdain for the Baggers' skills. "They just don't have the composure in hand unfortunately. It is a gaping chasm, the ability to hit targets". Garry Lyon plainly said the Blues were "butchering the ball everywhere". Sound familiar? Read my notes on pages 53 and 55 of this journal, regarding our predicament in 2023. Classic case of déjà vu.

Clearly, the Blues will need to make significant list and coaching department changes, which will set the club's fortunes back many years. I can now say, with hand on heart, that we Carlton supporters can be described as "long suffering", especially young nephew Ryan who, now in his thirties, has never seen Carlton win a flag.

Monday July 7, 2025

MUSHROOM COOK GUILTY

Staring at the jury, an emotionless mushroom cook is found guilty of triple murder

Erin Patterson did not react, staring at the jury as the verdict was read out. They had found her guilty of murder and attempted murder after lacing a beef Wellington with death cap mushrooms. If I was one of the juror's, I would also have found her guilty, as the dehydrator was, in my opinion, the smoking gun. This appliance allowed her to dry and store her foraged death cap mushrooms, ready for future use in the toxic deadly meal. She then tried to discard this "murder weapon".

Tuesday June 8, 2025

Some of the headlines in the newspaper this morning.

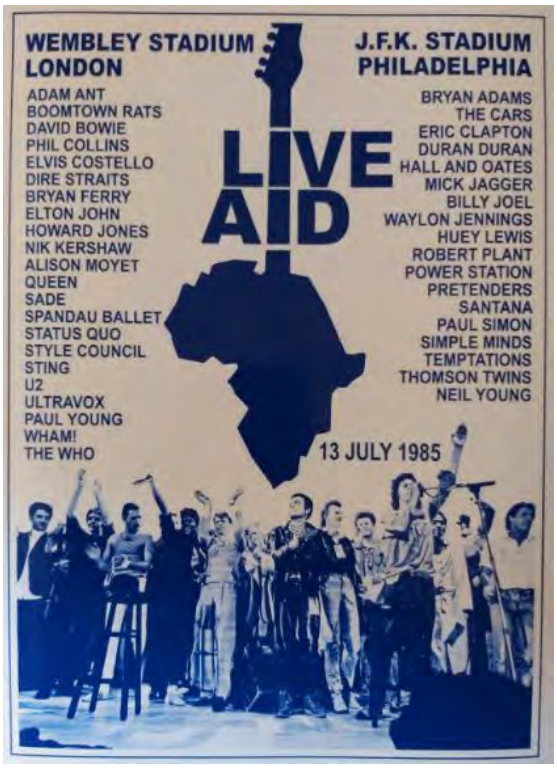
Murderer didn't flinch as she learnt her fate

THE FATEFUL WORD SAID FOUR TIMES

Twisted mind like Agatha Christie book

Saturday July 12, 2025

Yesterday I stumbled on a $2 copy of the 1977 Stars' album "Paradise" at an Op Shop on Sydney Road, Brunswick. Janny and I caught the train to Coburg Station and walked south along Sydney Road, wandering into record and Op Shops along the way. We were amazed at the amount of apartments that have been built on the west side of Sydney Road in Brunswick. A really hip and cool area.



Sunday July 13, 2025

On this day forty years ago the world's focus was on a huge global concert called LIVE AID. I distinctly remember this event and weekend. I worked my final day at Containers Packaging the previous Friday and on the Monday I started a new role at AMI Toyota in Bertie Street Port Melbourne. On the Monday morning I reported to the AMI HR Office and I struck up a conversation with another first day guy and we were talking about the Live Aid concert over the weekend and how great it was. History would show that I worked at AMI Toyota for three months and resigned as the work environment did not agree with my goals. I signed up with Skilled Engineering and worked as a builders laborer until the end of the year. DCI then beckoned.

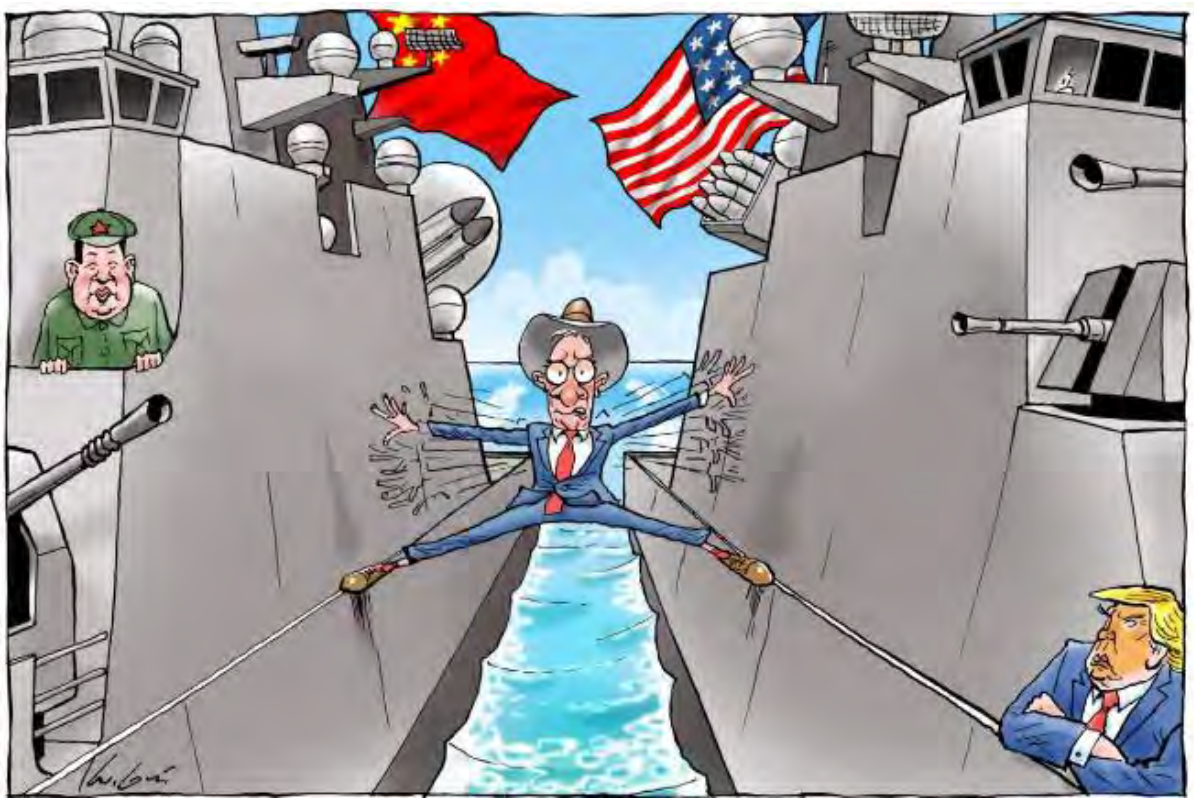
Tuesday July 15, 2025

Carlton players gathered at a Brunswick pub after their loss to Brisbane for a bonding session aimed at salvaging something from this years disastrous campaign.
Blues palyers and officials gathered on Friday, with key tall Marc Pittonet saying it was a key day to build trust with the group after a difficult season on and off the field. Speaking of Pittonet, the one pleasing aspect of the game against Brisbane was his 60 metre "torp" after the quarter time siren that sailed through the goals. It's heartwarming to see that players of today can launch these crowd pleasing kicks. I loved kicking torps back in the day. If you middle the ball off you foot and hit the sweet spot, the footy goes for miles – remember Malcolm Blight at Princes Park in 1977.

BLUES CALL BONDING SESSION TO FIND SPARK

. . . .

Albo is currently in China, trying to balance a diplomatic tightrope between appeasing our biggest trading partner and The Donald's insistence that we support the United States in the event that China invades Taiwan.



♫ Clowns to the left of me,
Jokers to the right,
Here I am stuck in the middle with.....my fellow Australians.
Good luck navigating these troubled waters.

Wednesday July 16, 2025

Today I am back in hospital for yet another medical procedure. I will be having basal cell carcinomas removed from the side of my face and my back at Epworth Freemasons hospital in East Melbourne. My doctor is Mr Rosario Donato. While sitting in the waiting room to be called in for surgery, a familiar face walked in. It was Rob Clements from DCI and we had a good chat. He was accompanied by his wife Karen.

Sunday July 20, 2025

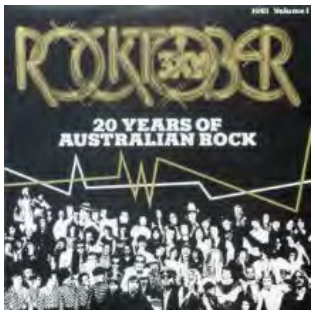
Today Janny and I attended the Box Hill Record Fair and caught the 109 tram to get there. We cut loose a bit and purchased 11 LP records.

I have coveted this glorious album for a fair while now. A 1970 original pressing, complete with rotating collage wheel.

LED ZEPPELIN III

Valhalla they are coming – with acoustic guitars!
LED ZEPPELI III IS A COMPATIBLE LINK BETWEEN THE GUTTURAL GRUNGE OF II AND THE MYTHIC, GLORIOUS EXCESSES OF IV

Credit must be given to **BRON-Y-AUR** *a small derelict cottage in South Snowdonia for painting a somewhat forgotten picture of true completeness which acted as an incentive to some of these musical statements — August 1970*



These LP's represent a good cross section of albums and artists that resonate with me. Slade, Santana, Huey Lewis, Brian Cadd, Ted Nugent, The Monkees, Sherbet, Boz Scaggs, Elton John and a smattering of classic Oz Rock. I also purchased a book titled "Hammer Of The Gods", which profiles the life and times of Led Zeppelin.

This morning Ross Stevenson mentioned that part of his recent holiday to Europe was to see ELO play their final concert in Hyde Park, London. The night before, he received a message on his phone stating that the concert had been called off, as Jeff Lynne was unwell. One of the jeopardies of committing to farewell concerts for aging rockers.

Wednesday July 23, 2025

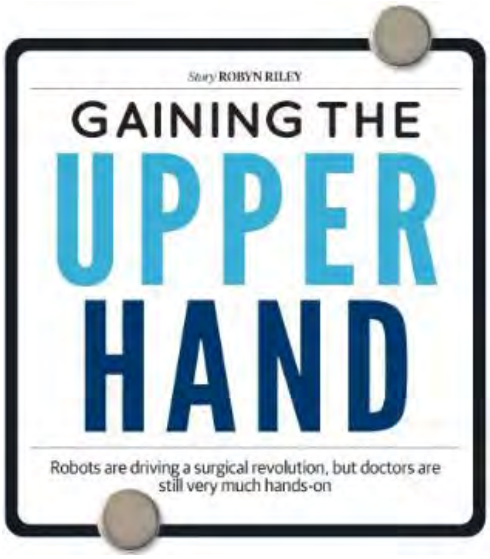
I woke up this morning to the sad news that John "Ozzy" Osbourne had passed away at the age of 76. This is following Black Sabbath's farewell concert earlier this month. Ozzy certainly left a long and enduring impression on me, especially as a teenager who loved Black Sabbath and later Ozzy's solo career. His 1981 album "Diary Of A Madman" is, in my opinion, his finest effort and he was ably supported by guitar prodigy Randy Rhoads. I have always maintained that the song "Diary Of A Madman" is an epic heavy rock masterpiece. Whilst Ozzy was much maligned, I have the utmost respect for his significant contributions to heavy rock and heavy metal. He has earned and deserves all the accolades the industry can bestow upon him. RIP the Prince Of Darkness. *"Ozzy is a heavy metal icon. Period. Few performers come even close to the Ozzmeister's reputation for lunacy and rock and roll carnage".*

Issi Berelian

Yet another farewell.....

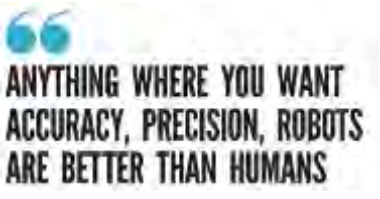
Carlton champion Sam Docherty will be given one final swansong announcing that tomorrow night's clash with Hawthorn at the MCG will be his final game. He has battled three ACL tears and two bouts of testicular cancer to forge a 184 game career. His biggest regret was not being able to share premiership glory with his great mate Paddy Cripps. His media conference was, as you would expect, very emotional. I'm sure a long career in coaching beckons.

Friday July 25, 2025



I read with interest an article from last weekend's V Weekend an article about RAS, or Robotic Assisted Surgery. My knee replacement was carried out using RAS.

Regarding RAS, surgeon Andrew Tan stated "What we are discovering is that it may well play a role in reducing the so-called revision rate, which is the rate at which the implants loosen and need changing".



Sunday July 27, 2025

Today Janny and I ventured to Doncaster to see Fantastic 4. Jann loves the actor Pedro Pascal, who seems to be in everything at the moment. He's certainly been busy of late.
The movie was good and opens up doors to other MCU franchises. I believe another Avengers movie is on the cards.

★★★

Meanwhile, footy is starting to heat up and you could say the finals have already commenced. Yesterday the GWS played Sydney in the local derby, and there was no love loss between the two.
Interviewed at half time, GWS skipper Toby Greene, when asked about Tom Papley, replied "He's looking overweight, so we'll see how he goes in the second half".
It didn't take long in the AI generating world of 2025 for Toby's sledge to come to life with this digitally altered image of Tom Papley, which appeared in this morning's paper.

T H E M A N Y F A C E S O F D E S P A I R
Palestinians clamour for food at a community kitchen.
Yet another example vis-à-vis the shame of humanity.
THE AGE **Monday July 28, 2025**

Tuesday July 29, 2025

A L L H A I L T H E N E S I A H

This Mark Knight cartoon in the Herald Sun today was the subject of much discussion this morning on 3AW's breakfast program.
Ross Stevenson had noticed that the score on the television was in fact incorrect. Melbourne's score should have read 13 12 90.
Ever the opportunist, Ross contacted Mark Knight and asked for a signed copy of the cartoon, as he reasoned that the image is now a collectors item, due to the discrepancy. Ross' goal was to raffle off the print for charity. Knight responed in kind by going one better via proffering the original hand drawn and signed illustration, duly framed.
The game in question was amazing. St Kilda, down by 46 points at three quarter time, kicked nine final quarter goals to win by 6 points. The hero was Nesiah Wanganeen-Milera, who took a glorious contested mark and goal to draw level with Melbourne and then found space in the forward line to kick the sealer. Not sure Sussan Ley's Libs can pull off a comeback like that.

Wednesday July 30, 2025

GREVILLEA HOUSE
CHRISTMAS IN JULY

Jann and I attended this event at MannaCare today, but we arrived late, as I had an appointment at Burgundy Hill Plastic Surgery at 10.30am to have stitches removed from my left cheek.
An enjoyable event and Mighty Mick's music was very entertaining, with Kellie providing wonderful dialogue.

Mark Knight, upon reflecting on who was his favorite cartoonist, mentioned Australian born Patrick Oliphant. Spending most of his career in America, Oliphant often drew US Presidents. He retired in 2015, however he was moved to come out of retirement in 2017 to create this illustration of Donald Trump and Steve Bannon.

H E I L T R U M P !

Thursday July 31, 2025

This has certainly been the year of medical appointments and hospital admissions. In the last twelve months I have had five hospital admission medical procedures, together with ten medical appointments. Today this trend continues with a visit to Dr. Phillip Antippa, a thoracic surgeon, who will consult on my lung condition or concern regarding a ground-glass opacity in the right upper lobe, which may represent a low-grade adenocarcinoma. At times, I have struggled to realise which condition I am presenting for, such is the number of different issues I have been dealing with of late.

Dr. Phillip Antippa MBBS FRACS, Cardiothoracic Surgeon, was a nice bloke who clearly and concisely outlined the nuances of my condition.
Basically, the ground glass opacity in my right lung is showing signs of AAH - Atypical Adenomatous Hyperplasia. It is recognised as a preinvasive lesion in the spectrum of the lung adenocarcinoma development. Dr. Phillip stated that my condition has started to morph into a semi-solid ground glass opacity (GGO) and is possibley invasive. While AAH is non invasive and benign, its presence may signal a field effect - a predisposition for malignancy in surrounding lung tissue.

Dr. Phillip explained that there are a number of questions to consider;

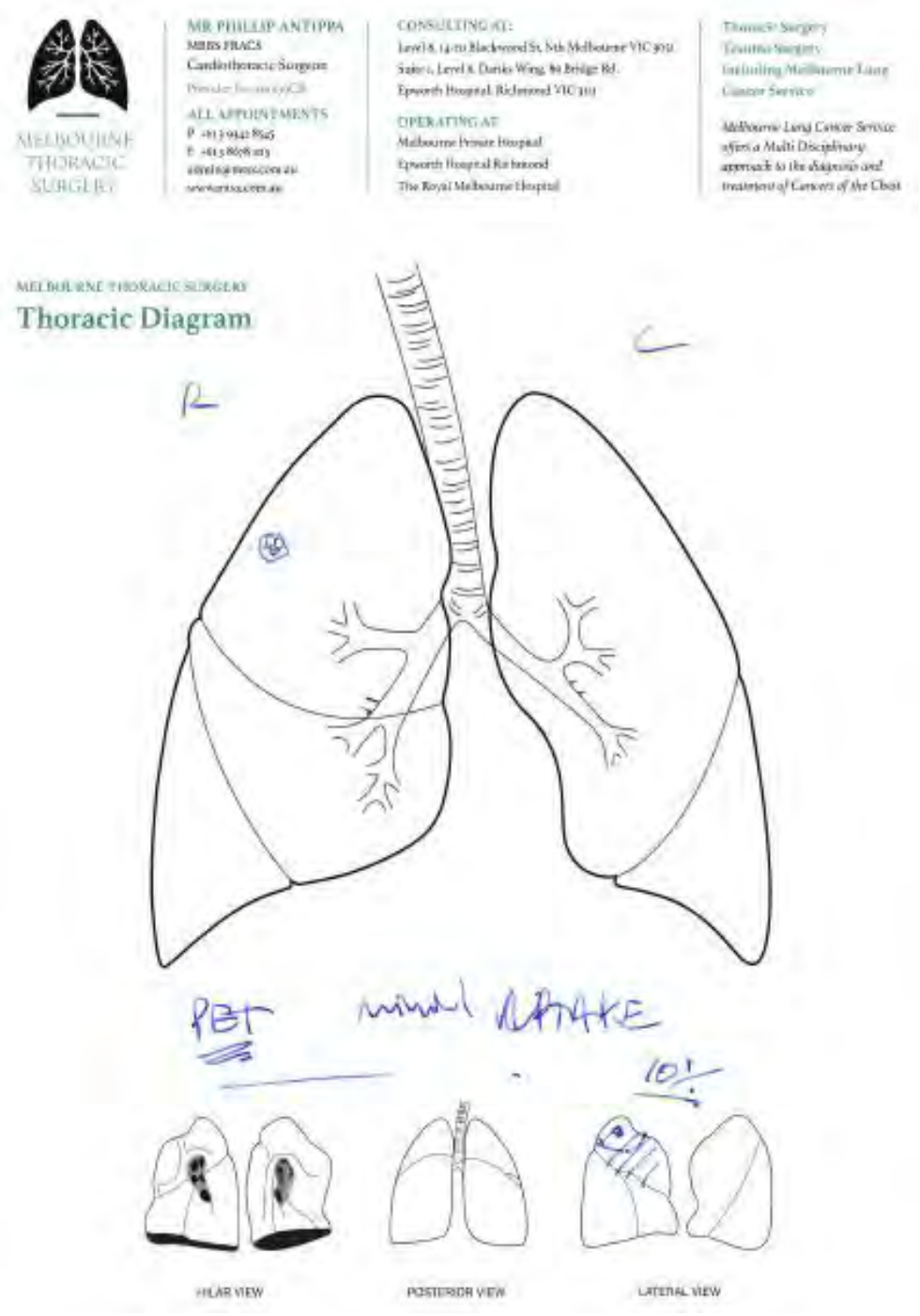
Does this lesion require further or testing or biopsy?

What is the likelihood this will progress to adenocarcinoma or remain stable?

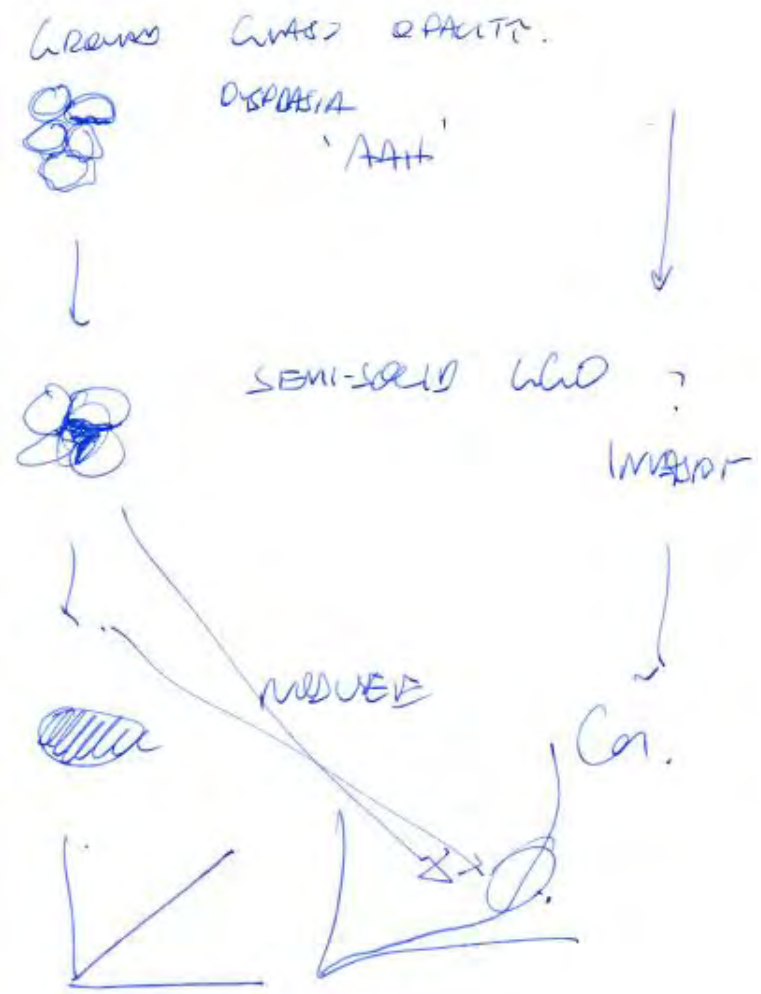
Should I consider surgical removal or biopsy of the GGO, which may not provide a definitive conclusion of its condition?

Most AAH lesions are detected incidentally and are often too small or subtle to biopsy, unless it is part of a larger surgical specimen. Surgical resection may be curative and is sometimes chosen if there is a risk of malignancy or growth.

My options are to either have a biopsy or have the AAH lesion removed, which would entail 10% of the lung being detached. This concerned me as I am worried about loss of lung funtion, But Dr. Antippa reaasured me that lung function loss is negligible. I am now leaning towards removing the lesion.



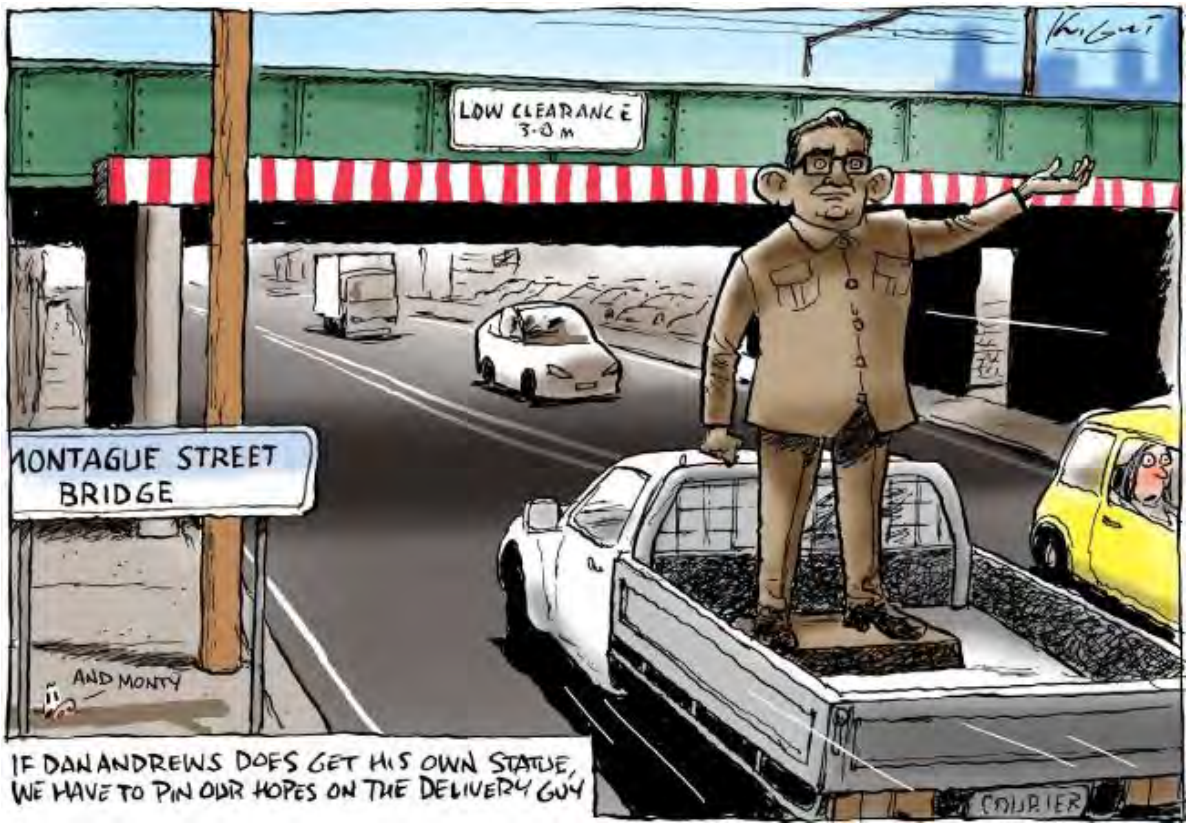
Dr. Antippa provided me with his notes as he discussed my condition.



Good to see Albo showing outstanding leadership

Monday August 4, 2025

The ongoing Free Palestine protests continued yesterday, with a large gathering set to close the King Street bridge. A heavy police presence deterred them, however some protesters decided to burn the Australian flag. This irritated me no end. In my opinion the burning of the Australian flag is worse than the Heil Hitler gesture. It should be made a criminal offence. Perhaps we could get the Jewish community to lobby for this, as I have noticed that our politicians tend to fall over themselves to appease our Israeli friends.



Talk about putting the Montague Street Bridge to good use.

Meanwhile, I often receive emails from Noel Whittaker regarding various financial topics, paticularly for retirees. He also attaches a few jokes to lighten the mood. I noted the following perspectives regarding aging;

Old age comes at a bad time.
- Ed Sullivan

Nice to be here? At my age it's nice to be anywhere.
- George Burns

Old people shouldn't eat health foods. They need all the preservatives they can get.
- Bob Hope

I was thinking about how older people tend to read the bible a lot more. Then it dawned on me – they're cramming for their final exam.
- George Carlin

Tuesday August 5, 2025

Yesterday Kath confirmed that her offer for 21 Elation Boulevard Doreen, which incidently is next door to Jeff and Janine's, was accepted. We are hoping that the vendor doesn't reconsider, as this transaction is perfect for Kath, both for her security and wellness. The house is well appointed and allows Kath to retire with a beautiful home, which she has worked so hard for and wholeheartedly deserves.

21 Elation Boulevard, Doreen
Fair to say that Kath felt a fair bit of "elation" in securing this property.

NEWSFLASH – The Melbourne Football Club has just sacked their senior coach Simon Goodwin. I suspect they will try and secure the services of former Swans premiership coach John Longmire. This would be a pity as I would have liked him coaching Carlton. Sorry Vossy, but I think your time is up.

"I feel incredibly supported by the Board"
Simon Goodwin – July 28, following the St Kilda loss

Wednesday August 6, 2025

I will this morning have the last of the stitches removed following the basal cell sugery, at Burgundy Hill Plastic Surgery, Heidelberg.
Today I will commence updating and formatting Paul Cleeland's biography, based on updates from Paul and Lara.

Thursday August 7, 2025

This morning I attended Grevillea House at MannaCare to do a presentation for the mens group. My topic was the King's Street bridge, and its structural failure in 1962, hydrogen embrittlement being the cause. I guess this was topical, considering that the Free Palestine protest group intended to blockade the bridge on the previous Sunday.

Friday August 8, 2025

Voss survives – rather un-Carlton like.
In the ruthless days of old he would certainly have been shown the door.

Famous last words…will they be on Vossy's epitaph?
If you have the full support of the board,
perhaps it's time to fall on your sword.

Friday August 8, 2025

Today I received a phone call from Jackie Edmunds, a clinical nurse at the Apheresis Unit of the Olivia Newton John Cancer Wellness Centre in Heidelberg. She is aware that I am related to Josh and my blood type is O+. She asked me a couple of questions and arranged for a medical assessment for white blood cell donation, which will take place on Thursday 14th August at 10.30am. Josh needs O+ white blood cell transfusions to help with his blood marrow cancer battle. Jeff was also contacted.

Saturday August 9, 2025

Market indicators;

ASX200	ALL ORDS	IRON ORE
8807.10	9076.60	$101.21

CBA	$176.61
NAB	$38.49
CSL	$260.88

COCHLEAR	$309.27
WESFARMERS	$90.26
SOUL PAT	$42.05
RAMSAY	$37.67

. . . .

Tuesday August 12, 2025

After much confusion with Royal Melbourne Hospital regarding a biopsy of my lung, which I knew nothing about, Mr. Phillip Antippa, Thoracic Surgeon, rang me and apologised for the confusion. We then mapped out a plan moving forward. We decided to arrange surgery to remove the lesion. This involves a rapid biopsy to determine if the lesion is benign or malignant. If benign, less than 10 percent of the lung is removed. If malignant, around 20 percent of the lung is removed. Procedure scheduled for Monday September 22, 2025. My sixth hospital admission in the last year. Of all my "medical conditions" I have had in the last twelve months, this one concerns me the most.

MELBOURNE THORACIC SURGERY

Wednesday August 13, 2025

We visited Vincent today at H&R Block, so as to get out tax done. I am feeling a bit anxious, as we will be declaring the sale of our two investment properties. The capital gains tax burden is what I am really worried about.
Total capital gain: $220k with 50% discount - $110k, less accumulated deductions.
I am delighted to reveal that our capital gains tax bill is $2,070. Vincent deferred payment to the ATO to June next year. Believe me, I breathed a big sigh of relief, as in the back of my mind I was expecting a CGT bill in the range of $20k.

Doop Snogg is this year's Grand Final entertainment.
His hip-hop songs are profanity laden and espouse the wisdom of smoking weed every day. Who signed off on this (fat) crap?

Thursday August 14, 2025

Janny and I caught the train to Heidelberg train station. We are currently sitting in the café within the Austin Hospital on Studley Road. It's quite busy and the café itself is quite large. I'm keeping an eye out for Stewie and Karen, just in case they turn up to see Josh. I have an appointment in the Olivia Newton John Wellness Centre next door for a medical assessment for a white blood cell donation, otherwise known as granulocytes. When you walk into the wellness centre, you are greeted with many images of ONJ and she has the most beautiful and warm face. There is, without doubt, no better ambassador for a centre to help people battling cancer, than our Olivia – herself a one time cancer survivor.
We took the elevator up to level 3, the Apheresis Unit which is part of the Day Oncology Unit.
My appointment was on a medical chair similar to that used to donate plasma. The nurse took blood from me and gave me instructions on how to self inject Zarzio, a medicine that encourages my bone marrow to produce more neutrophils, a type of white blood cell. The centre will test my blood samples to determine if I am suitable to donate. If given the green light, I will need to inject the Zarzio into my stomach at 8.00pm the night before, and at the same time take two dexmethsone tablets. At the end of the assessment I was ushered to the pharmacy to receive the tablets and pre-loaded syringe. Nurse Jackie explained to me that they needed suitable O+ granulocyte next week and asked if I could avail myself the following Monday, August 20, at 8.30am, to which I said yes. Tomorrow, Jeff will go through the same process, and Nurse Jackie mentioned that Jeff would be required next Wednesday, all going well.
Our donations could be life changing and whilst the donation process is a bit uncomfortable, these sentiments are swiflty dissolved by the thought that our contributions could hopefully set Josh's life on a path that will enable him to generate his own white blood cells and ultimately fight infections.

Introducing Delilah Fay Hilcke.
Mother Laura and daughter doing well.
When Delilah is 25, I will be 88 – the age which I have predicted will see my demise.

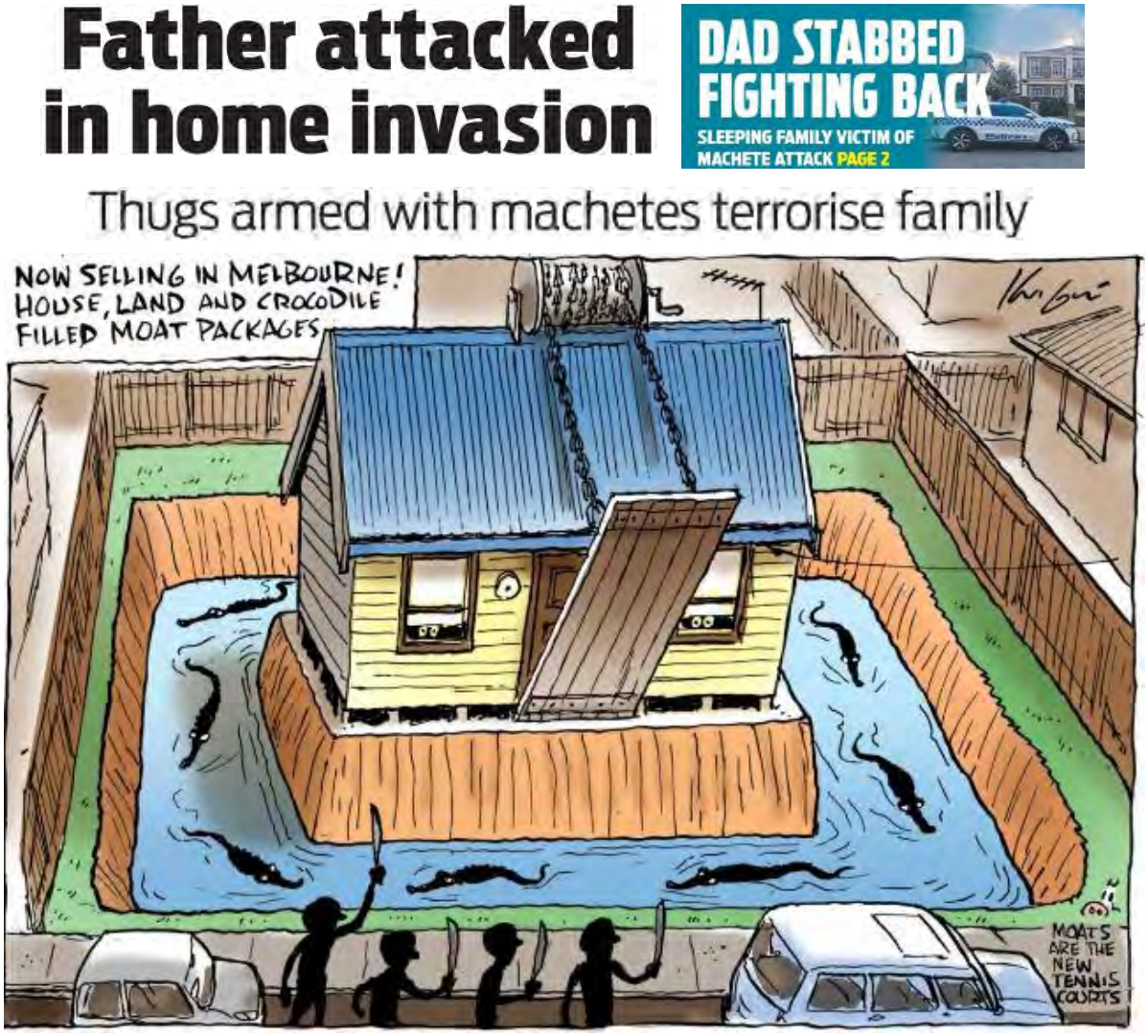
Sunday August 18, 2025

We spent the afternoon at Jimmy and Megan's home to celebrate Rio's first birthday. Present were Rob, Terrie, Brendan, Andrew and Megan's Mum Lesley. A very pleasant afternoon.

. . . .

I also received a phone call from Austin Health, informing me that Josh was doing well and my scheduled blood granulocytes donation has been put off for the moment. Very good news.

Monday August 18, 2025



The great new age deterrent – moats and cars with manual transmissions. I suspect these miscreants will be bailed and back on the streets within 24 hours.

Tuesday August 19, 2025

This photo, taken in December last year with student Candy, was published in the Carringbush Volunteer newsletter. Yesterday, Candy alleged that she revealed a medical condition to me and I allegedly revealed this to another student, who then revealed it to Elly. Candy was very upset about this and I was asked to attend a meeting with Kathy, Margaret (Carringbush management) and Candy's daughter Maggie. Candy wanted me to admit this, to which I knew nothing about, nor did Elly.
Candy also alleged that Elly told her that she was in danger and had to move. Candy then felt that the photo in the newsletter made things worse by

allowing everyone to see her and talk about her medical condition. At this meeting all I could do is reassure Candy that I knew nothing of her medical condition. She was unrepenetent and stated that I remained silent as part of a conspiracy with Margaret and Kathy. I resumed tutoring with Elly and stayed back to outline the situation with her. There certainly was a level of paranoia in what Candy was alleging. Very odd situation indeed.

Meanwhile, we have just successfully logged back into Disney+. Of course we couldn't help but view the new series ALIEN EARTH, set two years before the original ALIEN movie. We have just finished the first episode and it looks very interesting. When the final credits came up, I heard this eerie but familiar sounding keyboard piece, which was the intro to the Black Sabbath song "The Mob Rules".

We are huge fans of the ALIEN franchise.

Thursday August 21, 2025

Heard this questionn raised on the wireless this morning;

Did Greg Lynn, high country killer and JetStar pilot, ever land his aircraft under instruction from Erin Patterson, air traffic controller and death cap mushroom cook killer?

Friday August 22, 2025

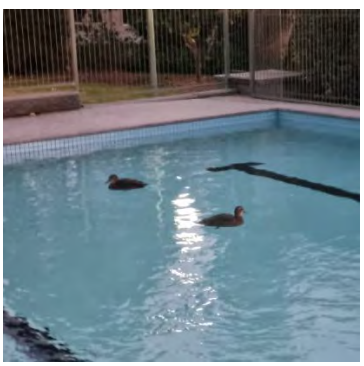
ASX SEES RECORDS TUMBLE

Sharemarket surpasses 9000 points

Australia's share market has made history, surpassing 9,000 points for the first time as a strong reporting term, interest rate cuts and subsided fears of global trade tensions sent the market into record territory.

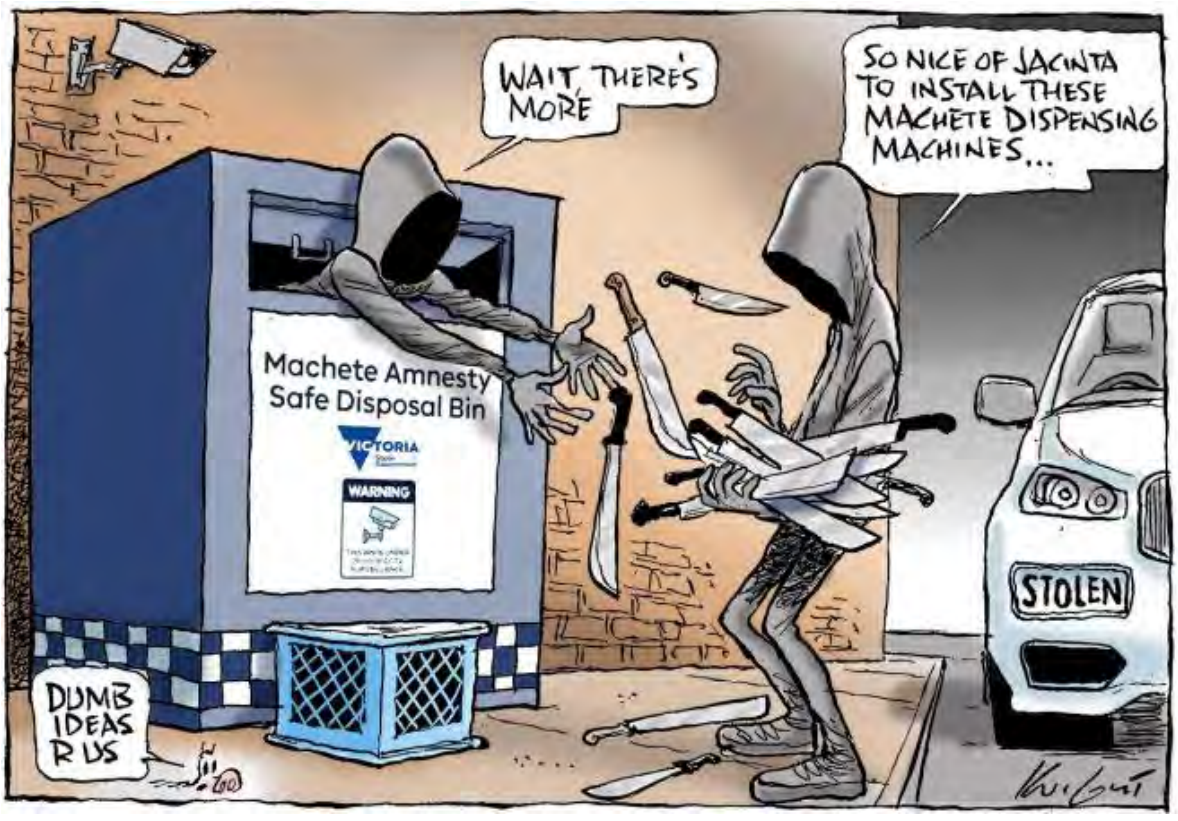
We received this email from Robert, our Willsmere facility manager;

We had two intruders early this morning. Apparently these two have been visiting Willsmere pool for the last 5 years signalling the coming of spring. Please have a good day.



Saturday August 23, 2025

Fed up and frightened



I's time we all raised our voices and issued a wake-up call to our political masters. We are fed up and frightened.

It would appear that we are attending a lot of farewell concerts. Wonderful musicians and rock bands of our youth are realising that father time is catching up with them. We have recently attended concerts featuring Elton John, Billy Joel and Paul McCartney. Black Sabbath played their farewell concert in July and in the same month Ozzy decided to ride on ahead. I suspect that we will not see them in concert ever again, certainly not Ozzy! Russell Morris is touring Australia for the last time, and we felt an obligation to see him, which we did last night. Russell mentioned during the concert that Brian Cadd had recently suffered a stroke. They have written many songs together. When I think of Russell Morris, I always think of my "Wings Of An Eagle" album, with superb songs and a very youthful Russell on the cover.
At this stage of my life I have become very reflective of how we were, how we looked, how we performed and where we are now.

Russell has an amazing voice, even at the age of 77.

Saturday August 30, 2025

Jeff met with us today to see Jaws In Concert. This year marks the 50th Anniversary of the release of this iconic movie. Back in 1975 a group of schoolmates and myself ventured into the Cinema Centre in Bourke Street to see this much hyped movie. This was Steven Spieberg's first big release movie and it didn't disappoint. The casting of Brody (Roy Scheider), Quint (Robert Shaw) and Hooper (Richard Dreyfuss) was spot on. Quint recounting the story about how the USS Indianapolis, after delivering the atom bomb for Hiroshima, was torpedoed by the Japanese and sank within 12 minutes, leaving the crew in shark infested waters, stayed clear in my memory. Quint's chilling description elevated the scene into cinematic legend. A magnificent movie, with yet another brilliant musical score from John Williams. We spotted and caught up with Rob & Terrie at the screening.

Saturday August 30, 2025

Alarm over aspirin use

Monash team points to bleeding risk in healthy adults

A major study has confirmed takiing an aspirin a day does more harm than good in healthy older Australians.
So concerning are the results of the Monash University-led research that people over 60 who have not had a heart attack or stroke and are taking the drug to protect against cardio vascular disease are being advised to discuss it with their GP. This cohort outlined above precisely described me and my circumstance. Great!.....I have been taking aspirin for two years now and only this week, while suffering parainfluenza, and had two nose bleeds!

"The overall findings of the trial suggested that the long term use of aspirin may not only fail to provide cardiovascular protection in healthy older adults, but also significantly increase the risk of hazardous bleeding complications".

Monday September 1, 2025

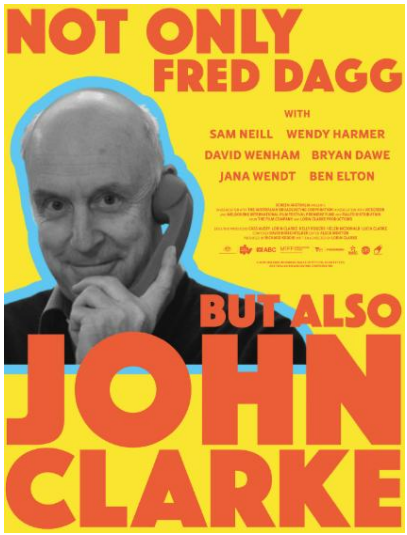
The next week will be critical for nephew Josh. His initial transplant failed and he has undergone another transplant recently, with the doctor's stating that he should be in a better and stronger position to ensure the transplant is successful. He will hope and pray.

Rubber bullets and stun grenades were used by police to stop violence between anti-immigration protesters and pro-Palestinian demonstrators as the CBD was again severely disrupted. Thousands of people, draped in Australian and Palestinian flags, descended on Flinders Street Station.

And of course, the neo-nazi's decided to stick their heads in as well. Police Minister Anthony Carbines described them as "unhinged grubs". Bring out the water canon.

There is something fundamentally wrong with the mob. There appears to be many particularly troubled individuals in Melbourne.

Friday September 5, 2025



Widely recognised as the world's greatest satirist, John Clarke has tickled the funny bones of Australian and New Zealand audiences for over forty years. Now, in this intimately produced documentary, we were able to hear his story in his words. I was amazed to find out that his program "The Games" included a very powerful speech delivered by actor John Howard which was an apology to indigenous Australia. It was heartfelt and sincere and I suspect many first nation Australians would have appreciated it.

Saturday September 6, 2025

Up to 17,000 rentals gone

State's landlord exodus goes on

Victorian government policies and taxes have been blamed for a landlord exodus that figures released this week suggested that up to 17,000 rental properties have been wiped out.

Aahhh! September – the best month of the year.
Janny (and cousin Nevil) are no doubt very pleased.

It's September again,
the business end of the tournament
and by the looks of that bus,
it's adorned with a unique ornament.

Monday September 8, 2025

10.18am: Erin Patterson has just been sentenced to three life sentences for murder and a 25 year sentence for attempted murder, and set a non-parole period of 33 years. All sentences (124 years) to be served concurrently.

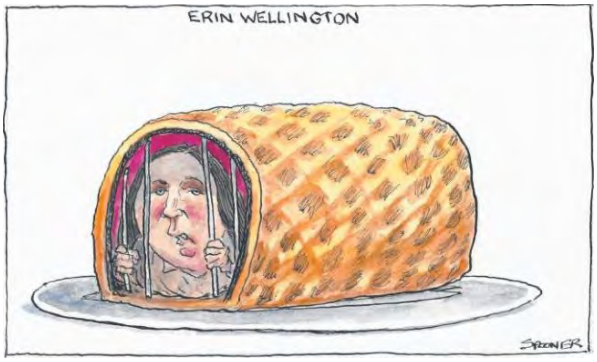
Mushroom cook Erin Patterson sentenced to life in prison, non-parole period of 33 years

The non-parole period was set down in consideration of her being in solitary confinement for most if not all her years of incarceration. Erin Patterson will be 81 when she will be eligible for parole in 2056.

No remorse, no pity and a long, lonely prison life ahead for mushroom murder cook

As the judge damned her as a liar, Erin Patterson showed no trace of emotion

Tuesday September 9, 2025



Our newspaper cartoonist's take on the happenings of yesterday.
It was all about beef Wellington, death cap mushrooms, murder most foul and Erin Patterson's life sentence.
An intriguing, absorbing and captivating case indeed.

Thursday September 11, 2025

Jackie at Austin Health rang me and asked if I wanted to participate in the granulocyte program for Josh, which I was part of last August 14. They wanted me to attend tomorrow for another blood test, which I agreed to. Jeff was also contacted and he will be participating tomorrow also.
My granulocyte donation will take place next Wednesday September 17.

This morning Jeff sent me the following message about where Josh is at this point in time;

"Not in a good place at the moment. Been in ONJ now since May 27. Infections have caused both attempts to fail. They're now looking at Beck who is a half match. His spirits are at rock bottom. Josh thinks he's never going to get out of there. Keep preying. Thanks mate".
Stewie

Tuesday September 16, 2025

This evening I prepared for my granulocyte donation tomorrow by self injecting Filgrastim into my tummy and also took two Dexamethasone tablets.

Wednesday September 17, 2025

I have a very busy day today.
Jann and I caught the bus and train to Heidelberg station so as to donate blood/granulocytes, which are white blood cells that help fight infection. My donated granulocytes will help Josh, who has no white blood cells, to fight infection. Donation time – 8.30am.
I have completed all my preparatory tasks for this donation and looking forward to the donation. As an extensive blood plasma donor, I am partially aware of what to expect.

Nurse Megan set me up for the donation, which involved a needle in both arms. I took my headphones and listened to RUSH from my Spotify account. It started well and Joy said that the donation was going well and the light red color of my blood augered well for a good donation. Then about 90 minutes in I felt cold and I asked Joy for a blanket. I then started shivering and this shivering started to morph into some serious shaking. I was also experiencing some intense lower back pain. It was then that I heard Joy and Megan call a code Blue on the two way radio, summoning the doctor and others to my room. They then disconnected the right arm canula and used this to inject other treatments into me to stop the shaking, and they warned me that I would become drowsy. At one point I counted seven nurses and doctors in my room working on me. Sure enough I was asleep in no time. Because of this reaction the donation was stopped, but I had donated enough to help Josh. By this stage Jann, who was in the room with me was very concerned for my welfare. They continued monitoring me and I was "discharged" around 2.00pm. So concerned were they for my welfare they arranged a Cabcharge voucher for us. Quite an eventful donation.

The cab dropped us off at our car and we immediately drove to Nathan White's clinic for my 6 month assessment of my knee. I mentioned to him that I was not pleased with the outcome and that I was still experienceing pain – especially at night. Nathan was surprised. He examined my knee and recent x-ray and saw no anomalies. He prescribed Celebrex anti-inflammatory tablets and also a blood test. I mentioned to Nathan that the brief was to remove the knee pain and at this point in time this has not been achieved and I regret proceeding with the knee replacement.

This evening, Janny and I attended a dementia seminar at MannaCare. We found the session, delivered by Chris from Dementia Australia, very interesting. Jann in particular, could relate to the many scenarios Chris raised, as she works with and observes the residents in the Lodge.

"People don't suffer from dementia,
they live with dementia"

. . . .

Thursday September 18, 2025

Reflecting on my physical challenges I face today, and my sporting life which may have contributed to these ailments, I can only contemplate on the following;
"I did the things that I loved. I wouldn't have lived if I hadn't done those things".

Janny and I watched "Death Cap Murders" on Stan today. An incredibly engrossing and intriguing case.

Friday September 19, 2025

We travelled to Jeff's place in Doreen this afternoon to stay for the weekend. Kath was there waiting for us and Jeff arrived later from work. We enjoyed a lovely weekend, On Saturday we helped Kath move some furniture to Jeff's and we watched both preliminary finals. Sadly, Janny's Pies lost to Brisbane.

Monday September 22, 2025

Today I am in hospital again for;

Right VATS Wedge Resection +/- Lobectomy

VATS - Lung cancer surgery can often be done using a keyhole approach. This is known as video assisted thoracoscopic surgery (VATS). In this approach, the surgeon makes a few small cuts (incisions) in the chest wall.
A tiny video camera and operating instruments are passed through the cuts, and the surgeon performs the operation from outside the chest. A keyhole approach usually means a shorter hospital stay, faster recovery and fewer side effects.

MELBOURNE THORACIC SURGERY

Post surgery, I woke up to multiple intravenous drips in my left arm and a drainage tube exiting the right side of my body, from my lung to a collection tank. I was completely tethered and urinating was a challenge.

Tuesday September 23, 2025

Dr. Antippa saw me today and confirmed that the ground glass opacity was in fact cancer. This medical procedure was in effect at remove lung cancer. Pretty scary! He outlined that 30 percent of my right upper lung was removed. In passing I mentioned to Dr. Antippa about the right lower lobe

lesion and he mentioned that it was also removed during the procedure. I was pleasantly surprised and thanked him for this.

Friday September 26, 2025

Out of control children
Crime rates in Victoria have reached record highs and are spiralling out of control, on a scale never seen before in this state. Year to date there have been 33,018 motor vehicle theft offences.

Saturday September 27, 2025

The Brisbane Lions have prevailed again, accouting for Geelong by 47 points, thus going back to back. The are very real signs that this team will form a dynasty and continue winning flags for many years to come. That have a fine blend of youth and experience. Will Ashcroft was again awarded the Norm Smith medal. I don't think I have seen a player with reflexes as sharp as him. I couldn't help but think that my Mighty Blues are light years away from playing at a level anywhere near Brisbane.

. . . .

Monday September 29, 2025

A Monday reflection…….
I am fast approaching the point of redefining the Trump Administration as the Trump Regime. What has led me to this conclusion is four key points;

1 Trump has made arrangements to stack the Supreme Court with sympathetic Republican judges, allowing him to pass or overide any legal roadblocks. Here in Australia, we are none the wiser to the political leanings of our High Court judges,
2 Trump is using his military for domestic disquiets,
3 Trump is constantly accusing the media of fake news. If the news item is not favourable to his cause, he savagely pursues them. You wonder how long before the media is state owned, and
4 Trump surrounds himself with "yes" men and if a senior bureaucrat provides data that reflects poorly on the regime, they are fired.

Tuesday September 30, 2025

Yesterday, while speaking to Gloria Gu, her husband Christian mentioned that he saw Soundgarden in Adelaide many years ago and wondered whether I was into this band. I decided to do some research on Soundgarden and it turns our that Chris Cornell (vocalist) and Matt Cameron (drums) were in the band. OK, you have my attention. Christian mentioned that their best work is the 1994 album Superunknown. I decided to download it and at 10.15am I am playing it. That's why I maintain that Spotify is an absolute game changer. This band and album rocks.

Superunknown

"A world beater. Huge riffs, depressing lyrics and big fat choruses make this a triumph of invention and wit. The eclectic range of material propelled the album into the Top 5 in the UK and straight to #1 in the US".

Essi Brerlian – Heavy Metal

Marnie from Dr. Phillip Antippa's office rang and confirmed that he has given me the green light to travel to Egypt on October 12.

Friday October 3, 2025

The Living End have released a new album titled "I Only Trust Rock n Roll". A glorious return to form for one of Australia's greatest rock bands.
This album bleeds attitude.
As declared in the title track of this their ninth album, Cheney doesn't trust religion or politicians, and I don't blame him.. He only trusts rock n' roll, and this record delivers in spades.
These 11 songs are "fast, heavy, aggressive – everything people want from us", said Cheney, calling it the most direct "three (and a bit) chord rock n' roll album since our first record".
Cheney's scorching riffs and solos are a standout throughout.

Sunday October 5, 2025

Janny and I felt a strong sense of homage in our desire to see Downton Abbey – The Grand Finale.
We have been staunch followers of this highly entertaining and splendid period series.
This finale offered a fitting and heartfelt farewell to this beloved 15 year series.

★★★★

Monday October 6, 2025

Stewart shared this photo with me and was coupled with the following message;
"Yesterday sharing an emotional moment watching life giving stem sells that Beck donated flowing into Josh. Now we wait for them to engraft".

I responded with the following;
"Wow, what a wonderful image of hope and love. I will put that photo in my journal and always look at it with a great deal of pride, optimism and confidence".

Wednesday October 8, 2025

Today we attended a coffee catch-up with my fellow volunteers from Melbourne AMEP. The venue was Liminal in the T&G building in Collins Street. I met my new student Jimmy and also caught up with Gloria's husband Christian. We talked about Soundgarden and I thanked him for alerting me to them and in particular their album "Superunknown".

Wednesday, October 8, 2025

Following our coffee catch-up, Jann and I had lunch and headed to the City Library. We then wandered down to Zinc at Federation Square for the WH Soul Pattinson general meeting. Again we were wined and dined and the presentation was very interesting. The presentation commenced with a video about Soul Patts and in particular the Chairman Robert Millner at his desk. Behind him was a portrait painting of an Australian cricketer, but his identity was partially obscured. After the presentation the hospitality continued and I asked Robert who it was, to which he replied, unsuprisingly, DG Bradman, which he mentioned was a limited print release from the Bowral museum.

Sunday, October 12, 2025

Late today we boarded Qatar flight QR905 bound for Doha and thereafter Cairo. Upon arrival we were met by our Viking representative and then whisked to our hotel – the Sheraton Cairo, and checked into our room on the 22nd floor. From our balcony we could get a plan view of the traffic chaos below, to the constant noise of car horns. Within the chaos were pedestrians who walked nonchalantly between the traffic and cars passing very close to them. Somehow this madness works. Our hotel gave us views up the Nile and Gezira Island.

Pharaohs & Pyramids

Roundtrip Cairo, Egypt

Monday October 13, 2025

At the hotel we were greeted by our Viking representative, Sahar Hammed, who would become our contact and tour guide throughout our voyage.
Next door to our hotel was the Russian embassy, and placed strategically around the compound were armed Egyptian guards, One guard, to our surprise, was slumped over asleep, Good to see Egypt's finest on the job. Cairo is surprisingly dirty and chaotic. Temperature around 36° C.

Tuesday, October 14, 2025

Following breakfast in the hotel, we joined our fellow travellers in the Salah El Din 1 room, where our program directors Hany, Nabil and Sahar provided important information about our trip. We were provided with audio receivers and earpieces for our excursions.
At 9.00am we embarked on our first excursion – Cairo Citadel and Egyptian Museum. At 2.30pm we then visited the National Museum of Egyptian Civilisation. Adjacent to the Citadel was the most magnificent Mohammed Ali Mosque, one of the holiest sites in Egypt.

Wednesday October 15, 2025

Our excursion today is one most anticipated – Sakkara Step Pyramid, Giza and the Sphinx. This was a busy day. Casting my eyes at these great pyramids was breathtaking and the Sphinx was as majestic as I had imagined. And of course what a trip to the pyramids be without a trek on a camel.

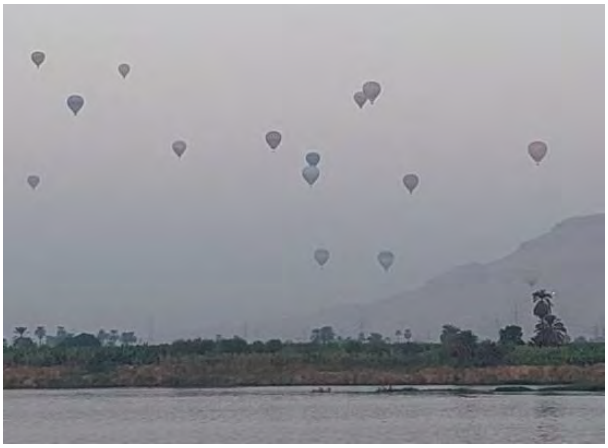
On the Giza Plateau, with the pyramids of Menkaure, Khufu and Khafre in the background,

Thursday October 16, 2025

Today we departed from Cairo to Luxor via a charted flight and then boarded the ship Viking Amun. We unpacked and settled in. At 5.30pm we embarked on a shore excursion to Temple of Karnak and Luxor.

Friday October 17, 2025

This morning I got up early and at 5.45am I was on top of the ship walking laps when I noticed that the Valley of the Kings was visible across the Nile and it was lit up. Soon after the glow of hot air balloons illuminating became visible. One after another they slowly ascended and at one point I lost count after 32 sighted balloons, drifting high above the valley.
At 8.00am we set sail for Qena and at 2.00pm we left for a shore excursion to the Dendara Temple complex and the temple of Hathor. During the day we were given a presentation by Hani about the Nile and its importance to Egypt. Did I mention that the temperature here in southern Egypty is hovering around 39 – 40° C, making our excursions very challenging.



Hot air balloons drifting over the Valley of the Kings at dawn.

Saturday October 18, 2025

This morning we headed off for an excursion to the Valley of the Kings, the Tomb of King Tut, Seti 1st Tomb, Hathshepsut and the Howard Carter House.

Sunday October 19, 2025

We arrived in Esna and embarked on a tour of a village within the town. It was like stepping back a hundred years. Dirt floors and roads and ramshackle buildings. We visited a merchant who grinds and presses seeds. He was using a wooden hand press and the screw had been hand chiselled into a "vee" thread – truly remarkable. We then purchased a galabeya for the Taste of Egypt Dinner that evening. Lucky for us the merchant accepted $AUD. The touts in this town were particularly aggressive and desperate for a sale.

That evening we attended a dinner dedicated to Egyptian cuisine in the Restaurant, while enjoying music from this country. We got in the spirit of things by dressing in our galabeya's. We dined with Ron and Nancy from Ohio.

Monday October 20, 2025

Today we traveled to Aswan High Dam and then boarded a chartered flight to visit the monolithic Temples of Abu Simbel, which were relocated in the 1960's, due to the building of the Aswan High Dam and the creation of Lake Nasser. This was a busy day.

Tuesday October 21, 2025

This day saw us visit a Nubian Village, the Philae Temple and the Papyrus Institute. The temperature hit 41° C.

Wednesday October 22, 2025

Today we took the excursion to the Edfu Temple, located on the west bank of the Nile between Luxor and Aswan and saw the falcon god Horus.

Thursday October 23, 2025

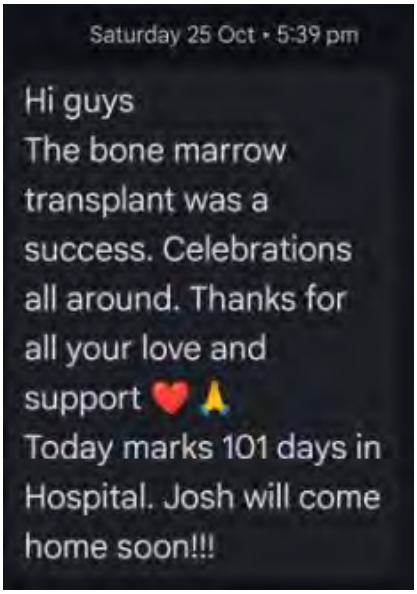
Today we flew back to Cairo and checked into the Hilton Heliopolis Hotel.. We then had lunch at the My Kind Of Place restaurant. At 2.00pm we embarked on an excursion to Old Cairo and the Coptic Quarter.

Friday October 24, 2025

We checked out of our hotel and flew home, arriving back in Melbourne at 5.50pm.
What surprised me about Egypt was the suffocating density of Cairo's city streets and the harsh elements of the open desert – certainly eye opening.

. . . .

Saturday October 25, 2025



Upon arriving home from Egypt, I took my phone off flightmode and immediately saw the following message from Stewie.
In life we at times receive good or pleasing news, but this update of this nature is as good as it gets. I, and I suspect many others, have been praying for Josh. It would be fair to say that our prayers have been answered.
Now Josh can get on with his life, unshackled from the intravenous drips that have accompanied him for so long, like a ball and chain.

Sunday October 26, 2025

Back in Australia and we are residing at Jeff and Janine's in Doreen while our bathroom and laundry are renovated by Saied, who has been giving us progress reports via WhatsApp. I am happy to report that Saied found no water damage due to poor waterproofing – something that has worried me for many a year. All demolotion works are now complete and water shut off gate valves have been fitted.

Monday October 27, 2025

Jann and me drove to Kew and withdrew $10k as a second payment for Saied. I then attended the Carringbush "English for Everyone" session in Richmond.

Saturday November 1, 2025 – Melbourne Cup Weekend

Jann, Kath, Molly, Adele and I drove up to the Whittlesea Show, which was interesting. We enjoyed watching the woodchop.
That evening Janny and I had dinner at a Indian/Nepalise restaurant in Mernda, Food was very nice. I had the Nasi Goreng – a gebnerous serve which I shared with Janny.

Sunday November 2, 2025

Today we took in the musical HAIR. I found it disappointing. It had a shallow storyline and the nudity was baffling.
On a day that reached 32°C, we caught the train from Mernda station into Flinders Street – a one hour trip.

Monday November 3, 2025

Prior to attending Carringbush English tutoring at Richmond, I received a message from Elly, informing me that she was running late by about 10 minutes. I then started the class until Elly arrived. During the class Nga gifted me an orchid and a dumpling. She is a very kind and considerate woman with a very happy disposition. In fact many of the students in our class appear very happy.

Wednesday November 4, 2025

My AMEP English tutoring saw me meet Jimmy Wu at Doncaster Shoppingtown at a Café named Shingle Inn. Upon arrival I noticed a long line of young, predominantly Asian girls lining up for a meet and greet with a "K Pop" band called TWICE THIS IS FOR. They were purchasing a lot of merch. This queue snaked around the centre for at least 100 metres.

Each morning Kath and I go for a walk around the Doreen neighbourhoods. This housing estate is quite unique as there are many parks and untouched bushland, together with an abundance of childrens playgrounds and conservations reserves. We sighted plenty of kangaroos, rabbits and native Australian birds. Many delightful homes as well.

Saturday November 8, 2025

The concert that never was.
Unfortunately I did not attend this concert due to difficulties getting tickets. Jeff and Ryan attended through a stroke of good luck. Samy and Steve had to offload their tickets as they had to attend a wedding.

Marvel Stadium – November 8, 2025
Lets hope James Hetfield has no substance abuse/rehab issues.
I am still filthy about missing the 2019 concert due to the tour being cancelled owing to Hetfield's rehab. issues.

Vale John Laws – Hello World and Likewise and More.

Tuesday November 11, 2025

"Well may we say God Save the King, because nothing will save the Victorian Premier."
How time flies. I was 13 and in Form 2.
If you look carefully, you can spot the key players in The Dismissal....in particular Kerr's Cur.
Apart from Gough, Leigh Hatcher, Norman Gunston, Sir John Kerr and Malcolm Fraser et al.

"Cos Gough was tough till he hit the rough,
Hey Uncle Sam and John were quite enough"

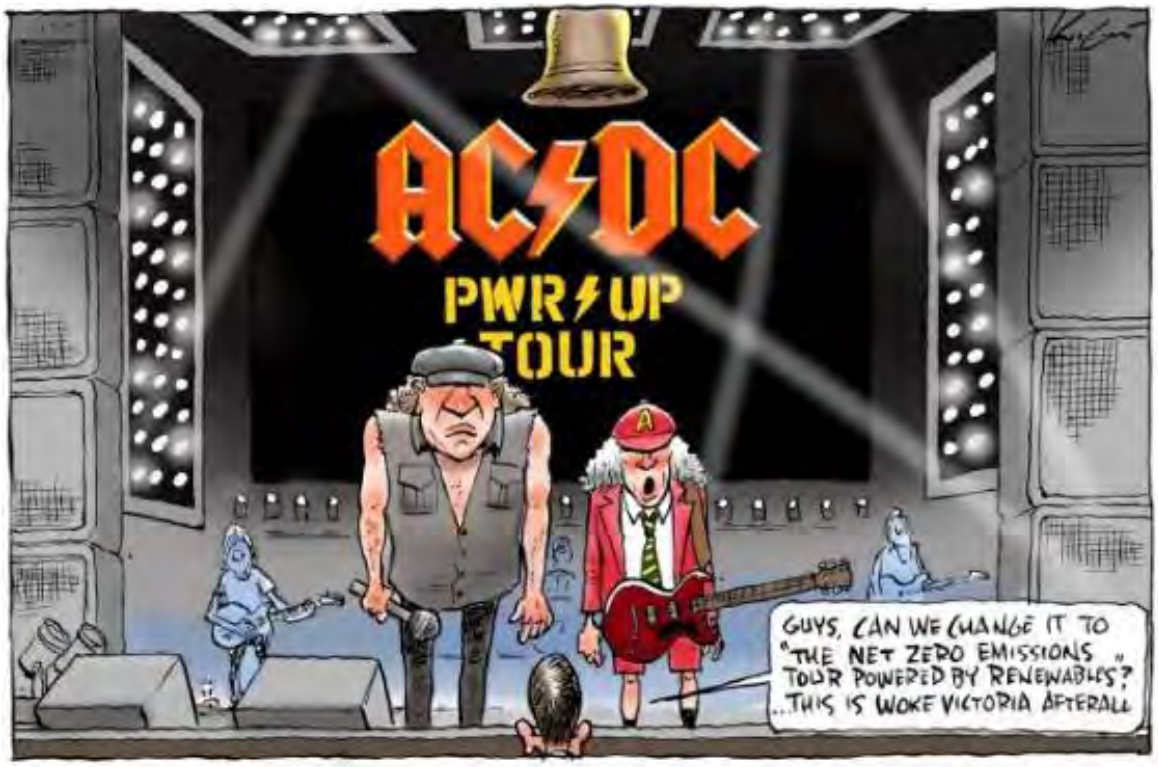
Wednesday November 12, 2025

Investment guru Warren Buffet has at the age of 95 stepped down as chief executive of Berkshire Hathaway and has signed off in style with the following words of wisdom;

"When you help someone in any of thousands of ways, you help the world. Kindness is costless.....but also priceless"

Today Kath, Jann and I travelled in Jeff's ute and my Santa Fe from Doreen to Epping to commence moving Kath's boxed items to her new home next door, We did two trips and tomorrow will do two more.

I was frustrated today that my car, the Santa Fe, was indicating that the front passenger side tyre was losing pressure, yet the reading was 33 PSI – the same as the other tyres. I rang Hyundai Roadside Assist and the problem was fixed.



It would now appear that High Voltage is now deemed Dirty Deeds.

This article was in today's Herald Sun. Pilates entrepeneur Caitlyn Mefflin has secured a start-up loan and established her own business which now employs 25. So proud to see a family member having a go. I rang Helen and we had a chat about this marvellous article.

Saturday November 15, 2025

Today we picked up a Sixt hire truck and emptied out Kath's storage unit, which we delivered to Kath's new home next door. It was fotuitious that we were staying at Jeff and Janine's, so it was "all hands on deck".

I drove the Sixt van for the day. The day was pretty full on and we didn't stop from 9.00am to 5.30pm.
With all Kath's belongings now in her home, she can now sort it and get settled.

Sunday November 16, 2025

Jann and I parked our car at Mernda station and caught the train to South Morang. Our intention was to see Predator Badlands. Once we alighted from the train station, the cinema was directly in front of us in Plenty Valley Westfield. The movie was excellent. A link to the Alien franchise is all but guaranteed with Weyland Yutani involved.

★★★★

Tuesday November 18, 2025

Two years ago I bumped into Jess Wilson, State Member for our seat of Kew, who was campaining in High Street Kew. I felt compelled to give her some sage words of advice. I suggested that she run for the position of leader of the Liberal Party. I reinforced this by saying that the Liberals in Victoria aren't resonating with the broader electorate and that she would bring a fresh new approach that would appeal to younger Victorians. The old, pale, stale males weren't cutting it with voters. She politely took in what I proposed.

Jess Wilson makes history as first Victorian Liberal leader

This morning I met with Loui at Axil Coffee Roasters in High Street Kew. Loui mentioned that on October 23, he attended his Australian Citizenship ceremony at the Hawthorn Civic Centre and received his Citizenship Certificate. He thanked me for my assistance with his Citizenship test.
He kindly forwarded to me this photo of the occasion.

From left;
Loui, Lucas, Vicky, Sophie Torney (Mayor of Boroondara) and Chloe.

While I was with Loui I received a phone call from Saied, who was confident that our home renovation would be complete by this weekend.

Wednesday November 19, 2025

I became aware last night that RUSH are embarking on a North American tour with a new drummer named Anika Nilles. You would have to think that RUSH fans would be focused on her every move, as she has very large shoes to fill.

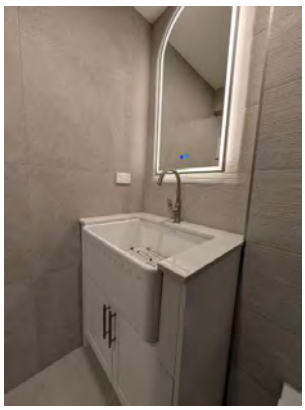
RUSH

Friday November 21, 2025

Jann and I took a drive with Cherry the dog to Whittlesea. We shopped in the local Salvo's and I found Rod Stewart's "Footloose and Fancy Free" LP, just sitting there on top of a stack of really crappy records.

Sunday November 23, 2025

Yesterday Saied rang and confirmed that our bathroom/laundry renovation was complete. We could now go home. Our stay at Jeff and Janine's was very timely, as we were on hand to help Kath move into her new home next door.

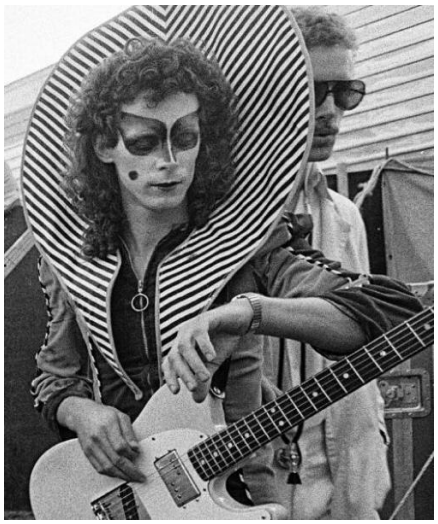


We are delighted with the end result of our bathroom and laundry renovation. It includes a second toilet, water mains shut off valves, floor heating, two pretty sexy illuminated mirrors and a heated towel rack.

Wednesday November 26, 2025

Jann and I were gifted mugs from MannaCare in recognition of our volunteer work. The following was emblazened on the mugs;

VOLUNTEERS
2025
A DEDICATED PERSON WHO CAN MAKE A BIG
IMPACT EVEN WITH JUST A SMALL ACTION OR
A FEW WORDS. SOMEONE WHO MAKES A
DIFFERENCE IN THE LIVES OF OTHERS.



Saturday November 29, 2025

News has just come through that Skyhooks (and one time Rose Tattoo) guitarist Bob (Bongo) Starkie has died aged 73, following a battle with cancer. A sad day for those of us who grew up "Living in the 70's" and by which Skyhooks left an indelible mark.

Skyhooks were born from the ashes of an unheralded Melbourne group called Frame (April 1973). Australia's top tunes were Carly Simon's "You're So Vain", Elton John's "Crocodile Rock", and "Top Of The World" by the Carpenters. "Tie a Yellow Ribbon Round The Old Oak Tree" was waiting in the wings....the days of Elton John's greatest popularity, all feathers and glitter; of "Jesus Christ Superstar" and "American Graffiti", "Tubular Bells" and "Dark Side Of The Moon". Elvis Presley had reached mega-media status by telecasting a

Hawaii concert live via satellite around the globe. "Has he still got it?", we asked ourselves. By the time Shirley Strachan took over from Steve Hill as the Hook's front man, Paul McCartney had established himself as top dog ex-Beatle with "Band On The Run". The change in singer utterly supercharged the group and completely changed the impact of the band, setting their songs alive with fire. "Hey" said a dozy Melbourne rock patronage, "What's happening here?" Case in point – listen to "Motorcycle Bitch" and crank it up.

Sunday November 30, 2025

TUNNEL VISION NOW A REALITY

Janny and I joined thousands of Melburnians at the openining of the $15 billion cross-city rail line, known as the Metro Tunnel. We started by descending into the State Library station. My first impression was how deep underground the platforms were. Reminded me of the New York subway. We then walked to the Town Hall station, where we caught the train to Anzac Station. The new Town Hall Station has reinstated the old City Square of yesteryear. I hope they re-erect the Burke and Wills statue on the site. From Anzac we caught the Sunbury train to Arden Station and walked to the North Melbourne football ground and "joined in the chorus" with the triumphant AFLW premiers North Melbourne, who easily accounted for Brisbane the previous evening. We then caught the train to Parkville Station and had a walk around Melbourne University. Each station had musicians, jugglers, mime artists and other assorted entertainers as part of the opening day celebrations. A carnival type atmosphere. The ceilings of these stations resembled a cathedral type grandeur. Without doubt a significant piece of transport infrastructure.

Janny and I at the new State Library Station.

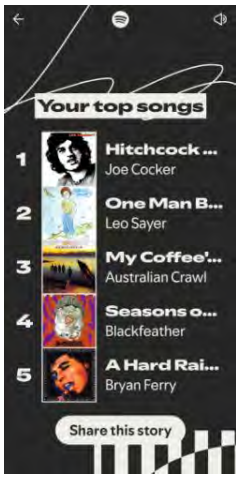
Monday December 1, 2025

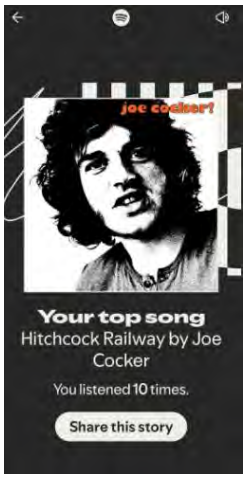
Monday considerations.....

"Life consists not in holding good cards,
but in playing those you hold well"

Thursday December 4, 2025

This morning Spotify released the Wrapped summary of your listening profile for the last 12 months. Spotify rated me as a 70 year old person, based on my song selection profile. My results are listed below;





I listened to music on my Spotify account for 13,000+ minutes in the last 12 months.

Saturday December 6, 2025 – Happy bithhday Jeff

In the Herald-Sun this morning was an article about the founder of Parkrun, Paul Sinton-Hewitt. It is now a global phenomenon with 500,000 participants every week. I miss Parkrun terribly, however the article mentions that it is open to walkers as well a runners. I will now commit myself to walking the Studley Park Parkrun trail.

Unfortunately I couldn't attend Jeff's birthday get-together tonight as I get bad hamstring pain when I drive. The long drive to Jeff's will give me aching grief. I will see Dr. Schulberg on Monday to address this and a number of other ailments such as my knee pain, the wart like growth on my right leg and a ringing sound in my ears. I will now make an appointment with ALIGN physio to work on my knee and hamstring. I advised Dr. Schulberg that I have discontinued taking aspirin due to two recent "difficult to stop" nose bleeds and the Monash University study cautioning

against taking aspirin - see page 285. He advised against this and recommended I take half tablets. I am now considering this.

Monday December 8, 2025

I attended my last "English for Everone" class for the year today. The class generously presented me with a Christmas gift. I was touched by their lovely generosity. I confirmed to the class that I will be attending the Wednesday class and Christmas lunch.

Vahn presents me with a Christmas gift.

Tuesday December 9, 2025

This morning I attended the Carringbush end of year concert at Lynall Hall Richmond. Always a moving event. It was also an opportunity to farewell Mary Dearing and Sarah Deasy, who are retiring and who interviewed and employed me at Carringbush. This gathering also acknowledged all us volunteers and we were given a gift. I will miss Mary - my main volunteer contact - as she was always good company and continually checked in on me.

Premier Jacinta Allan after her apology yesterday to Indigenous Victorians for violence, neglect and erasure of culture. Picture: David Crosling

Jacinta's apology 'day of reckoning'

Jacinta Allan following her apology yesterday to Indigenous Victorians for violence, neglect and erasure of culture. Get ready for more taxes and charges to cover reparation costs!

Wednesday December 9, 2025

"It's a sad, sad situation – Oh it seems to me, that sorry seems to be the hardest word"
(Depending on who you are!)

Thanks Elton

Dear Pat
Thank you for your energy and enthusiasm.
You've been a real asset to Carringbush.
The students love working with you - and so does Elly!
Merry Christmas from Mary

Thank you card I received from Mary Dearing

Thursday December 11, 2025

Today I had a doctor's appointment with Dr. Schulberg to remove and biopsy a growth on my lower right leg. Fingers crossed that it's benign. I also had a blood test as part of Nathan White's investigations to why my total knee replacement is still giving me grief at the nine month mark of my recovery.

. . . .

Friday December 12, 2025

Today Janny and I attended the Grevillea House Christmas Party. It was well attended and we were entertained by Mick and Colin. Following this we walked through Doncaster Shoppingtown and checked out the Mercure Hotel Tower Terrace, which is the venue for the MannaCare Christmas party next Friday. A very swish venue.

Saturday December 13, 2025

It was time to attend the Ernest Christmas function at Brendan's in Craigieburn. These get togethers seem to draw all of us closer together. I am so proud to be an Ernest. Brendan had set up a TV and had family photo's on repeat. Me as a kid with family members from days gone by to name but a few. Pat and Robyn were there and Gary made an appearance. I mentioned to Gary that I was collecting Elton John records from the 1970's and he recommended I get "Madman Across The Water", which I will endeavour to source. Brendan had great glee in showing me his collection of retro and antique collectables, including old appliances and a Wertheim Piano, built in the old GTV9 building at 22 Bendigo Street, Richmond in the 1920's – to name but a few.

Monday December 15, 2025

At least 10 killed at Bondi Beach after gunmen open fire into crowd

As this story unfolds, it has now been confirmed that 15 people have died and the shooters were a father and son combine. It was also revealed that the father was in possesion of six registered firearms. The media pack this morning was asking how this person could be granted a licence for all these firearms? My take on this is that from time to time, law abiding citizens who are not on the police radar, snap. These "terrorists" targeted Jews who had gathered in a park to celebrate the Jewish festival of Chanukkah.
I can't help but think – what could motivate these people to carry out such an atrocity, knowing full well that this act would in all likelyhood result in their ultimate deaths? Perhaps the following might.....

At least 70,000 Palestinians have been killed in Gaza by Israeli military actions since October 7, 2023, according to figures from the Gaza Ministry of Health, widely cited by international organizations.

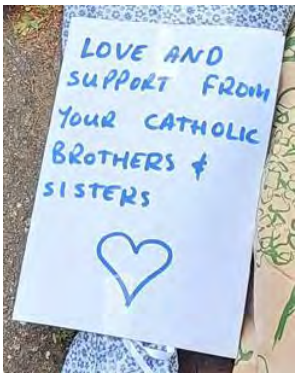
This is enough to piss a lot of people off. That is a very sobering statistic and, I dare say, more attacks will follow. History has shown, time and time again, that there are always consequences.

Monday December 15, 2025

Surrounded by yes-men, Putin sees no reason for real concessions on Ukraine

Boris Bondarev, a Russian diplomat who resigned in 2022 over the invasion of Ukraine, described in an essay how he had a front-row seat as this narrowing of opinion became embedded deep inside the state apparatus. "One of the invasion's central lessons had to do with something I had witnessed over the preceding two decades: what happens when a government is slowly warped by its own propaganda," he wrote. "The war is a stark demonstration of how decisions made in echo chambers can backfire."

I rode my bicycle to Leo's to purchase some salad greens for dinner. On the way home I rode past the Kew Synagogue and noticed floral arrangements had been placed on the front fence.



Lovely to see this support for our Jewish friends at the Kew Synagogue.

Tuesday December 16, 2025

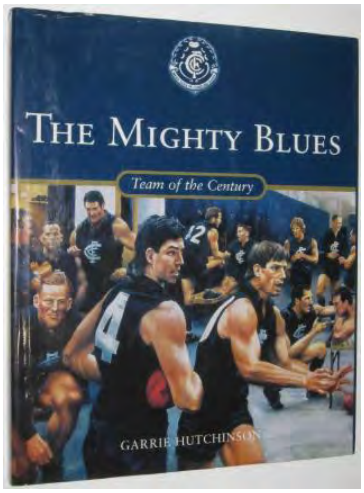
The word "hero" is so often loosely used to describe citizens doing brave things but nothing compares to Ahmed Al Ahmed's bravery in tackling and disarming this terrorist gunman. A bona-fide hero of the highest order. THANK YOU AHMED – OUR HERO OF BONDI.

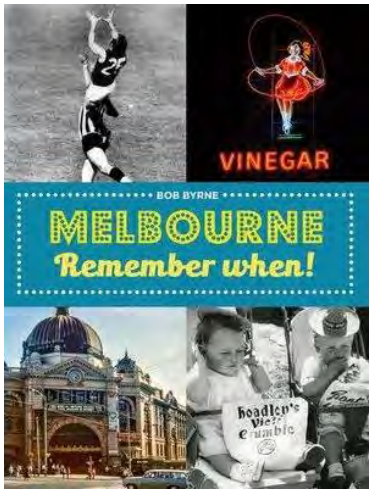
"Faster than a speeding bullet"
Heroes do walk among us.

UNITED IN GRIEF
Mourners embrace at Bondi Pavilion.

Wednesday December 17, 2025

I popped into FMIG imaging for an MRI scan and an x-ray for my back and hip, as part of my knee surgeon determining why my knee replacement continues giving me pain. We then popped into the Salvo's store in Hawthorn and I found two books - The Mighty Blues: Team of the Century and MELBOURNE - Remember When.





Plenty of nostalgia within the pages of these two books.

Friday December 19, 2025

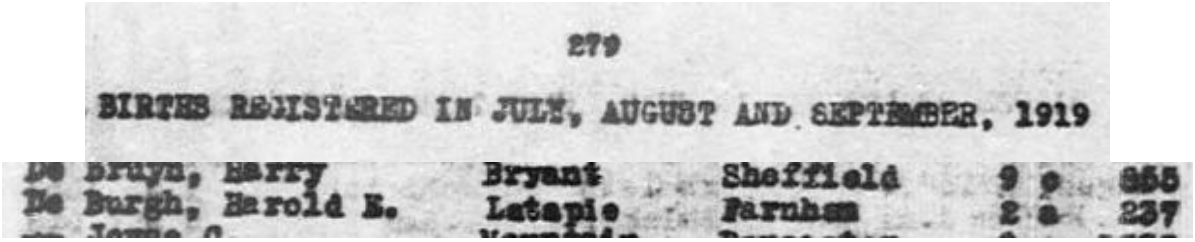
Janny and I attended the MannaCare Christmas Party. We caught the 207 bus and the venue, Mercure Doncaster Tower Terrace, was excellent. Thoroughly enjoyable.

Thursday December 25, 2025

Jann and I checked into the Rendevous Hotel in Flinders Street and then had a wonderful Christmas lunch on the boat Spirit of Melbourne as she sailed up the Yarra. Met and chatted with a lovely couple from the US.

Friday December 26, 2025

Helen sent me some futher information regarding Dad's birth.


279

BIRTHS REGISTERED IN JULY, AUGUST AND SEPTEMBER, 1919

De Bruyn, Harry — Bryant — Sheffield — 9 e 955
De Burgh, Harold E. — Latapie — Farnham — 2 e 237

I am now in the process of tracking down Dad's actual birth certificate, with the help of Helen Mefflin.

Saturday December 27, 2025

We attended Day 2 of the Boxing Day Test with Jeff, Vincent and his mate Nathan. As in Perth, the test was over in two days, with the Poms winning their first test of this Ashes series. A dodgy grass wicket made batting very difficult.

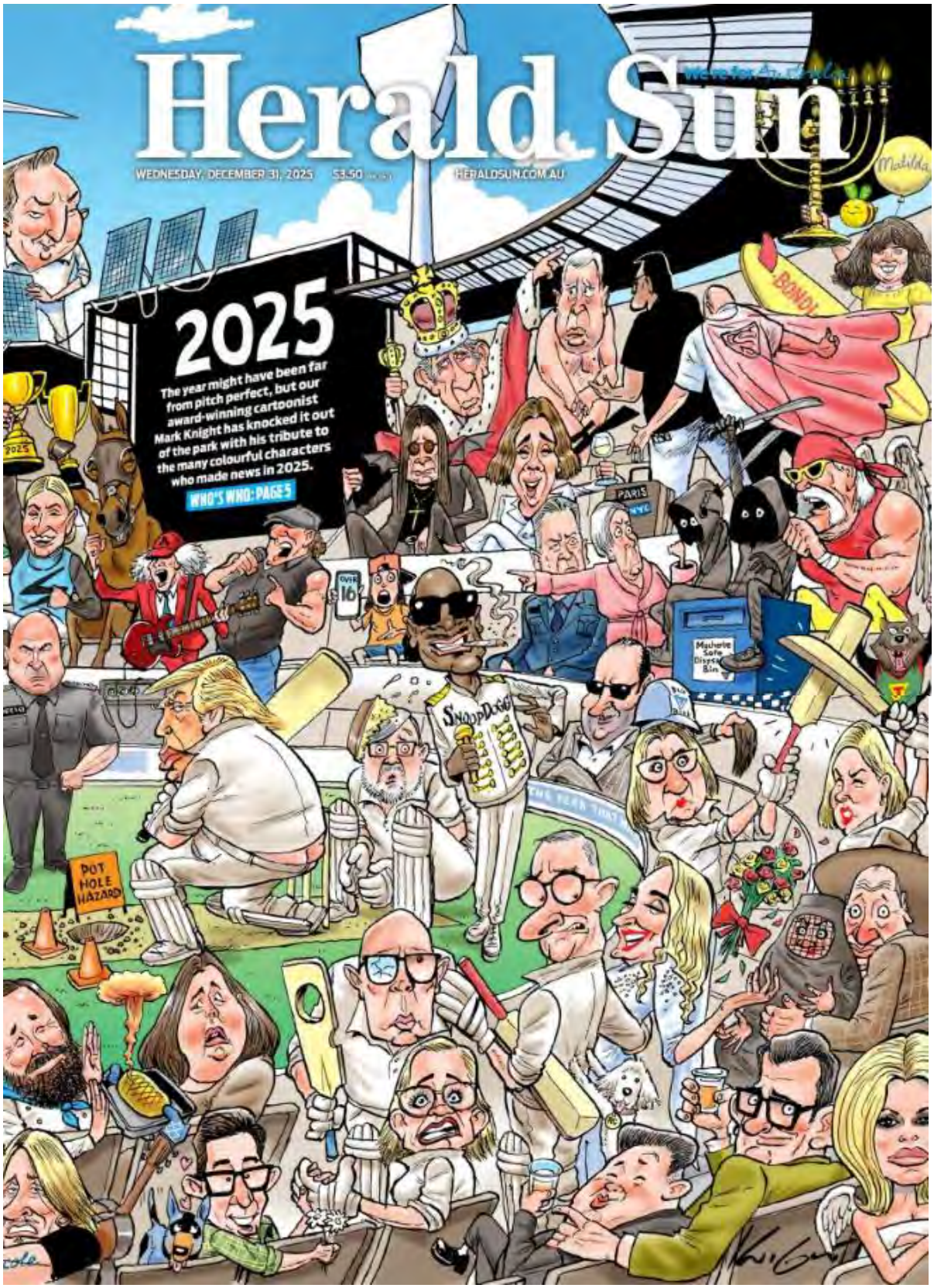
Wednesday December 31, 2025

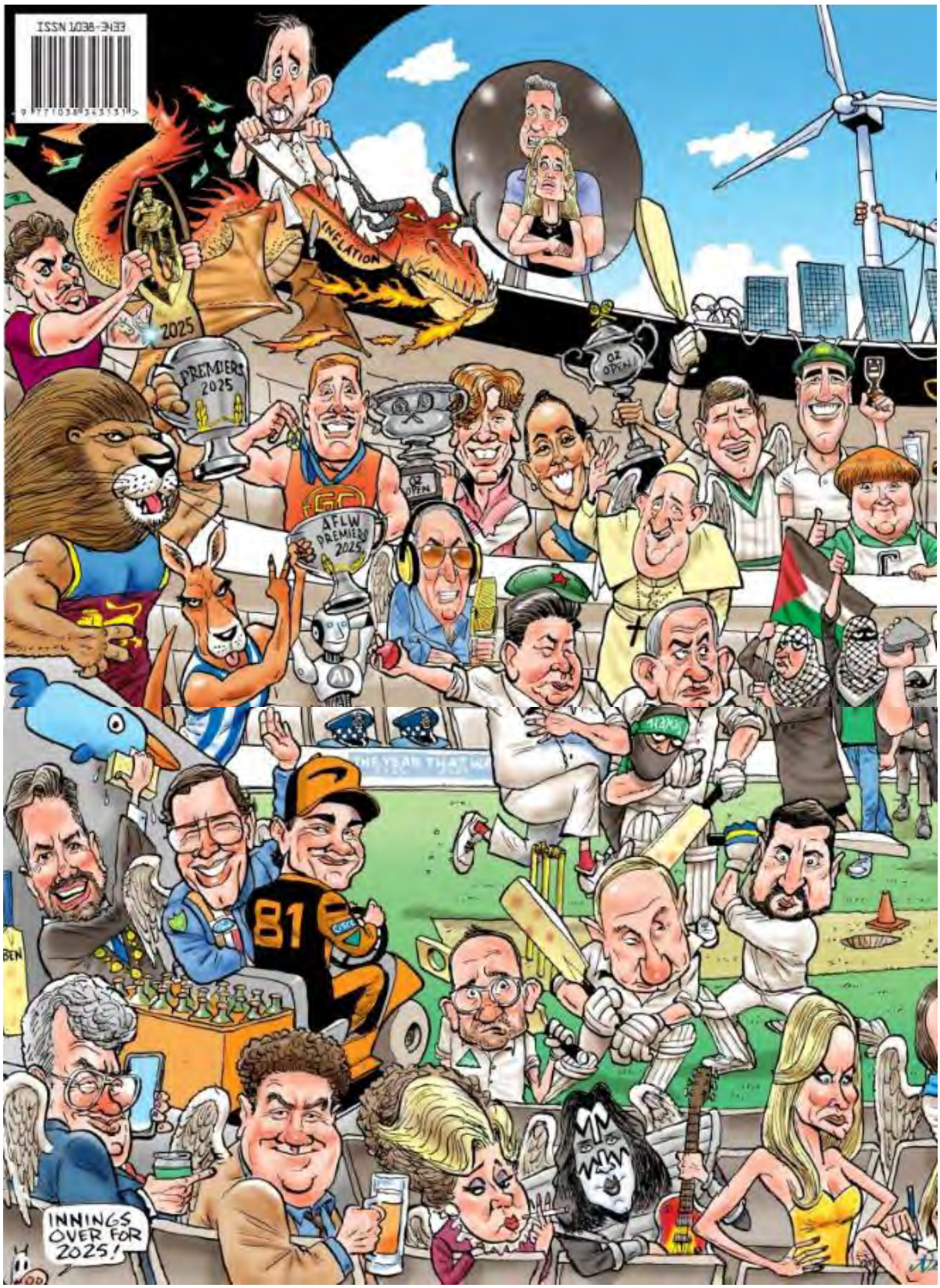
Janny and I saw AVATAR FIRE AND ASH today at Doncaster. Another very impressive epic by James Cameron – truly breathtaking.

★★★★★

At 315 pages, this Journal is getting rather expansive.
Time to start a new Journal.

. . . .


Herald Sun
WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 31, 2025 $3.50
HERALDSUN.COM.AU
2025
The year might have been far from pitch perfect, but our award-winning cartoonist Mark Knight has knocked it out of the park with his tribute to the many colourful characters who made news in 2025.
WHO'S WHO: PAGE 5
BONDI
PARIS
POT HOLE HAZARD



Farewell 2025
The year of hospital admissions and
multiple incisions.
You never realise how much you took
for granted until your body starts negotiating with you.